疯癫与文明
Folie et Déraison

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开篇
Prologue 9TH-01

Folie et Déraison
疯癫与文明

Prologue
开篇

英文 / ENGLISH
So the platonic year

Whirls out new right and wrong,

Whirls in the old instead;

All men are dancers and their tread

Goes to the barbarous clangour of a gong.

W.B. Yeats—Nineteen Hundred and Nineteen

中文 / CHINESE
因此柏拉图年
<So the platonic year>
席卷出新的是非观
<Whirls out new right and wrong,>
而卷入旧的观念
<Whirls in the old instead;>
所有人都是舞者，他们的舞步
<All men are dancers and their tread>
迈入了野蛮铿锵的锣鼓声
<Goes to the barbarous clangour of a gong.>

威廉·巴特勒·叶芝：《一九一九年》

It's the final days of March, and the daylight hours in Ushuaia are shrinking away.
三月已至下旬，随着时间推移，乌斯怀亚的白日时长正在逐渐减少。

Past the busy season, the city is faded and quiet. At this moment, in a café at the end of the world, conversation and laughter are sealed within an airtight glass dome.
这是一座孤寂的城市。此刻，世界尽头的咖啡馆里，所有的谈话与笑闹声都如同被笼罩在一个密不透风的玻璃盏之中。

Recoleta: "A few years ago, I worked as a forest ranger at a campsite in Cuernavaca. There, I met a Mexican surrealist poet."
虚构集：数年前，我在库埃纳瓦卡的露营地做守林员时，认识了一名来自墨西哥超现实主义派的诗人。

Recoleta: "He was especially grateful that I was there. Some animals had wandered into the campground, and I drove them off for him. It wasn't a big deal, really."
虚构集：为了感谢我对他的帮助——唔，一些不足挂齿的小事，只不过是替他赶走了露营地里突然出现的野生动物罢了。

Recoleta: "As a token of gratitude, he elucidated this strange story to me—one that happened in a Sonoran Desert town called Amalfitano back in 1975."
虚构集：言归正传。他告诉了我一个相当离奇的故事：这个故事发生在 1975 年的墨西哥索诺拉州，一个名叫**阿马尔菲塔诺[Amalfitano]的沙漠小镇**。

Recoleta: "The people there adhered to a most unorthodox belief, which centered on the Die of Babylon."
虚构集：故事的内容和当地一个神奇的风俗有关，他们管它叫“**巴比伦之骰**”。

Recoleta: "One day, a researcher with a suitcase arrived in town. She came to study their local customs—an unsurprising reason for a learned intellectual to appear in a remote desert settlement."
虚构集：一位提着箱子的能量扰动学家为了探索、记录这神奇的民俗而踏上这片土地。你们懂的，这类人嘛，不外乎是为了什么学术研究……

Cafe, Ushuaia
乌斯怀亚·咖啡馆

Recoleta: "But little did she know, this dusty old town and its peculiar custom would lead her down an entirely unexpected path—"
虚构集：她却不知道，这座破败的小镇、这些周而复始的习俗成为了她命运中未知一面的开始——

Young Woman: Hold on. Sorry to interrupt, Recoleta. Does this researcher have a name?
同行青年 I：虚构集，我觉得你需要给这个能量扰动学家取一个名字。

Young Woman: She could be Nora, Joanna, or Teresa. Any name really. I feel like you want people focusing on the story, not keeping track of who's who.
同行青年 I：她可以叫诺拉、乔安娜或者特蕾莎……只需要一个名字，这个故事就会变得易于理解许多。

Confusion and shock intertwine on the storyteller's face.
迷惑和震惊的神情交织浮现在故事讲述者的脸上。

Recoleta: Errr, thank you for your advice.
虚构集：谢谢你的建议，玛利亚。

Recoleta: But she isn't a Nora, or a Joanna, or a Teresa. She's just herself.
虚构集：但她不是诺拉，也不是乔安娜和特蕾莎。她不是任何别的人。

Recoleta: A Paracausality Researcher.
虚构集：她就只是这个故事里的能量扰动学家。

Young Man: Hahahaha! You see that look? She's halfway to eating you alive!
同行青年 II：哈哈哈哈！玛利亚，你有看到虚构集说“谢谢”的时候，那咬牙切齿的神情吗?

Young Man: Face it, María. She wouldn't be the freak we know if she listened to anyone.
同行青年 II：一个不容置疑的事实——如果虚构集愿意听你的建议，那她就不会是我们所认识的虚构集。

Recoleta: Ah, alright! So you didn't like the opening, fine. I'll come up with something new.
虚构集：好吧，我会重新思考故事的切入点。

Recoleta: Maybe I'll start with a bit of exposition on the Die of Babylon? Beginning with its origins as a secret relic created by an Aztec priest imprisoned by the Conquistadors—
虚构集：从巴比伦之骰开始怎么样？它来自一位被西班牙囚禁的阿兹特克巫师——

The mysterious die's origins never get a continuation, as her story is interrupted a second time.
遗憾的是，这枚神秘的骰子并没有等来它的后续。故事第二次被打断了。

Young Woman: I don't know if that's going to do much, sister. I'm beginning to think we'll never figure out what you're trying to say with this novel.
同行青年 I：唉……我很抱歉。只是看来这一次，我们也无法读懂你的小说了。

Young Woman: And, well, and this isn't your fault.
同行青年 I：但这并不是你的问题……

Young Man: Ay, goodness! Just tell her, María. We're going back to Buenos Aires!
同行青年 II： 玛利亚，你为什么不直接告诉她呢？这确实不是你的问题，因为我们决定回布宜诺斯艾利斯了！

Recoleta: Back to Buenos Aires? All of a sudden, just like that?
虚构集： 回布宜诺斯艾利斯？可……这太突然了！

Recoleta: Pancho, María, what's going on? Did I do something wrong during our travels?
虚构集： 潘乔，玛利亚，究竟发生了什么事？是我们路上闹了什么我不知晓的矛盾吗？

The startled storyteller eyes her companions of the last two months, searching for reasons.
毫无头绪的女孩观察着同行了两个月的诗人伙伴。

Recoleta: Ah, yes, I know what it is. I've bored you with my constant rambling over this novel.
虚构集： 我明白了，一定是你们对我一直念叨的小说感到不耐烦了。

Young Woman: No, Recoleta. It's got nothing to do with your novel.
同行青年 I： 不，不，不是这样的。你误会了……

Young Man: Don't you get it? We're flat broke!
同行青年 II： 你还不明白吗？我们没有钱了！

Young Man: Why do you think we're stuck here scrubbing tables?
同行青年 II： 不然我们在这儿干什么？我们为什么要在这里擦这些永远擦不干净的杯子、桌子和地板？

The man slams his damp washcloth on the table to emphasize his point. His voice breaks the illusion of silence in the café.
同行青年愤怒地扔下手中的抹布，拔高的音量让整座咖啡馆为之寂静一秒。

Recoleta: Because we can't pay for all the mate we've been drinking.
虚构集： 噢，那当然是因为我们还没还清这几天的马黛茶钱……

Young Man: That wasn't a question, Recoleta. We've crossed the continent, crashed the readings of all those "prestigious poets," and lived the way a real artist should. And, I admit it, it's been just as amazing as you promised.
同行青年 II： 听着，虚构集。成为一个诗人，环游拉丁美洲，在官方大诗人的集会上闹事，这一切确实如你所说的那样酷。

Young Man: But we can't go on living like this.
同行青年 II： 但它只是没法一直持续下去。

Young Woman: You know that we both care about you. And we believe in your novel, too.
同行青年 I： 我们都很喜欢你，也很喜欢你的小说。

Young Woman: I'd be lying if I said this journey meant nothing to me. Getting to ride around the continent on a motorcycle like Che Guevara himself? I never could have imagined I'd get the chance to go on an adventure like this. We got to live the dream!
同行青年 I： 我不想否认这段旅程给我带来的一切。哈，像切·格瓦拉一样骑摩托车环游拉丁美洲？自成年之后我就没有过这样的幻想了。

Young Man: A real dream, except for those days when the motorcycle broke down. Though that was a real tribute to Che's journey too.
同行青年 II： 是挺好的，除了像切·格瓦拉一样摩托车坏掉的那几天。

Young Woman: Don't tease, Pancho.
同行青年 I： 闭嘴，潘乔。

Young Woman: Recoleta, since you invited us to join the visceral realists, we've both found amazing new ways to channel our inner poetry.
同行青年 I： 虚构集，你知道吗？自从你邀请我和潘乔加入本能现实主义派之后，有那么一些时刻，我们确实感觉自己成为了一名真正的诗人。

Young Woman: Even though I still don't understand what in the world you're trying to say with your novel, or for that matter, what visceral realism actually is.
同行青年 I： 哪怕我到现在都不能理解什么是本能现实主义，也从来没有看懂过你的小说。

Recoleta: María, Pancho ...
虚构集： 玛利亚，潘乔……

Young Woman: You told us not to worry about the definitions, to feel and to live in our words. We did just as you said, and it felt great! But ...
同行青年 I： 但就像你说的那样，重要的不是这些，而是过着诗人一样的生活。我确信我们做到了。只是……

She looks out at Ushuaia, feeling a chill.
她看向窗外的乌斯怀亚，感觉到一丝寒意。

Snow falls from the dimming sky. The season is shifting. Soon, gray and white will blanket the colorful houses of this desolate land.
昏暗的天空下着小雪，季节正在蜕变。
很快，灰白色将会掩盖这片土地上所有闪闪发亮、色彩斑斓的低矮房屋。

Young Woman: Now the winter chill is setting in, and the only thing you seem to care about is that little fictional town.
同行青年 I： ……冬天马上要来了，而你看起来像是被困在那个永恒的沙漠小镇里了。

Recoleta: ...
虚构集： ……

The storyteller sinks back against their accusations, searching for words.
审判席上，一直在接受指控的女孩陷入了短暂的沉默。

Recoleta: I appreciate your honesty, friends. I was worried the problem was much worse than all that!
虚构集： 谢谢你们的肺腑之言，潘乔，玛利亚。但我必须说，情况比我想象中的要好。

Recoleta: Winter here isn't as dreadful as you think, and I know just the place to keep us warm!
虚构集： 听我说，我有一个绝妙的点子。我知道一个可以让所有神秘学家都安安稳稳度过冬天的地方。

Recoleta: It was 1520. Arcanist Ferdinand Magellan sailed across unfamiliar waters under orders from the Spanish crown.
虚构集： 1520 年，神秘学家麦哲伦背负着西班牙政府赋予的伟大使命，率领舰队在一片陌生的海域中航行。

Recoleta: Over the vast gray sea, he saw spots of light in the distance—an island. He named it Tierra del Fuego.
虚构集： 遥远处，岛上的堆堆篝火吸引了他的视线——他将这个新发现的神秘岛屿命名为火地岛【Tierra del Fuego】。

Recoleta: For the next 400 years, Ushuaia faithfully served its role at the end of the world: it became the continent's penal colony, and its largest building even served as a prison!
虚构集： 此后四百年间，关于乌斯怀亚的历史叙事就此展开：在这座世界尽头、遥远南端的城镇，它最大的建筑竟然是一所监狱！

Recoleta: Many arcanists were exiled there. By the turn of the century, the arcanist hunt had reached its peak, and the Comala Sanatorium was built.
虚构集：因其偏远的地理位置，乌斯怀亚逐渐成为了流放神秘学家死刑犯的绝佳场所。而科马拉疗养院，就建立于二十世纪初期，神秘学家获罪的高峰时刻。

Recoleta: Well, as you may already know, at that time, most arcanists were believed to be victims of madness.
虚构集：噢，请见谅——在当时，部分，或者说大部分的神秘学家，都被定义为一种疯癫的存在。

Recoleta: The sanatorium was their "Ship of Fools." However, as people began to realize that arcanist blood wasn't a guarantee of madness, fewer and fewer were imprisoned there. By 1947, it was officially closed.
虚构集：毕竟没有人在意“疯癫”的本质是什么，不是么？但人们总会意识到，神秘学血统并不是一种疾病，于是在 1947 年，疗养院就被废弃了。

Recoleta: Until the 1970s, when a group of people from the National Foucault Studies Association returned to the island with new ideas for the location.
虚构集：二十世纪七十年代，被弃置的科马拉疗养院迎来了一次真正的改头换面：一群国家福柯学会的人引进了来自欧洲的先进概念。

Recoleta: They spoke in abstract terms and opaque theories that no one could understand. They rebuilt this place and gave it a new name.
虚构集：没人知晓那些复杂的理论代表着什么含义，总之，他们将疗养院更名，并在旧址上哐哐当当地改造了数个月。

Recoleta: After a long period of construction, the Comala Sanatorium became a prison once more, one designed to hold arcanist criminals.
虚构集：漫长的改造结束了，科马拉疗养院成为了一座真正关押神秘学家罪犯的监狱——

Recoleta: They were taken from the streets and the psychiatric clinics, from secret societies, and rebel groups. Any arcanists deemed mentally or socially unfit would be locked away there.
虚构集：他们在这儿囚禁那些被诊断为精神分裂的嫌犯，那些在各种秘密集会、反对组织中被抓捕的神秘学家。

Recoleta: This association claimed the inmates would receive the best treatment, and they would fully "recover" before being returned to society.
虚构集：协会宣称会给他们最好的治疗，直到他们能痊愈，能回到日常生活里去。

Recoleta: A prison, a medical lab, a sanatorium—call it whatever you want. That is what Comala is today.
虚构集：一所实验性质的监狱，一所监禁性质的疗养院，这就是科马拉全新的面目。

Recoleta: And we could spend the whole winter there. It'd probably be the easiest winter we've ever had. All that it requires is a little bit of acting.
虚构集：我们可以在科马拉度过一整个冬天，保准不会遇到任何经济上的困难。尽管可能要付出一点点的代价……并且需要一点点的演技。

Recoleta: It won't be hard to pass ourselves off as a bunch of unstable crackpots. A touch of madness comes parceled with the gifts of being an arcanist!
虚构集：相信我，伙计们，饰演一个精神分裂的嫌犯没什么难的——这是所有神秘学家天生就掌握的技能。

Young Man: That's your "brilliant idea"? To get us locked up in an asylum?
同行青年 II：你的“绝妙点子”就是让我们都去坐牢吗？！

Young Man: You understand we'd be prisoners there, don't you? It's not like we'd get to put our feet up and relax by a fire!
同行青年 II：再多的花言巧语也掩盖不了它是一所监狱的事实！

Her increasingly agitated companion turns his head aside, catching the faint outline of a patrolling gendarme through the frosted window.
气急的同伴转过头看向一旁。结满霜的玻璃窗隐隐透出街道外的景色：一名巡逻的宪兵迈着轻快的步子，走过众人所在的咖啡馆。

Young Man: You wanna go to jail? Well, see that man over there? Go greet him with a punch to the jaw, then you'll be set for the whole winter.
同行青年 II：你看，现在外面正路过一个进入监狱的绝妙法子：冲出去，揍那个戴帽子的男人两拳，保准你马上如愿以偿。

Recoleta: Hmm. It sounds like a good idea.
虚构集：这听起来是一个好主意。

Young Woman: Recoleta, please! We're not messing with the gendarme.
同行青年 I：冷静点，虚构集，宪兵不是我们能招惹的。

Young Woman: We're going to my Aunt Julia's. She said she can take us in at her vineyard up north near the capital. But it's harvest season. They could use all the help they can get.
同行青年 I：我和胡丽娅姨妈已经说好了。她在布宜诺斯艾利斯周边有一座葡萄庄园，现在正是需要短工的时候，我们可以回去给她帮忙，再多的人也不嫌多。

Young Woman: We'll return to Ushuaia next year, or when the winter has passed. It'll still be great!
同行青年 I：等明年……或者冬天过去了，我们再来乌斯怀亚一趟！那也一定会是一趟好旅程。

Recoleta's expression is as cold as the mate tea on the table.
闻言，一直滔滔不绝的女孩平静下来，脸色疏离得好像桌上冷掉的马黛茶一样。

Recoleta: I hear you, friends.
虚构集：谢谢你们，玛利亚，潘乔。

Recoleta: But respectfully, I must turn down your offer.
虚构集：但我拒绝。

Recoleta: This has been more than just a road trip for me.
虚构集：对我而言，现在的一切不仅仅是一趟旅程而已。

Recoleta: I know sticking around here for the winter won't be easy. But this could be my last chance. What if things change again? I can't just wait for spring.
虚构集：冬天确实要到来了。但万一冬天过去，一切都变化而不复存在呢？也许这是我最后的机会了。

Young Woman: Recoleta ...
同行青年 I：虚构集……

Young Man: What did I tell you, María? She never listens. Wasting your breath!
同行青年 II：我早和你说过了，玛利亚，你是永远不可能说服她的。一切都是白费功夫！

Young Man: Goodbye, Recoleta. I don't think we'll meet again—
同行青年 II：那就永别了，亲爱的虚构集——

Pancho's apologetic words freeze in his mouth.
忽然之间，潘乔脸上的表情凝固了。

Young Man: S**t! Those gendarmes are looking straight at us!
同行青年 II：该死，外面的宪兵好像真是冲着咱们来的！

Recoleta: What?!
虚构集：什么？

The café door swings open.
咖啡馆的门被推开了。

A gust of cold air and dampness sweeps through the room. Recoleta's hair stands on end with the chill as she turns to face the door.
一阵寒意与潮气瞬间席卷了室内，虚构集寒毛直竖，视线不由自主地往门口聚焦。

Gendarme: Stop right there! You three match the descriptions of some intruders at the Poetry Meeting in Pioneer Street!
宪兵：别跑，你们几个！在先行者路的诗会上闹事的那批人！

Recoleta plans a response, only to hear the scrambling sounds of her companions bolting away out the back door.
话音刚落，身边的两个同行青年早已脚底抹油，不见人影。

Recoleta: Just when I thought things couldn't get any worse.
虚构集：这下糟糕了。

The gendarmes are left behind in the cold, but the flustered young writer still dares not stop running.
宪兵已经不见踪影，但狼狈的青年作家仍然不敢停下逃跑的脚步。

Street, Ushuaia
乌斯怀亚·街道

Until she stumbles on a patch of wet and mushy snow.
终于，她摔倒在了湿漉漉的街道上。

Recoleta: Oh! Thank God. I think I lost them.
虚构集：啊……！上帝保佑，他没有追上来……

Vertin: Are you alright?
维尔汀：您还好吗?

Recoleta: Ah, thank you.
虚构集：谢谢你，善良又热心的女士。

Recoleta: Better to kiss the ground than kiss the gendarme's boots, if one must choose.
虚构集：但我没事。不过是在路上狠狠摔了一跤，比被宪兵勒索一顿要好得多了——

Recoleta: Wait a second. Dores? Is that you?
虚构集：噢，德洛丝女士!

Recoleta: Funny how life moves in circles and puts an old friend in my path! How have you been? Are you paying another visit to Comala?
虚构集：您最近过得怎么样？果然，命运就是一个首尾衔接的环，我们又遇见了！这次，您能带我进去科马拉监狱吗?

Vertin: Dores?
维尔汀：……德洛丝?

A name falls from the sky—offered by a girl who has just face-planted and cannot see the figure before her.
一个从天而降的名字——由一位脸着地、看不清面前来人的小姑娘所提供。

Sonetto: Timekeeper, could she mean our Dr. Dores?
十四行诗：司辰，她提到了德洛丝女士!

Recoleta: Emm. Was I mistaken?
虚构集：唔……我认错人了?

She wipes the snow from her face. Still dizzy, she makes out the stranger before her.
线索提供者擦干净脸上的雪水，头晕目眩的她终于看清面前的陌生人。

As her vision clears, it becomes apparent that fate is not a perfect loop. At least, the person holding the suitcase in front of her is not the same woman she met before.
种种迹象表明，命运并不是个首尾相衔的环——
至少面前提着箱子的人不是自己数天前遇到的那位女士。

Recoleta: How strange. I've never seen two people so alike.
虚构集：真是神奇，这世界上竟然存在如此相似的面容。

Recoleta: But please, forgive me. It's been a long day.
虚构集：啊！请原谅我——

Vertin: No need to apologize. In fact, the person you just mentioned sounds like someone we're looking for.
维尔汀：没关系。您能告诉我，您是在哪里见到德洛丝女士的吗?

Vertin: Could you tell me where you last saw her?
维尔汀：……就是您所说的，与我长得有些相似的那位。

Recoleta: Sure, I—*sneeze*—excuse me.
虚构集：当然可以，但——阿嚏——

Recoleta: You're not from around here, are you? Your accents and those clothes give you away.
虚构集：看你们的衣着打扮与口音，你们并不是本地人对吧。

Recoleta: Come with me. I know a warmer place to talk.
虚构集：请随我来。我知晓一个比下着雪的街道更好的谈话地方。

TO BE CONTINUED...
TO BE CONTINUED…

回环的幽灵
The Circling Ghost 小径

The moment armies start to march, the world stands still.
???：一场战争开启之时，世界便开始了原地踏步。

You fight or fall back, charge forward, or run. Those are the only rules on the battlefield.
???：前进，撤退，冲锋，溃败，活在战场上不需要理解其他规则。

I don't see a start time on this report, nor does it state the reason for or the demands of this war.
???：这份报告上甚至没有写它是何时开始的，也没有陈述战争的诉求。

选项 / Choices

1. That's because the war hasn't started yet.
1. 战争还未开始

2. Because this is a war waged with paper and pens.
2. 词句是文学的战场

分支 1 / Branch 1

That's what you think. The scars left on the land may be the most obvious form of destruction, but the true devastation of war is one that develops gradually in the souls of people.
???：当然，你可以这样说。土地的疮痍总是触目惊心，灵魂的徘徊只能让人后知后觉。

分支 2 / Branch 2

Ah, a literary war. Indeed, the violence enacted upon words is often just as devastating as an order on a battlefield.
???：作家施加在音节与词语上的暴力，不亚于一道非人性的军令。

Words must fulfill their duties to their creators, just as soldiers must answer to their commanders.
???: 士兵必须按照军令行事，文字也得跟随作家的意愿排列。

选项 / Choices

1. I still don't see how this relates to what's happening now.
1. 这与现在发生的又有什么关系

You don't? Hmm. The young writers have been exiled—sent down a path with no signs to follow and no destination.
???: 这是一场看不到结局的流浪，年轻的作家可用的道标并不多。

In dark days of bloody conflict, soldiers often find comfort in scriptures and verses—or in letters from their loved ones.
???: 正如在厮杀的间隙，一些战士会捧出宗教的箴言，另一些则会流连来自亲友的书信。

They hold those words close—a fragile piece of home—a brief solace from the roaring of the battlefield.
???: 他们通常将这称为归宿，靠它盖过炮弹的轰鸣声，来提醒自己保持人性。

But, as they fall one by one, they learn the bitter truth. No destiny awaits them but death, that bitter homesickness still weighing heavy in their hearts.
???: 但他们总会意识到自己很可能回不了家，迟早带着思乡病死在战场上。

选项 / Choices

1. I hope they can at least find some peace in their dreams.
1. 一场梦会是最好的良药

In dreams? Maybe. Walking the streets of your hometown, spending a lazy afternoon at the writing desk—dreams can take you anywhere.
???: 当然，梦会带你去往任何地方，不管是老家的街景，还是趴在桌上写书的下午。

But live there too long, and the lines between fiction and reality will blur, and soon you'll never wake up again.
???: 直到你分不清梦和现实，最后忘了如何醒来。

Soldiers crawl through trenches, roll in the mud, and charge to their deaths again and again ...
???: 士兵将在烂泥巴战壕里徘徊一生，士官长将一遍遍地发出送死的军令。

... while words are forever trapped within the confines of poetry, made to live, die, and live again under the golden prophecy ...
???: 而词句将永远逡巡于诗篇的结构里，诗篇永恒复苏在预言的律令下……

Ugh. I can't stand the way poets talk.
???: 诗人说话真是拗口。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

The Circling Ghost
回环的幽灵

《布宜诺斯艾利斯分部交接报告》

Buenos Aires Division: Intake Report 小径

Buenos Aires Division: Intake Report
《布宜诺斯艾利斯分部交接报告》

英文 / ENGLISH

The Buenos Aires Division has received members of the "Storm" Research Team—Ulrich and Regulus. Both are to be temporarily stationed at the division while undergoing basic health examinations.

…

The Timekeeper and her assistant received the message upon landing at Tierra del Fuego and have departed on a mission.

The message source and details of the operation have been reported by Sonetto. Our side currently has no access.

…

Other survivors taken in:

Barcarola
A pureblood arcanist and musician aboard the "Free Breeze."

…

Fatutu
A pureblood arcanist, and a member of the Nukutaeo people.
*Further investigation of her people is required.

…

For the full risk level assessment report, see Attachments 1-35.
中文 / CHINESE
布宜诺斯艾利斯分部已收容“暴雨专项小组”成员乌尔里希、星锑，目前两位成员暂驻分部进行基础健康检查。
……
司辰及其助手于火地岛登陆后接到讯息，已离队执行任务。
讯息来源与该行动详情已由十四行诗自行提交报告，我方目前无权限查阅。
……

已收容的其余幸存者

芭卡洛儿
纯血神秘学家，“自由海风号”游轮乐手。

……

图图石子
纯血神秘学家，努库泰奥族人。
*该族群需进一步调查。

……

危险等级评估报告详见附页 1-35。

乌斯怀亚港口爆炸
The Ushuaia Port Explosion 小径

The Ushuaia Port Explosion
乌斯怀亚港口爆炸

英文 / ENGLISH

The tremors from the explosion at Ushuaia Port shook the surroundings for nearly 10 seconds, after which strong winds carried the flames across the dock area. Thick smoke spread for several kilometers. The explosion injured 12 people, over 200 residents were evacuated, and it took the navy and fire department nearly six hours to contain the fire. Unfortunately, key logistics facilities were reduced to ruins.

Investigations confirm that the explosions originated from three sources: an oil storage tank and two cargo warehouses along the third dock. However, the disproportionate scale of the explosions raises suspicions of arcane skill involvement. It is still unclear whether this incident is related to the Zeno mutiny, and simultaneous investigations are ongoing into other arcanist organizations that may be responsible.

What the hell is this?! You call this a report? This is all you're handing in? Panic is already spreading—do I need to remind you that Ushuaia is our nearest deep-water port? Flames higher than the lighthouse, seawater dyed blood-red—this catastrophe is bringing up painful memories of the war from over a decade ago! Our wounds are being torn open in the worst way possible, and after all this time I gave you to investigate, you're just giving me a list of possibilities?

A few days ago, people suspected those lunatics locked up in prison—but what the hell can they even do besides bash their heads against barbed wire and spout their pathetic rhetoric? Maybe they scribbled out a doppelgänger on a pile of backwards poetry, conjured up a few imaginary hot-air balloons to float them to the port, and then molded a ton of bombs from mud and ice? Fat chance! The only thing you got right was not including them in your list of suspects—otherwise, I'd have you thrown in that prison alongside them!

中文 / CHINESE

乌斯怀亚港口爆炸引发的地面震动持续近 10 秒，随后火势借助强风吞没了港区，浓烟蔓延数公里，爆炸造成 12 人受伤，200 多名居民被疏散，海军与消防部门消耗近六小时控制火势，但关键物流设施已化为废墟。

经查，爆炸源头是第三码头的一座储油罐与两处货运仓库，但港口的原油储存数量与爆炸规模严重不等，怀疑事件涉及神秘术，目前尚不明确是否与芝诺撤离有关，也正在同步调查其他神秘学组织。

这是什么情况?！到了今天你就给我交一份这样的报告？恐慌已经在蔓延了，乌斯怀亚港口是距离哪里最近的一座深水港还需要我给你们强调吗？窜得比灯塔还高的火焰，被映成血红色的海水，所有人都在想起十几年前的战争！现在我们所有人的伤口被人以这样的方式狠狠撕开，我给足你们时间调查，你就给我列几个可能性?

前几天居然还有人在怀疑监狱里关的那群疯子——他们除了拿脑门磕铁丝网磕出一首蹩脚的陈词滥调以外还会干什么？拿写满颠倒诗句的废纸给自己造个分身留在监狱里，再幻想出几个隐形热气球把他们带到港口，最后拿泥土和碎冰捏出大量炸弹？你唯一做对的事情就是没把他们列入你的可能性，否则我们就一起进监狱和那群疯子磕铁丝网吧！

实质与环
More than Circles 9TH-02

More than Circles
实质与环

Sonetto: According to these news reports from Ushuaia, there was an arcane attack on the pier about a week ago. All the ships in the port were destroyed.
十四行诗：据《乌斯怀亚新闻报》报道，大约一周前，乌斯怀亚的码头被神秘术破坏，现在，所有的船只都毁于一旦。

Sonetto: Could Manus Vindictae be responsible for this, or perhaps the Zeno rebels?
十四行诗：司辰，这会和重塑之手，亦或叛变的芝诺部队有关系吗?

Vertin: Hard to say. But things have been suspiciously quiet these past few days.
维尔汀：不能确定。但我们到达乌斯怀亚已有数日，这里平静得超乎寻常。

Vertin: I had been hoping we'd find some clues here in Ushuaia after we lost track of the Manus in the "Free Breeze" shipwreck.
维尔汀：在自由海风号的事故之后，我们就丢失了重塑的踪迹。

Vertin: They would've gone to ground, somewhere remote and off the radar. Indeed, it's possible they've already left Ushuaia.
维尔汀：重塑之手似乎隐匿在某个不为人知的角落，一个普通人不会轻易踏足的地方。亦或说，他们离开了乌斯怀亚。

Vertin: For whatever reason, it seems they haven't been pushing for the "Storm" to happen quite as eagerly as before.
维尔汀：他们再也不像往常一样，在各地积极促进“暴雨”的进程……

Vertin: I have a strange feeling about it all. They're definitely up to something.
维尔汀：这并不是一个好消息。他们有可能在谋划一些更为可怕的东西。

Vertin: For now, it seems our new friend's story lines up with the intel from Moth. It seems the Zeno rebels really did bring Dr. Dores here. We should see if there's anything more she can tell us.
维尔汀：如果目击信息属实，我们就能印证基金会从飞蛾处得到的重要线索：德洛丝女士确实被叛变的伊戈尔一行人带到了乌斯怀亚。

Sonetto: Timekeeper ...
十四行诗：但是，司辰……

The chief assistant hesitates.
第一助手欲言又止。

Sonetto: The Foundation doesn't have any intelligence on Tierra del Fuego. If the Manus really are here ...
十四行诗：自我们来到火地岛以来，基金会并没有足够的时间对这儿展开详尽调查。如果这里和重塑有关系……

Sonetto: Then, we'll be on our own. The closest Foundation Branch is in Buenos Aires, 3200 km away.
十四行诗：离乌斯怀亚最近的基金会分部，在布宜诺斯艾利斯，有 3200 公里……

She reflects without words, a reminder that the chaos caused by Igor's rebellion is still fresh.
最新消息是，那儿目前正忙着处理伊戈尔养子叛变所留下的混乱。

Vertin: Careful and well-considered as ever, Sonetto. It's possible they've already infiltrated Ushuaia, just as they did in Chisos.
维尔汀： 是的，重塑之手完全有能力在这段时间在这里进行渗透——就像他们对待那个名为奇索斯的镇子一样。

Vertin: But the Zeno rebels may still be holding Dores. We can't just wait around. I'm afraid we'll have to take the risk.
维尔汀： 但寻找德洛丝女士的任务同样紧迫。抱歉，我想我们没有时间再等下去了。

Vertin: Ushuaia's not very big. If Manus Vindictae is here, we'll notice. Stay sharp.
维尔汀： 乌斯怀亚并不是一个特别大的城市。只要重塑之手在这里活动过，我们肯定会发现线索的。

Sonetto: Understood, Timekeeper.
十四行诗： 我明白了。

Sonetto: I'll keep an eye out for them and for Dr. Dores.
十四行诗： 我们一定会完成任务的，司辰。

After a chaotic "hunt and escape," the café regains its usual peace.
经过一出“亡命天涯”的闹剧之后，咖啡馆已恢复了往日的宁静。

The gendarmes are gone, and so too are Recoleta's companions.
好消息是，追缉虚构集的宪兵已经消失；坏消息是，连带着她的同伴也不见踪影。

Recoleta: My friends ... They're really gone.
虚构集： 噢……他们真的走了。好吧。

Recoleta: "Goodbye, Recoleta. I don't think we'll meet again—" So that's all I get?
虚构集： “那就永别了，亲爱的虚构集——”那根本算不上一个真正的道别！

Recoleta: We could've exchanged some farewell poems, read them out loud like we used to, and shed a few bitter tears over our heartfelt goodbyes.
虚构集： 我们本可以互换最后一首诗歌，在咖啡馆里轮流念一遍，然后将它永远铭记在泪水里。

Recoleta: But you know what they say: "Goodbyes are only a senseless feast of unhappiness."
虚构集： 但伟大的神秘学家诗人说得对——我们不应该庆祝离别这种不幸，这是不明智的……

Vertin: Pardon?
维尔汀： 唔?

Recoleta: Oh, it's nothing. Never mind. Please, sit down. And could we get a pot of mate with mint, please?
虚构集： 没什么，两位请坐。请给我们一壶加了薄荷的马黛茶！

Sonetto: Thank you.
十四行诗： 谢谢。

Recoleta watches with interest as the two girls take the offered cups of tea.
虚构集颇有兴趣地打量着基金会的女孩们，她们正小心翼翼地接过滚烫的茶水。

Recoleta: So, you're looking for Dores?
虚构集： 你们正在寻找德洛丝女士吗?

Recoleta: I can tell she's important to you from your look.
虚构集： 从你们的表情中，我能看出她对你们来说非常重要。

Vertin: Correct. Is there anything more you could tell us about the day you met her?
维尔汀： 是的。请您详细描述一下，您与德洛丝女士遇见的经过吧。

Recoleta: Of course. It was one of those gray, overcast afternoons ...
虚构集： 当然可以。德洛丝女士与我相遇于一个太阳被阴云遮蔽的下午……

Recoleta: I had just turned onto Calle Bolivar when I ran into this blind woman on my way to the post office.
虚构集：在玻利瓦尔公寓外的街道，赶着去邮局寄信的我遇上了一位盲眼女士。

Recoleta: To be exact, I didn't run into her. She called to me. It felt like a sacred moment in time, like something unworldly. I just stood there, frozen, as she walked up and fixed a loose thread on my sweater.
虚构集：在当时，那位女士突然把我叫住，那是一个奇妙的时刻——她走了上来，将我衣服上的毛衣断线系上，仿佛这是一个神圣而包罗万象的举动。

Recoleta: I stared at her until my fingers went numb and the letter almost slipped out of my hand.
虚构集：我几乎没能握住手中的信封。

Dores: Miss, could you tell me what's in that direction?
德洛丝：这位小姐，你知道那儿是什么地方吗?

Recoleta: I followed her hand as she pointed forward. Strangely, even though I could see she was blind, I had a feeling that she knew exactly where she was pointing and where she intended to go.
虚构集：我看到了那位女士，她的手指精准地指向了一个方向。也就是说，她很清楚自己的目的地位于何处——这对一位盲人来说是多么的神奇！

Recoleta: That's the way to Comala Prison, madam.
虚构集：女士，那里是科马拉监狱。

Recoleta: Is that where you're headed? I could walk you there, if you'd like.
虚构集：难道那是您的目的地吗？如果您想要去那里，也许我可以为您引路。

Dores: Thank you, Miss. But I think I've found my way.
德洛丝：谢谢你，小姑娘……但我想，我已经找到了我该走的路。

Recoleta: She held a typewriter. How ironic that God would give her at once both books and night.
虚构集：神灵同时给予她书籍与黑夜，那可真是一个绝妙的讽刺。

Recoleta: I'm Recoleta. What may I call you, Ms. ...?
虚构集：女士，我可以得知您的名字吗?

Dores: ...?
德洛丝：……?

Recoleta: I hope you don't mind me asking, madam. I didn't mean to pry.
虚构集：请放心，我不是什么奇怪的人……我猜您是一位作家，是吗?

Recoleta: It's only that I have to know. You're a writer too, aren't you? I've been working on a novel, and for some reason, I have this feeling you could be a character in it!
虚构集：恰好我也在进行小说的写作……我总有一种预感，您很快就会出现在我的小说中！

Recoleta: Forgive me. I'm just so excited! I really want to remember this moment. Please, may I have your name? Or whatever you'd like me to call you?
虚构集：您也知道，灵感总是不请自来的，就像一些讨人厌的访客。我很难判断该用什么样的东西招待它们——所以，最好的办法就是全部记录下来。

Dores: Heh heh.
德洛丝：哈哈……

Recoleta: I don't think I'll ever forget her smile. It was soft, kind, almost merciful, and oddly, it felt so ancient.
虚构集：时至今日，我还记得她的笑容——一个出奇的笑，一个遥远的笑，一个跨越了时间、实质与世纪总和的笑。

Dores: No offense taken, Ms. Recoleta. But first, I have a question for you.
德洛丝：也许比较突然，但……小姐，我有一个问题想要问你。

Dores: What does literature mean to you?
德洛丝：对你来说，“文学”代表着什么?

Recoleta: Sorry?
虚构集：嗯?

Recoleta: What a question it was! I wasn't expecting anything like it!
虚构集：这可把我难住了——一个超乎创作范畴的问题!

Dores: You're a writer, are you not? And one, I sense, with purpose. Tell me—where does such powerful motivation come from?
德洛丝：你是一位具有文学追求的作家——但你是否想过，这种追求到底是从何而来?

Recoleta: Actually, well, I'm not sure, madam.
虚构集：……实际上，我不知道怎么回答您的问题，女士。

Recoleta: I have my pursuits and questions, but literature is neither the goal nor the answer to them. Literature is ... Well, it's just literature.
虚构集：就我个人的感受来说，也许文学只是文学，它不能替任何人回答问题……何况是一个关于它自身的问题。

Recoleta: I suppose if I had to define it, I'd say it's a tool, a kindling for fire, or a lens to see through, a means to explore and raise questions from different angles and express our perspectives.
虚构集：我想，也许文学能做到的只是从某种截然不同的角度抛出问题，而这也正是我贸然猜测您职业的缘由。

Dores: And what an interesting perspective you've expressed. I see.
德洛丝：一个很有趣的说法，我明白了。

Dores: But how does literature make you feel?
德洛丝：那么，它给你带来了一种怎样的感受呢?

Recoleta: As though I'm a kid looking through a kaleidoscope for the first time.
虚构集：……感受吗？有时我觉得自己像个学习口语的孩子，正努力地念出书本第一页的第一个词汇。

Recoleta: Well, maybe that's not the best way to put it. Perhaps something a little more subtle.
虚构集：等等，这个比喻也许并不恰当，需要更为精妙、更为直观的……

Recoleta: Just when I was looking for the right word, she turned away with a little wave, heading toward the prison, her feet crunching over the fine snow.
虚构集：就在纠结比喻措辞的时候，余光里的她轻飘飘地挥了挥手，随后穿过乌斯怀亚的细雪，朝监狱的方向走去了。

Recoleta: So, she must've gone to the prison!
虚构集：所以，德洛丝女士一定是往科马拉监狱去了!

Vertin: When did all of this happen?
维尔汀：您是什么时候遇到她的?

Recoleta: About three days ago. I remember the sun came out for a while that day, and the streets were glistening with melting snow.
虚构集：应该是三天前。那天短暂地出了一会儿太阳，街道上全是融化的雪水。

Recoleta: You've heard of Comala Prison, haven't you?
虚构集：如果有需要，我可以再为你们介绍一番科马拉监狱——

Word by word, the question turns from an implication into a declaration.
她的暗示之意已经逐渐变成昭然若揭的明示了。

Sonetto: Three days ago? Then we may be able to catch up with her there, Timekeeper.
十四行诗：三天前……司辰，这意味着我们还有机会追上她。

Vertin: You're right. We need to get there as soon as we can.
维尔汀：是的。我们应该立刻进入科马拉监狱。

Recoleta: Whoa. Amazing! So decisive, assertive—a true show of character!
虚构集：对，就是这样……不对，她竟然就这样斩钉截铁地说了出来……！

Recoleta: You must be the very archetype of a charismatic leader!
虚构集：真是一位有魄力的人物！

Recoleta: What's left to say? Whenever the protagonist has what they want fall into their laps, we're all quick to complain about lazy writers using "deus ex machina" to keep the story together. So let's not dwell on it.
虚构集：我能说什么呢？当一个不可思议的巧合来得过于轻易的时候，我们总是会质疑作者的机械降神，觉得这是一个很烂的桥段。

She reconciles this observation with a silent nod to an unseen author.
她很快和自己还有作者和解了。

Recoleta: But anything can happen in a place like Ushuaia. It's a city where the day may only last four hours and the streets are full of exiled arcanists.
虚构集：但不要紧，在一个白日只有四个小时的季节，一座以关押神秘学家作为历史叙事的小镇，发生什么事情都不稀奇。

Vertin: We appreciate your help, Ms. ...
维尔汀：感谢您的协助，这位——

Recoleta: Recoleta. Please, think nothing of it.
虚构集：无需客气，叫我虚构集就好。

Vertin: Ms. Recoleta, I'm Vertin, and this is Sonetto. We're investigators from the St. Pavlov Foundation.
维尔汀：我是维尔汀。这位是十四行诗，我们来自圣洛夫基金会。

Sonetto: Pleasure to meet you.
十四行诗：您好，虚构集小姐。

Recoleta: Likewise, likewise! Glad that I could help. But listen, ladies.
虚构集：我很高兴我能帮上忙，维尔汀，十四行诗。

The girl winks playfully.
女孩狡黠地眨了眨眼睛。

Recoleta: Everything happens for a reason, and now it's becoming clear. You're going to Comala Prison, and so am I.
虚构集：还有什么比这更巧的事情呢？你们要去科马拉监狱，我也要去科马拉监狱。

Recoleta: Maybe it's fate that brought us together.
虚构集：最终我们都会在科马拉监狱里相遇，也许这就是神秘学家的宿命……

Vertin: What's your business there, if you don't mind our asking?
维尔汀：虚构集小姐，您为什么要去科马拉监狱呢?

Recoleta: Oh, it's a ... writer's mission. But anyway, we're friends now.
虚构集：哈哈，那必然是出于一些文学方面的原因——总之，从现在起，我们是朋友了！

Recoleta: If you're going to Comala, you'll need someone who knows the way.
虚构集：让我们出发吧！我想，你们至少需要一个熟悉当地情况的人来带路。

世界尽头的乌斯怀亚
Ushuaia, the End of the World 小径

A gambling game's been set up in a place unfamiliar to you. Soon, you'll be invited to join the table as well.
???: 一场赌局在你不熟悉的地方开始了。不久后，你也会收到上桌的邀请。

选项 / Choices

1. Give me more details.
1. 说说情况

Hmph ... you seem to have grown quite assertive. But remember this: as a newcomer to the table, you have no privilege to make demands or probe for information unless you're looking to be targeted and isolated.
???: 呵……你的要求越来越明确了。首先你得知道，大多数赌局都有这么一条规矩：中途上桌的人不能问东问西，否则将饱受针对和排挤。

You have to lose a few rounds—pay your "entry fee." Only then can you start to learn the secrets of those at the table. The players' backgrounds, the dealer's habits, and the truth behind the highest-stakes gambler.
???: 直到他输上好几把，交够了“学费”，才会有资格得到问题的答案——比如对家的身份地位，比如庄家的发牌习惯，比如肥鱼的下注比例。

It's baffling to me. Why would anyone travel halfway across the world just to throw away their money?
???: 有的时候我就无法理解这种行为，怎么会有人千里迢迢过来，只为了输掉自己的钱。

选项 / Choices

1. They're seeking victory.
1. 为了胜利

2. They're seeking salvation.
2. 为了得救

分支 1 / Branch 1

That was a rhetorical question. But thanks for answering.
???: 这不是个问题，不过你回答了我，向你致谢。

You're right; the allure of winning is irresistible, even in a game of chance. People blow on the dice, clutch a rabbit's foot, or murmur a prayer, foolishly believing they can sway the outcome.
???: 是的，没有人不喜欢胜利。当骰子在空中旋转，赌徒就开始寻找好运——移动桌角、轻咳两声，再闭上眼做一次虔诚的祈祷……以为自己能左右命运。

How deluded. It's pathetic.
???: 愚蠢，愚蠢又迷信，还有点可怜。

分支 2 / Branch 2

Tsk, disappointing indeed. To think you're entangled in such empty words.
???: 啧，你好像被什么绊住了脚，但那绝不是一颗抬起脚就会爆炸的地雷。

Some are so captivated by these grandiose phrases that they feel empowered when using them. Despite their vapidity, it makes them feel important.
???: 有的人离开了这些漂亮的字眼就活不下去。他们本身无足轻重，但只要讨论起这些字眼，他们就有种自己成了大人物的错觉。

Ha, hypocritical. Delusional, even.
???: 虚伪，甚至自欺欺人。

选项 / Choices

1. Nonetheless, it's a fair game.
1. 反正赌局很公平

Oh, quite the opposite. The odds are rarely equal. Your opponents could have any number of advantages stuffed up their sleeves—a larger stack of chips, easier winning conditions, or even the power to change the rules. Want a fair game? You've got to fight for it, by any means necessary.
???: 不。赌本不对等、获胜条件不一致，甚至连比骰子的规则都在被单方面定义。这里的公平需要被争取，不择手段地争取。

The white suits always play it safe, carefully hedging their bets, while the black robes plot to overturn the table.
???: 那些身穿白色西装的职业牌手们步步为营，靠着四处下注来盈利，而披着黑袍的疯子们正考虑该怎么将桌子掀翻。

选项 / Choices

1. Clever countermeasures.
1. 聪明的对策

Clever? More like cretinous and atrocious.
???: 那不是聪明，那只是愚蠢到了极点，而显得任何改变都是对的。

Once the table's flipped, there'll be nothing but chaos. Who would bother to set it right again? No one.
???: 掀桌之后只会有一团乱，没有人会有耐心把桌子扶起来，陪对方再来一局。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Excerpt from the New York Times
《纽约新闻报》节选

英文 / ENGLISH

Around midnight two days ago, a large fire broke out in the oak forest on the western outskirts. The delay of the warning and the complex terrains full of inflammables in the forest resulted in a fire that lasted a whole night till dawn and 13 deaths.
The victims entered the forest at dusk. Identities of 6 of them have been confirmed: the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers Tomson Joyce, Shelley Gerald, Kelly Keith, and the project manager Russell James. The others' are still being verified.

The Weyerhaeuser used to be a leader in the wood industry, yet it went bankrupt not long ago due to the wood supply crisis these years. After donating the formula of the Resurrection Potion (basic version) to the Maria Sanatorium in New York, the Sacred Heart Sanatorium in Ohio, and the Presbyterian Church Health Center on certain conditions, the Weyerhaeusers sold all of their forestry lands.
On the night of the fire, the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers, and the workers went into the forest to start the disafforestation project before they died. The police has found traces of arcanist's activities and a small amount of gasoline at the scene, which shows the case is an arson attack. More investigations are needed to identify the suspect.

Reporter: James Welles/Dorey Johnson

中文 / CHINESE

前日深夜，位于市郊西侧的橡木树林发生大范围火灾，由于预警不及，林中地形复杂且可燃物繁多，抢险困难，火势持续直至清晨时分才得以扑灭。
　　于当日黄昏时分进入森林的十三名人员全部遇难。死亡人员中已确认身份的六人，包括韦耶豪

瑟夫妇，与其交易者汤姆森·乔伊斯、雪莱·杰拉德、凯利·基思，施工负责人罗素·詹姆斯。其余人员身份均在进一步核实中。

因近年来的木材供应风波，原本根基深重的韦耶豪瑟在前些日子宣告破产。韦耶豪瑟夫妇将基础版起死回生剂的配方，有偿捐赠与纽约玛利亚疗养院、俄亥俄州圣心疗养所与长老会医疗中心三方后，又将名下的所有林业用地对外抛售。

火情发生当晚，韦耶豪瑟夫妇与购买者三人带领工作小组进入森林，预备开始铲除作业，随后遇难。经市警署排查与分析，火情现场的残留有神秘学家活动与少量汽油的痕迹，已可确定为人为纵火案件。更多关于犯罪嫌疑人的信息仍在进一步调查当中。

报道记者：詹姆斯·威尔斯/多丽·约翰逊

岁月遗忘之地
The Place That Time Forgot 9TH-03

The Place That Time Forgot
岁月遗忘之地

Comala Prison Perimeter
科马拉监狱·外围

The gray riverbed winds through the frostbitten earth, disappearing into the distant horizon.
灰色的河床在冰冷的大地上蜿蜒，直至消失在视线的深处。

A neat yet dilapidated circular complex stands alone beneath the snow-capped mountains, as if abandoned by God, humanity, and ghosts alike.
这栋整洁而破旧的圆形建筑，像是被人类、上帝、鬼魂同时遗弃的存在，孤零零地伫立于雪山之下。

Outside the fence, three uninvited guests discuss their plan to get inside.
围栏外，不请自来的三人正商讨着进入的方式。

Recoleta: Behold! Comala Prison! It's the biggest building around. When the sun comes out, it looks like a rusty button stitched into the earth.
虚构集：瞧，这就是科马拉监狱！它是镇上最大的建筑，天晴时，我们总能一眼看到它。它就像一个锈掉的金属纽扣，歪歪扭扭地钉在地面上。

Recoleta: Everyone tries not to pay attention to it, but it's undoubtedly one of the most important places in town. This way, careful, we're heading uphill—Oops!
虚构集：没人在意它，但谁也不能少了它。小心点，上山的路不太好走……噢……！

The young writer begins to slip again. She is prevented only by Sonetto's quick reflexes.
快要滑倒的青年作家被眼明手快的第一助手拉住，避免了第二次摔倒的悲惨命运。

Recoleta: Phew! Thanks. So, my new friends! You're from that St. Palomino's ...
虚构集：呼……谢谢！所以，你是来自圣——

Sonetto: St. Pavlov Foundation.
十四行诗：圣洛夫基金会。

Sonetto: And Vertin is the Timekeeper there.
十四行诗：维尔汀则是圣洛夫基金会的司辰。

Recoleta: Ah, very impressive! Sounds all official and polished! Then, I take it you've already got a way into the prison?
虚构集：好极了，一个伟大的官方称呼。你们一定有办法，堂堂正正从门口进去是吗?

The gate presents an unwelcoming face to the world.
大门紧闭着，它不欢迎任何的访客。

Sonetto: I'll draft a letter to headquarters right away. Once they approve it, they'll notify the local branch in Buenos Aires. From there, they'll need to inform the Argentine government,
十四行诗：我可以立刻撰写一封信件，联络基金会总部。总部通过审核后，将会通知布宜诺斯艾利斯分部，随后通知阿根廷本地政府。

Sonetto: who will then issue us a permit.
十四行诗：届时，基金会可以为我们颁发一张特殊的准入许可……

Recoleta: Excellent! Looks like our bureaucrats still have some worth. No offense intended, of course.
虚构集：听起来，官方机构偶尔还是能发挥些作用的。噢，请见谅，没有针对两位的意思。

Sonetto: Since we're pressed for time, I believe we can ask that headquarters give high priority to our request. If all goes well, we should have the permit in about a month.
十四行诗：如果情况紧迫，相信基金会会加快他们的审批速度——顺利的话，预计在一个月之后，我们就可以拿到那张准入许可。

Recoleta: Ah. How, how expedient of them! But you know what? Maybe we shouldn't bother all those hard-working government officials with these trifling matters after all.
虚构集：……我改变主意了，我们还是不要麻烦官方比较好。

She instantly returns to her previous judgment.
她一秒重拾了自己的成见。

Recoleta: I have a simpler solution that suits the urgency of our cause!
虚构集：比起原地等待那封不知何时到来的倒霉许可，眼下，我有一个更快捷便利的做法。

Sonetto: That sounds great. Oh! Umm, where are you going, Ms. Recoleta?
十四行诗：等等……虚构集小姐，你要做什么？

Before anyone can stop her, the young writer hurls herself up the wall, scaling the side with the sort of skill that immediately suggests she's done this before.
来不及阻止，女孩已经熟练地、手脚并用地爬上墙头。

Recoleta: To the other side of the wall, of course! From Guadalajara to Ushuaia, there has yet to be a wall that could stop me!
虚构集：从瓜达拉哈拉到乌斯怀亚的这一路，没有任何一堵墙能拦住一个想要逃跑的诗人。所有的一切，都只是为了这刻而进行的演练……

Recoleta: Come on, ladies of the Foundation! Sonetto, take my hand!
虚构集：来吧，两位来自基金会的淑女！十四行诗，请把手递给我！

Sonetto looks utterly flustered.
被点名的第一助手显得十分慌张。

Sonetto: Ms. Recoleta, please! A reckless act like that could have serious consequences! Please come back down!
十四行诗：你的行为十分危险，虚构集小姐，请从围栏上下来……！

Sonetto: In fact, while the details of our mission are classified, I should warn you, it may be dangerous, and we cannot guarantee your safety once we're inside. Perhaps it's in your best interest to return to town.
十四行诗：感谢你的引路，根据《暴雨改革：增员与秩序》条约，接下来的任务会有一定危险性。我们无法告知你详情，但你可以返回小镇，在安全的地方等待。

Recoleta: What? That is definitely not in my best interest!
虚构集：这根本没有道理！

Recoleta: What sort of pusillanimous coward would I be if I just abandoned my fated companions here? Of course, I'm going in with you, or rather, you're coming with me!
虚构集：我以为我们已经是命定的同路人了！因为，我也有必须进入监狱的理由——

Vertin: Please get down, Ms. Recoleta. Someone's coming our way.
维尔汀：虚构集小姐，有人过来了。

From the other side of the prison fence, a predator's gaze locks onto the figure perched on the wall.
监狱围栏的另一侧，属于大型捕食者的视线锁定了围墙上鬼鬼祟祟的身影。

???: Stop right there! What do you think you're doing?!
???：你们在这儿做什么？

Recoleta: Damn! It's her again. The jailer of Comala!
虚构集：噢，糟糕，又是她。科马拉的狱卒来了。

Sonetto: Did she say jailer or jaguar?
十四行诗：科马拉的狱卒……？

Jailer: Ms. Recoleta. Haven't I made myself clear? I don't want to see you here again.
狱卒：虚构集小姐，我认得你。并且我衷心地希望不要再见到你。

Recoleta: Jailer! We meet again! What a delightful encounter on such a—
虚构集：嗨，狱卒小姐，我倒是很高兴见到你。你瞧，今天的天气多么——

A sudden gust of cold wind interrupts her.
一阵冷风及时打断了她无意义的寒暄。

Recoleta: —lovely day!
虚构集：多么舒适宜人！

Jailer: Would you please just leave this place alone?
狱卒：你可以现在就离开这里吗？

Jailer: I'll never understand why a promising young woman like you keeps snooping around a prison.
狱卒：我不明白，一位像你这样的小姐，为什么要执着地进入监狱？

Jailer: I can't make this any clearer: trying to break into Comala will do nothing to get you inside, but it will get you into a world of trouble with the gendarmes.
狱卒：我已经告诉过你，像试图闯入科马拉的这种行为，并不足以让你真正坐牢，却会让你在宪兵处吃尽苦头。

Jailer: So, will you stop these senseless break-in attempts?
狱卒：希望你不要再进行无谓的尝试了。

Jailer: Comala Prison is only accessible to academic researchers and journalists, and even they must have official credentials in order to enter.
狱卒：除却官方批准的学会成员与报社记者，科马拉监狱不允许任何外人参观。

Recoleta: Isn't there any other way to pay a visit? I truly do need to get in there.
虚构集：但、但是我必须得找到……

She racks her brain for a plausible excuse.
她绞尽脑汁地思索着理由。

Vertin: Sorry to interrupt, but did you just say "official credentials"?
维尔汀：您刚刚提到了，官方。

Jailer: Yes, you heard me right. And you are?
狱卒：是的。这位小姐，请问您是？

Vertin: I'm the Timekeeper of the St. Pavlov Foundation.
维尔汀： 实际上，我是圣洛夫基金会的司辰。

Vertin: My assistant and I are here to visit Comala Prison on official orders from the Foundation. Here, this is my ID.
维尔汀： 根据圣洛夫基金会的指令，我们前来拜访这座科马拉监狱——这是我的证件，它如假包换。

Sonetto: ...
十四行诗： ……

At the thought of lying, Sonetto's lips fail to open for even a squeak. She goes flush red with embarrassment.
一些无关紧要的先斩后奏，让旁边并不擅长撒谎的第一助手涨红了脸。

Through the prison fence, the jailer examines the pair as she takes the ID in her sizeable paws.
隔着监狱的围栏，狱卒犹豫地接过了那张身份证明。

It is at least a very presentable-looking card, boldly stamped with the seal of the St. Pavlov Foundation.
那是一张很有质感的卡片，上面还印有圣洛夫基金会的印章。

Jailer: This is indeed legitimate.
狱卒： ……的确是真的。

She murmurs.
她喃喃地说道。

Jailer: Welcome to Comala Prison.
狱卒： 欢迎您来到科马拉监狱，维尔汀小姐。

Jailer: Apologies for my earlier behavior. It's been a while since we've had any official visitors.
狱卒： 请您原谅我的鲁莽。事实上，已经很久很久，没有官方相关的人员来过这里了。

国家福柯学会
National Foucault Studies Association 小径

All it takes is one lie to set off a chain reaction, and I'm afraid the butterfly effect has reached you. I have bad news. You've been betrayed.
???: 一个谎言，造成了一系列的连锁反应。因此我带来一个坏消息，你遭到了背叛。

But there's good news, too: a certain flight lieutenant appears to be more loyal to you than to the organization she swore to serve.
???: 但还有一个好消息，那位飞行员中尉对你的忠诚，要比她所宣誓的组织来得多得多。

选项 / Choices

1. Who's the traitor?
1. 谁的胆子这么大?

You know him—the admiral who was pitted against an enemy he couldn't possibly defeat. This conflict has left an incurable ulcer in his once lofty heart.
???: 你认识那位将军。他为自己带来了一位不可战胜的敌人，也在自己的心脏上留下了不可愈合的疽疮。

Yet, as a leader, he must remain unyielding in both body and mind.
???: 坐在那个位子上，他必须把信念扎进脑髓，连着整条脊梁骨都挺得笔直。

Despite his continued victories on the front lines, he made a decision so counterintuitive that even his loyal adjutant found it questionable.
???: 就算前线捷报不断，他也有自己的判断。哪怕连手下的副将都怀疑他下了着臭棋。

The top brass always sees things differently, I suppose.
???: 站得高看得远，上面的人着眼点总是与众不同的。

选项 / Choices

1. Things never end well for traitors.
1. 叛徒不会有好下场。

2. Hopefully, he knows what he's doing.
2. 希望他足够聪明。

分支 1 / Branch 1

You must have heard the story of the Trojan Horse, right?
???: 你应该听过特洛伊木马的故事。

Greek soldiers sneaked past the walls of Troy inside a wooden horse. One Trojan priest tried to warn his people, but was executed by the gods themselves for doing so. Soon after, all the leaders of Troy were killed by the hidden invaders.
???: 但你是否了解那个试图制止木马入城的祭司的下场？还有木马里的将士们如何忍耐着不发出哀号？以及特洛伊将军的葬身之地?

Being killed by your enemy is bad; being killed by your ally is worse. It was an honorless way to go.
???: 他知道这点。被手下打穿脑袋是对那可怜的荣誉的伤害——相对而言选择背叛要好得多。

分支 2 / Branch 2

Don't get your hopes up. He's more like a desperate patient than anything. Weary from the pain of his ulcer, and frantically searching for a way out.
???: 这与智慧无关。只是一位病人受够了疽疮的折磨。于是，他看着窗外，有了一个主意。

In his desperation, he has clutched at an opportunity presented by none other than the Preacher herself.
???: 那是新晋的传道者画上的一片嫩叶，而他也决定争取所能争取的一切。

Deep down, he knows he's backed himself into a corner.
???: 他知道的，是他自己把自己逼上了绝路。

选项 / Choices

1. I'm done hearing bad news.
1. 够了，我听够坏消息了。

Great. I'm done reading reports anyway.
???: 太棒了，我也完成了这次汇报。

I look forward to your wise decisions. We need some good news for a change.
???: 希望你可以一直做出正确的决断，毕竟捷报并不常有。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Excerpt from the New York Times
《纽约新闻报》节选

英文 / ENGLISH

Around midnight two days ago, a large fire broke out in the oak forest on the western outskirts. The delay of the warning and the complex terrains full of inflammables in the forest resulted in a fire that lasted a whole night till dawn and 13 deaths.
The victims entered the forest at dusk. Identities of 6 of them have been confirmed: the

Weyerhaeusers, their buyers Tomson Joyce, Shelley Gerald, Kelly Keith, and the project manager Russell James. The others' are still being verified.

The Weyerhaeuser used to be a leader in the wood industry, yet it went bankrupt not long ago due to the wood supply crisis these years. After donating the formula of the Resurrection Potion (basic version) to the Maria Sanatorium in New York, the Sacred Heart Sanatorium in Ohio, and the Presbyterian Church Health Center on certain conditions, the Weyerhaeusers sold all of their forestry lands.
On the night of the fire, the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers, and the workers went into the forest to start the disafforestation project before they died. The police has found traces of arcanist's activities and a small amount of gasoline at the scene, which shows the case is an arson attack. More investigations are needed to identify the suspect.

Reporter: James Welles/Dorey Johnson
中文 / CHINESE
前日深夜，位于市郊西侧的橡木树林发生大范围火灾，由于预警不及，林中地形复杂且可燃物繁多，抢险困难，火势持续直至清晨时分才得以扑灭。
于当日黄昏时分进入森林的十三名人员全部遇难。死亡人员中已确认身份的六人，包括韦耶豪瑟夫妇，与其交易者汤姆森·乔伊斯、雪莱·杰拉德、凯利·基思，施工负责人罗素·詹姆斯。其余人员身份均在进一步核实中。

因近年来的木材供应风波，原本根基深重的韦耶豪瑟在前些日子宣告破产。韦耶豪瑟夫妇将基础版起死回生剂的配方，有偿捐赠与纽约玛利亚疗养院、俄亥俄州圣心疗养所与长老会医疗中心三方后，又将名下的所有林业用地对外抛售。
火情发生当晚，韦耶豪瑟夫妇与购买者三人带领工作小组进入森林，预备开始铲除作业，随后遇难。经市警署排查与分析，火情现场的残留有神秘学家活动与少量汽油的痕迹，已可确定为人为纵火案件。更多关于犯罪嫌疑人的信息仍在进一步调查当中。

报道记者：詹姆斯·威尔斯/多丽·约翰逊

科马拉流浪记
Comala's Callers 9TH-04

Comala's Callers
科马拉流浪记

Day after day, the Paracausality Researcher hid away in the wilderness outside the town of Amalfitano studying the data she had collected.
关于那些神秘的字句，那些词语中的停顿，能量扰动学家为了研究它们的随机性，日日夜夜躲藏在阿马尔菲塔诺城镇外的沙丘中。

One evening at dusk, a voice called out from outside her cave. She put down the equipment and her tapes and stepped outside. A man stood curiously at her door.
一天傍晚，就在能量扰动学家来回捣鼓那些断电的录音设备与磁带时，有人叫住了埋在沙洞里的她。

"What are you doing here?" he asked, raising both eyebrows. "Nothing ever happens in Amalfitano these days."
“阿马尔菲塔诺已经什么都不剩了。”陌生的男人好奇地问道，“你在这干什么?”

The local introduced himself as the Bank Clerk. He had probably the most amiable face around—bright eyes, lifted cheeks, a soft jawline. It was a face beaming with hope.
来人说他是阿马尔菲塔诺的银行职员。他面上带着一种灵动的希望，仿佛让人可以一直信任，而从不会对所处的境地感到绝望。

The Researcher showed him the spectrums she'd been compiling. "I've been collecting stories about the Die," she explained. "Perhaps they hold the key to explaining the randomness that fate displays."
能量扰动学家解释了那些高高低低的波纹中蕴含的迷人随机性：无限的宇宙与时间尽数潜藏于此，而她正是为此而来。

"Ah, that does intrigue me so!" the Bank Clerk replied briskly, "I'd love to hear all about it. But I have to go. I mustn't be late to the Dune Piscator's funeral." And with that, he left.
“伙计，这听起来真有意思，我愿意一直听你讲下去。但我必须去参加沙漠捕鱼人的葬礼了！”银行职员向她告别。

Three days later, the same footsteps returned to her cave.
三天后，同样的脚步声出现在相反的方向。

"You're back! How have you been? Did you make it to the funeral?" She asked.
能量扰动学家向这位老熟人问好：“银行职员，好久不见。你从葬礼回来了！”

"I have no idea what you're talking about," he replied tersely. "I'm not the man you think I am." His face was drained and gaunt, his eyes sunken deep into hollow sockets. It was as if every spark of life had been drawn out of him, leaving only an empty husk.
“我不知晓你在说什么，我并不是你想象中的那个人。”面前的男人说。他的神色是一种深深的疲惫，如同他的生活已经没剩什么可期待的了。

The Researcher insisted she wasn't mistaken. "I know people by their deeper nature, down to the synchronicity of their spectrums. I've never been wrong before."
能量扰动学家尝试向面前的人说明，她通过频谱中的停顿与随机性来辨认万事万物，因而她绝不会错认任何一人。

"Whatever you say." The man muttered roughly. "I don't understand anything of your high-minded ideas. Just let me go. It's been a long day out there fishing, and all I want now is to collapse on my rickety bed." He trudged off with footsteps that sounded exactly like those of the Bank Clerk's.
“我听不明白这些玄乎的。捕鱼耗尽了我的精力，现在我要回家去休息了。”沙漠捕鱼人迈着与银行职员一模一样的步伐，拖着破旧的渔网朝小镇中走去。

Jailer: As you might have noticed, Ms. Vertin, this facility isn't just a prison. It's also a research center.
狱卒：如您所见，维尔汀小姐，这里是一个特殊的实验机构——

Jailer: Its full name is "the Panopticon of Comala." It was established by the Foucault Association in 1975.
狱卒：它的全名为科马拉实验性全景监狱，由国家福柯学会在 1975 年建立。

Jailer: We've hosted workshops, academic sessions, and even lectures about the Panopticon. You may even have seen some reports about it.
狱卒：科马拉监狱举办过很多的学术讨论，如果您有留意过之前的官方报纸，甚至还能看到关于科马拉的专题报告……

Jailer: Experts of psychoanalysis and scholars from various fields have come here to exchange ideas and seek collaboration in their studies.
狱卒：协会一直保持开放与进步的态度。我们很欢迎任何官方的成员与精神分析专家前来共同探讨。

Jailer: In many ways, the Panopticon is unlike any other prison you've seen before.
狱卒：很快，您就会发现，这里和普通的监狱并不一样。

Vertin: I see. No wonder Ms. Recoleta has gone to such lengths to become a part of it.
维尔汀：谢谢您的介绍，我理解为什么会有人想主动被关进监狱了。

Vertin: Actually, my assistant and I are here to inquire about a prisoner named Dores. Does that name sound familiar?
维尔汀：事实上，我们本次前来，还有一个重要的任务。请问这里是否有一位名叫德洛丝的女士?

Corridor, Comala Prison
科马拉监狱·甬道

Jailer: Not that I recall. Could she have used a different name? What does she look like?
狱卒：据我所知，监狱中并没有名叫德洛丝的囚犯。她是否有别的名字，或者身份？您能描述一下她的外貌特征吗?

Vertin: Hmm. She'd have arrived here about three days ago. It's also possible that she came as a visitor, not a prisoner.
维尔汀：让我想想。德洛丝女士有可能是被囚禁于此的囚犯，也可能是……监狱的客人。我并不确定，她是三天前到达科马拉监狱的。

Vertin: She's a blind woman who always carries an old typewriter.
维尔汀：她是一位盲眼的女士，总是手持一台老式的打字机。

Vertin: She used to be a doctor at the São Paulo Veterans' Residence in Brazil.
维尔汀：她来自巴西圣保罗荣军院，是一名无国界医生。

Vertin: And on the subject of different names, she once wrote for UTTU under the name "Urd."
维尔汀：偶尔，她会编写游记，以“兀尔德”的笔名给神秘学杂志投稿。

Jailer: I don't think I've seen anyone fitting that description. And as I said, we haven't had any visitors in some time. Certainly not in the last three days.
狱卒：维尔汀小姐，您的描述让我困惑了。我没有见过这位女士，三天前也并无任何新囚犯进入。

Recoleta: But I did see her! I saw her walking towards Comala Prison!
虚构集：但我确实是在三天前遇到德洛丝女士的。当时，她正往科马拉的方向走去！

Jailer: Someone must have mixed up their memories. Simply put, I don't recall seeing anyone by that name or with that description here.
狱卒：那消息的来源就显得有些可疑了——

Vertin: I see. Thank you, Miss. Perhaps we made a mistake.
维尔汀：没关系，感谢您的回答。也许是我们弄错了。

Sensing that her current line of questioning is going nowhere, she shifts toward a different topic.
问话无果，在狱卒对她们生疑之前，调查员们马上转移了话题。

Vertin: Ms. Recoleta, you've gone to great lengths to get into the Panopticon. Would you mind telling us why?
维尔汀：虚构集小姐，刚刚您说，您有必须进入监狱的理由，所以为什么要如此执着地进入科马拉监狱呢?

Recoleta: Finally! I've been waiting for you to ask!
虚构集：终于，你终于问出了这个问题！我一直等待着这一刻，维尔汀。

Recoleta: I'm here to find my pen pal in Comala!
虚构集：一切都起因于我那位居住在科马拉的**笔友**！

Vertin: You have a pen pal ... in here?
维尔汀：笔友?

Recoleta: Yes. Six months ago, I went to a book exhibition in Guadalajara and came across the contact details of a few writers. I sent them my novel and asked for feedback.
虚构集：半年前，在瓜达拉哈拉的图书博览会中，我给一些与会的作家寄去我的小说开头，希望能得到他们的回覆和评价。

Recoleta: Looking back, it was a bit forward. But nothing unheard of between writers. A lot of friendships start through letters, you see.
虚构集：这听起来有些冒犯，但很多作家间的友情都是这样开始的。

Recoleta: And Aleph wrote back.
虚构集：就是在这时，我收到了阿莱夫的回信。

Recoleta produces a thick stack of letters from her coat.
虚构集从怀中取出一沓厚厚的信件。

The recipient's address changes with each letter, reflecting the turbulent lifestyle of the wandering writer, yet the sender's address is eternally constant—Comala.
收信的地址一直在发生变化，象征着面前流浪作家波动不断的人生；但寄信地址却是永恒静止的科马拉。

Vertin: And how much do you know about this pen pal of yours?
维尔汀：所以您的笔友，他是个怎样的人？

Recoleta: Oh, well. He calls himself "Aleph," which is a grammatically masculine word, so—
虚构集：噢！这很难形容，但首先“阿莱夫”是一个阳性词。

Vertin: So you assume Aleph is a man.
维尔汀：这就是您将阿莱夫称为“他”的原因。

A reasonable suspicion, but in her experience, never a certainty.
听起来只是一个没什么道理的主观臆测。

Recoleta: Yes. He's probably a poet, a writer, perhaps even an alchemist. He's one of the brightest people I know. There's never been a question that he couldn't answer!
虚构集：其次，我认为他是一个诗人，一个博学的作家，有可能是个隐居的炼金术师。他总是能回答我的任何问题，任何！

Recoleta: I've asked him about religion, politics, history, potions, even critters in length and breadth. Can you imagine someone who knows all those things and so extensively too?
虚构集：你能想象吗？无论是宗教、政治还是历史，或者偏门的魔药与炼金学……从来没有他答不上的范畴。他甚至给了我小说的续写建议。

Recoleta: And he helped me with my novel. He always seems to know the best ways to bring my characters to life.
虚构集：他对小说中人物动态的掌握总是无比精确而真实，就像那些人物都有了自己的意志一样。

Recoleta: Honestly, he's so insightful. I've begun wondering if he's omniscient.
虚构集：也许他真的是个故事天才，或者有着超于常人的阅历……

Recoleta: With his help, my story grew richer and fuller, like a well-tended plant. Strangely, I can't seem to take it any further now. It's as if the roots have been sapped of their strength.
虚构集：在他的协助下，我完善了一版又一版的小说开头，只是这个沙漠小镇的故事，却总是无法得到真正的结局……

Recoleta: I couldn't understand why. So, I resolved that I would see him in person to find out.
虚构集：这太不可思议了。我必须见到他，亲口问他，我的小说究竟哪里出了问题？

Jailer: Again with this story about your uncanny pen pal. I've already told you a dozen times.
狱卒：……关于你的笔友，我已经听过二十遍有余了。

Jailer: It's all very moving, but it still doesn't justify your actions.
狱卒：感人的故事。但很遗憾，我丝毫看不出这种无关紧要的个人琐事能成为你闯入公共权力机关的理由。

Jailer: Writers experience mental blocks all the time. Yet you don't see them trying to break into a prison over it.
狱卒：不少作家都会遇到这样的难题，写了一个美好的开头，却无法让故事继续下去，这没什么特别的。不是仅存在于你一个人身上的困境。

Vertin: She does have a point.
维尔汀：确实如此。

Recoleta: Please, Vertin, Jailer! Have a little mercy, will you?
虚构集：狱卒小姐，维尔汀，你们的说法有些伤人了。

Vertin: Hold on. I've been meaning to ask—why are you only calling her "Jailer"?
维尔汀：我还有另一个问题，虚构集小姐。为什么您一直称呼狱卒小姐为“狱卒小姐”?

Vertin: Don't you know her name? Or do you just prefer addressing people by their occupation?
维尔汀：将职务作为名称，这是作家特有的习惯吗?

Recoleta: Oh, about that—
虚构集：啊！不是，关于这个——

Unexpectedly, it is the jaguar herself that speaks up.
出乎意料，这回却是美洲豹打断了她们的对话。

Jailer: It's okay, Ms. Vertin. I don't mind being called by my job title. I take pride in what I do.
狱卒：请不要在意，维尔汀小姐。狱卒就是狱卒，它是一个很好的身份，也是一个很好的称呼。

Jailer: I'm perfectly fine with just being "the jailer."
狱卒：当然，您可以不用称呼我为“小姐”。我只是一个狱卒。

Recoleta: Exactly! A researcher is a researcher, and a jailer is a jailer.
虚构集：是的，就像能量扰动学家一样，她只是一个能量扰动学家。

Vertin: ...?
维尔汀：……?

Recoleta: Titles and code names often tell us more about people than their ordinary given names, don't you think? Take Sonetto, for example.
虚构集：我的意思是，这是一个值得琢磨的象征。就像你的名字一样，十四行诗。

Recoleta: Your name comes from sonnets, doesn't it? That great poetic form from Italy.
虚构集：你的名字很具有象征性。十四行诗，那是一种伟大的体裁，来自诗一般的意大利。

Recoleta: Some people mistakenly think Shakespeare invented it; some say it was Petrarca ... Though no one really knows when the first sonnet was written.
虚构集：少部分人误以为它来自于莎士比亚，而更多人以为它来自彼特拉克……但没人真正知道第一个写出它的人是谁。

Recoleta: Sorry, I'm straying from my point. You're Italian, aren't you, Sonetto? Is that your real name, or just a code name? Were your parents poets?
虚构集：十四行诗，从你的手势中，我猜你也的确是一位意大利人。这是你的笔名、代称，还是真正的名字？也许你是出生于一个诗人的家庭?

Sonetto: Umm. As much as I'd like to be able to answer your question, I never knew my parents.
十四行诗：嗯……我很愿意回答你的问题，但我其实没有父母，也没有对于家庭的印象。

Sonetto: My earliest memories were of the School of Primary Defense of Mankind. I've lived there since I was a small child.
十四行诗：自我有记忆起，我就在基金会的第一防线学校了。

Recoleta: Ah. My apologies. That was thoughtless of me.
虚构集：……抱歉，我不该这么冒犯的。

Sonetto: It's fine. You meant no ill intent, I'm sure.
十四行诗：没关系，虚构集小姐。如果德洛丝女士确实如你所说，进入了科马拉监狱……

Sonetto: Timekeeper, if Ms. Recoleta was right about Dr. Dores's whereabouts, perhaps the jailer is keeping things from us, or perhaps Dr. Dores visited the Panopticon without her knowledge. Either way, we need to do some digging here.
十四行诗：司辰，无论是狱卒小姐对此并不知情，亦或是监狱方藏匿了德洛丝女士的行踪，我们都应该继续调查。

Vertin: I agree. Let's see if we can talk to some of the inmates and find out what they know.
维尔汀：我认同。在这种情况下，也许询问囚犯们更能获得线索。

As they chat, the corridors—until now endless—reach a terminal point, with voices echoing ahead.
闲谈之间，无穷延伸的水域与甬道终于走到了尽头，前面也隐隐传来喧闹声。

Jailer: Ladies, we're about to enter the main hall of the Panopticon.
狱卒：来自基金会的诸位，我们马上要到达科马拉监狱的大厅了。

Jailer: This is one of the places where the inmates spend their recreation time. At this hour, they're supposed to be in their cells. But what's all that noise?
狱卒：平日，这里是囚犯活动的场地之一。但现在应该不是活动的时间……

The jailer seems to be tense with the apparently unusual amount of noise.
一反常态的嘈杂让狱卒心中有了不祥的预感。

Jailer: Ms. Vertin, could you keep an eye on Recoleta if anything happens?
狱卒：……如果一会儿发生了什么事儿，维尔汀小姐，您能帮我看好她吗?

Recoleta tries her best to avoid the hard stare of the feline jailer by blending into the Foundation team.
狱卒指了指正在努力融入基金会队伍，让自己不那么瞩目的虚构集。

Vertin: Certainly.
维尔汀：没问题。

Recoleta: What do you take me for? I'm not going to run away!
虚构集：什么？我不会逃跑的！

Recoleta: That'd be a pretty cheesy way to start a story!
虚构集：如果我逃跑的话，那可真是一个无比糟糕的故事开头！

Jailer: ...
狱卒：……

Jailer: Please just stay close to me.
狱卒：诸位，请跟紧我的步伐。

致未曾谋面的笔友
To the Pen Pal I Never Met 小径

To the Pen Pal I Never Met
致未曾谋面的笔友

英文 / ENGLISH
Aleph, my dear pen pal, enclosed is the latest revision of my novel. In your last letter, you suggested the role of a bank clerk, marking Amalfitano with the stamp of the capitalist production model—an excellent idea! In this revision, I have incorporated some of my own thoughts as well.

...

That is everything about my novel that I was impatient to share with you. Perhaps you won't mind me discussing something else? Throughout my creative journey, your encouragement and validation have been my greatest comfort when facing the countless closed doors of publishers. The long, futile efforts feel insignificant in the face of your understanding. Oh, my dear pen pal, I say this sincerely—though I suppose such explanations are unnecessary. Perhaps I do not need to waste more ink describing just how much your letters mean to me. So, I ask, with both sincerity and trepidation: may we speak in person—about the dead, the desert, fate, the ending that troubles me so much, and the tides of imagination and insight that carry us both?

Recoleta,

At the poetry gathering in Santafé de Bogotá's open-air theater, Colombia

Miss Recoleta, as I have mentioned several times in my letters—and as you may have already surmised—I reside in a prison. This is why I have never met my pen pals in person. Due to its remote location and cold climate, Ushuaia is not a place people readily visit. People would rather sip a hot drink in one of Buenos Aires's century-old cafés than travel such a distance.

...

Finally, I still wish you the best on your creative path.

Aleph,

At the Comala Prison in Ushuaia

中文 / CHINESE

阿莱夫，我亲爱的笔友，谨此附上我小说最新的修改部分。在上次的来信中，你向我提出了银行职员这一角色，赋予了阿马尔菲塔诺一个资本主义生产模式的标志，这当然非常好！在这次的修改中，我也增加了我的想法。

……

关于小说的部分，上面就是我迫不及待想与你分享的所有内容了，你或许不介意我与你聊些其他的话题？在我创作的途中，你的鼓励与肯定无疑是我面对无数扇合上的编辑大门时最大的安慰，那些漫长徒劳的努力在你的理解面前变得无足轻重，噢我亲爱的笔友，我说这些是出于真心——想必我做这样的解释都显得多此一举，或许我不需要再费笔墨去描述你的回信对我而言有多珍贵。因此，我诚挚且忐忑地向你询问：我们是不是可以当面聊一聊这些——这些亡灵、沙漠、命运、令我苦恼不已的结局，与你我沉浮的想象与见解。

虚构集

于哥伦比亚 圣菲波哥大 露天剧场的诗会

虚构集小姐，如我曾几次在信件中向你提及的而你或许也有所察觉的，我所处的位置是一所监狱，这也是我总是不与笔友们见面的原因。因为其偏僻的位置与寒冷的气候，乌斯怀亚不是一个人们愿意轻易踏足的地方，相比起跨越这样漫长的距离，人们更愿意在布宜诺斯艾利斯的百年咖啡店里喝一杯三十八度四的热饮。

……

最后，依然祝你的创作之途顺利。

阿莱夫

于乌斯怀亚的科马拉监狱

美洲神话
A Latin American Fable 9TH-05

A Latin American Fable
美洲神话

Hall of New Encounters
触发事件大厅

Sonetto: I didn't expect any of this from what we saw outside.
十四行诗：没想到这座环形建筑的内部，竟是这样的……

The mottled yet pristine walls, the still waters, the silent white tower standing within the labyrinth.
斑驳而整洁的墙壁，平静的水域，迷宫中无声伫立的白色巨塔。

Nearby, several prisoners form a circle, some standing, some sitting, engaged in conversation.
不远处，数名囚犯围成一圈，他们有站有坐，正在交流着什么。

Jailer: *sigh* Excuse me for a moment. I have duties that I must attend to.
狱卒：……哎。我要去履行一下我的工作职责，请几位稍等片刻。

With a sigh, the jailer steps into the gathering, causing a strangely subdued reaction from the prisoners.
狱卒一边叹气，一边走进了集会的圈子。出乎意料的是，囚犯们并未表现出任何应有的情绪。

Sonetto: They don't seem intimidated by her at all.
十四行诗：他们并不害怕她。

Recoleta: Yeah, they just look like a bunch of artists having a chat in the garden. And the jailer seems to be like a grumpy neighbor coming over to ask them to keep it down.
虚构集：比起囚犯，他们反倒像一群在自家花园里聊天的艺术家们。而狱卒呢，只是因他们大声喧闹而前来喝止的倒霉邻居。

The "grumpy neighbor" continues her chastising.
面前，“倒霉邻居”正呵斥着“艺术家们”。

Jailer: Everyone, you know the rules. There are to be no after-hours gatherings here without the Physician's approval.
狱卒：我已经说过许多遍，狱医没有允许你们在这里举办集会，你们不能这么做。

Inmate I: You sound softer and softer each time you come to warn us. Why not just join us? Isn't it better than circling around the Panopticon all day?
囚犯 I：哈哈哈……你的每一次警告，语气都会比上一次更温和。要不干脆加入我们？这可比你那无聊的工作要有意思多了！

Inmate I: And look around you. We're in the Hall of New Encounters. What better place to host a salon?
囚犯 I：触发事件之厅可是监狱中最适合举办沙龙的地方。

Inmate II: You're missing out in Comala if you don't even get a taste of our literature.
囚犯 II：如果你不能理解文学的美妙之处，那你在科马拉的人生将会毫无意义。

Inmate I: Exactly. Even those oil-dripping musicians drop by from time to time. Not that they're the kind to care about the beauty of words.
囚犯 I：的确如此。先前，就连那群滴石油的音乐家们，也会偶尔参加我们的集会呢——虽然我敢打包票，他们对文学一点儿兴趣都没有。

Sonetto: Oil-dripping musicians? Timekeeper, could they mean—
十四行诗：滴石油的音乐家？司辰，难道他们说的是——

Before the jailer can say anything else, two of the prisoners simultaneously gesture for her to stay silent, pointing to the center of their gathering.
狱卒正打算再说些什么，闲谈中的两名囚犯却同时朝她比了一个嘘声的手势，指了指围成一圈的人群。

Inmate I: Quiet now, please! The Idealist's salon is about to start.
囚犯 Ⅰ： 请保持安静！理想家先生的沙龙要开始了。

Jailer: ...
狱卒： ……

Vertin: These people seem friendly enough. Why don't we see what this is about?
维尔汀： 看来那边已经没什么危险了。走吧，我们也去看看。

Gathering Participant I: In deserts, in stars, within labyrinths,
集会囚犯 Ⅰ： 我们在荒漠，在恒星，在迷宫

Gathering Participant II: In waters, in mirrors, within reflections,
集会囚犯 Ⅱ： 我们在水面，垂直下沉，照镜子

Gathering Participant III: We dream on death's straw pillow.
集会囚犯 Ⅲ： 我们在村庄，做梦，与死亡贴脸颊

Gathering Participant IV: Here we are, paying tribute to the ghosts,
集会囚犯 Ⅳ： 我们在此处，向幽灵致意

Gathering Participant V: To give it all up again.
集会囚犯 Ⅴ： 我们抛开一切，再一次

All Participants: To give it all up again.
所有集会囚犯： 再一次，再一次

The Idealist: My dear friends, we face a difficult truth: the movement of visceral realism still stumbles in the dark.
理想家： 朋友们，我必须宣布：本能现实主义运动仍处于困难时期。

The Idealist: Our poems, our language, our minds are tangled by a stifling vine—a mundane, stale vision shared among all bourgeoisie.
理想家： 我们的诗歌、我们的语言、我们的头脑、我们的世界，每一个角落都充斥着古旧的幻想：一个属于中产阶级的幻想。

The Idealist: We follow this vision blindly, clinging to the comfort brought by logic and conventional wisdom, and by it, we nip every branch of new art in the bud.
理想家： 这是我们最大的障碍，在这种幻想之中，我们无法创造出任何的新艺术形式——人类的障碍在于过度依靠逻辑和常识。

The Idealist: Poems are perhaps too fragile an outgrowth to develop one's life upon. But here, we may light them like candles at our funerals.
理想家： 在个人层面，诗歌是无用的举动。但在这所监狱里，举办葬礼的我们比谁都崭新。

The Idealist: Let poetry become the bridge between us and the world.
理想家： 我们必须不断地活着，不断地死去，让诗歌连接我们与这个世界。

A lone clap breaks the silence. It comes earlier than all the other cheers from the audience.
突兀而孤单的掌声响了起来：它比其余所有观众的欢呼都来得要早。

Recoleta: As we come back and forth over the boundaries of life and death, the old obstacles begin to take on a new look. With the eyes of poets, we may see behind them.
虚构集： 在不断活着与死去之中，我们将获得一双生死过渡的眼睛。它能越过那些人类的障碍，这是一双属于诗人的眼睛。

Recoleta: You're a visceral realist.
虚构集：你是一位本能现实主义者。

Recoleta: I can't be mistaken. You must be—
虚构集：错不了，这位先生，你一定是——

The Idealist's eyes pierce through the grove of literary enthusiasts, reaching a distant, drifting new world.
理想家的目光穿越了文学爱好者的树林，直达远处漂浮而来的新大陆。

The Idealist: A lonely cowboy. Finally home.
理想家：我记得每一个牛仔回到故乡的神情，记得那种迟来的欣喜。

The Idealist: What a wonder.
理想家：它是一个美丽的奇迹。

The Idealist: You're in time. The salon has just begun. And La Sociedad de Poetas de las Américas isn't like those salons that care more about who's invited than the art. All are welcome here.
理想家：诸位很好运，本次文学沙龙才刚刚开始，并且美洲诗社与那些具备领地意识的正统沙龙不同——我们欢迎诸位的参与。

Sonetto: A literary salon in a prison? Though so far it seems to have more dancing than poems.
十四行诗：一个在监狱里的……文学沙龙，亦或是探戈舞会。还是说，两者兼具……

Vertin: Did you understand what that man just said?
维尔汀：你能理解这位先生方才的发言吗?

Sonetto: No, sorry, Timekeeper. I need a moment to think it through.
十四行诗：暂时还没有，司辰。我需要时间思考一下……

Vertin: Don't worry, Sonetto. I would guess we're not the only ones who are confused here.
维尔汀：没关系的。我想并不是只有我们听不懂。

Vertin: Ms. Jailer, is this that peculiarity about Comala you mentioned earlier?
维尔汀：狱卒小姐，这就是您所说的，科马拉监狱的不同寻常吗?

Jailer: ...
狱卒：……

Jailer: Enough, Idealist. You're still an inmate here, and you're walking a very fine line right now.
狱卒：理想家，停止你的危险行为。你应该意识到这里是监狱。

The Idealist: Oh, I'm quite aware of where I am and what lines I tread.
理想家：噢，是的，正因如此。

The Idealist: This is a prison. The safest place for poets in this part of the continent. One cannot be arrested twice, after all.
理想家：这里可是监狱。纵观拉丁美洲，还有什么地方比这儿的风险更小吗？毕竟我总不能被抓进监狱里的监狱去。

The man's words draw laughter from the other prisoners as they turn to discuss the speech with excitement.
男子的话引得哄堂大笑，囚犯们眉飞色舞，兴高采烈地讨论着刚才的演说。

The Idealist: But please, don't trouble yourself with our little farce. What harm could a few poets possibly do?
理想家：请你放心，狱卒小姐，我们不过是一群诗人罢了，又能制造什么麻烦呢?

All the irregular rhymes and wild contradictions of aesthetics converge into a chaotic countercurrent, crashing against the newcomers.
所有不规则的韵脚、自由野性的美学矛盾，都汇聚成一股纷扰的逆流，冲击着初来乍到的访客。

Recoleta clenches her fists in shock—certain that the man before her is her mysterious pen pal.
虚构集震惊地握紧拳头，她几乎要确信面前的男子就是自己那神秘的笔友了。

Recoleta: Mr. Idealist? Might I ask you something?
虚构集：这位先生，你是叫……理想家对吗？虽然有点冒昧，但我能问你一些问题吗？

Jailer: Hold on, Recoleta. All forms of communication with the inmates must conform to our regulations. We will need to record the conversation and submit it to higher authorities for review.
狱卒：等等！所有与囚犯的交流都必须符合监狱的行为规范。我们会将访谈进行记录并上交官方。

Vertin: I have some questions for the gentleman as well, but we're more than willing to follow the rules.
维尔汀：我也有些问题想要问这位先生。狱卒小姐，我们会遵守规定的。

Vertin: I think the person I'm looking for might have attended this literary salon, or at least talked to some of its members.
维尔汀：身为传记作家的德洛丝女士也许会对这个诗社感兴趣。

Vertin: I'd wager she's spoken to that gentleman. That is ... if she has been here at all.
维尔汀：如果她真的进入了科马拉监狱，面前这位……先生就有可能见过她。

Jailer: I see. Go ahead then. Just watch the time.
狱卒：……我明白了。请诸位控制交流的时长。

As the visitors petition the jailer, Recoleta pushes past the bustling crowd and takes a deep breath.
在访客们低声向狱卒解释的片刻，虚构集已越过纷纷攘攘的人群，她深吸一口气。

Recoleta: *deep breath* Are you Aleph?
虚构集：我就单刀直入地问了。理想家先生，你就是**阿莱夫**吗?

The noisy atmosphere plunges into silence, just like the still waters nearby.
嘈杂的氛围忽然陷入了寂静——就像一旁了无涟漪的水域。

The Idealist is evidently taken aback by the name.
理想家因这个出人意料的名字而诧异，他一边整理领带，一边整理措辞。

The Idealist: Oh! *chuckle* Another visitor looking for Aleph.
理想家：哈，又是一个等待阿莱夫回答的索问者。

Recoleta: So you know him!
虚构集：……你果然知晓阿莱夫这个名字！

The Idealist: Naturally. But I'm not obliged to speak of him to one who does not, stranger.
理想家：当然，只是——我没有义务告诉你。

The salon host is noncommittal, turning toward Recoleta's companions.
沙龙主持人不置可否。他的目光好奇地转向了虚构集的同行者。

The Idealist: And you, young lady in the hat? Are you here for Aleph as well? What a lively day this is!
理想家：你呢，这位戴帽子的女士，你们都是来找阿莱夫的吗？真是热闹的一天！

Vertin: No. I'm looking for a blind woman. Her name is Dores.
维尔汀：我与虚构集小姐有不同的目标。我正在寻找一位名叫德洛丝的盲眼女士。

The Idealist: Ah, yes. I remember. Her writing was impeccable, like an exquisite crocodile-skin handbag in a shop window, elegant, yet condescending.
理想家：噢，我记得她，她的文字干净整洁，仪表堂堂，就像橱窗里精美漂亮的异国鳄鱼皮手包，充满着高贵的凝视、傲慢和偏见。

Vertin: Do you know where she is now?
维尔汀：您知道她现在在哪里吗?

The Idealist: I'm not able to keep track of every inmate here, Miss.
理想家：女士，我不可能时刻掌握监狱中每一位囚犯的去向。

The Idealist: Perhaps you should ask those who have seen everything from above.
理想家：那些代表权力的规则知晓一切，也许它才是你该询问的对象。

The Idealist: Through the glass, where the scrutinizing eyes of power look down on us.
理想家：在这里，一切的行为都无法逃离瞭望塔里面的那双眼睛。

Recoleta: Eyes?
虚构集：……眼睛?

She scans the prison hall. The walls, the great tower, and the pool remain unchanged. Nothing appears amiss.
她下意识环顾监狱的大厅。墙壁、巨塔和水池一如既往，四周没有任何异样。

All the prisoners present nod in agreement, prompting a weary sigh from the jailer.
在场所有的囚犯都深以为然地点头，这让一直忍受着荒唐对话的狱卒叹了口气。

Jailer: Have you taken your medicine today, Idealist?
狱卒：理想家，你今天按时服药了吗?

The Idealist: I'm feeling marvelous! Today, I require no help from them!
理想家：无需服药，我现在状态极佳，谢谢你的关心。

Jailer: I've warned you. It's unwise to act against the Physician's orders.
狱卒：我警告过你，反抗狱医安排的治疗是不明智的行为。

The Idealist: Act against him? No one may act against him here.
理想家：你误会我的意思了。反抗？我们这里没有人想要反抗狱医。

The Idealist: The Physician must have misunderstood us. I suspect he doesn't understand half of what we say. I'd like to know how he got his medical degree. Not by cracking open skulls, I should hope.
理想家：事实上，狱医应该根本听不懂一个字——他是怎么得到他的医学学位的？靠用锯子打开神秘学家的脑壳吗？还是那落后的神秘学家颅相学?

The prisoners exchange knowing smiles.
囚犯们都会意地笑了起来。

The Idealist: What a pity, Jailer! You know, I've always believed you had the soul of a poet, just like us.
理想家：唉！狱卒小姐，也许你仍有机会成为一位诗人，但绝对不是现在。

The Idealist: We've already spoken enough "rebellious thoughts" outside of Comala.
How else do you think we ended up in your nuthouse?
理想家：那些反抗，那些政治的话题，在科马拉外头的时候，我们已经聊得够多了——
不然我们为什么会在这里，成为一名“精神病人”?

The Idealist: We've been here far too long, long after the Junta was removed from office,
理想家：已经过去太久，久到军政府下台，我们仍没能摆脱被成为一名精神病人的命运。

The Idealist: after our home became a deserted wasteland in the aftermath of the Latin American Boom.
理想家：久到文学大爆炸的时代过去，短暂的繁华消失，世界重新变成一片荒芜。

Jailer: What are you getting at?
狱卒：……你到底想说什么?

Recoleta: That power is boring, meaningless. Nothing holds onto power forever.
虚构集：我想他要说的是，有关权力的一切都让人感到厌倦而毫无意义。

Recoleta: And the one true connection we have to life is poetry.
虚构集：和生命真正有关的只有诗歌本身。

The Idealist: See, Jailer? Even an outsider understands our ideas better than you. It's time to open your eyes to reality.
理想家：狱卒小姐，你瞧，一位科马拉的外人都比你更通情达理。是时候适当地听从这些意见了。

The Idealist: La Sociedad is the only way for us to feel truly alive in here, beneath the gaze of those prying, ever-vigilant eyes.
理想家：为了对抗那双无处不在的眼睛，诗社才是我们使自己存在的方式——

Jailer: Idealist! Last warning. Stop this now.
狱卒：理想家！最后一次警告，你该停止这一切了。

The Idealist: Fine, fine! Alright, companions. Sadly, the salon must come to an end, as our jailer insists.
理想家：好吧，好吧！很遗憾，由于狱卒小姐的到来，今日的沙龙到此结束了。

The crowd murmurs and grumbles as they begin to disperse.
底下嘘声一片，聚集的囚犯渐渐散去了。

The Idealist: Dear friends, I do not mean to abuse the power of suspense. I sincerely invite you to come with me to the heart of La Sociedad de Poetas de las Américas.
理想家：至于诸位敬爱的客人，我并不想卖关子，但我诚挚地邀请各位，与我一同前往美洲诗社的根据地。

The Idealist: Perhaps you'll find the person you look for there.
理想家：也许你们要找的人，就在诗社的成员之中。

The man strikes a gesture somehow equally comedic and solemn.
男人做出了滑稽又肃穆的邀请姿势。

Vertin: We'd love to. Umm, only if that's okay with you, Ms. Jailer?
维尔汀：我们很乐意。狱卒小姐，请问我们能前往参观吗?

Jailer: I suppose that's alright. You're already here; we can call it part of your tour. But, please, ladies, take none of their ramblings seriously.
狱卒：……如果你们感兴趣的话，这也是囚犯生活的一部分。只是，请诸位不要把囚犯的胡言乱语当真。

The Idealist: Thank you, Jailer! Please, follow me.
理想家：太好了！让我为诸位引路，请随我来。

南方也存在
El Sur También Existe 小径

Let's take a step back—pull you out of that whirlwind of passion and dreams.
???：那么长官，是时候总结一下这番长篇大论的演讲，以便隔绝激情与狂想对你的毒害。

If you want to make the best call, you need to zero in on what really matters. So, what's your take on that big speech?
???：从纷繁的情报里提炼关键词，有助于你在战场上更有效率地做出战术抉择。

选项 / Choices

1. The Latin American Boom.
1. 文学大爆炸

A sudden explosion that shook Latin American literary circles about 30 years ago. It was destructive—but also gave rise to new life.
???: 一种暴力的军事遗产，在约莫 30 年前移植进入这片文学界，突然具有了与毁灭相对的含义——生机。

Lucky for us, we don't have to worry about shell shock in the literary world.
???: 自然，在虚构的世界里，你不用担心自己患上“弹震症”。

选项 / Choices

1. You don't strike me as someone who knows about literature.
1. 你还懂文学?

It's not about knowing literature. Any soldier with a little experience can deliver a status report. Alright, eyes on the map.
???: 是个士兵都该能做这样的汇报，除非你是动员兵。现在让我们看向地图。

As we speak, ships are lined up on the Spanish coast—but this time, they're poised to make a new kind of discovery, if you can call it that.
???: 消费社会与出版社已经为西班牙铸好了再次发现新大陆的船只。

And here are our new "Columbuses," heading to the docks to embark on their journey.
???: 而他们的“哥伦布”也已向时代的码头行军。

选项 / Choices

1. Who are these new "Columbuses"?
1. 新的“哥伦布”是谁?

Carmen and Carlos, the driving force behind this literary feast between Spain and Latin America.
???: 卡门与卡洛斯，加泰罗尼亚与拉丁美洲之间这场文学盛宴的策划者。

Carmen, with an eye for opportunity and a mind for business, sought out the continent's literary gems and secured generous publishing deals for them.
???: 前者的慧眼识出了拉丁美洲的硕果，严苛而又仁慈地为作家的心血赢得一份回报颇丰的合同。

Carlos, with his deep understanding of market dynamics, brought these works to the eyes of the European public.
???: 后者精通工业社会的运作模式，以诱人的奖金为西班牙语新美洲文学买好了登陆欧洲的船票。

选项 / Choices

1. What happened then?
1. 然后呢?

Then? A golden era began. It all kicked off with a scandal at a military academy, and soon the entire world was captivated by the story of a baby with a pig's tail from a faraway land.
???: 那之后的故事由一场军事学院的丑闻拉开序幕，猪尾巴男孩将飓风吹向了世界。

But we mustn't forget the writers themselves. Fuentes, a towering figure of the Spanish-speaking world, and Cortázar, the writer ever seeing through the eyes of a child.
???: 当然，不能忘记那位文学的外交官富恩特斯，和总“像孩子一样讲话”的科塔萨尔。

And of course, Mario and Gabo—key players in this literary revolution—will forever be etched in the annals of history.
???: 可谁都不能质疑，马里奥与加博是领军人，历史总会优先铭记一场大捷里关键的战略指挥家。

They corresponded regularly, always expressing deep admiration for each other's work. In fact, one even wrote a doctoral thesis on the other.
???: 他们互通书信，钦赞彼此的才华，甚至慷慨地将对方的前半生写入博士论文。

Ah, friendship.
???: 呵，友谊。

选项 / Choices

1. That must have been a proud time for them.
1. 友谊也是光辉的见证

It was.
???: 他们确实以此为傲。

But no matter how explosive the boom was, it couldn't escape its fleeting nature.
???: 但这一切都逃不过“爆炸”早已预示的落幕命运。

With the second imprisonment and self-criticism of a Cuban poet, in came an inexplicable right hook, and bang!—silence.
???: 一位古巴诗人的二次入狱与自我反省，加之一记再无解释的拳头——爆炸之后安静得令人心生恐惧。

The military junta had gripped the poets' throats. The verse of the pioneers was cut off, their voices no longer heard.
???: 接着，军政府的独裁扼紧了后爆炸时代的咽喉，“哥伦布”们还是没能到达预期的目的地。

The bond between two generations was broken, and for the younger of the two, the silence was intolerable.
???: 年轻一代无法与上一代和解，后者成了前者眼中的老古董。

They looked for a new theme, a new idea, a new voice—a new method to speak on their disappointment, their horror, and their anger.
???: 他们再一次找寻全新的写作方式，试图表达独属于他们这一代的恐怖现实。

And they became the new guerrillas.
???: 现在则到处打着游击战。

El Sur También Existe
南方也存在

生者的幻影
Shadows of the Living 9TH-06

Shadows of the Living
生者的幻影

The Researcher awakens in her dune cave, which felt to her as hollow as a tomb. It was a little before dawn.
黎明前，能量扰动学家在形如墓穴的沙丘中醒来。

Stacks of tapes had eaten up her living space, climbing up again and again, each of these spinning reels speaking of stories about that cottage with a blue roof.
磁带逐渐侵蚀了她所有的生存空间，录音反反复复地讲述着关于那座蓝色屋顶茅屋的传闻。

She heard the voice of the Murdered Donkey Driver behind her: "I hear them all, the laughter and voices of generations past. Like dry leaves caught in the cracks of old walls, rustling only when the wind blows through. I wouldn't set foot in that house if I were you."
身后，死于谋杀的赶驴人幽灵说：“我听到过那些嘈杂的声音，那些来自不同年代的声音。如果我是你，我就不会进入那间诡异的屋子！”

The Door-Side Beggar spoke too: "I sleep on the porch every night. Each morning, a dim light glows through the window. But no one ever leaves through that door ... and no one has ever entered."
门槛旁边的乞丐说：“我在屋子外面过夜，每天凌晨时都能看见屋里有微弱的光亮。但从没人进去，也从没人出来。”

Then the Bank Clerk's voice: "It's the story of the 'alter ego.' That house must've been filled with debts no one would return to claim."
银行职员推测：“一切都是有关**另一个我**[alter ego]的故事。这屋子里一定填满了死者的债务和无人偿还的账单。”

The sick old lady, struggling in her bed, whispered: "The house remembers those days, when people vanished in the darkness of night and children were stolen by the storms."
卧床的老妇人声音混杂着忏悔：“这屋子有自己的记忆。它记得那些在夜里失踪的人，还有在风暴中被带走的孩子。”

The Paracausality Researcher had heard enough and drifted back to sleep again. There was only the rattling of the Die of Babylon echoing in her hollow cave.
能量扰动学家听得够多了，于是她昏昏沉沉地睡去。巴比伦之骰在风中、小镇中，在所有的频率中反复回荡。

Gallery of Bewilderment
无人能懂展厅

In a deteriorating activity hall, thousands of floating slips of paper form a blurred, colossal face. It is hard to imagine how the prisoners managed to transform this place into what it is now.
荒废的活动场地内，成千上万张纸条悬浮在空中，构成了一张模糊的巨大面庞。
很难想象监狱中的囚犯们，是如何将这里改造成如今的模样的。

García: I've always wanted to use the element of fantasy to better establish our theme. And I was right.
加西亚： 我一直认为，加入一部分非理性的幻想元素能够完美推进这个主题，如今它已经做到了。

García: Now the stage is captivating, the timing is perfect, and the audience is ideally placed.
加西亚： 令人着迷的舞台，恰如其分的时间，构成精妙的观展人群……

García: Only one imperfect element remains in the scene—the creator, who hasn't stepped away from his creation.
加西亚： 时至如今，我唯一能够审视的，也是唯一不可称之为完满的构成部分……只有身为创作者的自己。

García: No, there's another thing.
加西亚： 不，至少我还有一件事可做……

García, the curator of the exhibition, stands beneath his work, deep in thought, agonizing over every minute imperfection.
监狱中的策展人站在自己的作品下苦思冥想，每英寸的误差都让人难以忍受。

His fellow poets whisper to one another.
与此同时，一旁围观的诗社成员正窃窃私语着。

Roberta: Can you even tell any difference between today's setup and yesterday's?
罗贝托： 考验你的时候到了。你能看出，今天的布置和昨天有什么不同吗?

La Sociedad Member I: Seriously, Roberta? That's a rude question!
诗社囚犯 I： 这是一个冒犯的问题，罗贝托。

Roberta: Well, what's the difference, then?
罗贝托： 所以，究竟有什么不一样?

La Sociedad Member I: Well, I can't see one either. But you should never judge art by how much it changes in a day! It's a creative process.
诗社囚犯 I： 我也不知道。但你不该用如此肤浅的眼光去衡量一件艺术品诞生的过程!

La Sociedad Member I: We might be standing at the edge of the world, but art has no boundaries! We have to show him our support.
诗社囚犯 I： 即使在世界尽头的监狱中，艺术也是不死的！我们应该竭尽所能地支持他！

Roberta: Easy for you to say. He's been tinkering and tweaking for over three months.
罗贝托： 唉……我就跟你说实话吧，他已经在这儿调整了三个月有余了。

Roberta: Even if the Idealist himself entrusted him with this exhibition, he can still be wrong sometimes. This gallery is turning into a dump!
罗贝托： 虽然是理想家先生亲自将活动场地交给他做展览的，但要我说，理想家先生就是太相信他了。这儿马上就要变成垃圾场了！

???: I'm seeing ghosts, all with the same faces, García. All too many. It's easy to get lost in them.
???: 笼罩在这片土地上面容相似的幽灵太多了，加西亚。你会迷失在这些幻影中的。

Having navigated through the labyrinth, the Idealist—the leader of La Sociedad—arrives at the exhibit's entrance, accompanied by several new faces and the jailer.
终于摆脱了迷宫的纠缠，诗社领袖带着数个崭新的面孔与狱卒，一同出现在展厅入口处。

García: Idealist! You're back. Are these new recruits for La Sociedad? You must have had a very successful day!
加西亚： 理想家先生，您回来了。这些都是要加入诗社的新人吗？真是收获颇丰的一天。

The Idealist: It is good to see you, García. How has your vision progressed today?
理想家： 午安，加西亚。今日的布展还顺利吗?

Recoleta: First a salon, and now an art gallery? Is this really a prison?
虚构集： 布展？难道说，这里是一个艺术展厅?!

Her shock is evident on her face, but her words are ignored as García begins to vent his frustrations.
女孩震惊地看向面前的布展人。对方正向着诗社首领汇报自己的苦恼。

García: As you can see, I've strived to push the element of fantasy in my work so that it might reach perfection.
加西亚： 先生，如您所见，它在非理性的幻想元素上已经达到了我的追求……

García: But why doesn't it look like what I imagined?
加西亚： 但我仍然不明白，这张面孔为何总是与我所想象的有微妙的差异?

García: It's like I'm trying to work on a shadow—some shapeless thing that morphs and shifts by the hour. Idealist, am I losing it again? I took my medicine as instructed.
加西亚： 日复一日，它似乎时刻处于变化之中……难道是我又发病了吗？但我明明照着规则得到了药物，也按时服用了那些小圆片……

The Idealist: It was never the pills that blinded you, my dear García.
理想家： 那些药并不重要，加西亚。

The Idealist: You mustn't let tedious routine stifle what's truly alive. Remember, like those old poems, your exhibition must have a timeless rhythm that's never lost to the changing of minds.
理想家： 别让美好的事物因繁复而黯然失色，你的展览该如古老诗篇那般，拥有一种不被打扰的纯净韵律！

García holds out his hands as if grasping something fleeting but fails to hold onto it.
加西亚感觉自己似乎领略了什么，但又抓不住那转瞬即逝的感觉。

García: Sorry, maybe I'm just not getting it.
加西亚： 请原谅我的愚钝。

The Idealist: Look up! There's your answer. Though the sun rises the same way every day, the multitudes of shadows it casts are ever-changing.
理想家：你有注视过那伟大日神的不灭光辉吗？尽管它日复一日地洒落于人间，但每日投影出的面孔却是无穷无尽的。

The Idealist: Isn't that the only constant in life—change?
理想家：这不正是我们所追寻的亘古不变之物吗？

The Idealist: We foolishly pursue stability and constancy, but our very world denies it. Take a step back—take several—and see the truth for yourself, lest you too become lost among the shifting shadows.
理想家：时间，呵！它不过是人类痴迷的一场浪漫的幻象。忘记所谓的视角吧，你只需要想象自己是一位游离于时间之外的旁观者。

García: I get it now! It's the changing light that makes the exhibits seem different from what I expected.
加西亚：我想我明白您的意思了。一切都是因为日照的偏移……！

García: I shouldn't waste my time on freezing things in one perfect moment. Instead, I need to embrace change as it comes.
加西亚：随着季节变换，太阳偏移的微妙角度，造成了展品投影的差异……这正是这张面孔不停变幻的原因……

García: I don't know how to thank you! I won't let you down. I must complete this exhibition.
加西亚：理想家先生……我不知道该如何答谢。眼下，我在这世间唯一需要做的，就是完成它……

García: Complete my "alter ego."
加西亚：完成我的作品，另一个我【alter ego】。

The choice of word widens the writer's eyes.
突然出现的名字，让一直旁听的青年作家瞪大了眼睛。

Recoleta: Did you say "alter ego"?
虚构集：你刚刚说什么？**另一个我**……？

Recoleta: And he called you García. Is that your name?
虚构集：等等，这位先生，你是叫“加西亚”对吗?!

Recoleta: García, where did you learn about this "alter ego"? Do you happen to write under the name —
虚构集：加西亚先生，你是如何得知“另一个我”这个名字的？你是否有个笔名叫——

But the curator has already returned to his work, uninterested or oblivious to his visitors.
但策展人已经走回展品之下，无心顾及来客的任何言语了。

The Idealist: Please, Recoleta! Give our artist some space. Can't you see? He's already returned to his own time and space. He can't hear a thing you say.
理想家：虚构集小姐，别太心急！你没看出来吗？时间与空间在他身上成为了重叠的波纹，外界的话语已经无法掀起涟漪了。

Roberta: He's right. García is deep in his own head now. He won't hear a thing until he's done with whatever he has to do.
罗贝托：新来的朋友，我可以作证，在加西亚完成他的展览之前，都没可能听见你说的任何话语了。

Roberta: Even if the floor were to collapse out under us, I think he would be left standing in the air without even noticing.
罗贝托：每次他开始捣鼓那些破纸屑的时候，除非监狱塌了，他都不会挪开屁股半步。

Recoleta: Ah. Pardon me then.
虚构集：好，好吧。

She takes a step back out of respect.
女孩不甘心地后退了一步。

The Idealist: Alright. My dear guests! Please forgive my late introduction. Welcome to the Gallery of Bewilderment.
理想家：虽然介绍得晚了些，但，无人能懂展厅欢迎诸位的到来。

Vertin: Thank you for inviting me here, Mr. Idealist.
维尔汀：谢谢您的邀请，理想家先生。

The Foundation's investigators have been carefully observing each prisoner's movements since they arrived. But unfortunately, there is no sign of Ms. Dores.
在到达展厅之后，调查员们的视线关注着每一位囚犯的动静。但遗憾的是，她们并没有找到德洛丝女士的身影。

The Idealist: I imagine you're curious about what we do here, in the heart of La Sociedad de Poetas de las Américas.
理想家：亲爱的客人们，你们一定很好奇美洲诗社究竟在这里做些什么。现在，让我来为诸位介绍一番：

The Idealist: We're putting together a magazine—a collection of poems from Comala, our very own Casa de las Américas.
理想家：我们计划在监狱中出版一本属于自己的《美洲之家》，一本科马拉的诗集！

Recoleta: Casa de las Américas?!
虚构集：我没听错吧，你说的是《美洲之家》……?!

The Idealist nods with a smile.
理想家微笑地点点头。

The Idealist: Exactly. Named after its great predecessor! You're a fine mind indeed! At this very moment, all our companions are working on it.
理想家：这位流浪的牛仔，你相当识货。目前，诗社中所有的同僚都正在为了这个伟大的目标而忙碌。

The Idealist: García's exhibition, "Alter Ego," is centered around the birth of this magazine.
理想家：加西亚的艺术作品“另一个我”，正是为了记录这本诗集诞生的过程！

The Idealist: And here, you can see the signatures from all the poets involved, along with a few words they've written for it.
理想家：你可以在上面找到诗社所有成员的署名，还有他们所写下的思绪片段……

The Idealist: Reading it is like looking into the soul of our society.
理想家：这一切共同构成了一张复杂、变幻的面容，属于美洲诗社的面容。

Sonetto: All these signatures ...
十四行诗：诗社所有囚犯的署名吗……?

Sonetto steps forward to examine the perplexing "artwork." In the dim lighting, the enormous face appears to be looming watchfully over the entire room.
第一助手走上前，观察着面前难以理解的“艺术品”。
昏暗的光线下，那张巨大的面容静静俯视着房间内的所有人。

A floating slip of paper catches her attention.
一张漂浮的碎纸片引起了她的注意。

Sonetto: Timekeeper, here! It's Dr. Dores's pseudonym—Urd!
十四行诗：司辰，这上面写着德洛丝女士的笔名——兀尔德！

Vertin: Then she was here.
维尔汀：德洛丝女士，她果然来过这里。

Sonetto pockets the slip of paper dutifully.
第一助手小心翼翼地将那张纸片收好。

The Idealist: Precisely. She used to be one of us, and still is, if I may correct myself.
理想家：是的，如你们所料。德洛丝是诗社的一员，她曾经是，将来是，永远都是。

The Idealist: You can ask around here. Maybe some of our members know where she went.
理想家：至于她如今在监狱的何处，你可以尽情地询问诗社的成员们！

The Idealist: Don't we all miss the familiar faces of old friends? I'm sure they'll do everything they can to help you find yours.
理想家：我相信，美洲诗社的成员们都有一副热心肠。他们会极力促成这场感人的会面。

As he finishes speaking, several enthusiastic prisoners come forward to greet the Idealist.
话音刚落，数名“热心肠”的囚犯都前来向理想家问好。

La Sociedad Member II: Mr. Idealist, I've finished my short story. It's called "Weightlessness." It drifts around the subject like a sheep floating in space! The readers can start anywhere in the story or read it in any order they like!
诗社囚犯 II：堂理想家，我撰写了一篇短篇小说《失重》，并让它就像失去重力的羊一般漂浮于意义之外！读者可以从任意一行开始，也可以按任何顺序解读情节！

La Sociedad Member III: And please take a look at my piece, "Off Limits!" Every word that has been forbidden is either erased or replaced with symbols. It's a one-of-a-kind jarring experience!
诗社囚犯 III：不如先看看我的《禁区》！凡是出现在禁区内的词汇，在该段落内全被剔除或替换成符号……我为读者带来了断断续续的阅读体验！

La Sociedad Member IV: And I've finished a new paragraph! Just wrote it today.
诗社囚犯 IV：请您也过目我今日新写的部分——

A prisoner, wrapped in several meters of manuscript paper, like a strange sort of mummy, squeezes into the crowd.
一名囚犯拖着数米长的稿纸，如同一个自我包裹的木乃伊挤入了人群中。

La Sociedad Member IV: Oh! New faces! Welcome!
诗社囚犯 IV：噢，等会儿？这些都是诗社的新人吗？欢迎大家！

Without any warning, he calmly tears the manuscript to shreds.
猝不及防地，他抬起手臂，平静地将手中的稿纸撕成了碎片。

The fluttering fragments fall like trailing sparks from a fireworks show.
纷纷扬扬的碎纸屑落下，好像一场古怪的礼花。

The abrupt "welcome ceremony" leaves the newcomers stunned, while the "natives" share knowing smiles.
唐突的“欢迎仪式”让新来者们愣在原地。而监狱的“原住民”们神情淡然，脸上浮现出一种见怪不怪的微笑。

Recoleta: Idealist! Did he just ...?
虚构集：理想家先生，这是——?!

The Idealist: This is the writer for the prologue of our magazine.
理想家：噢，这位是目前负责编写序章的同僚。

The leader of La Sociedad, either misunderstanding or evading the question, responds with enthusiasm.
兴致勃勃的诗社首领全然误解了对方的提问。

The Idealist: The prologue consists of a two-thousand-line poem and an introduction that is written in 86 languages to avoid misinterpretation. It represents every second we spend here.
理想家：诗集的序章包含一首两千行的长诗与八十六段不同语言版本的引子，用以保证所有描述的精确性。它将会分毫不差地代表诗社中所有人的每一秒——

The Idealist: Naturally, the arrival of new members disrupts its structure, and so we must begin again from scratch.
理想家：一位新成员的到来意味着整个循环结构彻底地紊乱，每一个标点符号和字母都势必要挪动它的位置。

Recoleta: So he just tore it all up like that because he thought we were joining?
虚构集：他认为我们加入了诗社，所以就把先前编写的部分全部摧毁了吗?

Recoleta: With all due respect, isn't this a little excessive? Heaven knows I'm not one to judge. I've torn up plenty of writing for my novel.
虚构集：请原谅我的唐突，但这是不是有点太拘泥于结构了？唔，也许我没资格说这话，我也忍不住在不断的重写中调整结构……

The Idealist: Please pay it no mind. It may not be an easy task, but he's doing his part.
理想家：别担心，这是一个艰巨的任务，但他完成得很好。

The Idealist: Destruction is hard, but more necessary than you think. Without it, we'd all be stuck in a still and stagnant pond, with all the smells that entail.
理想家：打破一切是很有意义的，我们的所作所为就是在不停地打破旧有的事物。

Vertin: This all sounds very complicated. When will your magazine be finished then?
维尔汀：如果是这样，这部诗集要什么时候才能完成?

Vertin: Forgive me, but I'm not sure what a floating sheep, a jarring reading experience, and all this constant rewriting are meant to express.
维尔汀：失去重力的羊、断断续续的阅读体验和不断的重写……这些行为有什么必要性吗?

The jailer, having remained silent, takes a deep breath and interrupts.
一直沉默的狱卒深呼了一口气，出言打断了这一切。

Jailer: As I've said, Comala is unlike any other prison.
狱卒：我想你们已经发现了，科马拉监狱中囚犯的异于常人之处。

Vertin: Ms. Jailer, do you mean ...
维尔汀：狱卒小姐，您的意思是——

Jailer: This place also serves as a research center. And the prisoners here, for all they claim, are not just "poets."
狱卒：其实，在进入监狱的伊始，我已经给诸位讲解过科马拉监狱的建立理念。这里的囚犯，他们并不是单纯的文学家，也不是所谓的“诗人”。

Jailer: They are arcanist criminals, and each one of them has been diagnosed as mentally ill.
狱卒：被送入科马拉监狱的神秘学家，他们都是患有严重精神分裂的嫌犯。

The leader of La Sociedad remains composed, like an island in a rough sea,
面对狱卒的指控，一旁的诗社首领好整以暇，这位精神病人中的“佼佼者”丝毫不显慌张。

leaving the onlookers to question whether he is entirely mad or the sanest of them all.
他要么是完全没疯，要么是疯得彻底。

The Idealist: You're quite right, Jailer. But let's not forget that mental illness is merely a deviation from the norm. And who decides the norm? You? The Physician? Or the ones outside these walls?
理想家：狱卒小姐，也许你说得不错，但究竟由谁来定义这“疯癫”？是狱卒、狱医、典狱长，还是来自外面的人?

The Idealist: We've been exiled here by the standards of our time, deprived of our roles in the outside world. So please, as we agreed before, I ask you not to interfere with the affairs of La Sociedad!
理想家：我们在社会的规训下被遣往此地，在囚禁的惩罚中丧失身份。请你不要干扰诗社的运作，这是我们一早就定好的约定！

Jailer: These people are visitors, not your new recruits.
狱卒：理想家，她们是前来科马拉拜访的基金会客人，并不是诗社的成员。

The Idealist: But should we not hear their thoughts first?
理想家：但如果她们想加入诗社呢?

The Idealist turns toward the visitors with an urgent plea.
理想家迫切地转向来访者们。

The Idealist: My friends! No one escapes the Eye of Power. We must resist. Stand with us. Pick up your pen and take poetry as your shield before it is too late!
理想家：诸位，加入诗社，加入我们对抗权力视线的实验吧，趁现在，一切还来得及！在权力的视线之下，只有文学是我们最后能苟且的所在。

Recoleta: Idealist, I admire your fight. But I came here with a different goal.
虚构集：理想家先生，我非常敬佩诗社的一切，但我来这里……还有更重要的任务。

The leader of La Sociedad, caught in his fervor, ignores her words and carries on.
陷入亢奋的诗社首领无视了她的婉拒。

The Idealist: "We're the last true owners of an old legend, words now only remembered as myth."
理想家：还记得那句话吗?“我们是最后一代拥有神话的拉丁美洲作家。”

The Idealist: We must stay on the path of literature until I find that transcendental solution ...
理想家：在文学这条道路的最终，我必能寻找到，超越一切的方式……

The Idealist: To invent an idiom that is generic, all-encompassing, yet precise. My poem will be written in this language, leaving no room for doubt or misinterpretation!
理想家：当那一天到来的时候，我就能找到一门包罗万象、又无比精确的语言，不需要模糊我任何的理解，去将那道无尽的、悲伤蜿蜒的诗歌完成。

The Idealist: How blessed is a man with infallible memory! He holds the finer details of each object within him, more vivid than anyone else. In the end, he'll have all the answers, if time allows him!
理想家：试想一下，如果一个人能记住所有的事情，那么只要穷尽所有时间和物质，就能获得自己想要的答案。这是一件多么幸运的事情!

A dream-like expression crosses his face. It briefly seems as if he has become an entirely different person. But his vision is soon interrupted.
他的面上呈现出一种梦幻的表情，仿佛变了一个人似的。可惜理想注定是要被打断的，这一次也不例外。

La Sociedad Member IV: Sweet tank! Sister ... howls! Hermaphrodite—Tango ...!
诗社囚犯 IV：甜美的……坦克……！嚎叫的……的姐姐……！钻石歌曲……不对，沙漠……！

La Sociedad Member IV: They put the whole city ... in the nuthouse!
诗社囚犯 IV：我们所在的城市……就是疯人院……！

Sonetto: Timekeeper, look over there!
十四行诗：司辰，那是……?!

Vertin: Isn't that the prologue writer?!
维尔汀：这是刚刚那位撕碎自己稿纸的囚犯?

Sonetto: There's something off about him. Please, Timekeeper, stay away from him!
十四行诗：他的样子不太对劲……司辰，请小心！

The Idealist: What's happening?
理想家：发生了什么？

Roberta: Idealist! Pablo is having another episode!
罗贝托：理想家先生，糟糕了！巴勃鲁又发病了！

La Sociedad Member IV: Multiples of ... us! You make reality sick!
诗社囚犯 IV：多重……我们！你让现实恶心！

A flash of arcane energy flares up, and the jailer steps into the crowd reactively.
电光火石间，神秘术的辉光已经亮起，狱卒也闪身至众人身前。

Jailer: I could use your help, ladies!
狱卒：各位，请协助我制服他。

The frenzied prisoner is subdued. He lies convulsing in the center of the exhibit hall.
终于，陷入癫狂的囚犯被众人制服，他四肢抽搐地倒在展厅的中央。

Roberta: Poor soul. I'll bring him to bed.
罗贝托：唉，可怜的巴勃鲁……让我先扶着他躺下。

Roberta: Well done, ladies. Aren't you full of surprises!
罗贝托：真是虚惊一场，没想到你们这些新人除了写东西之外，还有这么两下子！

Jailer: What was all that?
狱卒：这究竟是怎么一回事？

Vertin: It seems he had a mental breakdown and lost control of his arcane skill. It appears that every line he recited carried unbridled power.
维尔汀：在刚刚，这位囚犯陷入了神秘术暴走的状态。他所念出的诗句，都成为了释放神秘术的载体。

Sonetto: Usually, only specific lines can channel arcane energy. You can't just force the power into words or craft a poem to serve your purpose.
十四行诗：只有满足苛刻条件的诗句，才能用于释放神秘术，这是可遇不可求的。

Sonetto: Pablo must have a rare gift for identifying empowered lines. When he recited them all aloud, they overwhelmed him.
十四行诗：我想，巴勃鲁先生只是能一眼辨认出那些最适合释放神秘术的诗句，这却恰恰导致了神秘术的暴走……

Roberta: That's right. He's a genius who rides the tides of emotion, just like Arthur Rimbaud.
罗贝托：是的，他是个情感的天才，就像纯粹而野性的兰波，终日被澎湃的情感淹没。

Roberta: We always keep a close eye on him to make sure he doesn't recite anything while reading or writing.
罗贝托：平日里，我们都会小心地控制他，不让他将所写的内容念出来。

Roberta trades glances between the tense jailer and her visitors.
罗贝托尴尬地瞧了一眼严阵以待的狱卒，以及一旁的访客。

Roberta: But, sometimes, things slip through.
罗贝托：但凡事终究有意外——

The Idealist: You must understand how difficult it is for a poet to never taste the words on his own lips.
理想家：希望你们能理解，对一位诗人来说，终生不能读诗，这是多么残酷的惩罚。

Jailer: So, then this isn't the first time. And you're all fully aware of it.
狱卒：看起来他并不是第一次发病了，而你们也完全知晓这个情况。

Jailer: Do I understand you right? Did you just admit that you've been hiding an inmate with a dangerous condition from us?
狱卒：理想家，你们在这里藏匿了一个严重的癫痫病人吗?

Jailer: According to the Safety Regulations for the Panopticon of Comala, he must be sent to the Physician for immediate treatment.
狱卒：按照《科马拉实验性全景监狱安全管理条约》，他必须马上送往狱医处接受治疗。

The jailer's command causes a dramatic shift in the room.
狱卒的话让在场所有囚犯都面色一变。

Roberta: No, no! Wait, we can explain!
罗贝托：等一下……狱卒小姐！我们能解释！

Roberta: He's doing fine! We know how to help him. This was just an accident. We-We got distracted by the new members.
罗贝托：我想是新人的到来让他太兴奋了，一时间忘了要遵守约定！或者说，是，是……

The Idealist: We won't be handing him over to the Physician.
理想家：我们不能将他交给狱医。

The Idealist: No true writer would allow their mind—the most sacred palace of their thoughts—to be opened up to that cold-hearted, ignorant butcher. Even one who believes their inspiration flows from a source beyond the mere substance of a brain would refuse it!
理想家：没有任何一位作家愿意把藏着无限灵感与巧思的大脑区域交由一位冷漠而不可沟通的暴徒——即使是彻头彻尾的唯心主义作家。

Jailer: ...
狱卒：……

The jailer furrows her brows and pulls out her weapon. The air tightens into an invisible thread.
狱卒皱起了眉头，亦取出了随身的武器。无形的空气被拉成了紧绷的细线。

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打字机记录 #P5

英文 / ENGLISH

...

Even though they refuse to discuss the outside world, spending even a few days inside the prison makes clear that the reason they are here is precisely what they avoid speaking about.

Ushuaia is a cold town on the tip of Argentina's southernmost territory. The polar night, the frozen sea, the proximity to Antarctica, the endless winter—it all makes the place seem buried by time and forgotten. It possesses all the necessary qualities of a prison, making it an ideal place to send arcanist suspects diagnosed with mental illness, a place to be forgotten.

Setting aside the true definition of madness and their status as prisoners, what I see in this prison are former poets, writers, and social activists. In their era, some spoke of poetry—then disappeared from society for owning a book by Jean-Paul Sartre. Some incited grassroots rebellion against hierarchical structures—only to be exiled. They were repeatedly questioned, "Why do you read these books? Why do you write these poems?" They were branded "thought organizers" and eventually sent here to partake in an experiment conducted under the names

of Foucault and psychoanalysis. It is nearly impossible to determine whether their "madness" was defined by society because they resisted order, or if it was induced through relentless electric shocks and torture. Or perhaps all of these reasons are one and the same. This reason is often avoided, sanitized, or ignored—because deep down, we all know how deeply it is woven into the fabric of all our lives.

...

At first, they said nothing, but this very act of deliberate avoidance was what truly conveyed their grief and fear.

中文 / CHINESE

……

即使如今的他们对外界环境总是闭口不谈，但只需在监狱中短暂停留数日，你也会发现他们立足于此的原因正是他们不愿再谈及的理由。

乌斯怀亚是阿根廷边界的寒冷小镇，无论是极夜、冰海、咫尺之遥的南极还是漫长的冬天，这一切都使得它似乎沉眠在地层之下，由时间堆积，又被时间遗忘。它无疑拥有构建监狱所需的重要特质，使得一些患有精神疾病的神秘学家嫌犯被送入了这所监狱，让他们随同这里被遗忘的特性一般被遗忘。

抛去疯癫的定义与囚犯的身份，我在这所监狱里真正看见的，是曾经的诗人、作家与社会活动家。在那个时代，他们之中有人曾经谈论诗歌，随后因为存有一本让·保罗·萨特的书而从社会中消失；有人曾经在从属关系中掀起了自下而上的反抗，因此遭到流放。他们曾经被频繁质问“为什么要念这些书，为什么要写这些诗”他们曾经被打上过“思想组织者”的罪名，他们最终辗转至此，参与一场以福柯和精神分析为名义的实验，我们已经很难分辨他们的“疯癫”是因为无法被规训而被社会定义为“疯癫”，还是因为无尽的电击和拷问，或者根本来说，所有的原因都是一体的，这个原因常被逃避、美化或者忽略，因为我们都很清楚，每个人的生活都与这个原因息息相关。

……

他们起初的确闭口不谈，但恰是这样刻意的回避，才真正向我传达了他们的哀伤与恐惧。

激情与谵妄

Passion and Delirium 9TH-07

Passion and Delirium

激情与谵妄

Jailer: This is a serious violation of the rules. I'll have to report this to the Physician, and all of your treatments will need to be reassessed.

狱卒：你们已经严重违反了规定。我需要和狱医重新评定你们的治疗方案。

Jailer: Until a new treatment plan is in place, all members of La Sociedad are confined to their cells without any of their usual privileges.

狱卒：在评估完成之前，请“诗社”的诸位回到自己的房间。接下来的一段时间内，所有人的活动范围将会受到限制。

The jailer heavily emphasizes "La Sociedad," triggering a commotion among the prisoners.

狱卒加重了“诗社”的咬字，这让四周的囚犯陷入了喧哗。

La Sociedad Member II: This is not what we agreed to!

诗社囚犯 II：这，这和当初说好的不一样……！

La Sociedad Member III: You gave us your word! Affairs within La Sociedad were not to be disturbed!

诗社囚犯 III：你们承诺过不会干涉诗社的一切的！

Roberta: Please don't do this!
罗贝托：请你不要这样做，狱卒小姐！

Roberta: Please, he doesn't deserve this. No one does! We don't wanna lose our friend.
罗贝托：不要送走我们的同伴，让他们消失在未知的命运之中，这太残忍了。

The previously convulsing prisoner struggles to his feet.
方才发病的囚犯亦挣扎着爬起身。

La Sociedad Member IV: Please, madam! I swear it won't happen again. I'll take the medicine on time as instructed.
诗社囚犯 IV：狱卒小姐，拜托了……我会好好吃药、好好治病……

La Sociedad Member IV: I promise I won't hurt anyone.
诗社囚犯 IV：我不会影响到、别的囚犯……

Jailer: I'm sorry, Mr. Pablo, but rules are rules.
狱卒：我很抱歉，巴勃鲁。但规定就是……规定。

The Idealist: Before you take this poor man from his friends, may I ask you something?
理想家：狱卒小姐，我想请问你一件事——

The Idealist: Do you know where these inmates go after they see the Physician?
理想家：你是否知晓，所有那些被送往狱医处的囚犯，他们最终去了哪里?

Jailer: ...
狱卒：……

Jailer: My duty is to keep order here. What happens beyond these walls is not my concern.
狱卒：我并没有再见过他们。这不是我负责的范畴……

Jailer: Perhaps they've recovered from the Physician's treatment and were returned to society.
狱卒：在接受狱医梅林先生的治疗后，他们的身心状态也许已经逐渐恢复，并已经重新融入社会，回归正常生活。

The jailer's expression relaxes.
狱卒的面色有所松动。

The Idealist: Within these walls, the only truth we know is this: no one returns from the clinic of the Physician of Comala.
理想家：是的，所有被送去“治疗”的人，最终都从监狱里面消失了。他们再也没有在科马拉里出现过。

The Idealist: Are you certain this "treatment" they received is really a cure?
理想家：但你能肯定地告诉我，狱卒小姐，这种消失，真的是痊愈吗?

Roberta: Pablo is harmless. He-He's just a writer who has a talent for finding words and poems. That's all.
罗贝托：巴勃鲁他……只是一个有诗人天赋的神秘学家。

Roberta: Please, let him stay. We'll look after him. He can have our share of the medicine. We'll keep him in check.
罗贝托：狱卒小姐，求您网开一面！我们会让出自己的药品份额，好好看管他。

Jailer: But this doesn't conform to our regulations.
狱卒：可是……这，这并不符合科马拉的规定。

???: Still as arrogant as ever, Idealist.
???：你太狂妄了，理想家。

???: One day, you'll get us all killed.
???：你的决定会害了我们所有人。

A stranger enters the exhibition hall. As she arrives, the jailer exhales with relief.
一名陌生的囚犯从展厅入口走出。随着来人的出现，狱卒肉眼可见地松了口气。

Jailer: Ah, it's you. I'm glad to see you here.
狱卒：是你，奥克塔维奥。

Vertin: Who is that?
维尔汀：这位小姐是?

Jailer: That's Octavia, one of our model inmates. She's been a great help in the past.
狱卒：奥克塔维奥在许多方面帮到了我们，她理应是囚犯们的模范对象。

Jailer: If you're interested in prison literature, I'd suggest talking to her instead of the Idealist.
狱卒：事实上，如果你们需要了解囚犯的文学生活，我更建议诸位与她而非理想家接触。

Vertin: So, she's a writer, too.
维尔汀：所以，奥克塔维奥小姐也是一位作家。

Recoleta: Who would've thought! This place has got writers coming out of the woodwork!
虚构集：真有意思，又是一个生面孔！我还以为科马拉中的所有作家都在诗社里了。

Recoleta: I thought it would be easy to find my writer friend in a prison. But what are the odds that I'd break into a place absolutely lousy with them?
虚构集：我本来以为在监狱中寻找一位作家并不是一件难事。

Jailer: She used to be in their gatherings, until she got tired of their nonsense and started her own faction.
狱卒：她的确是诗社的成员，只是不再参与这种无聊的集会了——她成立了所谓另一派的文学派系，并且拉拢了不少囚犯过去。

The new arrival brings out a change in the Idealist. He clicks his tongue imperceptibly.
新生的派系领袖出场，令理想家不可察觉地啧舌。

The Idealist: What are you doing here, Octavia? Haven't you heard? The era of chieftains, ghosts, and plantation stories is over. Visceral realism is the future!
理想家：奥克塔维奥，你来这儿干什么？属于族长、鬼魂和种植园故事的年代已经过去了，现在是本能现实主义掌控着拉丁美洲！

Octavia: Ha. And has this brilliant "visceral realism" helped you finish any of these poems?
奥克塔维奥：哼，你还真是一如既往地热衷于装腔作势。你那不知所云的“本能现实主义”，帮你写完那首长诗了吗?

Octavia: What a waste of time. I'm not interested in your movement or arguing with you.
奥克塔维奥：算了……我不想跟你胡扯，也对反驳你的创作理念没有兴趣。

Octavia: I just walked by and happened to witness another episode of your brutal arrogance.
奥克塔维奥：方才我听到这儿的喧闹声，然后不得不目睹了你对巴勃鲁所做的狂妄行为。

Octavia: And I'm not about to just stand aside and watch you repeat your mistakes!
奥克塔维奥：我郑重地警告你，理想家，我绝不允许以往的悲剧再发生一次。

Octavia: I'm taking Pablo to the Physician. Care to lend a hand, Ms. Jailer?
奥克塔维奥：我要把巴勃鲁送到狱医先生那儿去。狱卒小姐，请帮助我！

The Idealist: We agreed to mind our own business. Are you breaking our agreement?
理想家：这完全打破了我们之前河水不犯井水的约定。

The Idealist: No one, no one will be allowed to erase a word from our poems!
理想家：无论是你还是狱医，都别想从美洲诗社中抹去长诗的任何一个词汇！

Jailer: Stand down, both of you!
狱卒：奥克塔维奥，理想家，你们都冷静一些！

Their heated debate continues without any concern for the jailer's warning.
但陷入激烈争辩的二人，根本无心顾及来自狱卒的警告。

Octavia: You've never listened. I pity your followers—to be led by such a reckless megalomaniac! Do you even think about the consequences of your actions?
奥克塔维奥：自始至终，你从没有听过我或其他人的任何一句劝诫。可笑的是，你根本不知道之后会发生什么。

Octavia: We fought hard to earn the freedom to discuss literature under their watch. Your impulsive ego threatens to destroy everything we've built here.
奥克塔维奥：我们好不容易在监视中获得了谈论文学的自由，而你的狂妄将令一切都归于废墟。

The Idealist: Spare me the lecture, Octavia. We don't need permission to do as we please.
理想家：哈哈，将那些多余的说辞省去吧，奥克塔维奥。什么时候谈论文学的自由需要靠外界来赋予了？

The Idealist: You're just another puppet of power, kneeling to the eyes behind those glass walls.
理想家：你不过是想让我们也像你一样，屈服于监视背后的权力罢了。

The Idealist: They have trained you to believe it was your own decision: to be good and conform. Who could've done a better job?
理想家：真正的权力，会让你们以为这是你们自己的信念：做个好人，好好遵守规矩，写一点儿从不出格的魔幻现实主义……

The Idealist: When I look at you, all I see is a sheep, docile and obedient, just the way the tower wants! What kind of work could someone like you create? Literature isn't defended by those lounging in cozy rooms, scribbling to soothing music.
理想家：真是悲哀，你已经完全被来自瞭望塔的视线驯化了！文学向来不是规规矩矩地坐在公寓里听着古典音乐就能完成的事情。

Octavia: Have you looked in a mirror, Idealist? You've become a pathetic, windmill-tilting fool, a monster tearing down everything around you!
奥克塔维奥：你……你从来没有透过镜子看到自己的丑陋姿态，理想家！你简直是一头拒斥一切形态威权的、离经叛道的、可悲的怪物！

The Idealist: A beast of prey, you mean? Naturally, a sheep would be appalled by the mere thought of such a creature.
理想家：呵！在长期被圈养、被看管的宠物那丁点儿大的脑袋里，当然无法想象猛兽的存在，也无法想象猛兽的缺席。

The Idealist: A fearful sheep caught in a vine, confusing the blade that would set it free with the jaws of a tiger!
理想家：你们先是将表现主义与意象主义那盘转缠绕的根系用手术刀从中切开，然后又将老虎与危险的武器混为一谈！

Octavia: Such a master of metaphor! But I beg you—learn to distinguish right from wrong, fantasy from reality. Only then can you truly lead our people toward what's right.
奥克塔维奥：你就这么喜欢玩文字游戏吗？在文学这座孤独的迷宫中，想要对民族性进行剖析，你就必须得先知道什么是正确的，什么是现实的。

The Idealist: "Distinguish right from wrong." Don't make me laugh. Is that the limit of your vision?
理想家：你们的脑袋里只能装得下一种标准——那就是“正确”！多么无趣的词汇！

Octavia: You ... You ...
奥克塔维奥：你……你这个……

The impassioned leader jumps onto a nearby bench, striking a dramatic pose before the crowd.
情绪激动的诗社首领跳至一旁的长凳上，在人群中做出演讲的姿势。

He raises his arms and launches into a speech.
他举起手，振臂高呼起来。

The Idealist: Companions! Friends! Listen to me!
理想家：朋友们，我的同胞们！你们都应该知道——！

The Idealist: There is no truer home to literature than a prison—
理想家：除了监狱，这个世界上再也没有文学的归处——

A blast of deafening sound and all words fall from the air.
一声枪响终结了理想家慷慨激昂的陈述。

The Idealist: The Idealist's expression freezes. His eyes search down from a frozen face to a dark red hole in his chest.
理想家：诗社首领的表情凝固了，他低头看向自己胸前的洞口。

An ominous shade of crimson seeps out.
而如今，那儿正慢慢渗出代表不祥的血色。

Octavia: No! NO!
奥克塔维奥：噢……！不！

The horrified arcanist stumbles back, screaming.
陷入惊骇的神秘学家倒退一步，失声尖叫起来。

Jailer: Who did this?! Hands behind your head and drop to your knees, all of you, now!
狱卒：是谁?！在场所有人，双手抱头蹲下！

Jailer: This is your last warning!!
狱卒：这是最后一次警告!!

The prisoners show no reaction to the jailer's final ultimatum. They stare at the Idealist, unmoving.
然而囚犯们对于狱卒的最后通牒毫无反应。他们一齐看着理想家，面容呆滞。

Roberta: Idealist, you-you're bleeding. It's in your chest.
罗贝托：理想家先生，您、您的胸口……在冒血……

As his life drains away, the Idealist appears unsurprised. He simply turns his gaze toward Recoleta.
对于自身生命的流逝，理想家似乎并不感到惊讶。他只是看向了虚构集的方向。

The Idealist: You must ...
理想家：你要……

Recoleta: Yes, Idealist?
虚构集：理想家先生，你……?!

Unfinished words dissolve into silence as the prison itself begins to tremble.
未竟的话语随着监狱的剧烈震动消失了。

The entire exhibition hall twists and contorts, its surroundings warping beyond comprehension, as if dissolving and expanding freely.
整座展厅在震动中扭曲起来，四周呈现出难以理解的变化，仿佛一切事物都在溶解，自由地生长、变幻。

Recoleta: What's going on?
虚构集：发生了什么事……！

Garden of Forking Paths
理想分岔花园

The hall is still. Time seems frozen in place, until someone utters the first words.
寂静的展厅内，时间仿佛永恒地凝固。直到第一个人，说了第一句话。

Octavia: Was he shot? Where did the bullet come from?
奥克塔维奥：他……他中弹了？我的天呐……我甚至都没听清是哪个方向传来的枪声！

Octavia: Ms. Jailer, and you ladies over there, come give me a hand! We need to get him to the Physician!
奥克塔维奥：狱卒小姐，以及那边的几位看起来有自保能力的访客们，快帮我一起把这家伙抬到狱医那儿……

Her words ignite the first spark.
第一句话，点燃了第一根引线。

La Sociedad Member II: Did you do this, Octavia? You couldn't face the burning truth of his words, so you pierced his very heart instead, just as it was blazing with the fire of justice!
诗社囚犯 II：是你，奥克塔维奥？是你的恼羞成怒，令你用话语的子弹击穿一位诗人为理想而鼓动的心脏？

La Sociedad Member II: Or was it you, Jailer? Did you intend to crush the voice of poetry beneath your wheel of power?
诗社囚犯 II：还是你，狱卒？是你的权力意志，令你竟不惜用官僚的齿轮将不朽的诗篇压成粉末，而浑然不为所动？

La Sociedad Member II: It has to be one of you. Devils in disguise! Beasts in human skin!
诗社囚犯 II：一定是你们……一定是你们这帮披着人皮的魔鬼……

Octavia: Can't you see? I had nothing to do with this. I'm as innocent as any of you.
奥克塔维奥：你们在说什么?！我根本就没有反应过来发生了什么事情！

Octavia: I've been trying to keep order here, to protect everyone. And now you blame me?
奥克塔维奥：天呐……我一直以来都在致力于维护这里的秩序，挽救大家的生命……现在，你竟然怀疑我是杀人凶手?

La Sociedad Member III: Don't listen to her! The Idealist made it very clear. She's trying to get us punished for her own gain!
诗社囚犯 III：不，就是她，就是奥克塔维奥！我分明听到理想家先生向我们传递的隐喻，他说她“将老虎与危险的武器混为一谈”！

La Sociedad Member III: You're a murderer, Octavia!
诗社囚犯 III：奥克塔维奥，你杀害了理想家先生！

The prisoners' fury erupts.
囚犯们的怒气一触即发。

In the chaos, Sonetto blocks an arcane skill that pierces the air.
混乱之中，十四行诗匆忙挡下了一道偏离方向的神秘术。

Octavia: This is mad. You're accusing me without proof. It wasn't me.
奥克塔维奥：你们都疯了……这完全是无理的指控，我说了，不是我动的手！

Jailer: This is getting out of hand. I suggest you ladies leave now.
狱卒：这里的情况已经逐渐失控了……我建议诸位客人先离开这里。

Recoleta: No, wait.
虚构集：等一下，可是……

Recoleta: It all happened too fast. What happened to the Idealist? Is he alright?
虚构集：这太突然了，理想家先生，他到底怎么样了？他还好吗?！

Recoleta: I ... I didn't even get a chance to ask about Aleph.
虚构集：我，我还没有来得及找到阿莱夫……

As the tide of people surges around them, the line between life and death blurs beyond recognition.
人群的潮涌中，生与死的界限早已模糊不堪。

Sonetto: I agree with the jailer.
十四行诗：我认同狱卒小姐的建议。

Sonetto: Timekeeper, Ms. Recoleta, let's get out of here.
十四行诗：司辰，虚构集小姐，安全起见，我们先离开此地吧。

The violent conflict rages on, and everything else becomes meaningless.
在激烈的冲突之中，一切都显得不再重要。

The illusion of time dissolves, its flow unknown.
时间如一场痴迷的幻象，无人知晓它流逝的速度。

Under the garden's influence, the frenzy of prisoners begins to resemble an unreadable, chaotic epic.
受到花园的影响，陷入混乱的囚犯们露出了谵妄的神色，就像一首每个部分都不可解读的紊乱长诗。

At this moment, an unidentifiable figure enters their midst, though no one takes notice.
就在此时，一个看不清面庞的人影靠近了，但没有人在乎。

The newcomer scrutinizes the motionless corpse.
来者打量着理想家毫无动静的尸体。

???: His vitals are gone. At last, some peace and quiet.
???：很好，他的生命体征完全消失了，我再也不会被这个聒噪的家伙打扰了。

???: Well. For a liar and a thief like him, there's hardly a better end than this.
???：对于一个谎话连篇的、可耻的盗窃者来说，最好的下场就是如此。

He reaches into the Idealist's coat pocket and pulls out a die.
他从理想家的外套口袋中取出一颗骰子。

It is an artifact marked by patterns veiled in smoke, an object seemingly not meant to exist in this world, a twenty-sided die known only through an omniscient perspective.
一个于烟雾中隐约可见纹理的艺术品，一类仿佛不应存在于现世的象征物，一颗在全景视角中已知具有二十个面的骰子。

And now, it is stained in an utterly corrupted blackness.
而现在，它已经被糟糕透顶的黑色所污染了。

???: Heh. Just as I thought. You had it all along.
???：骰子果然在你这里。

蛛丝网
The Spider's Web 9TH-08

The Spider's Web
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Jailer: Ladies, I must apologize for what happened back there.
狱卒：对于方才的事件，我谨代表科马拉监狱向各位致以歉意。

Jailer: We were caught off guard. There has never been a commotion of that scale before. I must report this to the Physician.
狱卒：虽然听起来很像是辩解，但从我就职以来，几乎未曾发生过如此大规模的暴乱。我必须向狱医先生汇报此事。

Vertin: Don't worry, Ms. Jailer. We made it out in one piece.
维尔汀： 没关系的，狱卒小姐，我们并没有人遭到袭击或受伤。

Jailer: Thank you for your understanding. Ordinarily, I would arrange to escort you to a safer location, but I'm afraid at this hour, you'll have missed the last train. And the roads are icy at night.
狱卒： 感谢理解。虽然我很想立刻护送各位离开监狱，但恐怕有些困难。在这个时间，乌斯怀亚的交通基本停运了，外面的道路还有积雪……

Hearing this, Recoleta exchanges a quick but meaningful expression with her companions.
闻言，虚构集连忙朝一旁的同行者们挤了挤眼睛。

Recoleta: Psst, Vertin. We can't leave like this.
虚构集： 嘿，嘿！维尔汀，我们不能现在就离开——

Vertin: We appreciate your kind consideration, Ms. Jailer, but we still have some unfinished business here.
维尔汀： 是的，我们还有一些基金会的重要任务没有完成。

Jailer: I see. I'll arrange a clean room in a safer section for you.
狱卒： ……好吧。如果诸位不嫌弃的话，我会在安全的区域安排干净的房间以供休息。

Jailer: We'll do our best to ensure your safety tonight.
狱卒： 我保证，科马拉监狱会对诸位的安全负责。

Cell, Comala Prison
科马拉监狱·囚室

Night falls as the girls huddle together, scrutinizing their unfamiliar surroundings.
夜深了，女孩们围在一处，打量着这个陌生的居所。

Sonetto: They actually found us a spare room.
十四行诗： 一个监狱里的房间。

Recoleta: Bleak, quiet, and somber. It's a cell like all the others.
虚构集： 一个破败而井然、静谧而忧伤的，监狱里的房间。

Vertin: Don't worry. This isn't the first time we've ended up on the wrong side of the bars.
维尔汀： 别担心，这并不是我们第一次在坐牢了。

Sonetto: At least this time we're just here for the night, not a full sentence.
十四行诗： 司辰，这只是狱卒小姐给我们提供的休息房间。我不认为我们在坐牢……

Sonetto lets out a whisper-thin protest.
第一助手发出细如蚊蚋的反驳声。

Vertin: Though, this cell is quite different from the ones we've been in before.
维尔汀： 这个牢房和我先前见过的都不一样。

Recoleta: Not just this cell. The whole prison is unlike anything I've seen.
虚构集： 不仅仅是这个牢房。这个监狱中的一切，都和外面的不一样。

Recoleta: And this society they've been running here isn't some mere pastime. They're having real discussions about meaningful topics, even though the rest of the world has been cut off from them.
虚构集： 那些来自诗社的囚犯，他们并不是在过家家或聊以解闷。那些讨论与实验，是真正跟文学的处境相关的。

Sonetto: But we're still in an arcanist prison, a place where conflicts and violence can erupt at any moment. Let's not forget that.
十四行诗： 但这里仍然是一个神秘学家监狱，一个充满着冲突与暴力的地方。我认为，你太轻视这一切了。

Sonetto: Ms. Jailer warned us from the start. These prisoners are mentally unstable and potentially dangerous.
十四行诗：狱卒小姐一早就警告过我们，这些囚犯都是危险的精神分裂患者。

Sonetto: Ms. Recoleta, with all due respect, we can't afford to see this place through rose-colored glasses. We'd be overlooking the risks, as we did earlier.
十四行诗：虚构集小姐，我想……你并没有意识到那些真实存在的危险，就像方才一样。

Recoleta: And with all due respect, Sonetto, we didn't overlook any danger. At least I didn't. A writer must be observant if she is to accurately reflect the world in her writing.
虚构集：我当然意识到了危险。一个作家必须得先懂得观察现实，才能精准地反映在笔下。

Sonetto: But you—
十四行诗：但是……

Vertin: We came here with different goals, and still, none of them have been accomplished.
维尔汀：我们抱有各自的目的，而它们尚未达成。

Vertin: I suggest we focus on our respective missions instead of fighting with one another.
维尔汀：我想，眼下争执并不能帮我们达成目的。

Sonetto: Apologies, Timekeeper. Ms. Recoleta, I take back everything I said.
十四行诗：……对不起，司辰，虚构集小姐。

Recoleta: Don't apologize, Sonetto. I'm at fault, too. Sometimes I forget that words can be as sharp as swords. You were only thinking about our safety. I shouldn't have been so rude.
虚构集：我也很抱歉，也许我有时候是太冲动了一些……我能理解，你只是非常担忧同伴的安危。

Recoleta: I actually really admire how you fought back there! If you'd allow me, I'd like to write a poem for you, once my novel's finished.
虚构集：我很敬佩你刚才在冲突时刻挺身而出的表现！我愿意将它写成一首诗赠予你，来赞颂你们如钻石一般璀璨的友谊，只需要等我完稿小说即可。

Sonetto: Ah ...
十四行诗：唔……?!

Vertin: That's terribly kind of you. But honestly, I think we've had enough poetry today to last a lifetime.
维尔汀：请不要这样做，虚构集小姐。

Recoleta: Let me know if you change your mind. By the way, did either of you see what happened to the Idealist?
虚构集：但刚刚……理想家先生，他究竟发生了什么事了?

Recalling their recent conflict, the indomitable girl finally hesitates.
提及不久前的那场冲突，这位一向以超乎常人的执着示人的少女，罕见地陷入了迟疑之中。

Vertin: The jailer told me she went back to the gallery once everything calmed down.
维尔汀：在骚动平息之后，狱卒小姐回去**无人能懂展厅**查看了情况。

Vertin: She found nothing: no blood, no shell cases, not even a trace of the Idealist.
维尔汀：她说，她发现一件诡异的事情。那里已经什么都没有了。没有弹壳，没有血迹，连理想家先生都消失了。

Sonetto: Timekeeper, now's really not the time for ghost stories.
十四行诗：司辰，现在可不是讲鬼故事的时候。

Recoleta: Do you mean that maybe the Idealist somehow managed to get out of there on his own?
虚构集：维尔汀，所以你的意思是，理想家先生的伤势并不严重，自己设法逃走了是吗?!

Recoleta: Or perhaps someone else helped him.
虚构集：不对，也可能是有囚犯带走了他，他并没有死亡……

Vertin: Well, according to the Idealist and our jailer, any inmates who are unwell will be taken to the Physician.
维尔汀：理想家先生与狱卒小姐先前都提及过，发病的囚犯会被送往狱医处治疗。

Vertin: It's possible someone brought him there while everyone else was shouting and running about.
维尔汀：也许在混乱之中，有囚犯将其送走了。

Recoleta: You're right. It could be that he's with the Physician right now. I'm relieved! That was a sudden plot twist, but a visionary of his magnitude doesn't deserve to die in silence like that.
虚构集：谢天谢地，那真是太好了！这个转折来得过于迅猛了，他的退场不应该是如此悄无声息的。

Vertin: To be fair, the gunshot was quite loud, as was the ensuing commotion.
维尔汀：事实上，那声枪响还挺大的。

Recoleta: ...
虚构集：……

Recoleta: Nonetheless, he couldn't have just died like that! I mean, the readers would riot if a writer were to kill off a character so abruptly!
虚构集：……我的意思是，在这种时候让关键人物悄无声息地退场，读者是会写信到出版社抗议的！

Recoleta: But, you believe he's still alive, too. Am I right?
虚构集：所以他一定还活着，对吗?!

She knows her words are merely a cover. She needs an answer—a real, undeniable answer.
她知道那些言辞只是掩饰。她迫切需要一个答案，一个现实的、肯定的答案。

Vertin: There's nothing that we can be certain of for now. But on a brighter note, we didn't come back empty-handed from our mission either, Sonetto.
维尔汀：我们一定能弄清楚这一切的。事实上，我们并非一无所获。

Vertin: We found Dr. Dores's signature in the gallery. You were right all along, Recoleta. She was here.
维尔汀：在混乱发生之前，我们成功在展厅里找到了德洛丝女士的签名。虚构集小姐，您提供的目击线索是正确的，德洛丝女士就身处科马拉监狱之中。

Sonetto: But we didn't see her at the gathering. Could something have happened to her, like with the Idealist?
十四行诗：但我们并没有发现德洛丝女士的身影。难道那位女士，也陷入了和理想家先生一样的状况吗?

Recoleta: Do you think she was also sent to the Physician and never made it back?
虚构集：你的意思是，他们都是因为科马拉监狱的治疗而失踪的?

Vertin: This is all just speculation. If we want to find the Idealist or Dr. Dores ...
维尔汀：并不一定。想要查找到更多的线索，我们需要见到监狱的幕后之人，比如说狱卒一直提到的“狱医”。

Vertin: We need to speak to this Physician first.
维尔汀：无论是关于理想家先生，还是德洛丝女士的下落——

Vertin: Ms. Recoleta, do you believe that the Idealist could be your pen pal, Aleph?
维尔汀：只是，虚构集小姐，您确定理想家先生就是您一直在寻找的笔友阿莱夫吗?

Recoleta: Whether he is or not, he's still my best lead.
虚构集：哪怕他并不是我的笔友，他也是这个监狱里唯一知晓阿莱夫的存在的人。

That name touches a nerve once again.
那个名字再一次触动了她的神经。

Recoleta: Friends, I've had this strange feeling in my gut since we got here. Something is slowing us down.
虚构集：我有强烈的预感，这个监狱里有一些异常的要素，它一直在阻拦着我们。

Recoleta: Now to figure out what it is ...
虚构集：如果能搞清楚这一切……

A silent fear grips her, like ripples suddenly appearing on a once-still lake, unsettling in its quiet disturbance.
一种无声的恐惧击中了她，就像在寂静的湖面看到阵阵涟漪那般令人心生不安。

Recoleta: Look, it's a wild guess, but just wait till I finish.
虚构集：听着，虽然这有些魔幻，但我有一个猜测——

Recoleta: It feels like everything happening in this prison is somehow connected to my novel, The Rise and Fall of Sanity.
虚构集：我认为，监狱中的一切似乎都和我的小说《理性家族的崛起与衰落》有联系。

Vertin: We're no strangers to wild guesses, and sometimes they're closer to the truth than you'd think. So this ...
维尔汀：别担心，魔幻的事情对我们来说并不少见。所以，您的小说《家族的历史》——

Recoleta: The Rise and Fall of Sanity.
虚构集：是《理性家族的崛起与衰落》。

Vertin: Sorry. What exactly is your story about?
维尔汀：……我会记下来的。请问它讲了什么内容?

The question scatters the midnight gloom. Outside, moonlight spills over gray-white snow.
猝不及防的提问吹散了午夜的阴霾。窗外，有月光正洒在灰白的雪地上。

Recoleta: Hah! I never thought that you'd be interested!
虚构集：噢……？噢！我还以为你们也不会感兴趣呢。

Recoleta: It starts—sorry, it's been a while since I told it from the beginning: A few, a few years ago, I worked, worked as a forest ranger. It happened in a desert town called Amalfitano, in Sonora back in 1975 ...
虚构集：让我想想……数、数年前，我认识了一名来自墨西哥超现实主义派的诗人……因此得知了一则关于阿马尔菲塔诺小镇的离奇故事……

Two patient listeners watch the stammering girl, waiting for the next part of her story.
两位耐心的听众注视着面前结结巴巴的女孩，等待故事的下文。

Recoleta: Ah, you know what? Most people say the beginning's a bit hard to get into, except for Aleph. I'm thinking of rewriting it.
虚构集：唔……事实上，许多人反馈过这样的开头有点难懂，除了我的笔友阿莱夫。

Recoleta: But if you like the sound of it so far, maybe I could read you the latest part I just finished?
虚构集：如果你们还愿意继续听的话，我还是想念一念最新的修改。

She studies her readers' expressions, guessing madly at their responses.
她谨慎地观察着两位读者的神色，小心翼翼地等待着答复。

Vertin: Please.
维尔汀：当然。

Recoleta: "It all started with the frequency data from the tapes."
虚构集：故事起源于磁带中所记录的频率。

Recoleta: "The general pattern seemed to have changed. At first, the Paracausality Researcher chalked it up to a statistical error—a glitch, perhaps."—Oh, sorry.
虚构集：能量扰动学家认为，巴比伦之骰的随机性正发生着变化——噢，很抱歉。

Recoleta: But after a few days and long nights of meticulous calculations, that explanation only became less and less plausible. The odds of success and failure kept shifting, and the chance of repeating the previous result kept growing. It was as if someone had tampered with the rules and tweaked it to their liking.
虚构集：有人做了小小的变革：能量扰动学家不停地计算，最终发现它的随机性中增加了一倍幸运，也增加了一倍罚码。她知晓巴比伦之骰的规则已然改变。

Recoleta: She took her findings to Amalfitano, "the town of nothing," as they called it then.
虚构集：能量扰动学家带着这项可怖的消息走进了无人的阿马尔菲塔诺。

Recoleta: Near the old looms, she met a blind weaver who spoke softly of an old tale:
虚构集：古旧的作坊中，那里的织工双眼已盲，她低声诉说着自己经历的一切。

Recoleta: "I heard a strange rustling at dawn, like a die rolling along a wooden floor. Then the morning light dimmed and died. That was the last time I saw the sun, my own hands, or the threads I worked with."
虚构集：“有一天，我在黎明时分听见骰子转动的声音。有什么东西夺走了我的视力，从此我不再能工作。”

Recoleta: "The second time I heard the die roll, I was told the oxen in the field sank to their knees and never stood again."
虚构集：“骰子转动了一次，老迈的牛在犁地时寿终正寝。合眼前，它回忆起牛犊时代对劳作满怀期待的遥远下午。”

Recoleta: "By the third roll, the fields were crawling with frogs. Plows ran over them, and some still writhed, squeezing themselves deeper into the cracks in the earth."
虚构集：“骰子转动了一次，无数青蛙在泥土间被犁耙碾过。它们拼命扭动着，向大地的裂缝绝望地钻去。”

Recoleta: "The fourth time the die rolled, ten dormice plunged into the sea in a strange sleepwalk, and ten bears feasted for the last time before winter arrived."
虚构集：“骰子转动了一次，十只睡鼠在睡梦中坠向大海，十只熊在冬天前得以餍足。”

Recoleta: "The final roll of the die was cast in a cage, during a duel, before a crowd of eager eyes. The winner left with ten pounds of gold, and the loser left with ten flies which fell on him to feast."
虚构集：“在界限中，最后一次转动应当是一次瞩目的决斗。胜者得到了十磅金子，败者引来了十只蝇虫。”

Vertin: ...
维尔汀：……

Sonetto: ...
十四行诗：……

The quiet spreads through their cell like a rolling tide.
名为静默的无形潮水，在狭小的囚室中漫延开来。

Vertin: Is that all?
维尔汀：这个故事，结束了吗?

Sonetto: Emm. Seems like it.
十四行诗：我想……应该是的?

Recoleta: Well, there's more, but I haven't quite figured those parts out yet.
虚构集：唔……后面的部分还没有完整到可以拿出来讲的程度。

Recoleta: Any thoughts? Anything? I can take it. Please. I really need some feedback.
虚构集：总之，目前的部分你们有什么读后感吗？什么都好！

Vertin: I ... I wonder if the protagonist ever finds this "Die of Babylon" in the end.
维尔汀：我只想知道主人公最后能不能找到那个骰子。

Recoleta: Oh, Vertin, it isn't a real die. It's just a metaphor!
虚构集：噢噢，事实上，那并不是一个具体的骰子。维尔汀，那只是一个意象！

Vertin: Oh, I see. I must've missed that. Sorry. Still, it's a beautiful story. Sad, but beautiful.
维尔汀：很抱歉，看来我没有理解它想要表达的内容。但这并不妨碍我能感受到，它应该是一个凄美而奇幻的故事。

Recoleta: The story is still too obscure, isn't it? *sigh* Aleph warned me about this. In our last correspondence, he suggested adding the Blind Weaver to shed light on the hidden theme.
虚构集：所以主题还是过于晦涩吗？唉……阿莱夫在上一次的回信中也提出了些建议，比如说这个盲眼的织工，就是他建议增加的角色，让她来引出主题的关联性。

Recoleta: It helped at first. But even with this sage advice, no matter how hard I tried, the plot just didn't seem to move forward.
虚构集：这确实有些帮助，但角色们总是在讲话，而故事其实并没有实质性的进展。

Recoleta: I feel stuck in that village with them—lost, dazed, isolated inside their small, disconnected moments. Something crucial is missing, leaving gaps between the characters and scenes.
虚构集：这很奇怪。就像这个小镇中缺乏了某种至关重要的元素，导致每个篇章仿佛游荡在各自的世界里，无法交汇，而逐渐走向瓦解。

Recoleta: Should I change the storyteller's perspective? Start a different angle? Or maybe rewrite the characters completely? What should I do?
虚构集：叙事视角、故事主题、人物设计……它究竟在哪方面有所欠缺？又缺了什么？

Before the writer sinks into a swirling vortex of self-doubt, someone decides to push for something tangible.
在不知名作家陷入自我怀疑的漩涡之前，需要有人推动眼下的实质性进展。

Sonetto: Apologies, but you said your story somehow connects to what's happening here in the Panopticon. What makes you think that?
十四行诗：所以，你认为科马拉监狱与你的小说有什么联系?

Recoleta: It's a strange feeling. Like everything here belongs to a dream I once had, only I can't remember it.
虚构集：我……我不知道。你们能理解这种感受吗？就像是你在梦里见过的场景出现在了现实中，虚实交织、令人恍惚，不知身处何境。

Sonetto: Do you mean that you have a sense of déjà vu?
十四行诗：你所描述的感觉，指的是似曾相识的**既视感**[déjà vu]吗?

Sonetto: It's nothing to worry about. Our psychiatrist friend, Kakania, told me those moments are often the result of a dysfunctional connection between two parts of the brain, like a little glitch in our heads.
十四行诗：卡卡尼亚小姐曾告诉过我，那是一种潜意识矛盾冲突的感知障碍……

Recoleta: No, it's nothing like déjà vu!
虚构集：不不，我不是这个意思……！

The storyteller snaps back, politely agitated.
不被理解的故事讲述者显得有些焦躁。

Recoleta: Déjà vu is a single moment, a specific situation. But here it's everything! La Sociedad, the rules, the Idealist, even the incidents in the gallery! Each one unfolds in a similar pattern, like the grooves on a record, telling a story I feel I've listened to before.
虚构集：诗社、规则、理想家……那些象征、意象和隐喻，它们分明就是按照同一种规律在推进！

Recoleta: Amalfitano and Comala. They're two sides of that same record, playing out the same tune. Whatever happens in my story seems to be happening here too.
虚构集：从阿马尔菲塔诺到科马拉，故事与现实构成了一个巨大的整体。当一个事物出现时，另一个也随之而定。

Recoleta: I had that feeling when I met you as well, Ms. Vertin.
虚构集：维尔汀，这一切都是从我遇见你开始的。

Recoleta: At first, I thought it was only an interesting coincidence. You're much like the first character in my story—a traveler with a suitcase.
虚构集：因为在这个故事的开头，也有一个和你一样的、提着箱子的能量扰动学家……！

The girl rambles on, desperately relating to her characters.
女孩语无伦次地解释着人物的对应关系。

Recoleta: But then I realized, the doctor, your Dores—she's like the Blind Weaver, who lost her sight to the die despite having always been faithful to it.
虚构集：就像德洛丝女士……她是盲眼的织工。织工是一个宿命论的拥护者，一直崇奉巴比伦之骰的存在，却被它夺去了双眼……

Recoleta: And the jailer—she's the Bank Clerk who assisted the corporation in taking over the town in order to escape her past.
虚构集：而狱卒小姐，则是银行职员，为了遗忘可怕的过去，甘愿让跨国集团建立的新制度将小镇侵蚀……

Recoleta: And the Idealist? He's the Murdered Donkey Driver. And the Die of Babylon ... No ...
虚构集：至于理想家先生，他则是死于谋杀案的赶驴人幽灵……当然，还有巴比伦之骰……

Recoleta: My dear fictional friends ... What on earth is happening to you?
虚构集：我亲爱的虚构朋友们，你们身上究竟发生着什么？

Vertin: Wait. Are you saying that everyone we've met here matches a character from your story, like some kind of archetype?
维尔汀：你所说的联系，指的是监狱里的人物，和你的小说是一一对应的吗？

Vertin: That sounds unbelievable. But, then again, maybe you're onto something.
维尔汀：……它太过抽象了，但我不否认你的推测，因为我觉得你有一个新奇、独特的视角。

Vertin: You see the world through a different lens that none of us share.
维尔汀：你用文学考量这个世界，而那是我和十四行诗都未曾尝试过的。

Recoleta: Not just the characters! The events here are mirroring my story, too.
虚构集：不，除了人物，事件也是对应的！只是，我还不能确认这种联系……

Recoleta: Aleph—he's the only one who truly understood my story. If things are playing out just like my novel, then ...
虚构集：阿莱夫是唯一能看懂我小说的人。如果这里发生的一切，真的与我的小说有关——

Recoleta: Maybe Aleph is in fact still here.
虚构集：那么阿莱夫，他一定就在科马拉监狱之中。

Vertin: Are you suggesting that someone is controlling the Panopticon in order to make it follow the same plot as your story?
维尔汀：所以，你认为有人将你的小说作为操纵监狱的蓝本？

Vertin: That they've set the rules, started the poetry group, planned the attack on the Idealist, and tried to prevent us from finding Dr. Dores?
维尔汀： 他根据小说情节修改了科马拉监狱的规则，策划了理想家先生的遇袭，也隐匿了德洛丝女士的踪迹。

Vertin: If that's true, Ms. Recoleta, it's very likely that the one acting against us is in fact Aleph himself.
维尔汀： 如果有这个人，那么他只可能是你的笔友，阿莱夫。

Recoleta never expected the chain of reasoning to unravel this way.
虚构集从未想过推理的链条会演变成这副模样。

Recoleta: But I ... No ... How could that be possible?!
虚构集： 等等，维尔汀，我、我没有这样说过！我只是……

She interrupts, only for confusion to creep onto her face moments later.
她着急地打断了对方的话，片刻后，女孩的神色显得迷茫起来。

Recoleta: Why? Why would he do this?
虚构集： 不，我不能明白。他为什么要这么做？他完全没有这么做的理由。

Recoleta: I don't see any reason why he'd be connected. He's an intelligent, cultured, and profound person, not a common killer.
虚构集： 他是博学的炼金术师，是高深的隐秘诗人，是世上唯一能为我的小说提供建议的导师。他怎么会和谋杀扯上联系？

Recoleta: No, none of this adds up.
虚构集： 这个监狱，这一切……究竟是哪里不对劲呢？

Sonetto: Remember, Dr. Dores was brought to Ushuaia by the Zeno rebels.
十四行诗： 德洛丝女士是由叛变的伊戈尔一行人带来乌斯怀亚的。

Sonetto: And we know they're connected to Manus Vindictae.
十四行诗： 而我们已经确认，伊戈尔已与重塑之手勾连……

Sonetto: If this Aleph really is hiding Dores from us, he may be working with them.
十四行诗： 如果按照虚构集小姐所说，阿莱夫隐匿了德洛丝女士的踪迹，那么他就与重塑之手有联系。

Recoleta stares blankly for a time before clumsily shifting the topic.
虚构集哑然地望向对方，随后仓促地转移了话题。

Recoleta: Oh my, Sonetto! I didn't know you had such a flair for stories! Maybe you should join us and become a visceral realist too.
虚构集： 就此打住！维尔汀，十四行诗，没想到你们如此有编故事的天赋……也许二位该加入本能现实主义派。

Recoleta: I think you're only imagining things. Perhaps you were inspired by this strange prison? Haha.
虚构集： 我知道了，是这个隔绝现实的监狱，以及我那迟早会成为杰作的小说启发了你们！

Vertin: Perhaps we all need to start writing our own stories.
维尔汀： 你说得对，我们应该学习一些虚构的思维。

Vertin: Come out, now. Whoever's out there, speak up.
维尔汀： 另外，躲在门外的先生，您在那里已经偷听了有一些时候了。

Vertin: How can we help you?
维尔汀： 请问您有什么事吗？

Sonetto: Who's there?
十四行诗： 什么？是谁在那儿！

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英文 / ENGLISH

When they speak of "Manus Vindictae," their tone is always light, often laced with jokes—colorful descriptions like "a greasy-headed musician smearing tiles like a drunk Edward Goya" frequently crop up in their poetry. Even though I have never "seen" such a scene myself, I can still grasp their attitude toward Manus Vindictae—it was an oppression surpassing even their past sufferings. Yet, subconsciously, they "ignored" this similarity—perhaps out of denial, or perhaps because this prison had already taught them to obey, also subconsciously.

But as far as I know, Manus Vindictae did bring their terror here. Those masks drove arcanists to insanity and caused unbearable suffering, as if they were caught in an inescapable snare. After prolonged torment, they lost the ability to utter even a single phrase of their own language, reduced to slaves of this underground faction—left with only a singular thought, their souls having left the empty husk of their former selves.

And as for humans—it seems they were driven to death en masse. At night, they were not allowed prolonged sleep, woken by their companions every hour to sit beneath the watchtower and chant prayers. And by dawn, high-intensity training and interrogations that did not require or expect any answers would begin again ... The purpose of Manus Vindictae is buried beneath these cruel methods, as clear as the deepest crevasse in the ice field—it is nothing but destruction. They seek to "completely destroy" humanity.

中文 / CHINESE

他们谈起“重塑之手”时，总是语调轻松且夹带玩笑，诸如“脑袋流油的音乐家把瓷砖抹得像爱德华·戈雅醉酒后的即兴创作”，这样的话语时常在他们的诗句之间突然出现，即使我从未“亲眼”见过那样的画面，也能感受到他们对“重塑之手”的态度——那是比起他们曾经的遭遇有过之而无不及的压迫，但他们在潜意识中“忽略”了这份相似性，或许是因为逃避，或许是因为这所监狱的确教会了他们服从——依然是在潜意识中。

但就我所知，“重塑之手”的的确确将恐怖降临到了这里，那些面具使得神秘学家变得疯狂而痛苦，犹如被捕兽夹困囿而不得解脱，漫长的折磨之后，他们变得无法再念出哪怕半句他们自己的语言，成为了这个民间组织的奴隶——只剩单一的思维，灵魂已经脱壳而去。

而人类，人类则在大量地死去。夜晚，他们不被允许保持长时间的睡眠，每隔一小时就会被交接的同伴叫醒，在思维的迷雾中坐到瞭望塔下合念祷词，而等到天亮，高强度的训练和不需要答案的拷问又会来临……“重塑之手”的目的藏在这些残忍的手段之下，明确得像是冰原中央最深的孔洞——只是摧毁，他们只是想“完全地摧毁”人类。

全景中央
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全景中央

García: Easy, easy! It's me, García! We met at the gallery earlier.
加西亚： 嘿，快停手……！我是加西亚，白天在诗社中布展的。

García: Please. I come in peace.
加西亚： 我没有恶意。事实上，我带来的是友善与和解的信息。

Recoleta pays no mind to the young man's explanations; her focus holds on the woman beside him.
虚构集并不在乎青年的解释，她的注意力完全停留在加西亚身旁的女性身上。

Recoleta: It's you, Octavia! The murderer herself!
虚构集：是你，奥克塔维奥！对理想家先生动手的人！！

Vertin: Please, calm yourself, Ms. Recoleta.
维尔汀：冷静些，虚构集小姐。

Vertin: The jailer has already confirmed that she wasn't the one to fire at the Idealist. The shot came from somewhere else in the room.
维尔汀：狱卒小姐已经确认过了，那声枪响，并不是由她所造成的。开枪者另有其人。

Recoleta: Hmph.
虚构集：……哼。

Recoleta bites her lip, giving up a little space to the intruders.
虚构集咬了咬唇，不甘心地后退了一步。

Vertin: Ms. Octavia, what brings you here at this hour?
维尔汀：奥克塔维奥小姐，您深夜拜访，是有什么想要和我们说的吗?

Octavia: I come here out of goodwill. Believe me, I didn't want any bloodshed either.
奥克塔维奥：诸位，我也无法想象在科马拉会发生这种事……我从来都不支持以暴力作为维持秩序的手段。

Octavia: I understand you just arrived today. There's something you need to know about the inmates here.
奥克塔维奥：你们应该是第一天来到科马拉的吧？所以并不了解这座监狱的运转情况。

Their visitor's expression is weary and low.
来者的神情中带有不难察觉的疲惫。

Octavia: We're outcasts rejected by society and literature, and our privileges are limited within these walls. But before I started my own literature group, I struck a deal with the Panopticon authorities.
奥克塔维奥：无论是文学还是现实，我们都是被放逐至边陲之人。事实上，在成立新派系之前，我就已经与监狱的管理者们达成了共识。

Octavia: If we cooperate and stay out of trouble, they'd leave us be. We could discuss literature freely and openly in Comala. Such a thing may seem trivial to you, but this is of immense importance to us.
奥克塔维奥：只要我们配合管理者的一切行动，就能获得在监狱中自由谈论文学的权利——你可能很难理解这对我们来说有多重要。

Recoleta: Oh, there's no happier thing in this world than discussing literature! No one should ever put limits on it!
虚构集：谈论文学是世上最快乐的事情，它不应该需要什么前提条件。

Octavia: You're right, Recoleta. But we're prisoners here. There are certain rules we have to follow.
奥克塔维奥：虚构集小姐，你并不明白我们的处境。只要在这座监狱里，有些规则就是永远无法逃离的。

Octavia: Except, the Idealist didn't see it our way. He refused to compromise, believing that the long poem and his so-called "-ism" could break us free from the cage of the ever-watchful eye.
奥克塔维奥：理想家……他总以为自己是这里唯一清醒的存在，认为那篇长诗和所谓的主义能带领大家冲破“视线”的牢笼。

Recoleta: Perhaps he was right. You might've achieved more if you'd listened to him. After all, visceral realism keeps us connected to who we are.
虚构集：理想家先生他并没有错……因为本能现实主义，本身就是一个能够让我们回归创作本质的好东西。

Recoleta: You have to believe in the truth of visceral realism! Because out there, beyond these walls, many of us still do!
虚构集：在外面，许多像我一样的青年诗人，都相信它带来的力量。

Octavia: And what has it changed? García, you're the latest inmate here. Tell us, three months ago, before they arrested you and took you here ...
奥克塔维奥：是吗？加西亚先生，你是三个月前才进入科马拉监狱的，也是诗社中最晚到来的成员。

Octavia: What has the visceral realism movement accomplished out there?
奥克塔维奥：请你告诉我们，在监狱外，你们本能现实主义派的运动进行得如何了？

Beside them, García, who had been patiently leaning against the railing, produces a metallic vibration on its grates. A rough paper roll burns between his lips.
一旁，沉默许久的加西亚靠在了栏杆上，发出了金属振动与摩擦的响声。
他的嘴唇间有一根粗糙的卷纸条正在燃烧。

García: At first, it was revolutionary. Young poets joined in droves. We held gatherings, and the literary world seemed alive again.
加西亚：我们曾经吸引了许多有志青年，也的确发起了数场文学运动……

García: I was just a kid when the leading poets left the city. Everyone thought it was only temporary. But they didn't come back, and nothing has happened since.
加西亚：在核心成员离开拉丁美洲的时候，我还是个孩子，我以为那无关紧要。事实却是——我们的运动再也没有任何起色了。

García: No one says it, but we all know: visceral realism died in 1977.
加西亚：所有人都心知肚明：属于本能现实主义者的故事，在 1977 年就已经宣告完结了。

Recoleta: No. Not for me.
虚构集：不……它没有结束，至少在我这里没有。

Recoleta: It's not dead as long as people still believe in it. I believe in it!
虚构集：它依然存在着，哪怕世上只剩下我一个人在坚信它！

Octavia ignores the childish remark. She knows that "conviction" can be as fragile as a spider's web.
奥克塔维奥并没有在意对方孩子气的发言。她知道，“坚信”有时柔弱得像一滴蜘蛛丝上的露水。

Octavia: Belief, faith—what is this obsession with the "true self"?
奥克塔维奥：为什么你们总喜欢说“遵循自我”？

Octavia: Why does your type always insist on there being a true self hiding beneath our roles in society, our disciplines?
奥克塔维奥：为什么你们总觉得在社会身份与规训下，还藏着一个独一无二的真实自我呢？

Recoleta: Look at the Idealist! He never once stopped fighting for what he believed in, even long after he was put behind these bars.
虚构集：恕我直言，理想家先生就是一个鲜活的例子，他在监狱中仍坚持着自己想做的事。

Octavia: "Idealist," what a name he gave himself. Who will he be when he finally breaks free from the eyes of the central tower? When he's left without his willful audience? A nobody, that's what.
奥克塔维奥：“理想家”，哈，真是人如其名……当他摆脱瞭望塔的视线后，他只会发现自己一无所有，并且谁也不是。

Octavia: And that is a truth even he is terrified of.
奥克塔维奥：那才是真相，一个令人惊恐而叹息的真相。

Vertin: Ms. Octavia. I hope you've come with something more important to share than just some criticism of the Idealist.
维尔汀：奥克塔维奥小姐，你应该不是为了说理想家先生的坏话才特地前来的吧?

Octavia: You're right. I have an important message for you.
奥克塔维奥：那不是坏话……算了。你说的不错，我是为了一件重要的事情才特地前来，而那与你们此行的目的有关。

Octavia: Dr. Dores—I heard you were looking for her. The woman from the São Paulo Veterans' Residence. She used to write under the name "Urd," didn't she?
奥克塔维奥：德洛丝女士——我听到你正在寻找她。她来自圣保罗荣军院，笔名叫“兀尔德”，对吗?

Vertin: Yes, that's right. Do you know her? You're the first person I've met here to speak plainly about her.
维尔汀：我很惊讶……在这座监狱中，你是第一个主动与我提起她的人。

Vertin: Do you know where she might be?
维尔汀：所以，奥克塔维奥小姐，你知道德洛丝女士现在在哪里吗?

Octavia: We crossed paths, but only briefly. I'm not sure where she's gone. Maybe the authorities know.
奥克塔维奥：我确实见过她，但我并不知晓她现今在监狱的何处，也许你得直接去问监狱的管理者们。

Octavia: However, she left this with me. I think you'll need it more than I do.
奥克塔维奥：这是德洛丝女士先前交给我的东西，我想你比我更需要它。

Octavia hands over her personal folder.
奥克塔维奥将随身携带的收纳册递上前。

Before they might open it, she has already turned to leave.
在翻开之前，她就已经转过身去。

Octavia: We have other matters to attend to. I'll leave you to your business. García, shall we?
奥克塔维奥：我还有事情要筹备，就不奉陪各位的推理游戏了。加西亚先生，我们走吧。

Their visitors leave in haste, their faces and expressions obscured by the night's shadows.
来访者脚步匆匆地离去了，没有人看到她藏在阴影中的表情。

The Foundation's investigators open the worn manuscript folder with caution.
调查员们半信半疑地翻开手中破旧的稿件收纳册。

Vertin: "The Physician told me the horrifying truth about the Panopticon of Comala and the power behind it—Manus Vindictae."
维尔汀：“在狱医先生的告知中，我得知了科马拉监狱那令人惊骇的真相，以及一只隐藏在阴影之下的无形之手，即名为‘重塑之手’的民间组织。”

Vertin: "By becoming the Panopticon's sole patron, they seized control of the resources and the allocation system, turning this place into a living hell. I suspect that the Physician, the current highest authority here, is responsible for this situation."
维尔汀：“……他们以资助为由，实则垄断了资源的供给与分配，让整座监狱的规则洗牌，并制造了难以言喻的恐怖氛围。其中，狱医先生的默许难辞其咎。”

Vertin: "... I discovered that the inmates were put through brutal training, even when they were too sick to carry out their tasks. They also forced pure-blood arcanist inmates to wear their masks, effectively turning them into murmuring puppets ..."
维尔汀：“……他们举办高强度训练，令不少身体羸弱的囚犯在绝望的折磨中病重离世；他们迫使纯血神秘学家戴上面具，在疯狂的呓语中成为被奴役的对象……”

Sonetto: Just as we suspected, Manus Vindictae is orchestrating everything.
十四行诗：这一切果然与重塑之手有关联。

Sonetto: No wonder we didn't find them in the city. They've been hiding here all along.
十四行诗：我们在乌斯怀亚的城市中，无法寻找到与重塑之手有关的线索，就是因为他们一直躲藏在科马拉监狱。

Vertin: No one would've thought to come looking for them here.
维尔汀：而这里，正是一个日常中不可能踏足的地方。

They snap the folder shut.
重重地合上手中的稿件收纳册。

A familiar signature, seen on the foreword page of UTTU magazine, and the receipt found in São Paulo's Heartfelt Home.
似曾相识的签名字迹。在《UTTU》杂志的扉页里，在巴西圣保罗热情之家找到的账单上。

Sonetto: But why would Ms. Octavia bring this to us? What's in it for her?
十四行诗：但是，这种送上门的线索……总让我感觉有些不安。

Sonetto: Do you think she's trying to mislead us, Timekeeper?
十四行诗：司辰，是否有可能，她在故意误导我们?

Vertin: Maybe. But the handwriting in that notebook is most certainly Urd's.
维尔汀：不排除这种可能，但根据字迹判断，这本手记的确是属于德洛丝女士的。

Vertin: If she's leading us astray on purpose, why? Ms. Recoleta, what do you think? Could she be Aleph?
维尔汀：如果奥克塔维奥小姐在故意误导我们，那她一定是监狱的幕后主使……虚构集小姐，她会是你的笔友阿莱夫吗?

Recoleta: Not a chance! Haven't you seen how she denies everything beautiful in the world? Aleph would never be so biased.
虚构集：等等……她怎么可能是我的笔友！你们没有看到她试图否定那些美好事物的极端性吗？阿莱夫绝不会如此偏颇。

Recoleta: No, Aleph is like a mirror. He reflects both light and shadow.
虚构集：阿莱夫更像是一枚镜片，一枚不光映出事物的光亮，也会同样映出其中的暗影的镜片。

Recoleta: But Octavia ... Maybe she hasn't looked at the shadow within for a long time.
虚构集：而奥克塔维奥……更像是在极端的环境下逐渐忘记了自己本来的模样。

Recoleta: I know that look on her face. It's the look of a writer.
虚构集：但我不得不承认，她的确是一名作家。

Recoleta: I've seen so many like her during my trip—the faces of a lost, struggling generation.
虚构集：那是一副令我感到熟悉的模样，属于拉丁美洲的、迷茫的、挣扎的青年面孔。这一路上，我见过无数张这样的面孔……

Under the night sky, Comala Prison stands like a forgotten gravestone covered by fine, cold snow.
夜幕下，科马拉监狱如同一块被世界遗忘的墓碑，缓缓为冰冷的细雪所覆盖。

In a room repurposed from a prison cell, three girls in search of someone share an absurd, bizarre tale. Meanwhile, at the entrance of the central watchtower, a jaguar knocks on a secure door.
在形似囚室的房间中，三位寻人的女孩分享着荒诞离奇的故事；
而在中央的瞭望塔前，美洲豹敲响了一扇紧闭的门扉。

Jailer: *deep breath* Dr. Merlin, I'm here to report on today's events.
狱卒：呼……梅林先生，我前来汇报今日的监狱情况。

???: Come in.
???：请进。

Central Tower Waiting Area
瞭望塔·等候室

Frantic writing breaks the quiet of the room.
寂静的办公室中仅有书写的唰唰声。

The jailer's visit does not deter the man behind the desk. He continues writing, wholly absorbed, as if each letter were filling the world around him.
狱卒的拜访并未让办公桌后的男子放下手中的纸笔，他心无旁骛，仿若这个世上空无一人。

Jailer: There was a commotion in the gallery today, sir.
狱卒：梅林先生，方才在囚犯活动场地中发生了一场暴动。

Jailer: An inmate known as the Idealist was severely injured. The inmates nearby said he lost consciousness from blood loss.
狱卒：一位名叫理想家的囚犯受了重伤。据当时在他身边的囚犯描述，他因失血过多，一度停止了呼吸。

Jailer: However, after we put everyone back in their cell, the Idealist was gone. I made a sweep of the grounds, but there was no trace of him.
狱卒：但在暴动结束后，理想家却从活动场地中消失了。这是我的失职，我搜查了一遍监狱，也没能找到他的尸体，明天我会扩大搜查的范围。

Jailer: It's possible that he regained consciousness and went into hiding. I'll perform a full search tomorrow.
狱卒：也许理想家他，并没有死亡……

The jaguar finds herself quite unexpectedly concealing the truth about Pablo.
美洲豹下意识隐瞒了癫痫发作的巴勃鲁。

The Physician: No need.
狱医：不需要。

Jailer: Sir?
狱卒：您的意思是……?

The Physician: He knew the consequences of breaking the rules, did he not?
狱医：是他先违反了规定，不是么?

Jailer: Sir, with all due respect, I think today's incident proved just how dangerous it is to let the inmates keep their weapons.
狱卒：……梅林先生，我认为，今天的暴乱已经足以证明让囚犯自主持有武器的危险性。

Jailer: We never should've let them walk around with deadly weapons! Even if we had to, we should've doubled the guards. We can't expect them to follow their own rules simply out of fear of the central tower.
狱卒：我们应该限制违禁物品的使用，或者增加巡逻狱卒的数量。囚犯的自发规训是不稳定的，我们不能仅仅依靠瞭望塔的权威性去——

The Physician interrupts her sharply, with no hint of concern.
狱医毫不在意地打断了她的话。

The Physician: Such matters fall beyond your purview, Jailer. You only need to do what's required of your title.
狱医：这不是你该在意的范畴。你只需要做好属于“狱卒”的本职工作。

The Physician: Is there anything else?
狱医：继续你的汇报。

Jailer: There is another thing. Two guests from the Foundation came through today. They said they were looking for someone named Dores.
狱卒：……好的。今日有来自基金会的官方人员进入监狱参观，她们正在科马拉中寻找一位名叫德洛丝的女士。

Jailer: They've shown a willingness to cooperate. Though, they were involved with the incident in Corridor Zero.
狱卒：在 0 号通道中，基金会的来客与囚犯一同清理了监狱中的魔精。

The sound of writing continues. Her report is disregarded. The jailer takes a deep breath. The next part is difficult to say.
唰唰的书写声仍在继续，她的汇报并未得到重视。
狱卒深吸一口气，接下来的内容让她难以启齿。

Jailer: Sir, there is one more thing.
狱卒：梅林先生，我必须汇报一件事……

Jailer: I told Ms. Octavia we're short on rations, and she's adjusted the inmates' portions accordingly. But that won't last long.
狱卒：我已经让奥克塔维奥小姐重新安排了监狱中的劳作与物资分配，但我们的物资很快就要消耗殆尽了。

Jailer: Manus Vindictae stopped providing supplies back in March, and Zeno has collected all the prisoners they had previously placed in our custody.
狱卒：那个名为重塑之手的民间机构，自三月起，他们就停止了提供资助……来自芝诺的军人带走了最后一批由他们送入监狱的囚犯。

Jailer: I just wonder why they have so suddenly withdrawn from Ushuaia and brought all their prisoners with them.
狱卒：为什么他们忽然撤离了乌斯怀亚？是因为他们不再需要监狱了吗?

Jailer: I also noticed that we haven't received any orders from the government since Warden Tartuffe was transferred.
狱卒：自从原来的典狱长达尔杜夫先生调任之后，我留意到，官方似乎也再没有联系过科马拉了。

Jailer: In fact, we haven't had any communication with them at all.
狱卒：今天，我们也没有收到任何来自阿根廷官方政府的消息。

Jailer: Sir, in frank terms, we're facing down a serious shortage of medicine, food, and basic supplies. At this rate, the Panopticon will soon be unable to operate. Where will our inmates go then?
狱卒：梅林先生，无论是药物、食品还是生活用品，再过一段时间，我们就无法维持监狱的正常运作了……

The man before her says nothing for a long time, his pen still flickering over the page.
面前的男人长久地沉默着。

Jailer: Can we ask the Foundation for help? Th-They've sent their people here. Maybe they're interested in the Panopticon?
狱卒：我们是否可以寻求基金会的帮助？今日，他们派人过来视察科马拉，是不是意味着他们对神秘学家监狱或者全景监狱理论感兴趣?

Jailer: I could arrange a meeting if you like.
狱卒：也许，您会愿意会见来自基金会的使者……?

The Physician: You're unusually talkative today.
狱医：这真是一件奇异的事情。

The man finally stops writing and looks up.
男人终于停下了书写，抬起头来。

Jailer: Pardon, sir?
狱卒：……您说什么，梅林先生?

The Physician: It's fascinating, you know. You've become so much more concerned about this place and its inmates than when you first started. You are now dictated by your title.
狱医：狱卒这个身份，竟然让你产生了这等的责任心。你和以前不再是一个人了。
“狱卒”——这个名字塑造了你。

Jailer: I didn't mean to overstep. I'm sorry.
狱卒：我很抱歉，梅林先生。是我僭越了。

The Physician: You can go now. I have a great deal of work to do. Oh, and one more thing.
狱医：你下去吧，我接下来还有事——对了。

He beckons the jailer back before she leaves.
他忽然记起了什么，叫住了准备离开的狱卒。

The Physician: Make sure this month's Comala Congress is held according to schedule.
狱医：记得保证科马拉议会的如期举行。

Jailer: Yes, sir.
狱卒：请放心，我会的，梅林先生。

The jaguar disappears beyond the door, metallic footsteps fading into the distance. Only then does the Physician allow his suppressed frustration to surface.
美洲豹的身影消失在门扉后，无声息的脚步逐渐远去。
直至这时，神经一直紧绷的狱医才展露出该有的烦躁。

The Physician: How many times have I warned you about this? The Idealist has to go. He's nothing but trouble for us! You're too soft on him, Aleph. Look at the mess he has us in now!
狱医：我早就说过——理想家那个家伙必须死。你得管管他，阿莱夫。你看他捅出了多大的篓子!

Aleph: Calm down.
阿莱夫：冷静些。

The Physician: He's a rabble-rousing thief, a self-destructive maniac, a snake in the grass.
狱医：一个无耻的偷盗者，自毁的狂徒，处心积虑的疯子。

The Physician: He even stole the Tear of Comala from me. He's nearly ruined everything we've worked for!
狱医：他甚至从我手中偷走了科马拉之雨。那个疯子险些毁了这一切。

The man angrily raises the once-lost and now-found die.
男人愤怒地举起那颗失而复得的骰子。

In the dim room, it flickers with a comforting glow.
幽暗的室内，它若有似无地闪烁着抚慰人心的辉光。

Aleph: It's only a die, Merlin. It does nothing more than a die can do.
阿莱夫：这只是一颗骰子，梅林。

The Physician: You were there today. You saw what he did. He managed to change the Panopticon with this die, even if only for a second.
狱医：你也看到他今日的举动了。虽然只有短短的一刻，他成功使用科马拉之雨改变了监狱的模样。

The Physician: He'll ruin my work, Aleph. He's a slave to his passion; his head is filled with impulsive thoughts. I don't trust him. We can't trust him!
狱医：他的内心如此混乱，全是非理性的映射和超现实的感受，这会彻底影响我对监狱的掌控。

The Physician: I've done everything you've asked. Now it's time to do your part.
狱医：阿莱夫，我已经按照你的吩咐，完成了你要求的一切，而你也必须对此付出应有的回报。

Aleph responds with indifference to the Physician's frustration, continuing his writing without pause.
阿莱夫对狱医的愤慨激昂呈现出一种全然的漠视，他一秒不停地书写着回信。

The Physician: Time's ticking down. I can't afford any further mistakes. No one can be permitted to stop my experiment in the Panopticon.
狱医： 剩下的时间不多了，我绝不能、不能再出任何的差错。我不会让任何人影响我对全景监狱的实验。

The Physician: I'll prove it to them that we've found the path to the ultimate answer.
狱医： 我会证明，这条道路能通向真正的答案。

监狱改造笔记
Prison Reform Notes 小径

Prison Reform Notes
监狱改造笔记

英文 / ENGLISH
During the third Comala Congress, ■■■'s daily dose of diazepam was reduced from two and three-quarter tablets to none, replaced with two classified poetry collections (A1675) and sixty chlorpromazine tablets, to be taken one and a half per day.

1. Two days, eleven hours, eight minutes, and four seconds later, an eight-millimeter crack appeared on a bar of his cell, which is on the second floor, near the third staircase, and is the eighth cell from the left. He scraped off a four-by-three-millimeter fragment from the thirty-second tile.

2. Mentions of "the other me" increased from three times in 48 hours to twenty-five times in 48 hours.

3. Four days, three hours, seven minutes, and eight seconds later, he transitioned from merely collecting manuscript paper to collecting manuscript paper and mirror fragments. Within the next twenty-four hours, he collected eleven mirrors, which totaled one hundred and three shards.

...

During the sixth Comala Congress, ■■■■'s supply of fluoxetine and valproate was completely discontinued, replaced with four classified L6759 literary selections and four rolls of 400 cm bandages.

1. ... Averaged thirty-two bangs against bars and walls per hour. The bandages were all used up within four days, fourteen hours, twenty minutes, and nine seconds, with 89.3 cm lost in the water due to excessive ripping.

2. ... Wrote fifteen pages of poetry over ten days, six hours, eight minutes, and three seconds. Tore up fourteen of those pages and swallowed the remaining one.

...
中文 / CHINESE
·■■■■的日常地西泮用量为二又四分之三片，于第三次科马拉议会取消，换为两本经归类的A1675 诗集和六十片氯丙嗪（给予每日一又二分之一片医嘱）。
1.两天十一小时八分钟零四秒后，他位于第二层第三楼梯左数第八间的囚室栏杆出现八毫米的破损，第三十二块瓷砖被他抠下四毫米×三毫米的碎屑。

2.提及“另一个我”的次数，从四十八小时内三次，变为四十八小时内二十五次。
3.四天三小时七分钟零八秒后，从仅收集文稿纸张，变为收集文稿纸张与镜子碎片，在接下去的二十四小时内共收集十一块镜子也即一百零三块碎片。

……

·于第六次科马拉议会，将[redacted]的氟西汀和丙戊酸盐供给完全取消，换为四本经归类的 L6759 文选和四卷四百厘米的绷带。
1.平均每小时撞击栏杆与墙三十二次，绷带在四天十四小时二十分钟零九秒内用尽，有八十九点三厘米在其拉扯中落入水池。
2.在十天六小时八分钟零三秒内共写诗十五页，其中撕毁十四页，剩下的一页被他吞入肚中。
……

《芝诺叛逃部队动向报告》
On Zeno Defectors 小径

On Zeno Defectors
《芝诺叛逃部队动向报告》

...

Based on the above information and recent intelligence from the Timekeeper's squad, it is confirmed that Zeno's defector unit had entered Comala Prison, which held numerous arcanists, and withdrew from Ushuaia on March 2nd. The operation clearly involved cooperation with Manus Vindictae. The current whereabouts of the defectors remains unclear, pending further intelligence from the Timekeeper's squad.

*The information is fragmented and primarily inferential. For the full reasoning behind the operation and additional details, please refer to Attachments 4-28.
……
综合以上多方信息以及近日司辰小队传来的情报，可以确认芝诺叛逃部队曾涉足关押众多神秘学家的科马拉监狱，并于 3 月 2 日从乌斯怀亚撤离，该行动轨迹明确涉及重塑之手，叛逃部队目前的行踪去向尚不明确，可以等待司辰小队的进一步情报。
*信息较为琐碎，以推断为主，行动推论过程与情报原件索引见附件 4-28。

费洛蒙漩涡
The Ant Mill 9TH-10

The Ant Mill
费洛蒙漩涡

The cottage with the blue roof was silent as always.
那座蓝色屋顶的茅屋一如既往地沉默着。

In a fleeting dream, the Paracausality Researcher uncovered the truth behind the Die of Babylon.
能量扰动学家在一片梦的投影中，发现了巴比伦之骰的真相。

She carefully examined hidden patterns, much like an astute astrologer tracks the movements of the stars.
正如所有的历史学家一样，她尊敬相仿的规律。正如所有的占星师一样，她尊敬星轨的移动。

What may seem like errors or accidents doesn't negate the verities of destiny. On the contrary, they affirm its very existence. Just ask the great Heraclitus!
容忍错误不等于否认命运的真实性，相反，它证实了命运的存在。如果您对此有疑问，不妨问问伟大的赫拉克利特吧！

In an unobserved universe, the Die of Babylon spins in perpetuity, dictating the fate of all in time that is both infinitely long and infinitely short.
在无人观测的宇宙中，巴比伦之骰将永不停止地旋转。在无限长又无限短的时间里，它将为所有人赋予命运。

Look, she closed her eyes! She respected the randomness of numbers and destiny. She respected the Die's judgment.
瞧，她已经闭上了眼睛！她尊重数字的偶然性，尊重命运的随机性，尊重巴比伦的决定。

Otherwise, she would have acquiescently lost herself in the gaps of time and wandered forever as a ghost in oblivion.
否则，她自愿迷失于时间的间隙中，成为永恒徘徊的幽灵。

Hall of New Encounters
触发事件大厅

In the solemn prison hall, under the half-light of the next day, the prisoners of Comala gather.
翌日。静穆的监狱大厅中，几乎所有科马拉的囚犯都聚集在了此处。

Octavia steps onto the podium with a stern expression.
在众人的视线下，面色严肃的奥克塔维奥走上了主持台。

Octavia: First, allow me to make one thing clear: I had absolutely nothing to do with what happened to the Idealist yesterday. I swear it on my career as a writer!
奥克塔维奥：首先，我必须向诸位澄清：昨日，发生在理想家先生身上的事情与我毫无干系。我愿以我未来的作家生涯起誓！

Octavia: As you all know, the Idealist and I are the representatives of the two factions of La Sociedad de Poetas de las Américas. As you also know, we have been at peace since the Let Sleeping Dogs Lie agreement was signed a few months ago.
奥克塔维奥：诸位皆知，我与理想家先生分别代表着美洲诗社的两个不同派别。
制定不要自找麻烦条约[Let sleeping dogs lie]以来数月，我们一直保持着和平。

Octavia: Despite our differing views, we have coexisted to this day under the watchful gaze of the central tower. Rest assured that we will work tirelessly to locate the missing Idealist.
奥克塔维奥：时至今日，我们仍然共同生存于瞭望塔的视线下，奉行着同样的行事原则。请诸位相信，我们与管理者们会共同努力，寻找理想家先生的下落。

Inmate III: Don't put so much pressure on yourself, Ms. Octavia. His death wasn't your fault!
囚犯 III：奥克塔维奥小姐，无需自责，这并不是您的错！

Inmate III: After all, he was the one who threw the first verbal dagger!
囚犯 III：分明是他先口出狂言，在精神上攻击了您！

The murmurs cascading below reach the ears of the prisoners from another faction.
台下的窃窃私语自然也传到了另一派系的囚犯耳中。

Roberta: Show some respect, you morons!
罗贝托：嘿，你们这些家伙，对理想家先生放尊重一点！

Roberta: The Idealist is missing, not dead! I'm sure he'll show up in one piece before we know it!
罗贝托：理想家先生只是失踪了！在我们找到他之前，他就会完好如初地出现在我们所有人面前！

Inmate III: Better face the hard truth now, Roberta. Though I have to say, it won't be easy for you to find a new leader as mad as him!
囚犯 III：趁早节哀吧，罗贝托！我只能说，你们很难再找到一个像他这样疯得彻底的领导者了！

A polite cough from the hostess pauses the heated debate.
主持人的轻咳打断了台下的争论。

Octavia: Please, everyone, quiet down!
奥克塔维奥：……请诸位保持安静！

Octavia: According to the agreement, today's congress should've been chaired by the Idealist. Since he is still missing, I will be acting on his—
奥克塔维奥：按照条约，本次科马拉议会[The Congress]的主持人应是理想家先生。由于他在那场意外中失踪，现在由我代理——

???: Pardon my lateness. Go ahead. I'm ready to moderate.
???：抱歉。作为议会的监督者，我来晚了。

Unfamiliar footsteps break the regular pattern of events. The jailer leads her visitors to the entrance of the prison hall.
属于外来者的脚步声响起，狱卒带领着访客出现在监狱大厅的入口处。

Jailer: Ms. Vertin, I looked over the incarceration and visitor records from the past six months.
狱卒：维尔汀小姐，昨晚，我查阅了监狱近半年的档案，但均一无所获。

Jailer: There was no mention of anyone named Dores.
狱卒：科马拉监狱中，并没有关于德洛丝女士任何的官方书面记录。

Vertin: Then it seems only the Physician knows the whereabouts of Dr. Dores. Ms. Jailer, we need to meet with the Physician. It's important.
维尔汀：目前看来，只有狱医才知晓德洛丝女士的下落。我们有迫切见到监狱管理者的理由，希望您能安排。

Jailer: Listen, you really shouldn't take the inmates' ramblings too seriously.
狱卒：请理解，囚犯们的胡言乱语并不能代表什么。

Considering the identity of the person before her, the jailer softens her tone.
思索至面前人的身份，狱卒仍然缓和了措辞。

Jailer: But, if it's as critical as you say, I'll make another request later.
狱卒：但……基金会的诸位，如果你们确实有此诉求，我可以稍后再次去询问。

Jailer: That said, I'm afraid the meeting won't happen for at least a few days.
狱卒：只不过，接待的时间不会是近几天。

Vertin: Understood.
维尔汀：我们明白了。

Jailer: For now, please join us for today's congress.
狱卒：在此之前，我诚挚邀请诸位参与今日的科马拉议会。

Recoleta: Spectacular! Do you hold literary salons like this every day? This place is practically a writer's paradise.
虚构集：看这里的阵仗，难道每天大厅中都要办一场文学沙龙吗？科马拉监狱简直就是作家的天堂……

Recoleta: So, you're the host of the salon, Octavia?
虚构集：奥克塔维奥小姐，又见面了。今天是你来主持吗？

Recoleta: I say we set aside our differences and have a titillating literary discussion!
虚构集：也许在沙龙上，我们能撇开成见，好好聊聊文学本身！

Octavia: You've come at the right time. You may serve as witnesses for the congress alongside the jailer, like a citizens' jury in a court.
奥克塔维奥：……你们来得正好。除了狱卒小姐外，我希望各位客人也能作为科马拉议会的公证人，就像法院的公民陪审团那样。

Jailer: Your suggestion aligns with the congressional rules. Very well.
狱卒：很好，这的确是一个符合议会规则的提议。

Recoleta: Huh? Congress? Witnesses?
虚构集：……？什么议会？什么公证人？

Recoleta: Isn't this a salon? Which topic are we discussing? Literary theories, schools, principles, languages, oh, narrative perspectives?
虚构集：这议会代表着什么？学科、流派、主义、语种还是叙事视角？

Octavia: None of those.
奥克塔维奥：并非如此。

Octavia lowers her head, giving her questioner a long and deep look.
奥克塔维奥低下头，深深地看了提问者一眼。

Octavia: This congress is about the randomness of fate, Ms. Recoleta.
奥克塔维奥：是命运的随机性，虚构集小姐。

Recoleta: Randomness of fate?
虚构集：命运的……随机性？

As she sinks into confusion and bewilderment, the jailer's voice rises into a triumphant introduction.
在她陷入了迷惑与恍惚之时，狱卒的声音却前所未有地高昂了起来。

Jailer: Dear visitors from the Foundation, allow me to introduce the Comala Congress.
狱卒：来自基金会的诸位官方职员，请让我为大家介绍“科马拉议会”。

Jailer: What happened yesterday was merely a brief anomaly. In the Panopticon, spontaneous order among the inmates is the norm, and the Comala Congress serves as its truest reflection.
狱卒：昨日发生的暴乱只是一场短暂的意外。在科马拉实验性全景监狱中，囚犯们自发性的秩序才是常态。科马拉议会正是在这种状态下诞生的最佳写照！

Vertin: Spontaneous order?
维尔汀：这是囚犯们自主治理的方式？

Jailer: Yes. Through the congress, the inmates assign and distribute medication, communal duties, and rest periods. They are entirely self-regulated.
狱卒：是的，囚犯们通过科马拉议会，分配精神药物、安排劳作场所、管理休憩时间。这一切都是自发的。

Her tone is filled with pride.
她的语气充满自豪。

Octavia: I hereby announce the commencement of the seventh Comala Congress!
奥克塔维奥：我宣布，第七届科马拉议会正式开始！

As her words fall, Octavia takes out a worn lottery box and a small trinket from her hand. The prisoners move in perfect order like a swarm of ants.
话音落下，奥克塔维奥取出一只残旧的彩票箱，以及一个捏在手上的小玩意儿。囚犯们像一个巨大的蚁群，井然有序地移动了起来。

Sonetto: A cardboard box and—is that a paper die? Hmm. It has 20 sides.
十四行诗：一个纸皮做成的箱子，和一只 4 面、6 面、8 面、10 面、12 面、14 面……20 个面的纸质骰子。

Recoleta: ...?
虚构集：……?

Octavia: We carefully examine hidden patterns, much like an astute astrologer tracks the movements of the stars.
奥克塔维奥：正如所有的历史学家一样，我们尊敬相仿的规律。正如所有的占星师一样，我们尊敬星轨的移动。

Recoleta: Isn't this ...?!
虚构集：这是……?!

From somewhere in the audience, the girl unconsciously mumbles a revelation.
台下的女孩情不自禁地喃喃道。

Recoleta: Isn't this just like the Die of Babylon?! The MacGuffin that weaves through the entire plot, the infinite symbiote of fate, and the symbol that compresses time into a shriveled circle?
虚构集：就像，**巴比伦之骰**……？那个凝集作品主题的麦高芬，那个无穷无尽的命运共生体，那个将人类的时间压成干瘪圆圈的符号?

Octavia: What may seem like errors or accidents doesn't negate the verities of destiny. On the contrary, they affirm its very existence. Just ask the great Heraclitus!
奥克塔维奥：容忍错误不等于否认命运的真实性。相反，它证实了命运的存在。如果您对此有疑问，不妨问问伟大的赫拉克利特吧！

Octavia: In an unobserved universe, the Die spins in perpetuity ...
奥克塔维奥：在无人观测的宇宙中，骰子将永不停止地旋转……

Recoleta: "Dictating the fate of all in time that is both infinitely long and infinitely short"?
虚构集：“在无限长又无限短的时间里，它将为所有人赋予命运”……?

Vertin: ...?!
维尔汀：……?!

Inmates: Look, I've closed my eyes! I respect the randomness of numbers and destiny. I respect the Die's judgment.
囚犯们：瞧，我已经闭上了眼睛！我尊重数字的偶然性，尊重命运的随机性，尊重骰子的决定。

As the prisoners recite their announcements, the author's voice becomes more and more sluggish.
在囚犯高亢的宣读中，原作者的声音却显得迟疑而滞涩。

Recoleta: "Otherwise, we will acquiescently lose ourselves in the gaps of time and wander forever as ghosts in oblivion."
虚构集：“否则，我自愿迷失于时间的间隙中，成为永恒徘徊的幽灵。”

Recoleta: I-I don't understand what's going on.
虚构集：我已经无法理解眼前的一切了……

Recoleta: Oh, but the irony's that I probably have more idea what's going on than anyone here.
虚构集：但，好笑的是，我也许是那个最知道会发生什么的人。

Vertin: Ms. Recoleta, this is all in your novel, isn't it?
维尔汀：虚构集小姐，这些……全是你小说的内容吗?

Recoleta: I'm afraid so. The recitations, the references to an astrologer, and Heraclitus—they couldn't possibly be just a coincidence.
虚构集：是的，无论是界限的咒语、历史学家、占星师还是赫拉克利特……

Recoleta: Then, could it be? Will they look to the die to dictate their fate?
虚构集：难道说，接下来他们要让巴比伦之骰为一切赋予命运……?!

The girls' audible shock does not affect the proceedings on stage; the congress continues.
台下女孩们的震惊并没有影响到台上的一切，议会仍在继续着。

Octavia: I shall perform the first roll. Its result will determine the subsequent roll order for this congress.
奥克塔维奥：第一次抽签将由我进行，它首先决定了本次议会的代表顺序。

The hostess tosses the twenty-sided die into the cardboard box and begins shaking it rhythmically.
议会主持人将二十面骰抛入纸箱，并遵循某种节奏开始了摇晃。

Octavia: The result is 5. This check complies with the prerequisite conditions of the Ruling of the Die, and the standard roll order has been established.
奥克塔维奥：投掷的结果是数字“**5**”。本次检定符合**科马拉议会投掷准则**中的初始先决条件，标准投掷顺序已被决定。

Octavia: Inmate José, please come forth.
奥克塔维奥：何塞先生，请上前来。

Octavia: You are the first in the initiative order. Therefore, fate's judgment shall fall upon you before all else.
奥克塔维奥：作为团众中的先攻[Initiative]，你需要第一个接受命运的裁定。

Inmate III: Me? O-Okay ...
囚犯 III：是我吗……好的，好的。

The prisoner steps forward, taking the fragile box in his hands, shaking it to roll the die of absurd fate inside.
被点名的囚犯上前来，他接过那只仿佛随时就要破碎的彩票箱，晃动着，让那枚代表着荒唐命运的骰子在里面翻滚。

The die stops, and just like that, a simple number decides his fate.
骰子停止了转动，就这样，一个简单的数字决定了这名囚犯接下来数十天的命运。

Inmate III: 17! It's 17! Ah, what a wonderful number, 17! Like an oasis in an endless desert!
囚犯 III：是“**17**”!！太好了!！**17** 是像沙丘之间的绿洲那样稀有的好数字！

Octavia: The result is 17, and the score combination 6+4+4+3. According to the Ruling of the Die, he shall receive 60 risperidone tablets, 40 clozapine tablets, and 40 diazepam tablets. Additionally, he will assume the role of cultural manager of the Comala Congress.
奥克塔维奥：判定值为“6+4+4+3”。根据**科马拉议会投掷准则**，何塞的奖励是 60 片利培酮、40 片氯氮平、40 片地西泮。与此同时，他将擢升为科马拉议会的文化管理员。

Octavia: Before he takes office, Inmate José must clean the first restroom for the next seven days.
奥克塔维奥：述职交接前，何塞需要在第一厕所完成为期七天的清扫任务。

Inmate III: W-Wonderful! I'll gladly clean the toilet! I've got the brooms here, the toilet detergent, oh, and the toilet brush, too!
囚犯 III：太……太好了！我早就有一个伟大的想法了！扫把在这里、清洁剂在这里、对了、还有马桶刷……

Inmate III: I have been waiting for this opportunity! As cultural manager, I will speak with every inmate and complete the Comala Memoir, finally capturing the moments when literary sparks ignite and explode.
囚犯 III：我要写一本《科马拉监狱亲历记》♪要与每位成员进行一对一会谈♪要记下他们文学的火花爆炸的瞬间♪……

Octavia: Next is Inmate Edoardo. Please come forth.
奥克塔维奥：接下来是爱德华多先生，请上前来。

The man in question is a nervous mess. His gaze flickers, his eyebrows fight for space on his forehead, and his teeth clash against each other in turmoil.
来者的面孔显然处于极度的精神紧张中。他的眼神闪烁不定，两撇眉毛在争夺眉心，牙齿也打着群架。

Inmate IV: B-But I can't remember the Ruling of the Die. I can't remember anything. Damn it!
囚犯 IV：可……可是，我忘记了判定的准则……我什么都不记得了！该死！

Inmate IV: Sorry, Ms. Octavia, but I-I don't think I can do this! I didn't get any medication in the last congress. I've had multiple episodes. It's like ... like my brain's jammed or something!
囚犯 IV：很抱歉，奥克塔维奥小姐，我没有办法继续下去……！自从上次没有分配到药物后，我犯了好几次病，现在脑袋里塞不下任何一个字母……

Octavia: It's alright, Inmate Edoardo. It's easy. You don't need to know the rules to roll the Die. Give me your hand. I'll help you.
奥克塔维奥：别紧张，爱德华多，遵从投掷准则是整个环节中最容易的事情。来吧，把手放上来，我会协助你进行掷骰。

The prisoner follows suit, hands trembling as he shakes the box—the only thing he can do.
囚犯一脸惊恐地照做了。跟随悬于空中的双手摇晃箱子——那是他唯一能做的事。

Octavia: My sincerest apologies, Inmate Edoardo. The Die dictates that you must voluntarily descend into the sewers and write the thematic keyword that currently causes you the most anxiety on the walls.
奥克塔维奥：我很遗憾，爱德华多。你必须自愿踏入下水道的污秽中，并在墙上写下一个你眼下最为焦虑的、作品主题的关键词。

Inmate IV: I ... Th-Thank you very much, Ms. Octavia.
囚犯 IV：我……非常感谢您，奥克塔维奥小姐……

Inmate IV: Agh. I think my head's about to split in half. I ... I need a moment to rest before I head down there ...
囚犯 IV：只是我的脑袋要裂开了。我想我需要休息一会儿，再循着臭味去往下水道……

Inmate IV: ... and fulfill my destiny.
囚犯 IV：然后，完成我的命运。

Clutching his head, the prisoner leaves. His steps heavy, his hands empty, but his brow finally falling at ease.
捂着脑袋的囚犯离去了。他步伐沉重，一无所获，眉心却反而得以舒展。

Recoleta: Jailer, are you really letting them make every decision with the roll of a die?
虚构集：等等……！狱卒小姐，他们是在以骰子来决定一切吗？

Recoleta: Edoardo is clearly in a much more dire condition than José. The medication should've been given to him!
虚构集：可爱德华多的病情看起来比何塞要严重多了，他才是那个最应该得到药物的人！

Jailer: As I said, this is how the inmates of the Panopticon maintain order. The Physician periodically provides medication, food, and other necessities, and the inmates distribute them in this spontaneous and efficient manner.
狱卒：我先前已经解释过，这是科马拉监狱自发诞生的高效管理模式。狱医阁下将一定数量的药物、食品等生活物资交由囚犯们，他们则通过自发的方式进行分配。

Jailer: Neither authority nor violence is involved in this process. This is what sets Comala apart from all other custodial facilities.
狱卒：这当中不需要管理层的介入，也不涉及到暴力事件——这就是科马拉相较于世上所有监狱的不同之处。

Recoleta: Is that it? You abdicate all agency to the roll of a paper die and call it the "randomness of fate"? What kind of sick joke is this?!
虚构集：而这一切……仅仅是因为“命运的随机性”吗？你们管那颗用纸皮糊成的骰子叫“命运”——这是哪门子的玩笑？

Jailer: Please calm down, Recoleta. This is the method that the inmates have collectively decided to recognize. They're prepared to face the possible sacrifices that it brings.
狱卒：你需要冷静，虚构集小姐，这是囚犯们所共同认可的公平秩序。有时，我们必须正视它所带来的牺牲和代价。

Jailer: This isn't about you or me. It's not our place to interfere with a procedure that has been proven both pragmatic and effective.
狱卒：……无论你我是否能理解，我们都不该干涉一项合理运行并卓有成效的规则。

Jailer: My duty is to assist the inmates in maintaining order through the methods that they have established, and yours is to witness their self-governance, not judge it.
狱卒：我身为“狱卒”的职责是维持秩序，而你，虚构集小姐，你也不具备定义这一切的资格。

The jailer takes a deep breath. Her words clearly meant to convince herself as much as anyone listening.
狱卒深吸一口气。比起说服对方，她的话更是在说服自己。

Recoleta: If everything somehow unfolds as it does in my novel, then every roll is already predetermined.
虚构集：但是，如果这都在按照小说所运行，那一切都是早已被注定的……

Recoleta: Vertin, do you remember the story I told you last night? The odds of both success and failure were consecutively multiplied.
虚构集：维尔汀，你还记得我昨晚所提到的故事吗？巴比伦之骰的随机性中增加了一倍的幸运，也增加了一倍的罚码。

Vertin: I remember.
维尔汀：我有印象。

Recoleta: As soon as a character experiences a failure, they continue to suffer failures in an endless chain reaction.
虚构集：从一次简单的失败开始，命运将会像链式反应一样无止境地溃败下去。

Recoleta: None of Edoardo's future dice rolls will ever result in a number higher than 10.
虚构集：爱德华多在下次、下下次和往后的每一次，都永远无法掷出大于 10 的点数。

Recoleta: At this rate, this system ... this Sociedad ruled by the Dice of Babylon, is bound to collapse.
虚构集：而且最终，由巴比伦之骰所掌控的一切，只会导向毁灭……

She looks around, realizing that her words—weighty as they seem to her—have garnered no attention.
她看了看周围，发现如此具有重量的话语，竟然没有得到任何人的注目——一个也没有。

Recoleta: Edoardo will never receive any medication.
虚构集：……总而言之，爱德华多这辈子都不会获得任何的药物。

Recoleta: The moment he writes the keyword on the wall could very well be the moment he spells out his own death!
虚构集：按照巴比伦之骰倍数的惩罚，在墙上写下关键词的瞬间，他就会迎来自身的终局！

Recoleta: No, I can't let this happen. I have to do something!
虚构集：如果真的是这样，我得想办法改变这一切……！

Recoleta rushes to the stage.
虚构集冲向了讲台的方向。

Jailer: Wait, Ms. Recoleta! What are you doing?
狱卒：等等，虚构集小姐！你要干什么?!

命运豪赌
Gamble of Fate 小径

Few soldiers would appreciate the idea of taking orders from an accursed die. A skilled commander would never rely on luck to make decisions.
???: 没什么人愿意听一枚骰子的指挥，指挥官不应该用运气下命令。

On the battlefield, the distance for every maneuver should be clear and precise—not two numbers with a "d" in the middle—unless you're looking to invite a mutiny.
???: 每天的行军路程得是一个简单明了的数字，而不是两个数字中间夹着一个“D”，这会引起哗变的。

That said, if a die with such power were placed in a soldier's hand ...
???: 当然，若有一枚骰子，可提前为士兵宣告命运的选择——

I'm pretty sure they'd roll it and let it decide their destiny.
???: 我想他应该会把命交给骰子，专心等待它落下。

选项 / Choices

1. Luck won't always be on your side.
1. 不会次次都有好运的

Exactly. There's no good luck without bad luck—just as a coin must have two sides. Luck essentially defines one's entire life.
???: 而幸福正好需要厄运作伴，运气好和运气坏加起来就足以概括任何人的人生。

And whether it's make or break, life or death, the die will keep on rolling.
???: 不论生存还是死亡，骰子可以无数次地滚落。当然，也不止骰子……

Of course, dice aren't the only tools used to "play" with fate—coins, lotteries, even shells on the beach can all serve the same purpose.
???: 一枚硬币，一只贝壳，或者一张彩票，娱乐命运的手段要多少有多少。

Thanks to the randomness of fate, a Babylonian may rise to be a proconsul one day and fall into slavery the next.
???: 一个巴比伦人可以在十天前成为总督，更可以在二十天后变为奴隶。

选项 / Choices

1. Some tragedies could have been avoided.
1. 有些事本可以避免

Well, that's where historians come in.
???: 这就是历史学家的工作了。

With a little creative editing of the history books, even the random rolls of a die can suddenly make sense.
???: 让他们在书上删减几笔，增添几笔，骰子的结果便有了合理性。

What were once "avoidable tragedies" are rebranded as "reasonable incidents" or even "desirable outcomes."
???: “不该如此”就变成了“这很合理”以及“本应如此”。

选项 / Choices

1. At least the roll of a die is impartial.
1. 毕竟骰子公平公正，充满机会

Hmph, you're starting to sound like a gambler.
???: 你已初步洞察了赌徒的心理。

But even gamblers, after hitting a hot streak—or a losing spell—start to convince themselves that they've figured out the grand pattern behind games of chance.
???: 不过输多了或者赢多了的家伙都会觉得自己看穿了骰子之上的伟大规律。

It isn't just gamblers, either. Witches tried to influence fate through rituals and charms. Ancient mathematicians calculated probabilities on paper. Some even wrote books on game theory.
???: 巫师装神弄鬼换取幸运，数学家在纸上倒腾可能性，赌博游戏成为了著作的养料。

Meanwhile, others suspected there were cheaters among them.
???: 或者单纯怀疑有人出老千。

I just hope these high rollers unite to confront the demon who holds the laws of the universe—the past, present, and future—in its claws and give it a "Well done!" and a slap in the face.
???: 但愿这群人能走到一起，然后找出那个真正掌握了宇宙万物过去未来所有规律的恶魔，再赏它一耳光说辛苦了。

选项 / Choices

1. You're talking in circles today.
1. 你今天说话真是混乱不堪

Haven't I always? It's just that today, the die rolled a peculiar number.
???: 我想我一贯如此，只是今天骰子给出了一个独特的数字。

But all things considered, I prefer the other kind of commander.
???: 不过话说回来，其实我更喜欢另一种指挥官。

The die is cast. But regardless of what number has been rolled, it's time to cross the river.
???: 骰子已经掷下了，但别管是几，该过河了。

Gamble of Fate
命运豪赌

《科马拉监狱治疗清单第 303 目》

Treatments, Entry 303 小径

Treatments, Entry 303
《科马拉监狱治疗清单第 303 目》

英文 / ENGLISH

December 1
Numbers 704-733
Each person is uniformly allocated 1 dose of chlorpromazine and 1 dose of thalidomide.

December 3
Numbers 704-710, 712-730, 732-733
Each person is uniformly allocated 3 doses of chlorpromazine and 3 doses of thalidomide.

December 7
Numbers 706-708, 712-717, 722-730, 732
Each person is uniformly allocated 6 doses of chlorpromazine and 11 doses of Veronal.

...
中文 / CHINESE
12 月 1 日
704 号-733 号
各人统一配发氯丙嗪 1 剂，沙利度胺 1 剂
12 月 3 日
704 号-710 号，712 号-730 号，732 号-733 号
各人统一配发氯丙嗪 3 剂，沙利度胺 3 剂
12 月 7 日
706 号-708 号，712 号-717 号，722 号-730 号，732 号
各人统一配发氯丙嗪 6 剂，佛罗那 11 剂
……

先知、宇宙、造就
Soothsayer, Worldmaker 9TH-11

Soothsayer, Worldmaker
先知、宇宙、造就

On the stage, Octavia remains the picture of serenity as she orchestrates the congress.
主持台上，奥克塔维奥有条不紊地组织着科马拉议会的运行。

Octavia: Ms. Recoleta, as a witness to the congress, you have the right to express your doubts—calmly.
奥克塔维奥：虚构集小姐，你可以提出你的疑惑或质疑，这是你作为公证人的权益。

Recoleta: Listen, you—
虚构集：你们……

She recalls the complaints of her two former companions, the jailer's dismissals, and the confused expressions of every editor she has ever faced.
她想到了同行青年的抱怨，想到了狱卒的否定之辞，想到了她所面对的每一位编辑的迷惑脸色。

If she were to lay out every detail of her novel here and now, she would only get the same response.
如果她将小说的一切和盘托出，那也许只会收获一模一样的反应。

Recoleta: *huff* No, it's nothing. It's just that I'd like to participate in the dice-rolling ceremony. May I?
虚构集：……不，没什么。我也想要进行你们神圣的投掷仪式。请问我能加入吗?

Octavia: Of course! The very fact that you're standing here in the Panopticon proves that you share a common fate with it.
奥克塔维奥：当然！只要你身处科马拉监狱之中，那就证明了你与监狱的命运具有共通性。

Recoleta surveys the prisoners waiting to cast their die. Their expressions are serene, untroubled, calmly awaiting their fate. The joys and misfortunes of those before them do not affect the long, winding queue in the slightest.
初来乍到的青年作家，环视四周等待投掷的囚犯。他们面色平静，等待着命运的降临，前人的惊喜与噩运并没有影响这条蜿蜒的队列丝毫。

She takes a deep breath.
她深吸一口气。

Recoleta: It doesn't matter when I roll the Die, since the rolls are simply a reflection of the randomness of fate, right?
虚构集：如果这一切都是全然随机的命运，那么我加入队列的时机并不会影响投掷的结果，对吗?

Octavia: Precisely.
奥克塔维奥：当然。

Recoleta: Then, I'd like to perform my roll after the 27th inmate. Is that alright?
虚构集：我要在第二十七位囚犯完成投掷之后加入，可以吗?

Octavia: As you wish, Ms. Recoleta.
奥克塔维奥：如你所愿，虚构集小姐。

Octavia: It seems fate favors you, Ms. Recoleta.
奥克塔维奥：你拥有很好的运气，科马拉的命运在眷顾你，虚构集小姐。

Octavia: Here are your supplies.
奥克塔维奥：这是属于你的药品与物资，请拿好。

Octavia: Please be sure to follow the distribution rules of the congress. This is an essential structure of Comala and a belief shared by all its inmates. Honor it.
奥克塔维奥：请务必遵守议会的分配规定，这是所有人共通的信念，也是维持科马拉运作最重要的部分。

Recoleta: Just as I suspected.
虚构集：这一切果然……如我所料。

Recoleta: These supplies belong to me now, Octavia. I'm free to use them however I please.
虚构集：奥克塔维奥小姐，既然这是我得到的东西，我想我有权处置它。

Recoleta strides toward Edoardo, who has curled up in a distant corner, clutching his head, as his body trembles in silence.
获得了个人胜利的女孩，走向蜷缩在不远处角落的爱德华多。在投掷结束后，他一直抱着头，躯体无声颤抖着。

Recoleta: Here, Edoardo, take them.
虚构集：爱德华多先生，我将我得到的东西都赠送给你。

Inmate IV: ...?
囚犯 IV：……?

Inmate IV: B-But I haven't fulfilled my destiny yet.
囚犯 IV：可……可是，我还没有完成我的命运。

Inmate IV: These precious tablets and capsules ... I can't accept them. They are gifts from fate. The Die has placed them in your palm.
囚犯 IV：这些珍贵的圆片和五彩的胶囊……它们并不属于我，它们是命运馈赠给您的礼物。

Recoleta: But I don't need them; you do.
虚构集：这些药对我来说没有用，我觉得你才是最需要它们的人。

Inmate IV: Th-Thank you, kind miss.
囚犯 IV：谢谢你，善良的小姐……

The prisoner's trembling stops. He blankly pinches his arm, as if trying to distinguish reality from dream.
囚犯的颤抖停止了，他呆滞地掐了掐自己的手臂，仿佛在分辨梦境。

Then, all at once, he snatches the medication from her hands and shoves it into his mouth.
随后，他猛地把对方手中的药物抢过，疯狂地塞入嘴中。

Recoleta: Edoardo?! What's wrong? A-Are you taking the medicine right now?
虚构集：……爱德华多先生？你怎么了？你……你现在就需要吃药吗？

Recoleta: There's no need to rush. There's plenty of it. You can have it all.
虚构集：请不要着急，我会把剩下的药物都给你的！

Inmate I: For goodness' sake, Edoardo! How could you squander fate's gifts like this?
囚犯 I：你可真是该死，爱德华多！这是来自命运的馈赠，你怎么能如此挥霍！

Inmate I: Kind miss, please, give me the medication. I need them more than anyone else.
囚犯 I：善良的小姐！请将您的药物赠予我吧……我才是那个最需要它们的人！

Inmate II: No, I'm the one who needs them most. Give me the medication. I beg of you.
囚犯 II：不，不，是我！给我吧，善良的小姐，将您的药物给我！求求您了！

Inmate II: With the protection of these amulets, I might finally be able to get a peaceful night's sleep, no more trembling floors and wailing ghosts.
囚犯 II：我很久没有睡过一个安稳的觉了！有了护身符[Amuleto]，那些该死的幽灵今晚一定会放过我的，这监狱的地板也不会再震动了。

The prisoners shove and struggle, countless hands reaching toward the hapless writer, trying to snatch the small round pills of salvation.
囚犯们推搡着、扭打着，许多只手朝无助的访客伸去，试图撷取她手中那些代表着救赎的小小圆片。

Octavia: Enough! Enough!!
奥克塔维奥：够了……都停下！

A blue glow spreads through the room, forcing the prisoners to clutch their heads and fall down to their knees. Their riot comes to an abrupt halt.
青色的光芒使囚犯们都不约而同地抱头蹲下，骚乱停止了。

Octavia: You shouldn't have done that, Ms. Recoleta.
奥克塔维奥：……你不该这么做的，虚构集小姐。

Octavia: Your ignorant generosity could shatter the very basis of our survival.
奥克塔维奥：你一无所知，却又盲目善良。你的一次布施就会摧毁我们赖以生存的一切。

She steps toward Edoardo, now writhing in pain, and picks up a few stray capsules scattered at his feet.
她走至痛苦的爱德华多面前，将他脚边遗落的几颗胶囊捡了起来。

The pills dissolve into a stream of voided sand, vanishing as it pours through her fingers.
药片化作一阵虚无的沙砾，从她的指尖消散了。

Octavia: We have never had such chaos at the congress. Understand this: We rely only on the randomness of fate to distribute supplies and assign responsibilities.
奥克塔维奥：在此之前，我们从未发生过这样的骚乱，我们用命运的随机性来决定药品与物资的分配，安排大家的劳作。

Octavia: If you disrupt this status quo, the entire system of the Panopticon will collapse beyond repair.
奥克塔维奥：一旦你打破了其中一项，这个监狱的制度就会陷入彻底的溃败，它将不复存在。

Octavia: It is only by respecting the arbitrariness of fate and adhering to the rules of the Die of Babylon that we have kept this place functioning all this time.
奥克塔维奥：我们遵从命运扑朔迷离的规律，遵从巴比伦之骰法则，才将监狱秩序维持至今。

Recoleta: The Die of Babylon?!
虚构集：巴比伦之骰……?!

Recoleta: Tell me, how did you know this name? Are you the one orchestrating this whole thing?
虚构集：告诉我，你是从哪里得知这个名字的?！难道是你在操纵这一切吗?

Recoleta, equally confused and furious, grabs the hostess's collar.
女孩茫然又愤怒地抓住了主持人的衣领，如同在阻止她逃离一般。

Recoleta: C-Could it be? Are you Aleph, just as Vertin suspected?
虚构集：难道，难道维尔汀的猜测是对的……你就是阿莱夫?

Octavia: Let go of me, Ms. Recoleta! Have you gone mad?
奥克塔维奥：放手，虚构集小姐，你怎么也像他们一样发疯?

Octavia: The roll of the Die is absolutely random. I'm not orchestrating anything. Before the congress began, I made an oath. I intend to keep it.
奥克塔维奥：骰子是全然随机的，我并没有任何背后的操纵举动。我以过去与未来的作家生涯起誓过，我绝不会违背我在科马拉议会开始前的誓言。

Vertin: Please, calm down, Ms. Recoleta. I think she's telling the truth.
维尔汀：冷静些，虚构集小姐。奥克塔维奥小姐并不像在撒谎。

She lets go of her grip as the reality of their situation dawns on her.
她像是忽然回过神来一般松开了手。

Recoleta: S-Sorry, Octavia, but, please, you have to tell me how you learned about the Die of Babylon.
虚构集：我很抱歉……奥克塔维奥小姐。只是，请你务必如实告诉我，你是如何得知巴比伦之骰的?

Recoleta: I must know. Only my pen pal and I should have any knowledge about this die.
虚构集：这应该是只有我笔友知晓的故事……这对我来说真的很重要。

Octavia: I heard about it from the Physician. He described it as a symbol of collective consciousness that we could harness to maintain immaculate order in the Panopticon.
奥克塔维奥：……这是狱医先生告诉我的概念，它是一种存在于集体意识中的象征体。我们只要能够借用它，就能让科马拉处于完美的秩序之中。

Octavia: The Comala Congress was coined, iterated, and perfected by the Physician based on this concept.
奥克塔维奥：至于科马拉议会，它来自狱医先生在此基础上提出的一种天才式设想。后来，它经过了数次修改，才真正落实为一个合理的方案。

Vertin: The Physician again. Everything eventually leads back to him, just as we suspected.
维尔汀：又是狱医。看来我们的推测无误，这一切果然和幕后的这个人有关联。

Recoleta: I see.
虚构集：原来如此……

Recoleta casts her eyes over to the silent jaguar, who has remained wordless from beginning to end, watching it all unfold.
虚构集看向从头到尾一直不作声的美洲豹，大型捕食者只是默默地注视着这一切的发生。

Recoleta: Jailer, we have to meet with the Physician in person, now.
虚构集：狱卒小姐，我们现在就要见到那位狱医本人。

Jailer: As I've told you many times, Dr. Merlin is too busy at the moment.
狱卒：我已经告诉过诸位多次了，梅林先生现在非常繁忙，不便于接待。

Jailer: I couldn't possibly trouble him over a novel and a pen pal. They're just fantasies.
狱卒：关于虚构集的小说和笔友……这种无稽之谈无法成为打扰梅林先生工作的理由。

Vertin: Couldn't you make an exception?
维尔汀：狱卒小姐，请您再考虑一下。

Vertin: What if they're not just fantasies? What if they're tied to the very survival of this place?
维尔汀：如果这一切，并不是无稽之谈，而是和监狱的存亡有着直接关系呢?

Vertin: Ms. Recoleta said the Panopticon could collapse because of the Die of Babylon.
维尔汀：刚刚虚构集小姐提到过，由巴比伦之骰所掌控的一切，最终只会导向毁灭。

Jailer: Are you seriously telling me you believe that nonsense?
狱卒：您的意思是，您相信虚构集所说的那些胡话……?

Recoleta: It wasn't nonsense, nor are they fantasies! You saw with your own eyes how I won the die roll!
虚构集：那些并不是胡话。你也亲眼看到我在投掷中取得胜利了!

Jailer: It was just a coincidence.
狱卒：……那只是一个巧合。

The jailer's words are at odds with the subtle motions of her eyes and face. The Foundation's investigators seize on a prime opportunity to apply pressure.
她的态度将信将疑。基金会的调查员们马上意识到，现在是一个施压的好机会。

Vertin: What if we present you with stronger evidence to prove it's more than just a coincidence?
维尔汀：狱卒小姐，如果我们能拿出更有力的证据呢?

Vertin: If everything in the Panopticon proceeds according to Ms. Recoleta's novel, as she says, she should be able to predict what happens next.
维尔汀：如果科马拉监狱中的一切，确实按照虚构集小姐的小说在进行，那么她应该可以预测接下来发生的事情。

Vertin: Including the roll results of the "absolutely random" Die.
维尔汀：包括那枚“具有绝对随机性”的骰子。

Recoleta: That's right! The Die of Babylon isn't random at all. It's nothing but a supercilious fraud veiled under the guise of fate, an enactor of the inescapable loop of history, and—
虚构集：当然，因为**巴比伦之骰**并不是随机性的代表。它是一场宿命论的骗局，一个令人无可奈何的历史闭环。

Recoleta: And not one of you is paying attention to me whatsoever. Ugh, to hell with this era of ignoring unknown writers.
虚构集：我觉得，你们根本就没人听我说话……算了，这就是一个没有人会听不知名作家说话的时代。

Vertin: Ms. Recoleta, please make your prediction for the next inmate's die roll.
维尔汀：虚构集小姐，请你在狱卒小姐面前，预测接下来囚犯们的投掷结果。

Vertin: This way, you can prove to Ms. Jailer the irrefutable connection between Comala and your novel, The Rise and Fall of Sanity.
维尔汀：这样就能向狱卒小姐证明，你的小说《理性家族的崛起与衰落》同监狱的联系。

Recoleta: You finally remembered its name! Oh, what sweet balm to my spirit!
虚构集：我很欣慰你至少记住了它的名字，维尔汀。

Vertin: Ms. Octavia, please continue the congress, and let the next inmate perform their roll. Then Ms. Recoleta's statement will be proven true.
维尔汀：为了证明虚构集小姐所言属实，奥克塔维奥小姐，请您继续主持科马拉议会，让下一位囚犯开始投掷。

The hostess of the congress remains noncommittal.
主持人对此不置可否。

Octavia: I appreciate the reminder. No matter the interruption, the Comala Congress must go on, though not for Ms. Recoleta's sake, of course.
奥克塔维奥：感谢你的提醒。尽管已经遭受了如此粗鲁的打断，但科马拉议会必须进行下去——当然，那绝不会是为了虚构集小姐。

Octavia: Next inmate, please.
奥克塔维奥：请下一位议会成员上前来进行投掷。

Following the die's designated order, the next prisoner steps forward to roll.
按照骰子所规定的顺序，下一名投掷的囚犯走上前来。

Octavia: Hello, Inmate García. You know what to do.
奥克塔维奥：你好，加西亚先生，你应该很熟悉这套流程了。

García: Of course.
加西亚：当然。

Recoleta: "The 6th face. A broken pillar. The conflux of fortune and calamity."
虚构集：**“第六面，一根断裂的石柱，一个运气与灾厄的交汇之点。”**

Recoleta: So, the result of the next roll will be a 6.
虚构集：所以，下一位囚犯会获得的数字是 6。

Her prophetic precision plunges the Hall of New Encounters into breathless silence.
准确无误的预言让触发事件之厅陷入了彻底的沉默。

Octavia: As fate reveals, the number is 6.
奥克塔维奥：……我们得到的命运是数字 6。

Vertin: Just as Ms. Recoleta predicted.
维尔汀：得到的数字确实如虚构集小姐所说。

Jailer: That could still be a coincidence. Do it again.
狱卒：再来一次。我怎么会相信这种巧合般的儿戏……

Recoleta: "The 13th face. A bewildering cadenza lacking a true beginning or end."
虚构集：**“第十三面，隐秘而无尽的变奏曲。令人心境紊乱的是，它显然不具备实际的开头与结尾。”**

Recoleta: "The 4th face. A drowning man used the last of his strength to swim to safety, only to discover he'd mistaken a mirror for the surface of the water."
虚构集：**“第四面，快溺亡的人用尽力气游向水底，却发现自己将一面镜子当成了水面。”**

Recoleta: "The 17th face. He limped toward the distant oasis, only for the faint moisture and eerie stillness to cruelly reveal it as a mirage."
虚构集：**“第十七面，沙丘之间的绿洲，微微的湿气和诡秘的宁静让他意识到，那是一座不属于现世的幻影之城。”**

Recoleta: "The 6th face. Another broken pillar, with identical cracks to the last. It confirmed the Paracausality Researcher's hypothesis—this place used to be a circular building."
虚构集：**“第六面，又是一根断裂的石柱，裂痕一模一样。它证实了能量扰动学家的猜测，那是一片环形的废墟。”**……

Recoleta: Is that enough? I've almost finished the entire chapter.
虚构集：这样足够了吗？这一节已经快要念完了……

Octavia: It's not possible.
奥克塔维奥：这……这不可能……

One "coincidence" after another begins to stir into an uproar.
一次又一次“巧合般的儿戏”让人群喧闹了起来。

The coincidences appear endless.
巧合仿佛无穷无尽。

Octavia: Who are you?
奥克塔维奥：……！你……你到底是谁?

Recoleta: I'm sorry if this comes as a shock to you, but I did warn you, Octavia.
虚构集：我很抱歉……但我一早就告诉过你了，奥克塔维奥小姐。

Recoleta: Now, it's proven. The Die of Babylon is anything but the so-called "randomness of fate."
虚构集：巴比伦之骰所代表的，并不是命运的随机性。

Octavia: Have you been sent here by some god, or are you a Hopi prophet?
奥克塔维奥：……你是神的使者，还是掌握古老预言术的霍比族祭司?

Octavia: Have you brought this knowledge to save us, or to shatter our beliefs, our world?
奥克塔维奥：你带着这样的消息前来，是为了拯救我们，还是击溃我们的世界?

A question destined never to need an answer. She lets her eyes fall into the cardboard box and onto the twenty-sided die. The ridiculousness of its nature becomes starkly visible.
一个注定不需要答案的问题。
她无所适从地望着手中的纸皮箱子与二十面骰——此刻，它们显得那样滑稽可笑。

Octavia: What is this thing in my hand? What are we? What is this prison?
奥克塔维奥：你们究竟是什么东西的拙劣仿制品？我们又是什么？这座监狱到底是什么?

Jailer: I don't know if it's some kind of sorcery or arcane skill, but it's unfathomable.
狱卒：无论是巫术、神秘术还是什么更未知的力量……这太不可思议了。

Jailer: I'll take you to the Physician. Not because of your earlier request, but because the situation has escalated beyond my means.
狱卒：我会带你们去见狱医，但这不是因为我答应了你们的请求，而是因为这一切都已经超出了我的预料。

Jailer: The overseer of the Panopticon will decide how to handle your situation.
狱卒：你们需要得到来自科马拉监狱管理者本人的专业裁决。

Vertin: To be honest, Ms. Recoleta. I wasn't sure you'd be able to correctly predict everything.
维尔汀：虚构集小姐，没想到你真的能做到这样的事情。

Sonetto: Timekeeper, are you saying that you risked everything on a hunch?
十四行诗：司辰，难道在此之前，您都只是在误打误撞地尝试吗……?

Vertin: It worked, didn't it?
维尔汀：但我们成功了。

Jailer: Come with me. Dr. Merlin's office is in the central tower.
狱卒：诸位，梅林先生就在中央瞭望塔的某个位置。请随我来。

For her part, the now vindicated writer follows at the end of the line, letting her mind race like a bullet train.
大展身手的女孩则跟在队伍的最后，没有任何话语能钻进她高速思考的脑袋里。

Recoleta: In the sixth version of my novel, everyone in the town dies because of the Die of Babylon, for only death can close the loop of history.
虚构集：如果继续下去，在第六版故事修改中，小镇中的所有人最后都会因为巴比伦之骰而死去……因为只有死亡能够达成历史闭环。

Recoleta: And Jailer, you're the Bank Clerk, right?
虚构集：而你，狱卒小姐，你就是银行职员对吗?

Recoleta: So, in the end, will you also have a meltdown, like the Bank Clerk does, when he realizes that he and the Dune Piscator are the same person?
虚构集：……所以最后，你会像银行职员一样，因为发现自己与沙漠捕鱼人是同一个人而崩溃吗?

Recoleta: If all of this is tied to The Rise and Fall of Sanity, then, as its creator ...
虚构集：如果这一切都与《理性家族的崛起与衰落》有关，那我才是撰写它的人……

Recoleta: I will get to the bottom of this.
虚构集：我会搞清楚这一切的。

台前，幕后
Behind the Operating Curtain 9TH-12

Behind the Operating Curtain
台前，幕后

Central Tower Waiting Area
瞭望塔·等候室

An otherwise tidy room is covered in fine scratches and small unidentifiable stains. The smell of disinfectant lingers in the air, mixed with mildew.
看似整洁的室内密布着细小的划痕和难以辨别的污渍，令人感到压抑。
空气中弥漫着微弱的消毒水味道，其中混杂着潮湿的霉气。

Jailer: Wait here a moment.
狱卒：请诸位在此稍等片刻。

Jailer: I'll report the situation and your request to Dr. Merlin.
狱卒：梅林先生应当正在忙碌中。就诸位的拜访诉求，我会将情况完整地向他汇报。

Jailer: However, since he's always busy, I can't guarantee he'll agree to meet you, but I'll do my best to persuade him.
狱卒：我不能保证梅林先生一定会接见各位，但……我会尽力让他改变主意。

The jaguar's figure slinks out through the inner door.
美洲豹的身影无声息地消失在办公室内间的门后。

Vertin: Now's our chance, Sonetto.
维尔汀：现在是个好时机，十四行诗。

Sonetto: Our chance? What do you mean, Timekeeper?
十四行诗：司辰，您的意思是?

Vertin: It's unlikely that the jailer will let us search the central tower, even in this situation. We should take the initiative and look for clues while she's away.
维尔汀：想让狱卒小姐批准我们搜查瞭望塔并不是一件易事。我觉得我们应该主动出击，寻找任何有用的线索。

Sonetto: I-I see, Timekeeper. I will do my best.
十四行诗：我明白了，司辰……我会尽力的!

Sonetto swiftly conducts a thoroughly unauthorized search.
第一助手迅速开始了违规的搜查。

Vertin: Thank you for your assistance, Ms. Recoleta. Without your precise predictions, we wouldn't be standing here now.
维尔汀：感谢你的协助，虚构集小姐。如果不是你所展现的神奇预测，我们很难说服狱卒小姐改变主意。

Vertin: I haven't yet grasped the connection between the Die, your novel, and what's happening in this place, but ...
维尔汀：虽然我仍未弄明白这一切如何与骰子、与你的小说扯上联系，但——

Vertin: By process of elimination, it's almost certain that your pen pal, Aleph, is right behind this door.
维尔汀：哪怕是根据排除法，我们也几乎可以断定：你的笔友阿莱夫就在这扇门的背后。

Recoleta: Sometimes I envy your decisiveness, Vertin. I'm sure many people have praised the special talent of yours.
虚构集：……有时候，我很佩服你的果断，维尔汀。我想应该有很多人和你说过，你是一个很特别的人。

Vertin: Are you alright? You don't seem as excited as when we first entered Comala.
维尔汀：你还好吗？看起来你似乎不如刚刚进入监狱那般兴奋。

Recoleta holds her gaze on the tightly shut door, uncertain whether she hopes it will open now or ever again.
虚构集看向紧闭的大门，她并不确定自己是否希望它会在下一秒打开。

Recoleta: The all-seeing sentinel of the Panopticon, veiled within the central tower ... If it truly is Aleph, I—
虚构集：如果那个在瞭望塔中操纵一切的视线真的是阿莱夫——

Recoleta: I don't know how to face such a terrifying and increasingly plausible reality.
虚构集：这是一个可怕的猜想，我暂时还不知道该怎么去面对它。

Sonetto: Sorry to interrupt, but, Timekeeper, I think you'll want to see these.
十四行诗：很抱歉打断了你们的谈话——但司辰，我想您需要看看这个。

Vertin: Signed "Urd." This is a letter from Dr. Dores.
维尔汀：落款兀尔德——这是德洛丝女士留下的信。

The delicate signature matches the one in the manuscript folder.
轻盈的签名字迹，同稿件收纳册上的一致。

Recoleta: Her handwriting—It's as beautiful as I'd imagined. Who is it addressed to?
虚构集：她的字迹和我想象中一样漂亮。这封信是写给谁的?

Recoleta: "Dear Mr. Aleph ..." Aleph?!
虚构集：“阿莱夫阁下亲启”……?!

Vertin: Looks like Dores and Aleph are acquaintances. Or, at least, they've had some correspondence.
维尔汀：是的，这是德洛丝女士与阿莱夫来往的信件。

Vertin: "Dear Mr. Aleph, my apologies if this reaches you at an inconvenient time. I am Dores, pen name 'Urd,' an ordinary inmate of the Panopticon of Comala. I write seeking your guidance, if you wouldn't mind offering it to me."
维尔汀：“敬爱的阿莱夫阁下亲启。初次通信，冒昧叨扰。我是科马拉监狱中的囚犯之一，名叫德洛丝。如今，我以笔名‘兀尔德’来信，向您请教问题。”

Dores: "I heard from the Physician, Dr. Merlin, that ..."
德洛丝：“我从狱医梅林先生那儿听说——”

Dores: You have the answer to every question—a statement which has been echoed by the Idealist and the other inmates.
德洛丝：您能回答人们向您询问的所有问题。类似的说法，理想家与其他囚犯的只言片语中同样有所耳闻。

Dores: I have something I wish to ask you. What exactly is your role at the prison? Chief warden? A secret backer? An observer who dominates the prison? Are you truly the supreme ruler of the Panopticon of Comala?
德洛丝：您是科马拉监狱的典狱长，是隐秘的投资者，还是隐藏在背后的权力意志？您真的是科马拉的至高存在吗？

They tear open the next letter, eager to read on.
她们迫不及待地将下一封信拆开。

Aleph: Dear Urd,
阿莱夫：敬爱的兀尔德女士：

Aleph: I do indeed have answers for every question, including yours. I'm afraid every one of your speculations is off the mark. I am merely an inmate who chose to imprison himself here.
阿莱夫：恐怕这些猜测都不准确，我不过是一名选择自囚于此的囚徒罢了。然而，既然您有疑问，我确实可以作答。

Aleph: And allow me to point out that your identity isn't as ordinary as you claim. Why is it that you, my fellow inmate and guest of Manus Vindictae, are so interested in Comala?
阿莱夫：且允许我先指出一项事实：您的身份并不如您自称那般普通。您是科马拉的囚犯，也是重塑之手的客人。是什么让您对监狱中的一切起了兴趣？

Vertin: Dr. Dores, a guest of Manus Vindictae?
维尔汀：德洛丝女士是重塑之手的……客人？

A muffled shattering of glass interrupts their reading.
突然之间，器皿碎裂的声响打断了书信的阅读。

Sonetto: It came from inside the room. Do you think they're okay?
十四行诗：这是门后传来的声音……怎么回事？他们还好吗？

Recoleta: The jailer and the Physician! What happened?
虚构集：狱卒小姐——狱医先生——！请问里面发生了什么事！

The door defies any attempt at an answer, sealing all the events from view.
大门一如既往地沉默着，执行着封锁与扭曲的意志，无人应答。

Vertin: I'm not sure, but it could be bad. Come on. Let's go in and see if they're alright.
维尔汀：他们也许发生了什么意外。我们直接进去看看吧。

Central Tower Surgical Theater
瞭望塔·手术室

The unlocked door leads to another room, more decrepit and oppressive than the last.
并未上锁的大门通向了一个破旧而压抑的小房间。

A cold operating table lies in the center, surrounded by scattered bottles and medical instruments.
一张冰冷的手术台摆放在房间中央，四周堆满了零散的药品与医疗器具。

Vertin: It seems we've stumbled upon the Physician's—
维尔汀：我想，我们也许误入了狱医的工作地点……

Recoleta: The Physician's office. I should've known. But, is this an operating room?
虚构集：我早该想到的，狱医的工作地点……但这种鬼地方是手术室?!

Recoleta: As if this prison wasn't bizarre enough already.
虚构集：这里简直是这座监狱中最怪异的地方……

Inside the narrow operating room, the jaguar reacts badly to their intrusion.
狭窄的手术室内，突如其来的闯入者让美洲豹惊慌失措起来。

Jailer: Didn't I tell you to wait outside? What do you think you're doing, barging in like this?
狱卒：你们怎么能私自闯进来？我不是告诉过诸位，请在外面等候吗?!

Recoleta: We were just worried about your safety, Jailer.
虚构集：我们只是在担心你的情况，狱卒小姐。

Jailer: Enough. Get out of—
狱卒：别说了，快离开这里——

???: Quiet!
???：安静！

The Physician: The reptilian complex governs all our fundamental functions.
狱医：在一开始，爬虫脑[Reptilian Complex]主导着一切。

The Physician: Our heartbeat, breathing, fight-or-flight responses, and our territory and hierarchy awareness—our primitive ancestors, like reptiles and birds, followed such instincts to survive.
狱医：我们像所有的爬虫与鸟类一样，遵循着典型的本能生存：心跳、呼吸、攻击、逃跑，拥有了领地与等级意识。

The Physician: Through millions of years of evolution, we developed the limbic system.
狱医：进化使我们获得了边缘系统[Limbic System]。

The Physician: This processes emotions and forms memories. It allows us to feel—fear, sadness, anger, joy—our behaviors are given "meaning."
狱医：它处理着我们的行为与记忆，使我们产生对快乐的追求，同时带来了恐惧、痛苦、忧虑与愤怒。一切得以被蒙上意志的色彩。

The Physician: Now, it's the neocortex that makes up more than two-thirds of our total brain volume.
狱医：在最后，却是新皮质[Neocortex]占据了我们脑容量的三分之二。

The Physician: Language, perception, logical reasoning, abstract thought—this is what forms the complexity of human nature. We read, create, perceive. We try to understand both the world and ourselves. We are forever setting goals, one after another.
狱医：语言与感知、逻辑推理、抽象的能力，构成了人性与行为的多维。我们阅读创作，认知世界与自我，定下一个又一个的目标——

The Physician: And all this—these multitudes—happens within the confines of the skull, in the tight folds of the crowded cerebral cortex.
狱医：而这一切，不过都发生在颅骨内的方寸之地中，在这弯曲拥挤的脑皮层里。

Vertin: Is he performing surgery?
维尔汀：他是在……做手术?!

The Physician: Such a delicate and elaborate organ.
狱医：一个精密的、让人迷惑的、容易损坏的器官……

The Physician: Were it unable to forget, what would come of it?
狱医：如果它再也不能遗忘，它会变成什么模样——

The Physician: Can this space, no larger than the palm of my hand, truly accommodate dozens of people at once?
狱医：这个巴掌大的房间，能同时容纳数十个人吗?

At last, the Physician sets down his operating scissors and needle, signaling the end of the surgery. Yet at the same time, the old machine issues an alarm, signaling that his patient's vital signs are wavering.
终于，狱医放下了组织剪与持针器，昭示着手术的结束。
然而破旧冰冷的机器也同时发出警告，生命的曲线正在逐渐拉直。

Recoleta: What's happened to the patient? It looks like he's dying.
虚构集：台上的病人，他……发生了什么事情？他看起来不太好！

Her anxiety rises as the question goes unanswered. On the screen, the last waveforms disappear, leaving only a constant flat tone.
没有人回答她急切的问话。屏幕上，最后一丝波浪形的室颤与室扑也消失了，室内只余恒长的警报声。

Recoleta: Did the surgery fail?
虚构集：手术，失败了吗……？

The Physician: Nonsense! The surgery was a tremendous success.
狱医：荒谬！手术当然成功了。

The Physician: I have erased his debilitating hysteria and restored order to the Panopticon.
狱医：我帮助他消除了令他困苦的癔症，同时光复了科马拉监狱的秩序。

The Physician: What are you trying to achieve by barging in here?
狱医：你们闯入这里想干什么？

The man behind the operating table stares at the uninvited guests expectantly but does not give them a chance to respond.
手术台后的男子看向不请自来的访客，但并没有给她们回答的机会。

The Physician: Forget it. The next operation requires my attention.
狱医：算了，下一台手术马上就要开始了。

The Physician: Jailer, show them out. Bring me the next patient in 15 minutes.
狱医：狱卒，马上带她们出去。15 分钟后将下一位病患带进来。

Jailer: I'm sorry, Ms. Vertin. I'm afraid you have to leave now.
狱卒：……很抱歉，但维尔汀小姐，请你们现在就离开吧。

Recoleta steps forward, blocking their path. There is a hint of pleading in her voice.
她上前一步，拦在了众人的面前，语气几乎是恳求的。

Recoleta: Please, just let us speak with you! It'll only take a moment! I have something very important I need to ask.
虚构集：拜托了，只需要一分钟的时间！我有非常重要的事情问你——

Her question is not given time to take shape.
她的提问还未成形，就被狱医毫不留情地打断了。

The Physician: Important? Nothing is of greater importance than my experiments in the Panopticon, outsiders.
狱医：重要？没有什么比我在科马拉所做的实验更重要。

The Physician: To ensure they continue, the stability of time and schedule is absolutely paramount.
狱医：外来者们，为了维持实验的长久进行，时间的稳定性必须超越一切。

Recoleta: Experiments in the Panopticon? So you really are the controller of the prison, then?
虚构集：科马拉的实验……?！科马拉监狱的幕后控制者，果然就是你吗？

The Physician: Controller? What an outdated notion—superficial, really.
狱医：控制者？真是一个老旧而幼稚的说法。

The Physician: The Panopticon has no need for such a power. Regardless of who occupies the central tower—or even if no one's there at all—every inmate is both the observer and the observed, both wielders and subjects of power.
狱医：一切都是自发的、非个性化的权力，由谁来行使根本无关紧要。控制者无处不在，却从不使用物质手段——建筑本身才是维系一切的关键。

The Physician: Achieving such a state requires no physical or violent measures; the structure of the Panopticon itself is the mechanism which sustains it. Comala is simply a manifestation of this model.
狱医：所有人都是那个匿名的观察者，而科马拉监狱不过是一个模版罢了。

The Physician: Once I confirm its feasibility and adaptability, this model can be applied to any functional setting with only minor modifications.
狱医：一旦我验证了这种模式的可行，只需要做一些必要的修改，它就能套用在任何职能的场所中。

The Physician: So far, it has proven to be far superior to any current system of governance in our world —transcendental, even.
狱医：它是如此的优越、如此的有效，如此具有超凡的价值。

The Physician: Curse it! Why am I wasting time explaining this to you? Time is running out.
狱医：……该死，我根本没有必要和你探讨这一切。剩下的时间已经不多了。

The investigator keenly senses the key within his words.
调查员敏锐地察觉到了其中的关键。

Vertin: Dr. Merlin, you keep mentioning "time." What exactly do you mean by that?
维尔汀：梅林先生，您一直在强调的“时间”，指的究竟是什么?

The Physician: Really? You need to ask? Even those oily-headed lunatics know it.
狱医：就连那群丧失了全部理智的面具脑袋都知晓——

The Physician: The end of this era is imminent, is it not?
狱医：时代的终点马上要到来了，不是吗?

Indeed—the word that was so close to being spoken.
果然如此——那个呼之欲出的词。

Vertin: You know about the "Storm."
维尔汀：梅林先生，您知晓“**暴雨**”的存在。

The Physician: That's what you call it, is it? A "Storm" that washes everything away?
狱医：这就是你们的叫法吗——一场冲刷一切的“暴雨”?

The Physician: You employees of the St. Pavlov Foundation should know better than I. Soon, this era and everything in it will cease to exist.
狱医：来自圣洛夫基金会的职员，你们应该比我更为明了，很快，这里的一切都将不复存在。

The Physician: I must prove the feasibility of the Panopticon model before this place is turned to ruins, or something even more unrecognizable.
狱医：长时间的稳定观察已成奢望。我需要在这个监狱变成一片废墟或者更加不可理喻的事物之前，证明全景监狱的可行性。

Recoleta: A "Storm" that washes everything away? Vertin, what on earth are you two talking about?
虚构集：带走一切的“暴雨”……维尔汀，你们究竟在说什么?

The conversation extends beyond even the most imaginative creations of the aspiring writer.
话题发展的方向逐渐超越了一名自诩想象力丰富的作家的想象。

Vertin: ...
维尔汀：……

The Physician: No one can predict the era to which we'll be reversed.
狱医：没人能预测我们会回到什么年代。

The Physician: I've seen the eras change time and time again—the transformation of this place over and over.
狱医：我见证着这片土地一次又一次回到过去，这座监狱不断改变模样……

The Physician: But no matter which era each of these nine "Storms," as you call them, has taken us back to, caudillismo continues to plague this land.
狱医：但在九次所谓的“暴雨”中，无论我们返回到何种年代，考迪罗主义的幽灵从未离开过这片土地。

The Physician: Dependency theorists, martyred revolutionists ... I've seen them all. You, young writer, are no different from those intellectuals who were swept away in the rain.
狱医：无论是古典的依附论学家，还是殉难的救赎者，我都见识过了——年轻的作家，你与那些被雨水带走的知识分子没什么不同。

The Physician: There is no romance in this era, only the repeated cycles of madness and brutality—an endless, meaningless struggle.
狱医：……这个时代的浪潮，它疯狂、激进、残暴、魔幻，里面没有什么所谓的浪漫，只有困兽的剧烈挣扎，一轮又一轮循环的开始。

The Physician: Only in this forgotten corner can we momentarily escape the plundering of the marauders and the chaos they unleash.
狱医：只有在这个被流放的边陲，我们能稍微远离野心者的掠夺与他们所带来的混乱。

The Physician: Although, it won't be long before this place is looted by those oily-headed lunatics.
狱医：虽然很快，那些戴面具的家伙就要把这里洗劫一空了。

The Physician: Just as it has countless times before on this land as rich as silver.
狱医：就像在此之前，在这片如银子般富饶的土地上，已经发生过无数次的掠夺那般……

He mutters to himself.
他自言自语着。

The Physician: But there is still hope. Even in a wasteland, we may still be saved.
狱医：但没关系，即使在一片废墟之中，我们仍能拯救我们自己……

The Physician: As long as I uncover the path to transcendentality, I will find the ultimate answer.
狱医：只要我赶在所有人之前，寻找到那条通往超限的道路，这一切都会迎来答案。

The Physician: Ugh, I've already wasted far too much time on you! Leave. Now!
狱医：够了，请你们离开！我已经在你们身上浪费了过多的时间！

The Physician turns away, beginning preparations for the next surgery, organizing his worn-out instruments.
狱医转过身去，开始为下一场手术做准备，整理那些残破不堪的手术工具。

Jailer: You heard him. Please don't press things any further.
狱卒：事已至此，请诸位不要再纠缠了。

Recoleta: Alright, sir, I get it. Obviously, you don't want to discuss my novel with me anymore, so I won't insist upon it.
虚构集：我知晓你的意思了，先生。你不想再跟我讨论我的小说，我也不会再多提。

Recoleta: All the letters we wrote to one another, all those inspiring revisions and suggestions ... I guess they meant nothing to you.
虚构集：那些书信的往来，那些振奋人心的修改建议……也许对你来说都没有意义……

Her voice wavers. Rejections, closed doors, harsh critiques—this proves more devastating than all of them together.
她的声音在颤抖。
退稿、闭门羹、激烈的批评——这比她所经历的那一切都要更加令她怅然。

Recoleta: But there's still something I must tell you. Jailer, could you please allow us a private conversation with the Physi—no ...
虚构集：但我仍有一件事必须要告知你。狱卒小姐，你能让我们和狱医先生单独谈话吗?

Recoleta: With Aleph.
虚构集：和……阿莱夫先生。

Hearing this, the Physician stops.
闻言，背对着众人的狱医停下了手中的动作。

The Physician: Leave us, Jailer. I'll spare these outsiders five minutes.
狱医：狱卒，你先出去吧。让我和访客单独谈话五分钟。

Jailer: ...
狱卒：……

The jaguar turns to leave, her face revealing an uncharacteristic sorrow as she lingers on the girls one last time. This time, she offers no words.
美洲豹沉默地离开了手术室，不属于大型捕食者的悲伤目光最后望了女孩们一眼。
这一次，她什么也没有回应。

一份剪报
A Clipping 小径

A Clipping
一份剪报

英文 / ENGLISH
In 1935, Professor António from Portugal became intrigued by a medical study documenting how gorillas became docile after the removal of their frontal lobes. Inspired by this, he successfully performed the world's first human frontal lobotomy, known as leukotomy. The surgery was remarkably successful, paving the way for significant breakthroughs in research. In 1949, Professor António was awarded the Nobel Prize in Medicine for his work.

Through continuous practice and refinement, he and others eventually improved and perfected the procedure, even developing a specialized leukotome. However, the surgical technique required a high level of expertise, and as a result, it was never widely adopted.

In 1945, American doctor Walter Freeman modified the procedure, which became infamously known as the "ice pick lobotomy." The technique involved rendering patients unconscious with electroshock or anesthesia, and then hammering a steel pick—roughly the thickness of a chopstick—through the upper part of the eye socket into the brain. The pick was then manually rotated to destroy the frontal lobe.

In 1950, following strong recommendations from psychiatric pathologist Vasily Gayanovsky, the Soviet government became the first to announce a complete ban on frontal lobotomies. Over the next two decades, most countries, including the United States, followed suit and passed laws prohibiting the procedure.
中文 / CHINESE
1935 年，来自葡萄牙的安东尼奥教授被一份记录着猩猩在被切除了前额叶后会变得温顺的医学研究报告所吸引，并成功地做出了世界上第一例人类前额叶切除手术。这被称为脑叶白质切除术。手术非常成功且带来的一系列研究都成果颇丰。在 1949 年安东尼奥教授因此获得了诺贝尔医学奖。
在不断的实践与总结下，他们终于改进并完善了手术，甚至研究出了一种专门的脑白质切除器。但是这种手术技术要求极高，所以并没有被普及。
1945 年，一名美国医生弗里曼对手术进行了改进，也就是现在臭名昭著的“冰锥疗法”。先将病人通过电击或麻药的形式放倒后，直接用锤子将一根大概筷子粗的钢针从病人的眼球上方凿入脑内，而后徒手搅动那根钢针以摧毁病人前额叶。

1950 年，在精神病理学家瓦西里·加雅诺夫斯基的强烈建议下，苏联政府率先宣布全面禁止前脑叶白质切除术。此后的二十多年里，包括美国在内的绝大多数国家也纷纷立法禁止前脑叶白质切除术。

迷宫的主人
Master of the Labyrinth 9TH-13

Master of the Labyrinth
迷宫的主人

Only the steady beeping of a heart monitor keeps the eerie silence at bay.
寂静的室内只余心电监护仪的声响。

Recoleta: *deep breath*
虚构集：呼……

Recoleta: Dr. Merlin, or should I say Aleph? I don't know why you're using my novel to manipulate the Panopticon.
虚构集：狱医先生，如果你真的是阿莱夫的话……我不知道你为什么要这么做，要利用我的小说来操纵监狱。

Recoleta: But you need to know that it won't serve your purpose, whether in fiction or reality.
虚构集：但无论是小说还是现实，最终都无法达到你想要的效果。

Recoleta: You claim that the inmates are "both the observer and the observed" and "both wielders and subjects of power." How could you be so blind as to not see the true state of the Panopticon?
虚构集：你说，想通过这种模式，让所有人都成为科马拉监狱的观察者……但你有正视过科马拉监狱现在真实的状态吗?

Recoleta: The inmates haven't achieved any "perfect order." No, they've devolved into pitiful caricatures of themselves—performers in some endless pantomime to be watched from the central tower.
虚构集：那些囚犯没有因为这个所谓的实验，而实行某种完美的纪律……相反，他们成为了一种可悲的存在，享受着来自瞭望塔的视线，进行着夸张的自我表演。

Recoleta: Even their medication has become a prop to demonstrate the so-called "randomness of fate" in the theater that is the Panopticon.
虚构集：本应根据病情分配的药物与物资，变成了一场彰显“命运的随机性”的表演道具；瞭望塔与环形监狱，则成为了他们的舞台。

Recoleta: This farce hasn't made the Panopticon a better place. No, it has warped it into a twisted theater of cruelty where the sick are denied treatment and left to quietly perish in the dark corners of its halls.
虚构集：监狱并没有因为这场表演而变得更好，应该得到救治的病人最终只会默默地死亡在角落。

Recoleta: And literature has died alongside them.
虚构集：就连文学也是如此……

Recoleta: This prison is a monster born under the gaze of this "all-seeing power."
虚构集：这个监狱的一切，都是在这种“权力的视线”下诞生的怪物……

Recoleta: Aleph, is this truly the ultimate answer you've been searching for?
虚构集：阿莱夫，这就是你想要的答案吗?

The Physician suddenly seems startled, stepping back and accidentally knocking over his tools.
漫长的沉默后，狱医仿佛被惊醒一般，他后退一步，失手碰掉了台上的手术刀具。

The Physician: What?!
狱医：……什么？

The Physician: Are you suggesting that this is the answer I've reached?
狱医：这就是……我获得的答案？

The Physician: That my experiment has been a failure all along, and I've been too blind to see it?
狱医：你的意思是，在我不知晓的时刻，我的探索早已失败了吗？

The Physician: No, impossible. Foucault's theory is flawless!
狱医：不，这不可能。福柯的理论是完美的！

Having his life's work denied is something he cannot tolerate. The man searches the tabletop with feigned composure, but in doing so, he unintentionally sweeps all the surgical tools onto the floor.
全盘否定的言辞让他难以容忍。
男人看似镇定地在台面上寻找着什么，却不小心将所有手术工具都清空到了地上。

The Physician: I have removed every obstacle to the running of this prison. It is pure, sacrosanct.
狱医：我排除了所有的障碍，才让这座监狱运作起来，它是如此的纯粹，如此的独立……

The Physician: I have constantly re-evaluated the system, adjusting my instructions to my subordinates to ensure the most efficient maintenance of the established order.
狱医：我不断评估、改变下属的行为，只为了让他们用最好的方法来监管这里。

The Physician: And now, you stand here and tell me that everything I've done has been meaningless from the very beginning?
狱医：……而你现在告诉我，我所做的一切，都早已失去了原本的意义？

The Physician: That the power model I have implemented has already been replaced by an alternative?
狱医：我奉行的理论，它早已被另一种权力模式取代？

The Physician: No, outsiders. The perfect order of the Panopticon shall not be disrupted. I will not be swayed by your lies!
狱医：外来者，你只是妄图阻碍纪律的运作……那些犯人，他们仍然处于完美的纪律之中！

The Physician: This facility is superior to all others. Nothing here escapes my notice.
狱医：在这个优越的场所里，任何情况都瞒不过我。

At last, in a barely noticeable corner, he finds the twenty-sided die wreathed in black mist.
终于，在不易察觉的角落中，他找到了那颗萦绕着黑雾的二十面骰。

The Physician: That said, it isn't easy to work a miracle, as we all know.
狱医：制造奇迹不易，我们一向知晓。

The Physician: I shall personally verify it all myself.
狱医：我将亲自确认一切。

All of his emotions dissolve as he grips the die.
监狱掌控者所有的情绪，在将骰子握入手掌的瞬间消融。

The narrow operating room shakes, as if responding to him, emitting a distorted screech.
狭窄的手术室震颤着，仿佛回应掌控者的呼唤一般，发出扭曲的尖啸。

Vertin: What's happening?
维尔汀：发生了什么？

The Physician: Visitors from another era, you have come here with plagued ideologies in an attempt to break the subtle balance of the Panopticon.
狱医：来自另一个时代的访客们，你们企图凭借语言传播的疾病，将科马拉的幽禁打破。

The Physician: But did you not notice the tiles beneath your feet, the cracks, and water stains on the walls constantly changing right before your eyes?
狱医：但你们有认真凝视过脚下的每一片瓷砖、每一条裂缝、每一道水痕的消失与重现吗?

The Physician: This room, the previous room, every room.
狱医：从这个房间，到另一个房间，到每个房间。

The Physician: You have blindly wandered through them, seeing them as nothing more than the building blocks of a monotonous labyrinth.
狱医：你们徘徊于此，认为它们一模一样，认为它们是一个不可理喻的疯人迷宫。

The Physician: But this place was not born from the chaotic imaginings of a madman. No, every inch has been crafted through the meticulous harnessing of order and power.
狱医：但这里并非奇妙幻想的空间，而是基于对秩序与权力的运用所诞生的天地。

The Physician: Every wisp of spider silk drifting in the wind, every speck of rust on the gallery rail,
狱医：从一根在风中漂浮的蜘蛛丝开始，到活动场地走廊把手上的一粒锈迹结束——

The Physician: every detail of the Panopticon has been built by my own hands.
狱医：我亲手搭建了这座圆形的房子。

The Physician: With this ever-shifting die, concepts may be transformed into reality, and ideals into substance.
狱医：在这颗无尽变幻的骰子里，它的映射足以让概念变成现实，让思想成为物质。

The Physician: I observe the movement of every entity—the passage of every second. The moment you entered this realm, you, too, became subjects of my experiment.
狱医：我观察着每一件事物，时间每一分秒的流动：你们的脚步从来没有走出过这个实验的范围。

Recoleta: This happened when the Idealist was attacked, too!
虚构集：在理想家先生遇袭的时候，我们也遇到过这样的情况!

Sonetto: To think we've been trapped in a prison fabricated by a die all this time ...
十四行诗：原来从一开始，我们就身处骰子所构建的监狱之中吗……

Sonetto: Did the Physician really build all this with such a small, simple object?
十四行诗：这一切，都是狱医所创造的场景……?

Vertin: The distortion is getting worse. Prepare yourselves to fight or flee.
维尔汀：监狱的扭曲愈发严重了……我们要做好随时战斗和撤退的准备。

The situation begins to spiral out of control. Now everything in the room screeches and twists until they become a mess of meaningless black-and-white lines.
情况逐渐变得不受控制。手术室中，所有的一切都在尖啸，扭曲，化作意义不明的黑白线条。

Recoleta: Please, Dr. Merlin. Stop this!
虚构集：拜托了，梅林先生，快停下来!!!

The Physician: No. You're asking for the impossible.
狱医：不，你们的要求太荒唐了。

The Physician: Power model of the Panopticon is destined to permeate all of society. Such insignificant interferences could never plunge it into chaos.
狱医：这种精心设计的概念不应该受到一丝外来影响就陷入紊乱……因为它是注定要传遍整个社会机体的……

The Physician: But it already has, Merlin. You've failed.
狱医：但你失败了，梅林。

The Physician: I have not failed! As long as I keep the prison running ...
狱医：我没有！我没有！只要保证它不停地运作……

The Physician fiddles with the die, muttering baffling and incoherent words to himself.
狱医摆弄着骰子，古怪地自言自语着。

The Physician: It isn't your power model running the prison. It's the die.
狱医： 运作的只是骰子，而并非你的权力机制。

The Physician: It's simply a form of magic, unrelated to the microphysics of power you seek. It provides no aid in your experimentation with power.
狱医： 它是巫术，是魔法，它不包含多种多样的力量，并不是你所追求的权力物理学，也无法成为权力实验室。

The Physician: It's a false hope, a castle in the sky given to you by the military Junta and Manus Vindictae.
狱医： 它是重塑之手和军政府给你的幻想，一个不存在的存在。

Sonetto: Manus Vindictae?
十四行诗： 重塑之手?

Sonetto: So you really are working with them. What exactly do you intend to do?
十四行诗： 你果然和重塑之手有关系。你们究竟想做些什么?

The Physician: I ...
狱医： 我……

The Physician: Then, I've also failed?
狱医： 所以我也失败了吗?

The Physician: I've ended up a pathetic fool, lost in the chaos of reality, just like the Idealist chasing visceral realism, Paracelsus seeking the Fountain of Youth, and Zahir obsessing over the one-sided coin.
狱医： 就像追求本能现实主义的理想家、炼制永生之泉的帕拉塞尔苏斯、寻找单面硬币的扎伊尔那样，成为了一个在混乱纷芜现实中迷失的可怜虫。

The Physician: When did it all start falling apart, Aleph?
狱医： 阿莱夫，一切都是从哪里开始溃败的?

The Physician: When the doorknob loosened? When the prisoners' wounds started to fester? Or when the daily disinfectant concentration reached 28 mg, or the crack in the second gray brick on the wall expanded to 6 mm?
狱医： 是从门把手的松动、囚犯溃烂的伤口、每日 28 毫克浓度的消毒水、墙壁上第二块灰砖的裂缝扩至 6 毫米开始吗?

The Physician: Or was it when Warden Tartuffe left Ushuaia with news of the Foucault Association's dissolution?
狱医： 还是说从典狱长达尔杜夫，带着国家福柯协会解散的消息离开乌斯怀亚开始?

The Physician: This place should've been the ideal ground for psychoanalytic practice. Why did they halt all research, all discussion?
狱医： 我们这儿理应是精神分析的最佳实践场所……为什么他们不再探讨这一切了?

The Physician: We've been abandoned, haven't we? By eras old and new.
狱医： 我们被旧时代和新时代同时放弃了，对吗?

Aleph: You designed and have maintained everything in Comala, right down to the smallest detail.
阿莱夫： 你为科马拉设计了一切，每一处细节都经过了精心的雕琢和漫长的调整。

Aleph: But it is these details that trap you. And, as the bars close around you, you are losing your name, Merlin, and you are becoming the Physician, a man forever imprisoned within these walls.
阿莱夫： 但最终这一切细节也将你束缚在这个监狱中。梅林，你马上就会丢失自己的名字，永远成为一个被困于此处的“狱医”。

The Physician: I don't understand.
狱医： 我不能理解……

Aleph: All these false eras are like a dreadful novel with no conclusion. Trying to find answers within such things is, in itself, a mistake.
阿莱夫： 这些虚假的时代，它本身就是一本无尽的书。在这本可怕的书里寻找答案，本身就是错误的。

Aleph: Much like them, you are destined never to attain transcendentality.
阿莱夫： 你和他们一样，注定无法寻找到属于自己的超限。

The Physician: ...
狱医： ……

The Physician: Tell me, Aleph. Does the ultimate answer even exist?
狱医： 告诉我，阿莱夫，那个答案，它真的存在吗?

The die becomes too heavy for him to hold any longer. It drops to the floor.
那颗掌控一切的骰子重得让他再也无法握住，它掉到了地上。

The distortions and tremors of the prison finally subside, as if the pulse of a massive heart had stopped for an instant.
监狱的扭曲与震颤终于归于寂静，仿佛一道不可视的巨大脉搏停止了瞬息。

Amid the swirling dust, the girls help each other stand but fail to notice the truth revealing itself before them.
受到扬起的烟尘影响，互相搀扶着站稳身形的女孩们并未留意到谜底的出现。

Sonetto: *cough* Timekeeper, are you alright?
十四行诗： 咳咳……司辰，您还好吗?

Vertin: *cough* Yes, and you? And Ms. Recoleta, are you okay?
维尔汀： 咳咳……我没事，你呢？还有虚构集小姐，你还好吗?

Vertin: Ms. Recoleta?
维尔汀： 虚构集小姐……?

The smoke clears, but no one responds. The named girl simply stares in shock at the figure before her.
烟雾散去，没有人应答。被点名的少女只是震惊地望着眼前的人影。

Recoleta: Y-You're ...
虚构集： 你……你是……

???: The word "utopia" derives from Greek. It means "no place."
???: 乌托邦[Utopia]源自于希腊语，意思是“不存在的地方”。

???: People cannot understand the structure of the labyrinth, yet they continue to follow its paths.
???: 人们深信不疑，潜心琢磨这无休止的迷宫，探索人类的奥秘。

???: They cannot comprehend the mechanics of fate, yet they believe in its jurisdiction.
???: 同时，人们迷惑不解，亦感荒谬，信奉命运带来的吉凶祸福。

???: As if, by doing so, everything will naturally fall into place.
???: 仿佛只需如此，世上所有的一切都会变得微不足道。

Aleph: And now, the polar night approaches.
阿莱夫： 在今日，极夜已经造访南方。

Aleph: How good it is to see you, pen pal.
阿莱夫： 欢迎你的到来，我的笔友。

流动的哲学
Philosophy in Motion 小径

I have some news you'll be happy to hear.
???: 我有一些你听了会高兴的情报。

选项 / Choices

1. I'll spare you one minute.
1. 我给你一分钟。

Trust me, you'll wish you had more than a minute for this. It involves a mutual friend of ours—a long-lost acquaintance you've been searching for.
???: 你会希望这一分钟够长的。因为这情报涉及我们都熟悉的一位朋友，一位你一直在寻找的故人。

Doctor, writer ... she goes by many titles, just like you and I. Sadly, in her current state, her brain capacity is limited.
???: 那位医生，那位作家。她有很多个好名字，就像你，就像我。遗憾的是，她脑子里留存的东西可不算多。

It's just like after that fateful battle ended. Few survived to remember her awe-inspiring feats.
???: 正如那场战役之后，只有少数幸存者记得她的厉害手段。

Now, this kind-hearted doctor has become a crucial part of another wicked scheme of which our dear admiral is well aware.
???: 如今，那位心地善良的好医生又成了阴谋中的一个必要部分，老将军对此心知肚明。

选项 / Choices

1. What does he know?
1. 他又知道了?

2. What scheme?
2. 什么阴谋?

分支 1 / Branch 1

An orchestra without a conductor can barely play a symphony. Recognizing that missing, vital piece, the admiral seized the opportunity without hesitation.
???: 失去指挥家的管弦乐队虽不至于崩断了弦，但确实演不出像样的交响乐了。老将军抓住了这点，他知道对方现在急需什么。

Experience gives a veteran his scars, yes, but also a scrap of wisdom. He knew he should gain the upper hand in this one-sided gamble.
???: 经验除了带来伤疤，还馈赠一指甲盖大小的智慧。在这场单方面的豪赌中，他率先抓住了最大的筹码。

分支 2 / Branch 2

I don't know yet; there's no mention of it in the reports. I do have some speculations, however.
???: 我不知道，这份报告里没有写。但我有一个推测。

Those troublemakers have been focused on nothing but cultivating chaos and fanning the flames of conflict, paying little attention to the scale and extent of their intended retribution.
???: 那些热衷于捣乱的家伙充其量只是在四处撒下混乱的种子，再顺手给炸药的引线煽把风，但他们都未曾怀疑过炸药的当量和排布。

Now, it seems they've realized the uncertainty of this approach—drastic, volatile retribution won't get them anywhere. To reach their destination, they must forge a new path, even if it's more arduous and perilous than the last.
???: 现在，他们或许意识到了这是不可控的变量，光有爆炸不能解决问题。所以他们得另想办法——即使会是一场长久而艰难的迁移性工程。

选项 / Choices

1. Go on.
1. 说下去

Your minute's up. Time certainly does fly, doesn't it?
???: 一分钟到了，我该走了，时间真是过得特别快，一如既往。

I'll be back when there's a new development. Stay alive if you can. I'd like to keep reading reports for you.
???: 我会在有进一步报告时回来，希望你能活得长久一点，这样我们还能相处很长一段时间。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Excerpt from the New York Times
《纽约新闻报》节选

英文 / ENGLISH
Around midnight two days ago, a large fire broke out in the oak forest on the western outskirts. The delay of the warning and the complex terrains full of inflammables in the forest resulted in a fire that lasted a whole night till dawn and 13 deaths.
The victims entered the forest at dusk. Identities of 6 of them have been confirmed: the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers Tomson Joyce, Shelley Gerald, Kelly Keith, and the project manager Russell James. The others' are still being verified.

The Weyerhaeuser used to be a leader in the wood industry, yet it went bankrupt not long ago due to the wood supply crisis these years. After donating the formula of the Resurrection Potion (basic version) to the Maria Sanatorium in New York, the Sacred Heart Sanatorium in Ohio, and the Presbyterian Church Health Center on certain conditions, the Weyerhaeusers sold all of their forestry lands.
On the night of the fire, the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers, and the workers went into the forest to start the disafforestation project before they died. The police has found traces of arcanist's activities and a small amount of gasoline at the scene, which shows the case is an arson attack. More investigations are needed to identify the suspect.

Reporter: James Welles/Dorey Johnson
中文 / CHINESE
前日深夜，位于市郊西侧的橡木树林发生大范围火灾，由于预警不及，林中地形复杂且可燃物繁多，抢险困难，火势持续直至清晨时分才得以扑灭。
　于当日黄昏时分进入森林的十三名人员全部遇难。死亡人员中已确认身份的六人，包括韦耶豪瑟夫妇，与其交易者汤姆森·乔伊斯、雪莱·杰拉德、凯利·基思，施工负责人罗素·詹姆斯。其余人员身份均在进一步核实中。

　因近年来的木材供应风波，原本根基深重的韦耶豪瑟在前些日子宣告破产。韦耶豪瑟夫妇将基础版起死回生剂的配方，有偿捐赠与纽约玛利亚疗养院、俄亥俄州圣心疗养所与长老会医疗中心三方后，又将名下的所有林业用地对外抛售。
　火情发生当晚，韦耶豪瑟夫妇与购买者三人带领工作小组进入森林，预备开始铲除作业，随后遇难。经市警署排查与分析，火情现场的残留有神秘学家活动与少量汽油的痕迹，已可确定为人为纵火案件。更多关于犯罪嫌疑人的信息仍在进一步调查当中。

　报道记者：詹姆斯·威尔斯/多丽·约翰逊

镜子与面具
The Mask in the Mirror 9TH-14

The Mask in the Mirror
镜子与面具

Vertin: Where did the Physician go? Wait.
维尔汀： 狱医先生呢？不对……

Vertin: Sir, are you ...?
维尔汀： 先生，您究竟是……

No one notices when the unfamiliar prisoner appears.
没有人留意到面前的陌生囚徒是何时出现在那儿的。

He seems calm and almost ordinary, like an unchanging mirror that has stood here all along—in this room, in this labyrinth, passed unseen by everyone.
他平静、普通得如同一面亘古不变的镜子，仿佛一开始就存在，存在于这个房间、这个迷宫之中，存在于所有人的身边。

Recoleta: *pant*
虚构集： 唔……

The answer she now sees plainly makes her step back in a panic.
近在眼前的答案让她仓惶地后退了一步。仿佛事到如今，这个名字所代表的含义，与接下来会发生的事情，让她本能地感到害怕。

But in the end, she says the name out loud. Its sound is heavy, cold, and leaves her at a loss.
但她最终仍然喊出了那个名字。它沉重，冰冷，让人无所适从。

Recoleta: Aleph.
虚构集： 阿莱夫。

Recoleta: It's you, my pen pal.
虚构集： 是你，我的笔友……阿莱夫。

Recoleta: You are in fact in Comala.
虚构集： 你果然在这里，在科马拉监狱之中。

Recoleta: All those letters, all the ideas we shared—they weren't just my imagination or some prank. Vertin, Sonetto, it's all just as I told you!
虚构集： 那些回信，那些措辞，那些字符的组合，它们并不是我的想象，也不是神圣的恶作剧……维尔汀，十四行诗！一切就和我先前告诉你们的一样！

Recoleta: They weren't meaningless. *pant* They're all real.
虚构集： 它们果然都是有意义的，是真实的存在。嗯……

Yet, why does she feel no joy?
只是为何，她并没有感到一丝的欣喜？

Vertin: So, sir, are you Aleph, the ruler of this prison?
维尔汀： 先生，所以您就是阿莱夫，监狱的控制者？

Vertin: Are you the one controlling the Panopticon with a die? The one hiding Ms. Dores's whereabouts?
维尔汀： 就是您用骰子控制了监狱，并隐匿了德洛丝女士的行踪？

Aleph: What curious inquiries, quite different from the last 2666 questions I've received.
阿莱夫： 新奇的提问。有别于之前的两千六百六十六个问题。

Aleph: My guests, you may call me Aleph, or by any other name, be it a symbol of god's oneness or a farcical epithet.
阿莱夫：诸位科马拉的访客，你们可以叫我阿莱夫，也可以叫我任何名字，无论是敬神的符号，还是可笑的代称。

Aleph: I am merely one of the many prisoners who voluntarily reside here—a single letter in the alphabet of the Panopticon.
阿莱夫：我只是一位自愿居住于此的囚徒。组成科马拉万千字符中的一个。

Vertin: A letter ... The way you speak is quite different from Dr. Merlin.
维尔汀：一个字符……阿莱夫先生，您的说法与措辞，都显然与狱医先生相别甚远。

Vertin: Still, I wonder what your relationship is with him.
维尔汀：但我仍然有些费解，您和狱医究竟是什么关系？

Under the dim lighting, the man looks drained of all energy.
在昏暗的灯光下，面前的男子看起来疲惫不堪。

Vertin: But allow me to make a guess: You're Dr. Merlin, aren't you?
维尔汀：我有一个斗胆的猜测：您就是狱医，对吗？

Aleph: I'm afraid that's not entirely accurate, but you may think of it that way.
阿莱夫：这是一个不完全正确的说法。但你可以如此认为。

Aleph: Merlin is a figment born of my mind, an incomplete reenactment. He is me, yes, but not entirely.
阿莱夫：梅林，他是我脑海中诞生的一个幻影，一个不完整的重演……他是我，但也并不完全是我。

Aleph: He—or rather, they—failed to find their answers.
阿莱夫：他……他们只是在自己的命题中求索的失败者。

Aleph: They fought against their predestined fates, only to be inevitably crushed under their weight. I simply stood by and watched it all unfold. That was the extent of our relationship.
阿莱夫：我旁观着这一切，看着他们在注定的命运中挣扎，最后理所当然地溃败，而没有去阻止。这就是我们的关系——仅此而已。

Vertin: "They"?
维尔汀：他们……？

Aleph: You've already met Merlin and the Idealist—even witnessed their demise.
阿莱夫：你们已经见过梅林与理想家了，也亲眼目睹了他们的死亡。

Aleph: Shackled by the delusions of verses, the Idealist lost his own name. Merlin, too, imprisoned himself within the system of the Panopticon.
阿莱夫：理想家被困于诗句的梦魇，最终甚至失去了自己的名字。
而梅林，不过也是被困于科马拉的建筑结构之中罢了。

Aleph: I'm sure their desperate pursuits caused you some trouble.
阿莱夫：沉湎于美妙的希望中无可自拔，孤注一掷。他们的行为确实给诸位带来了一定的麻烦。

Aleph: Please forgive them. After all, your fleeting encounters led to the demise of them both.
阿莱夫：如今，他们以自身的溃败作为这场短暂邂逅的落幕。

Vertin: I think I understand now. The Idealist and the Physician are both parts of you, or, to put it another way, they're your alter egos.
维尔汀：……我想我大概明白了。所以理想家先生与狱医，都是您的一部分，或者说，您的人格之一。

It seems the jailer's diagnosis, that the whole prison is mad, has been shown to be more accurate than anyone could have imagined.
看来，狱卒小姐所说的“监狱中都是精神病人”，并非一句虚言。

Sonetto: The Physician mentioned Manus Vindictae. What's the relationship between this prison and the Manus?
十四行诗：狱医先前提到了重塑之手——科马拉监狱中的一切，以及狱医，又和重塑之手有什么关系？

Aleph: Visitors from the Foundation, we all witnessed those eras perish.
阿莱夫：基金会的访客们，我们都经历过那些消逝的年代。

Aleph: In 1977, not long before the fourth "Storm," I arrived in Ushuaia. Shortly after, some members of the National Foucault Studies Association reached out to me.
阿莱夫：1977 年，第四次暴雨来临前，我来到了乌斯怀亚。他们找到了我——国家福柯学会的人。

Aleph: But it wasn't just them. An arcanist organization called Manus Vindictae also approached me. Each of them wanted answers. They named me their "advisor."
阿莱夫：同时到来的，还有一个自称重塑之手的神秘学家组织。他们都想让我回答他们的问题，把我称为“顾问”。

Sonetto: You acted as an "advisor" to the Manus?
十四行诗：重塑之手的“顾问”？

Aleph: The two parties presented me with a concept and a parable, respectively.
阿莱夫：他们分别给了我一个概念，以及一个寓言。

Sonetto: A concept and a parable?
十四行诗：概念，以及寓言……？

Aleph: The Foucault Association sought to explore the feasibility of the Panopticon concept here.
阿莱夫：国家福柯学会想要在这里探求全景监狱概念的可行性。

Aleph: While Manus Vindictae showed me a parable of the past and future.
阿莱夫：而重塑之手，则向我展示了，那一则关于过去和未来的寓言。

Aleph: Day and night, I wandered through endless texts, endless realities, as I searched for answers. And thus, Merlin was born. He was both an experiment and a price I paid.
阿莱夫：我日夜不停地寻找答案，在无尽的文字与现实中逡巡——于是梅林基于此诞生了。这是一种尝试，也是一种代价。

Aleph: A new concept, a new direction ... Pursuing such things always leaves me confined by the limitations of human knowledge.
阿莱夫：很抱歉，全新的方向，总是会使我陷入人类摄取知识的局限性。

Aleph: Merlin spent his entire life exploring Foucault's theories in pursuit of that singular yet infinite answer.
阿莱夫：梅林终其一生，只想通过探索福柯理论的方式，来获取那个唯一的、无限的答案。

Vertin: What about the Manus, Mr. Aleph? You didn't explain why you helped them.
维尔汀：可是，阿莱夫先生，您仍然没有说清楚您帮助重塑之手的理由。

Aleph: Explain why?
阿莱夫：……理由？

Aleph: Because they asked me to, just as you have.
阿莱夫：他们发问了，就像你们一样。

Aleph: I simply worked to answer their questions.
阿莱夫：而我只是在为他们的问题寻找答案。

Vertin: So you're saying that, to you, we're no different from Manus Vindictae?
维尔汀：……阿莱夫先生，您的意思是，在您眼中，我们和重塑之手并没有不同。

Vertin: And if we ask, you'll answer us, without holding anything back?
维尔汀：如果我们发问，您也会如实地回答这一切吗？

Aleph: Is that not precisely what is happening this very moment?
阿莱夫：这不正是我们正在经历的事情吗?

Vertin: ...
维尔汀：……

Aleph picks up the fallen die. It flickers with a familiar, comforting glow.
阿莱夫拾起了那枚掉落在地上的骰子。它闪烁着抚慰人心的微弱辉光。

Aleph: This is what the Manus gave Merlin, a magical die named the Tear of Comala.
阿莱夫：这就是他们交给梅林的玩具。一个名叫科马拉之雨的巫术骰子。

Aleph: It was once a gemstone that belonged to a god. At the beginning of the century, explorers plucked it from an ancient gate they discovered in Antarctica.
阿莱夫：二十世纪初的探险家们，在无人踏足的南极大陆挖掘出这块属于神祇的魔法石头。它来自一道古远的门扉。

Aleph: To the explorers' amazement, the gemstone could turn human desires into reality.
阿莱夫：他们惊讶地发现，这块石头能够忠实地映射出人们内心的渴望，将幻影的断壁残垣变成现实。

Aleph: So, they cut it into a die, a symbol of fate, and used it to build a sanatorium, which was later transformed into the Panopticon you are standing in right now.
阿莱夫：它被雕琢成代表命运的骰子模样。他们曾用它搭建起一所流放神秘学家的疗养院，最后这所疗养院，又被改造成了如今的监狱……

His words are direct, yet they still leave the outsiders perplexed.
他的话语并不迂回，却依旧让经历了这一切的外来者们感到困惑。

Recoleta: Then, Aleph, you really are the mastermind behind the Panopticon?
虚构集：阿莱夫……所以，科马拉的幕后主使，真的是你吗?

The silent girl grips her notebook. Her knuckles turn white from the pressure.
一直沉默的女孩握紧了手中的笔记本。她的指节正因用力而泛白。

The draft of an unpublished novel, with words that only she knows—the countless hours spent at her desk, the self-reflections, the meticulous questioning, revisions, and scrutiny of every word.
那是一本尚未出版的小说雏形。那里留存着只有她本人所知晓的——属于每日伏案，属于自我审视，属于逐字逐句地质疑、推敲、考究的岁月。

That book holds the life of its writer.
那是一段属于作家的人生。

Recoleta: You said Merlin used the Panopticon to seek his answer. W-What does that have to do with my novel?
虚构集：你说，梅林他想要用全景监狱去追求属于自己的答案，可是这和我的小说有什么关系?

Recoleta: I don't get it, Aleph. Why would you use my novel to manipulate this place?
虚构集：我不能理解……阿莱夫，你为什么要用我的小说来操纵监狱中的一切?

Recoleta: Roberta, García, Octavia, Pablo, the jailer, everyone ... Not one of them deserved to be trapped in a deadly loop in which everyone's fate is already predestined.
虚构集：这里的人们，罗贝托、加西亚、奥克塔维奥、巴勃鲁，还有狱卒小姐……他们都因此而沦陷于一场注定结局的命运之环。

Recoleta: They're just like the ghosts in Amalfitano, inescapably trapped within the ruins.
虚构集：他们被迫成为了阿马尔菲塔诺小镇中的幽灵，被困于这座环形的废墟……

Recoleta: Tell me, what is it you really want?
虚构集：……你究竟想要做什么?

Hearing this, the lonely prisoner fidgets with the die, looking puzzled.
闻言，孤寂的囚徒只是不解地把玩着手中的骰子。

Aleph: It's not about what I want. It's about what you want.
阿莱夫：但这是你自己提出的问题。

Aleph: The third line of your first letter.
阿莱夫：第一封信件的第三行。

Aleph: You said you wanted to give The Rise and Fall of Sanity an ending.
阿莱夫：你说，你想要给《理性家族的崛起与衰落》这篇小说一个结局。

一封破碎的邀请函
A Tattered Invitation 小径

A Tattered Invitation
一封破碎的邀请函

Dear Mr. Aleph,

The National Foucault Studies Association extends a formal invitation for you to join our organization. Our mission is to guide society and the world toward a more structured and enlightened future. We believe your exceptional abilities will be instrumental in achieving this vision. We eagerly await your response.

Sincerely,
José Tartuffe
Comala Prison, Ushuaia
尊敬的阿莱夫先生：
国家福柯学会诚挚邀请您加入，这是一个能使我们的社会乃至世界走上一个更加规范的未来的组织。我们相信您的优秀能力能够帮助我们更好地实现这一目标。静候您的回信。

何塞·达尔杜夫
于 乌斯怀亚 科马拉监狱

奇怪术式的草稿
Draft of a Strange Incantation 小径

Draft of a Strange Incantation
奇怪术式的草稿

Regarding the ... (blurred by water stains) ritual:

1. A large number of Arcanists—this should be an easily achievable goal for Manus Vindictae. Young people capable of lifting bricks and setting sail are plentiful. Devotion remains the best catalyst.

2. Roar Lion's Tail, Sacred Scarab Wings, Nukutaeao Shell—when combined with the Fountain of Immortality, it seems likely that Manus Vindictae aims to achieve something extraordinary. Given the shell's properties, it can withstand an immense amount of energy, ensuring the ritual's success. This is indeed an incantation requiring considerable meticulous preparation.

3. The location ... (blurred by water stains)—remains an excellent choice, but for the ritual itself, timing is of paramount importance. The "time" referred to here is not our traditional understanding, but time "itself."
关于……（模糊不清的水渍）仪式：
1.大量的神秘学家——对于重塑之手来说，这应该是一个简单的目标。那些有能力捡起砖块的，能出海的年轻人遍地都是，虔诚是最好的催化剂。
2.吼狮之尾，圣甲虫双翼，努库泰澳族人的贝壳——这些材料配合永生之泉，可以想象，重塑之手想要做一些了不得的事。基于贝壳本身的性质，它可以承载仪式大量的能量，保证其顺利进行。确实有一个法术需要如此周密的筹备。
3.地点…（模糊不清的水渍）——确实是个很好的地方，但对于仪式本身，时间更加重要，这里所指的时间并非我们传统的认知，而是时间“本身”。

阿莱夫
Aleph 9TH-15

Aleph
阿莱夫

Recoleta: "Historical records of the Die of Babylon can still be found in the library of Santa Teresa University."
虚构集：“我们仍然能在圣特莱莎大学图书馆中，寻找到有关巴比伦之骰的历史记录。”

Recoleta: No, no, no. An opening like this would make the story too ambiguous.
虚构集：不，不。这样的开场会让故事不清不楚。

Recoleta: "In 1975, in the town of Amalfitano, Sonora, Mexico, something terrible and eerie took place in the cottage with the blue roof. It all began with the peculiar customs of the loc—"
虚构集：“1975 年，墨西哥索诺拉州，阿马尔菲塔诺小镇，在那栋蓝色屋顶的茅屋中，一件诡异而可怕的事情发生了。一切起因于当地一项神奇的民俗……”

Recoleta: Wait, how did I learn about all this? I need to add a role for the narrator—the storyteller!
虚构集：不对，我是怎么得知这件事的呢？得在小说开始时加入一个故事的讲述者！

Recoleta: "A surrealist poet from Mexico told me this story. An old woman walked into the bar she frequented in town. At the same moment ..."
虚构集：“一名来自墨西哥超现实主义派的诗人告诉了我这个故事：像往常一样，一名老妇人走进了小镇的酒馆。就在这时——”

Aleph: "... the Bank Clerk entered the bar, too, bringing news that a multinational corporation was going to build a cookie soap factory in Amalfitano."
阿莱夫：“银行职员亦走进了这家酒馆。他带来了一个全新的消息：跨国企业将会在阿马尔菲塔诺兴建一家饼干肥皂厂。”

Recoleta: Wait, "Bank Clerk"? I didn't know there were banks in Amalfitano.
虚构集：等等，银行职员？我从来不知道阿马尔菲塔诺还有银行……

Recoleta: But it does make sense! Commercial banks are no doubt a hallmark of capitalism. Thanks, pen pal!
虚构集：但……这很合理！商业银行是资本主义生产模式的标志……谢谢你，我的笔友！

Recoleta: "Before he became a Bank Clerk, he was an advocate of the town's ancient customs."
虚构集：“在他成为银行职员之前，他也曾是小镇古老习俗拥护者中的一员。”

Recoleta: "He was a Dune Piscator."
虚构集：“他曾是一名疲惫的沙漠捕鱼人。”

Aleph: "After accepting the fate bestowed by the Die of Babylon, he chose to leave everything behind: the sad horrifying village, and the cycles hidden within infinite randomness."
阿莱夫：“在接受了巴比伦之骰赋予他的命运之后，他选择将一切都抛之脑后：可悲可怕的村庄，隐藏在无限随机之中的轮回。”

Recoleta: Oh, how ironic. But it's still realistic, too. Now we just need a contrasting character—a believer in fate.
虚构集：噢，这很讽刺，但也很现实。现在，我们还需要一位与他形成对照的角色，一个宿命论的拥护者。

Recoleta: "An elderly weaver sat in her ancient workshop, tirelessly spinning her wheel, a precious gift bestowed to her by the Die of Babylon."
虚构集：“一名年迈的织工在古老的作坊中，不停地转动她的纺车，这是巴比伦之骰赠给她最珍贵的礼物。”

Aleph: "The Blind Weaver softly recounted all she had experienced."
阿莱夫：“她双眼已盲，低声诉说着自己所经历的一切。”

Recoleta: What a brilliant idea, Aleph! A blind weaver couldn't possibly witness the murder!
虚构集：阿莱夫，这简直是一个天才的提议。眼盲的织工，不可能目击谋杀案的目击证人！

Recoleta: Fantastic! In that case, I'll add a donkey driver who gets murdered in this chapter.
虚构集：好极了，好极了，让我在这一节里加入一个死于谋杀案的赶驴人幽灵……

Recoleta: With each of your suggestions, the story takes a step forward. Thanks, Aleph.
虚构集：每一次，你的提议都让这个故事更进一步，阿莱夫。

Recoleta: But I still can't see any sign of the ending.
虚构集：但为什么……我仍然看不见它的终局？

Recoleta: It's like no matter how many new characters we add, there's still something missing in the desert town. It lacks a key figure.
虚构集：这种感觉就好像，无论我们新增多少角色，这个沙漠小镇中却总是缺少了一名核心的关键人物……

Recoleta: Aleph, what should I do? How do I give this story an ending?
虚构集：阿莱夫，我到底该怎么办？到底要怎么样，才能给这个故事一个真正的结局？

Aleph: You asked me yourself, "How do I give this story an ending?"
阿莱夫：你提出了这个问题：“如何给这个故事一个结局？”

Aleph: You described to me how your words had transformed into an immoderate, infinite puzzle—an unrecognizable language, a collection of ambiguous information, and a parable that had lost all meaning.
阿莱夫：你说，它已经从一行行的文字，化作一个狂热的、无限的谜题。它变成了一门秘密的语言，一列无用信息的组合，一则失去寓意的寓言故事。

Aleph: The absence of an ending still gnaws at you, forever trapping you in that scorching desert town.
阿莱夫：它困扰着你，让你永恒地被困囿于那座炎热的沙漠小镇之中。

Aleph: All I'm doing is trying to find it for you.
阿莱夫：而我只是在尝试解答它。

Recoleta: A-Are you saying you've been manipulating the happenings in the Panopticon like this ever since we first exchanged letters last September?
虚构集：难道从去年九月的时候，我们第一次来信开始，你就一直在科马拉监狱里做着这种……操纵吗？

She struggles, vainly hoping for him to deny it.
她艰难地发问了，期待着一个否定的回答，来结束这荒唐的一切。

Aleph: Yes. Every time you revised the novel, corresponding adjustments were made in the Panopticon. Faithfully reflecting the intricacies of every detail was key to ensuring the story proceeds smoothly.
阿莱夫：是的。每一次，根据你对小说的修改，科马拉监狱中的一切亦会做出对应的调整。考究的细节是故事得以顺利进行的关键。

Aleph: Such adjustments were handled by Merlin mostly; sometimes, the Idealist; and before them, Zahir and Paracelsus.
阿莱夫：有时，梅林会完成这一任务；有时是理想家；再之前，则是扎伊尔和帕拉塞尔苏斯。

Recoleta: "Every time"?
虚构集：每一次……？

Aleph: Six versions of the Amalfitano story have played out in the Panopticon already.
阿莱夫：阿马尔菲塔诺的故事，已经在监狱降临过六次了。

Recoleta: Does that mean ... the frog crushed in the mud, the cow dying of old age, the dormouse falling into the sea,
虚构集：那些泥地间被碾死的青蛙，寿终正寝的牛，坠入大海的睡鼠……

Recoleta: the ghost killed in the duel, and the sudden changes to the Die of Babylon ...
虚构集：那些在决斗中死去的幽灵，骤变的巴比伦之骰……

Recoleta: All the revisions you suggested—all the deaths, chaos, and madness—they all actually happened right here?
虚构集：你在回信中为《理性家族的崛起与衰落》编写的后续，那些死亡、混淆、疯狂与破碎的一切，难道说，难道说，都是在这里……

The ever-knowing prisoner falls into a long, dark silence. He will not answer a question when the one asking already knows the answer.
一直无所不知的囚徒陷入了难得的沉默——他并不会回答一个索问者早已明了答案的问题。

Aleph: Even eternity has its limits, Recoleta.
阿莱夫：……无尽终有尽时，虚构集。

Aleph: In the sixth revision, we added the Blind Weaver, an extraordinary figure.
阿莱夫：在第六次故事中，我们加入了盲眼的织工这一角色，她是一个特殊的存在。

Aleph: Just like the Paracausality Researcher who carries a suitcase that you introduced in your seventh letter.
阿莱夫：就像你在第七次来信中所新增的，提着箱子的能量扰动学家一样。

Sonetto: The Paracausality Researcher carrying a suitcase?
十四行诗：提着箱子的……能量扰动学家?

Sonetto: Ms. Recoleta, is this character really based on the Timekeeper?
十四行诗：虚构集小姐，你所写的这个角色，难道指代的真的是司辰吗?

Recoleta: What? Of course not! The Paracausality Researcher is an entirely different character!
虚构集：什么?！怎么可能，维尔汀和能量扰动学家绝不会是同一个人！

Aleph: Don't you understand? We are only one die roll away from the ending.
阿莱夫：你还不明白吗？我们离结局非常近了，仅有一次投掷的距离。

Aleph lifts the core of the Infinite Labyrinth. The Tear of Comala swirls slowly in his hand.
阿莱夫：阿莱夫举起那颗无限迷宫的核心，科马拉之雨正在他手中缓缓旋转着。

Recoleta: I-I don't ... What on earth are you trying to do?
虚构集：我……我不明白，你到底还想做些什么?

The filament lamps of the operating room dim in time with his motions. The walls ripple like water, then transform into countless mirrors.
手术室的白炽灯瞬间黯淡，墙壁上映射出水面的波纹，而后化作无数面镜子。

Within the mirrors, an endless stream of information appears.
镜子中映出了无数的信息——

A seemingly possessed telephone babbles, an old radio sings, a flickering slide projector whirs and cracks, a muted film projector spins, a timetable opens, and dictionaries of countless languages flow past.
仿佛通了灵的电话、老旧的无线电、摇晃的幻灯机、喑哑的电影机、时刻表……还有无数门语言的词典。

A room without an exit, an eternal predicament, a prisoner's dwelling.
一个没有出口的房间，一个永远的困境，一个囚徒的居所。

Aleph: Recoleta, it is the cycle of fate that has brought you to the Panopticon of Comala in Ushuaia.
阿莱夫：虚构集，是无限轮回的命运，让你来到乌斯怀亚的科马拉监狱。

Aleph: Now, return to The Rise and Fall of Sanity. Return and become a character once more.
阿莱夫：重新回到《理性家族的崛起与衰落》之中吧，再次成为故事中的一名角色。

Aleph: You've been searching for its ending, but how could you possibly find it when you're no longer inside the story?
阿莱夫：你追寻着这个故事的结局，但在这个故事之外，你又如何能找到它的结局?

Aleph: I believe that this time, you will witness the grand finale with your own two eyes. No more sadness. No more loneliness.
阿莱夫：我相信，这一次，你能亲眼目睹一切的终局。你不再需要感到孤独和痛苦了。

Aleph: The answer you've long sought lies in the inevitable final roll of the Die.
阿莱夫：那在劫难逃的、骰子的最后一次转动，就是你一直渴求的答案……

Recoleta: So the jailer is the Bank Clerk and Urd is the Blind Weaver. But what about Roberta, García, and Octavia?
虚构集：狱卒小姐是银行职员，兀尔德女士是盲眼的织工，那罗贝托、加西亚和奥克塔维奥小姐他们呢?

Recoleta: They weren't even assigned roles! They were just playthings, helpless in the face of "fate."
虚构集：他们甚至没能拥有自己的角色，只是那群被命运摆布的动物吗……

Recoleta: What right do you or I have to decide what happens to them, to dictate their gains and losses?
虚构集：……我凭什么决定一个人在监狱中所有的遭遇，凭什么为他制定所有的惩罚与胜利?

Aleph: But they couldn't possibly understand such a thing, could they?
阿莱夫：但他们都看不懂，不是吗?

Aleph: To you, it's just a story. But to them, it is the manifestation of bittersweet destiny.
阿莱夫：对你而言，这只是一个故事，虚构集。但对那些无法理解故事的人而言，这就是苦涩或甜美的命运。

Recoleta: Do you think hiding behind the guise of fiction absolves you from the reality that you've turned the Panopticon into a living hell?
虚构集：难道因为这些都是虚构之物，就能够掩盖你将科马拉变成地狱的可怖事实吗……

Recoleta: Yes, you're the only one who truly understands The Rise and Fall of Sanity. Goodness knows how many manuscripts I sent out that never received a reply.
虚构集：我做过很多徒劳的努力，寄出过无数没有回音的稿件……是的，我的笔友，你确实是唯一能看懂《理性家族的崛起与衰落》的人。

Recoleta: I was so grateful to you. For your replies, for understanding my novel. Those things were more precious to me than any sunrise over the Andes.
虚构集：我很感谢你给我回信，感谢你能理解我的小说——这比安第斯山脉的日出还珍贵。

Recoleta: Had I known that your feedback was created in such a way, and at such a cost, I would've preferred not to receive it at all.
虚构集：但……如果我知道你是通过这样的方式给我回答的，我宁愿从一开始，就不要收到那封回信……

Recoleta: Don't you get it? Even if they don't understand my novel, the people I meet are still my friends, whether we took a long journey together or we simply chatted for a few hours.
虚构集：你不明白吗?！那些看不懂我小说的人，他们都是我的朋友……哪怕我们只同行了一段路程就分别，亦或是仅仅认识了短暂的一天……

Recoleta: We formed an inseparable, miraculous bond. They're a part of me.
虚构集：对我而言，他们都是复杂的奇迹。他们与我自身产生了不可分割的关联，是我的一部分。

Recoleta: How could you treat them like fictional characters?
虚构集：你怎么能够拿这一切与小说做简单的类比?

Recoleta: It's disrespectful to my work and to life itself.
虚构集：这既不尊重我的文字，也不尊重关于生命的一切。

The writer's resistance is so sharp that it cuts through Aleph's carefully constructed labyrinth easily.
作者的抗拒如此尖锐，瞬间击碎了魔法师精心搭建的迷宫。

Aleph: But you raised the question yourself.
阿莱夫：但这是你提出的问题。

Aleph: Why do you resist receiving its answer?
阿莱夫：为什么你如此抗拒得到答案?

He lowers his head, and for the first time, cracks appear on that indestructible mask.
他低下头，那张坚不可摧的面具上仿佛突然出现了裂痕。

The Physician: Hah, they're always like this, aren't they? They throw a question at you only to abandon it along with the fading of the era.
狱医：哈，他们总是这样。提出一个疑问，然后抛弃它，将它扔在时代的脑后。

The Physician: This "Storm" will spare no one. You've known it all along, Aleph.
狱医：阿莱夫，你早就知晓，这场“暴雨”不会放过任何人。

The Physician: Only the timeless Panopticon can maintain control. The all-seeing tower. The perfect governing system.
狱医：只有环形的权力牢狱方可以掌控这一切，一座洞察一切的高塔，才是完美的规训方案。

The Idealist: What a hopeless fool you are, Merlin. Haven't you heard what they say? "There is no need to build a labyrinth when the whole world already is one!"
理想家：梅林，你当真是个无可救药的废物。你没有听过那位伟大诗人的箴言吗？世界本身就是一座巨大的迷宫了！我们为什么要再建一座?

The Idealist: Your meaningless questions will be swept away by the tides of time, only to resurface on the shores of our minds once more. We've seen it happen over and over again! Surely you've realized by now that the only true meaning can be found in literature.
理想家：真正有意义的只有文学。时代的浪潮会将这些被抛下的问题洗涮，最终它们又会回到脑海中的沙滩上来。这种事情我们已经经历过不少了！

The Idealist: For over a century, literature has remained the singular, ultimate answer. This lonely cowboy is simply feeling lost at the moment.
理想家：从一百年前到现在，文学才是唯一的解答，这位孤独的牛仔只是一时迷了路。

The Physician: Spare us your ramblings, Idealist! You're wasting our time.
狱医：放屁，理想家！你是在浪费我们的时间！

Aleph: Enough.
阿莱夫：停下……

The die that reflects the heart can no longer bear its weight, as it glows from within burning fissures.
映射内心的骰子不堪重负，呈现出灼热的裂痕。

On the surrounding mirrors, countless reflections of Aleph appear, each wearing a different face. They crowd into the room as a flood of ghosts.
四周的镜面上，反射出无数道属于阿莱夫的身影，每一面都呈现出不同的容貌。
他们像幽灵一样挤满这个狭窄的房间。

Vertin: Aleph seems to be in a terrible state. We have to be careful. Something isn't right about that die!
维尔汀：阿莱夫先生，他的状态不太对劲……小心，那枚骰子似乎出问题了。

The chaotic battle comes to an abrupt halt.
混乱的战斗戛然而止。

Sonetto: Wait, Mr. Aleph, are you human?
十四行诗：等等，你是……人类?

Sonetto steps back, lowering her glasfeder.
第一助手后退了一步。最终，本来指着前方的玻璃笔迟疑着移开了。

She is shocked to realize that her opponent has no arcane skills at all. From beginning to end, all he had was the die.
她震惊地发现，对方并没有任何的神秘术能力，从头到尾，他所拥有的只有骰子。

Sonetto: Please hand over the die peacefully!
十四行诗：先生，请交出骰子，停下你危险的行为……!

Vertin: Mr. Aleph, please stop resisting. It's futile.
维尔汀：阿莱夫先生，不要再挣扎了，这毫无意义。

Aleph: Futile. Yes, it's all futile.
阿莱夫：是的……这一切都毫无意义。

Aleph: The cage of rules, the ideals of literature ... Both are futile, mere illusions conjured along the path to transcendentality.
阿莱夫：规则的铁笼和理想的文学，都是无用的，只是追寻超限道路上所产生的幻象。

Aleph: They all fear that they're nothing more than phantoms in someone else's dream—that reality will devour everything, including their very existence. That's why they drift further and further away from transcendentality.
阿莱夫：他们都害怕自己只不过是另一个人梦中所产生的幻影，因而抗拒走入那片会吞噬一切的真实，却离超限越来越遥远。

Aleph: They couldn't break free from that false dream. None of them could.
阿莱夫：最终，他们都没能挣脱那个虚假的梦。没有人能。

Aleph stumbles as he looks up at the storyteller.
操纵骰子的魔法师笨拙地看向故事创作者。

Aleph: Both the Physician and the Idealist walked toward their own destruction. Just as I expected.
阿莱夫：狱医和理想家都不出所料地走向了毁灭。

Aleph: But your novel still has hope, Recoleta. Its ending hasn't been written yet.
阿莱夫：但……虚构集，你的小说，它还没有。它没有结局。

Aleph: We cannot deny that it may be the answer to achieving transcendentality.
阿莱夫：在得到结局之前，我们无法否认，它也许是一个迈向超限的答案。

Vertin: You're not going to stop, are you?
维尔汀：……所以，阿莱夫先生，您是不会停下这一切的，对吗?

Vertin: Not until you get your "answer."
维尔汀：在得到一个答案之前。

Vertin: Sonetto, we have no choice but to seize the die from him by force.
维尔汀：十四行诗，我们得先抢过那颗控制监狱的骰子——

Sonetto's arcane energy gathers at the tip of her glasfeder. At this moment, the silent storyteller takes a step forward.
第一助手的神秘术凝聚在玻璃笔的笔尖。
就在此时，一直沉默的青年作家向前走了一步。

Recoleta: Enough.
虚构集：够了。

Recoleta: I said, enough!
虚构集：我说……够了！

She shakes as she reveals the notebook that has never left her side.
她颤抖着，取出了从不离身的笔记本。

未寄出的信
An Unsent Letter 小径

An Unsent Letter
未寄出的信

英文 / ENGLISH
Dear Ms. Recoleta,

I have completed reading the sixth edition of The Rise and Fall of Sanity, which you enclosed with your letter dated February 8, 1991.

Below are some of my personal insights and suggestions for the story's direction:

...

I believe we are nearing the conclusion, and I sincerely hope you never lose your passion for writing.

Additionally, regarding the character of the Blind Weaver ...

(The letter remains unfinished, as it appears the correspondent encountered an unforeseen interruption).
中文 / CHINESE
尊敬的虚构集小姐：
对于你 1991 年 2 月 8 日随信附上的《理性家族的崛起与衰落》第六版修改稿，我已阅读完毕。
以下是一些我个人的见解与故事发展方向的建议：
……
我相信我们离结局已经非常接近了。希望你永远不会放弃对于写作的热爱。
另，关于盲眼的织工一角色……
（信件还没有写完，看得出来回信者是遇到未知的突发事件而停笔了）

虚构的界限
The Boundary of Fiction 9TH-16

The Boundary of Fiction
虚构的界限

Expo Guadalajara
瓜达拉哈拉·博览馆

1990, Guadalajara, International Book Fair.
1990 年，瓜达拉哈拉，国际图书博览会会场。

People move between bookshelves and corridors, engaged in heated conversations. The air is filled with the mingling of multiple languages.
人们在书柜与走廊间来来往往，彼此热烈交谈，空气中充盈着多种语言的交汇。

Editor: I'm afraid we can't publish your novel in its current state, Recoleta. We look forward to seeing more refined work from you in the future!
编辑：很遗憾，虚构集小姐，我们无法刊登你的小说。希望你能拿出更成熟的作品！

Editor: Ah, Mr. Cruz! What a pleasure to see you here! I'm an editor from Naranja Dulce Publishing House. Could you spare a moment to discuss the copyright for The Bluebird? We're huge fans of your children's literature.
编辑：噢，克鲁斯先生，稍等一下！请问您是否有空赏脸和我们聊聊《青鸟》的版权问题？我们甜橙庄园出版社很喜欢您的儿童文学风格……

The editor leaves, hurrying after another writer, leaving Recoleta standing alone in place. The 17th publisher to reject her today.
交谈的编辑追着另一位作家的身影远去了，留下了站在原地的虚构集。
这是今天拒绝她的第十七家出版社。

Recoleta: Hey, relax, Recoleta! Look at all the books around you. This place is heaven! You can't get down on yourself, not here!
虚构集：嘿……放轻松！这种被书本环绕的地方简直就是天堂，至少在这里，在今天，我不应该那么快感受到沮丧。

Recoleta: There are so many writers and publishers here. It's only natural you'd be turned down 17 times. This is just the beginning!
虚构集：没关系的，一次庄严隆重的拒绝可能是某种不祥的预兆，但十七次——它就什么都不是了。

The young writer, attempting to forget her 17th rejection, flips through the event guide in her hands.
在一日之内遭受十七次拒绝的青年作家翻阅着手中的场地指引。

Recoleta: Now, which section should I visit next? Hmm, oh, this brochure might help.
虚构集：接下来我该去哪个展区呢？等等……这本手册里面应该有一些线索才是。

She turns to the last page of the thick handbook, where all the invited authors and their contact details are listed.
她将厚厚的手册翻到最后一页，上面赫然陈列着所有受邀参与本次大会的作者与联系方式。

Recoleta: Wonderful! An exchange of ideas between writers—nothing could be more incredible than that!
虚构集：好极了，一位作家和另一位作家的直接交流——没有什么比这更好的事情！

Recoleta: I recall James Joyce was inspired by a letter he received from Henrik Ibsen. So, maybe what I need is to find someone to share my manuscript with, but who?
虚构集：在当年，乔伊斯也是受到了易卜生一封信的鼓励，才完成了伟大的《尤利西斯》。我该把我的手稿寄给——

Recoleta: Tadeo, Emma Zunz, Aleph, Averroes ...
虚构集：塔德奥，埃玛·宗兹，阿莱夫，阿威罗伊……

Lima Apartments, Buenos Aires
布宜诺斯艾利斯·利马公寓

A knock at the door interrupts her daydream.
敲门声打断了女孩在领奖台上发言的美梦。

Recoleta: Oh, it's you, sir!
虚构集：……房东先生！

Recoleta: Don't worry. I promise I'll catch up on the rent next month! Although I must say, this apartment's hardly worth the price. The cracks on the walls must date back to the last century!
虚构集：请放心，我保证下个月一定补齐房租！要我说，您这破烂公寓还真不值这价钱，墙上这些裂缝就像是从上个世纪遗留下来的……

Landlord: Hmph, make all the excuses you want, ingrate. If you don't pay the rent soon, you'll either end up in that crumbling colonial building on the corner or on the street selling oranges at the San Telmo market!
房东：哼，我一点儿也不急。反正你要是交不出房租，我就得请你搬到街角那座随时会坍塌的殖民公寓去住，或者去圣特尔莫市场的地摊上卖橘子。

Landlord: By the way, Julia told me you lost your job at that textile factory.
房东：对了，听胡丽娅太太说，你又从纺织厂辞工了？

Landlord: You under some kind like "can't work in one place for more than three months" curse or something, little girl?
房东：你这小姑娘，活像是被咒语附身似的！难不成世上真有“在同一个地方工作超过三个月就会身亡”的咒语吗？

Recoleta: Oh, you don't even want to know about the terrible things that happened in that factory. All I did was lend the oppressed workers a hand.
虚构集：您不知道那间纺织厂里头发生了什么可怕的事情。我只不过是为受到压榨的工人们提供一些协助罢了。

Landlord: Bah, you're just like those college kids—full of hot air. Anyway, I'm not here about the rent.
房东：你和那些满嘴胡话的大学生一个模样——算了，我今天来不是为了说这个的。

Landlord: Didn't you tell me to watch out for your letters a while back, when you'd just returned from abroad?
房东：前段时间，你刚从国外回来的时候，不是一直念叨着让我注意你的信件吗？

Landlord: Well, here it is, a letter for you.
房东：喏，你的信——

The girl freezes for a moment, then snatches the letter and slams the door shut, almost buzzing with excitement as she unfolds it.
女孩愣住片刻后，她飞速地抢过信，一把摔上房门，颤抖着展开信件。

Recoleta: My goodness! Someone actually wrote back to me! This is incredible! Oh, oh, thank you so much for bringing it to me, sir!
虚构集：哦，天啊，竟然真的会有人给我回信——我是说，谢谢您，房东先生！

She slits open the long-traveling letter.
她飞速地裁开了那封漂洋过海的信件。

Recoleta: "Dear Ms. Recoleta ..."
虚构集：“敬爱的虚构集小姐……”

Recoleta: It's from—let's see—Aleph!
虚构集：让我看看……回信的作家，是一位名叫阿莱夫的先生！

Street, Buenos Aires
布宜诺斯艾利斯·街头

Young Woman: Eh, I've been watching you. You're not a local, are you? What are you writing?
同行青年 I：嘿，我留意你很久了。你不是本地人吧？你一直在这儿写什么？

Recoleta: Oh, hello! You're right. I just arrived in Buenos Aires three days ago. My trip's been a lot like a Copes tango performance—full of twists and turns, but nothing much worth telling, really.
虚构集：噢，你好！事实上，我三天前才到布宜诺斯艾利斯——中间的故事长得像一段探戈，曲折但没什么值得一说的。

Recoleta: I'm actually writing a reply to my pen pal! Long story short, I sent him a manuscript of my novel, and to my surprise, he actually wrote back.
虚构集：至于现在，我正在给我的笔友写回信！说来有些话长，但我给他寄去了小说的复件，没想到他竟然真的回信了……

Recoleta: Amazing, isn't it?
虚构集：总之，这听起来很奇妙对吧！

Recoleta: In our recent letters, we've been discussing how my novel lacks a key character to drive the story toward a decisive ending.
虚构集：最新的来信中，我们正讨论到这部小说缺少了一个更为重要的角色，因此它无法得到一个决定性的结局。

Recoleta: So we've been debating whether to introduce a new ghost to act as a turning point for the story.
虚构集：于是，我们正在商量是否需要引入一个新的幽灵，作为故事的转折。

Young Woman: Oh, so then you're a writer? Hey, Pancho, come over here! I've found an actual real-life writer!
同行青年 I：这么说来，你是个作家？嘿，潘乔，过来看看！我遇到一位真正的作家！

Young Man: What's the big deal? I wrote plenty of poems in middle school.
同行青年 II：这有什么可大惊小怪的，作家有什么稀奇的？我初中的时候写过不少诗呢！

Recoleta: Oh, so you're a poet!
虚构集：噢，这么说来，你也是一位诗人了！

Recoleta: I have a feeling we're about to embark on an incredible adventure together! Are you interested in joining the visceral realism movement?
虚构集：我有预感，我们会共同开启一场不可思议的冒险故事！你们有兴趣参加本能现实主义派的运动吗？

Young Woman: Vis what? I've never heard of it. But it sounds like fun.
同行青年 I：我从来没听说过这本能……什么的派系。但这好像很有意思！

Recoleta: Fabulous! We have no time to waste. Once I finish this letter, you two must join me on a journey to Ushuaia!
虚构集：太好了！事不宜迟，等我写完这封回信，两位就与我一起前往乌斯怀亚吧！

Young Man: Ushuaia? The end of the world? Why the heck would we go to that icebox?
同行青年 II：乌斯怀亚？那不是世界尽头吗？咱们跑到那个冻得要命的鬼地方干什么？

Young Woman: Oh, don't be such a downer, Pancho. Just think of the fun we'll have, the breathtaking scenery we'll see, and the incredible stories we'll hear.
同行青年 I：潘乔，别扫兴！你什么时候变成这么没趣的人了？试想一下，我们会看到怎样壮丽的景色，聆听多少荒芜中的故事！

Young Man: Fine, María. I'll deal with the cold if you really wanna go so badly.
同行青年 Ⅱ： ……好吧，玛利亚，只要你想去，这些都不是问题。

Young Woman: By the way, could you tell us about your novel?
同行青年 Ⅰ： 话说回来，能不能讲讲你写的小说?

Recoleta: Of course. I'll tell you all about it on the way. Hmm, now where to begin?
虚构集： 当然，路上我会慢慢讲给你们听的！让我想想该从哪儿开头呢?

Recoleta: Alright, let's start with the cottage with the blue roof in Amalfitano.
虚构集： 就从阿马尔菲塔诺里，那座蓝色屋顶的茅屋开始吧……

Recoleta: It's been six months since we first exchanged letters.
虚构集： 从我们的第一次来信开始，已经过去了六个月。

Recoleta: Since then, I've been traveling. First from Chile to Mexico, then from Mexico to Argentina. And I've never stopped writing.
虚构集： 在这六个月里，从智利流浪到墨西哥，又从墨西哥流浪到阿根廷的一路上，我从不曾停止写作。

Recoleta: I'm not really sure what the purpose of my novel is. I just keep writing and writing. I can't stop.
虚构集： 我不知道我的小说，它究竟是什么，我只是在写，一直不停地在写。

Recoleta: What power does literature hold? What responsibilities? Perhaps only by continuing to write will I understand one day.
虚构集： 文学应当拥有怎样的力量？又该承载什么？或许只有持续不断地写下去，我才会明白……

Recoleta flips through her notebook, every turn of the page containing a different-colored letter.
虚构集翻开她的笔记本，几乎每两张纸页间都夹着另一种颜色的信纸。

After their long journey, these pages of letters form a faded riddle, their handwriting long since blurred.
经过漫长的旅行后，这一页页信纸就像褪色的谜团，上面的字迹早已模糊不清。

Recoleta: Aleph, you're right. I do want an ending to my novel.
虚构集： 阿莱夫，你说得对，我确实是很想要一个故事的结局。

Recoleta: But not like this.
虚构集： 但不应该是以这种方式……

Aleph: You really have no idea, do you, Recoleta?
阿莱夫： 虚构集，你真的不知道吗……?

Her only reader realizes she has still not grasped what is happening, forcing him to reveal a truth he has long concealed.
唯一的读者意识到了接下来会发生的事，这迫使他说出了一直隐瞒的真相。

Aleph: The Rise and Fall of Sanity is your story.
阿莱夫： 《理性家族的崛起与衰落》是关于你的故事。

Recoleta: What do you mean?
虚构集： ……什么?

Aleph: You are a ghost, wandering this forsaken land, still striving to create a miracle.
阿莱夫： 你是一个幽灵，一个游荡在这片被遗弃的土地上，却还在试图书写神话的幽灵。

Aleph: You are a wandering poet born in Amalfitano, the foolishly brave protagonist of the story, and the embodiment of the author herself.
阿莱夫： 你诞生于阿马尔菲塔诺，是整个故事最核心的人物：作者自身写照的角色，一名流浪诗人。

Aleph: A reflection, yes. The author, no. You are simply a figment of her imagination, a manifestation of her dream to wander.
阿莱夫：你是那位作家，却也并非那位作家，是她幻想中的自我，一个隐秘的、关于流浪梦想的化身，一个故事中勇敢而荒唐的主角。

Aleph: Have you not realized it? The literary pursuits and romantic adventures you described ... they are merely faded memories from 1975.
阿莱夫：你没有发现吗？你的文学追求，那些愚蠢而高尚的冒险，它们并不属于这个年代，只是一道来自 1975 年的旧时代泡影……

Aleph: The poets who joined the visceral realism movement with "you" left Latin America long ago.
阿莱夫：与“你”一同参加本能现实主义运动的诗人们，他们也早已离开了拉丁美洲。

Recoleta: Faded memories?
虚构集：旧时代的……泡影?

Aleph: As for the novel, it's yours now—a story you're writing, a story about yourself.
阿莱夫：这是你的小说，不仅是你所创作的小说，还是关于你自身的小说……

Aleph: Your departure has turned Amalfitano into a ghost town. The characters have lost their connection to you. They're gradually fading away.
阿莱夫：你的离去，使得阿马尔菲塔诺成为一座鬼城，所有的角色都失去与你的联系，相继化作模糊的存在。

Aleph: If the novel is destroyed, you too will cease to exist.
阿莱夫：……如果你摧毁这部小说，你也会随着故事而消失。

Vertin: Wait, this is ... Ms. Recoleta, is what he said true?
维尔汀：等等……虚构集，他说的是真的吗?

Recoleta: ...
虚构集：……

Recoleta: I ... I know you never lie, pen pal.
虚构集：我知道你从不说谎，我的笔友。

Recoleta: In your first letter, you told me that a character's role and fate must be determined from the outset and consistently adhered to throughout the story.
虚构集：在第一次回信中，你告诉我，需要在最初就决定好角色所被赋予的身份与命运，并让其一直在故事中遵循下去……

Recoleta: Reading the perspective and insights of a walking encyclopedia—having such a person be willing to share their thoughts at all—was an exhilarating experience.
虚构集：这太新奇了，一个来自旁观者的视角，一个博学的读者，一个无问不答的先知。

Recoleta: I had never imagined my novel could develop in this way. Words could hardly describe how I felt in that moment.
虚构集：我从来没有想过故事还能这样发展。欣喜若狂都不足以形容我那一刻的心情。

Recoleta: No one but you has ever understood the story of that town, let alone offered any revisions.
虚构集：我一直知道的，从来没有人能看懂这个小镇中发生的事情，从来没有。

Recoleta: Following your advice, I added the Bank Clerk, the Dune Piscator, the Blind Weaver, and the Murdered Donkey Driver.
虚构集：第二次、第三次，乃至往后的每一次来信，我按照你的建议，在故事中加入了银行职员、沙漠捕鱼人、盲眼的织工、死于谋杀的赶驴人……

Recoleta: Amalfitano was no longer an empty town with a single blue-roofed cottage. The new ghostly residents had begun to fill the skies over it.
虚构集：阿马尔菲塔诺小镇不再仅有那座蓝色屋顶的茅屋，新到来的幽灵挤满了沙漠上空。

Recoleta: The story was finally reaching completion. I could feel that the ending was within reach.
虚构集：理性家族的历史与故事也越来越完整，我能够感觉到，它的结局近在咫尺。

Recoleta: I became increasingly eager to meet my pen pal. I couldn't get the thought out of my mind.
虚构集：我越来越迫切地想要见到这位唯一的笔友。这个异乎寻常的想法占据了我的脑海。

Recoleta: I wasn't sure what I would say to this Aleph. A simple "thank you," perhaps? Or maybe a discussion about the future of Amalfitano with its sole reader?
虚构集：我不知道我要与“阿莱夫”说什么。一句来自作者的、轻飘飘的感谢？还是说，我要与这个唯一的读者商讨阿马尔菲塔诺的未来？

Recoleta: Or maybe I'm no different from everyone else—led up the garden path by "fate."
虚构集：或者我也只是受困于这个念头的、受到命运摆布的人罢了……

Aleph: ...
阿莱夫：……

Recoleta: But even if I am a ghost, as you say, an incarnation of someone else, a fictional being—
虚构集：无论你所说的这一切，是真实亦或虚假——我是一个幽灵，一个隐秘的化身，一个虚构出来的存在。

Recoleta: So what?
虚构集：但……这又何妨？

Recoleta: My resolve will not waver, even if my existence is bound to fade away.
虚构集：无论我自身是否会随之消亡……我的决心都不会改变。

Recoleta: Because this isn't what literature is supposed to be.
虚构集：因为文学不应该是这样的。

Recoleta: You once told me there isn't an ounce of reality in fiction—only voids and glorified lies.
虚构集：你曾告诉我，故事里没有纯粹的现实，只有一个个深渊，一层层谎言堆叠的地基……

Recoleta: Let me tell you this: whether real or fictional, corporeal or intangible, I have accepted my existence.
虚构集：我将回答你，在现实与虚构那闪烁不定的边界里，我早已接受了自身存在的事实。

Recoleta: Now, let's put a stop to this, Aleph.
虚构集：阿莱夫，停下这一切吧。

Recoleta: The inmates aren't characters in my novel. They're people trapped in a prison, just as you are.
虚构集：他们……那些监狱中的朋友们，他们并不是我笔下的角色。你不仅把他们困于这座环形的废墟之中，也困住了你自己。

Recoleta: By simulating my story here, you have made me into some kind of god, a guilty false creator, a dictator of fate.
虚构集：你赋予了我操纵他人命运的力量，让我成为了一名愧疚的神明，一个虚假的、让人顶礼膜拜的造物主……

Recoleta: I never wanted any of this!
虚构集：但我根本不想要这样……！

Shattered words and ghostly illusions roar forth, breaking free from the story's structure and the gaps between its lines, filled with regret and obsession.
那些破碎的文字和幽灵的幻影呼啸而出，从故事的结构、从字里行间解脱，充满悔恨与痴醉。

Torn letters and book pages flutter in the air, like snow in a crystal globe on a winter night.
被撕碎的信纸与书页，纷纷扬扬地在房间内飘落，像是一个美丽的冬夜水晶球。

Everything is quiet.
一切都归于宁静。

Sonetto: Ms. Recoleta has vanished.
十四行诗：虚构集小姐，她消失了……

Sonetto: Did she really "cease to exist" like Aleph said?
十四行诗：难道，阿莱夫说的都是真的吗?

Vertin: Recoleta ...
维尔汀：虚构集……

《…图书…博览会导览》
... Book ... Fair Guide 小径

... Book ... Fair Guide
《…图书…博览会导览》

英文 / ENGLISH
B Section Works Guide:

1. The Bluebird, Watson Cruz, Children's Literature.
Editor's Review: A children's book, but not just for children. Viewing the world from a different perspective reveals an entirely new reality.

2. Fox Beneath the Sky, Tadeo, Social Literature.
Editor's Review: A classic intellectual autobiography offering profound reflections on the nature of time.

3. Blood Monster, Averroes, Horror Fiction.
Editor's Review: Undoubtedly the finest novel about vampiric creatures this century. A three-hundred-year tale of immortality, jealousy, and humanity.

...

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...
中文 / CHINESE
B 区作品导览：
1.《青鸟》，沃森·克鲁斯，儿童文学。
编辑点评：儿童文学，但不只是儿童文学。从另一个角度看世界，会发现一切都截然不同。
2.《天空下的福克斯》，塔德奥，社会文学。
编辑点评：人类历史上经典的思维自传之一，呈现了对时间本质的深刻思考。
3.《血怪》，阿威罗伊，怪谈小说。
编辑点评：毫无疑问，本世纪最优秀的关于血食怪的小说。一部关于永生、嫉妒与人性的，长达三百年的故事。
…

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往昔的幽灵
Ghosts of the Past 9TH-17

Ghosts of the Past
往昔的幽灵

On an unknown night, the wind carries the cold desolation of the desert.
无人知晓的夜晚，风带来了属于沙漠的冰冷与荒凉。

In the cottage with a blue roof, a girl dreams of a circular prison.
在那座蓝色屋顶的茅屋里，一个女孩梦见了一座环形的监狱。

Then, she wakes.
然后，她醒了过来。

Recoleta: What a bizarre dream.
虚构集：……真是一场混乱又荒唐的梦。

Recoleta: The taste of reality—so bitter and sad.
虚构集：那现实的味道，尝起来如此的沉重和悲伤……

Recoleta: But full of dialectical thinking, haha. Maybe the people of the Panopticon were reflecting my inner thoughts?
虚构集：但是它又充满了精确的辩证，哈哈——那是我内心的投影吗?

She looks around, surveying the cobwebbed corners where stacks of manuscripts have piled up to the ceiling and over empty ink bottles collecting dust.
她环视四周，打量着结了蜘蛛网的角落、堆上天花板的稿纸和落满灰尘的墨水瓶。

Recoleta: Ah, so I really am a character in the novel!
虚构集：看来我真的是小说中的人物！

Recoleta: The mysterious cottage with the blue roof was my home all along. Then, the rumors the ghosts spread were indeed just that—rumors.
虚构集：噢！这栋最为神秘的蓝色屋顶茅屋，原来是我的住所。那些幽灵们所说的可怖传闻，果然只是以讹传讹。

The young writer steps out of her home and into the streets of the familiar yet foreign desert town.
归来的青年作家走出了自己的家，来到了熟悉又陌生的沙漠小镇街道。

Countless nameless characters and ghosts arrive upon hearing the news, filling the roads and skies.
无数没有名字的角色与幽灵都闻讯赶来，挤满了道路与上空。

The Bank Clerk: Welcome back to Amalfitano, dear writer!
银行职员：我亲爱的作家朋友，你终于回到阿马尔菲塔诺了！

Recoleta: Thank you, dear icon of capitalism. But, didn't I tear this novel to pieces?
虚构集：谢谢你的欢迎，亲爱的资本主义象征。但我记得我明明摧毁了这本小说……

A woman wearing a peculiar hat steps forward.
一名风尘仆仆、戴着帽子的女士走上前。

The Paracausality Researcher: You see, Amalfitano is a dimension beyond life and death.
能量扰动学家：因为阿马尔菲塔诺，是生与死的边界，是超脱一切存在的存在。

The Paracausality Researcher: This town is a reflection of your inner thoughts. It's incorporeal. You can't tear something incorporeal into pieces.
能量扰动学家：因为这里，是你内心的投影，它并不真实，自然也无从消亡。

The Paracausality Researcher: Literature is endless and timeless, like a river flowing across life and death.
能量扰动学家：因为文字是一条能跨越生与死的河流，它不受到时间所管辖。

Recoleta: No wonder you're my favorite character. You never cease to enlighten me.
虚构集：您不愧是我最喜爱的角色，总是能让我领悟到生活另一面的答案。

The Door-Side Beggar: Unfortunately, literature is a dangerous and futile calling. Nobody truly understands or even remembers your work!
门槛旁的乞丐：但很可惜，文学它只是无用的举动。没有人能看懂，也没有人会记得你的文字！

The Door-Side Beggar: Do you remember the saying? "The only truly dead are those who have been forgotten."
门槛旁的乞丐：还记得那句俗语吗？当我们从所有人的记忆中消失时，就是我们真正的死亡。

The Door-Side Beggar: Hahaha, Recoleta, you'll disappear for good if you leave Amalfitano again. It'll be like you never existed!
门槛旁的乞丐：哈哈，虚构集，你只能留在这个生与死的边界！一旦离开了阿马尔菲塔诺，你还是会迎来消亡的命运！

Recoleta: I've always admired your critical thinking, sir. It fits your role perfectly.
虚构集：乞丐先生，作为一个彻底的批判型角色，我一直非常欣赏您的批判性思维。

Rough hands grasp the writer's palm, feeling at the lines etched into her skin.
一双粗糙的手握住了青年作家的手，来者摸索着她掌心的纹路。

The Blind Weaver: Everything will be alright, Recoleta.
盲眼的织工：没关系的，虚构集。没关系的。

The Blind Weaver: Whatever happened, you've returned now. That's what matters.
盲眼的织工：无论之前发生了什么事情，你回到了这里，这是最重要的。

The Blind Weaver: The Die of Babylon will roll again, and each of us will get our endings.
盲眼的织工：巴比伦之骰得以恢复正常，得以再次转动，我们所有人都会迎来属于自己的结局。

The crowd erupts in cheers.
在场的人都欢呼起来。

The Murdered Donkey Driver: That's right. Solve the murder at the bar and put my soul at rest!
赶驴人的幽灵：快侦破那起发生在酒馆的谋杀案，让我的灵魂得以安息在这片大地！

The Dune Piscator: Free the village from the madness inflicted by the ancient spirit!
沙漠捕鱼人：快摧毁一直困囿着这座村庄的疯狂，让它不再受到古远幽灵的侵扰！

The Paracausality Researcher: Fix the randomness of the Die of Babylon and flatten the calamitous frequency!
能量扰动学家：快修正巴比伦之骰的随机性，让风中飘荡的频率不再为所有人带来噩运！

Amalfitano Residents: Roll the Die one last time, Recoleta!
所有人：快掷下最后一次骰子吧，虚构集！

The young writer takes a step forward. Everyone, the living and the ghosts, watches expectantly.
青年作家往前走了一步，所有人与幽灵都饱含期待地望着她。

Recoleta: So the ending I've been searching for is the one the other "me" was unable to give me?
虚构集：原来我一直在追求的，是那个“我”所未能给我的结局吗？

Recoleta: The "me" that plunged headfirst into the struggle against an undefeatable power. The "me" who ultimately left this land ...
虚构集：那个不顾一切、投身于抗争的“我”，那个忙于做怪人和献祭者的“我”，那个终究离开了这片大陆的“我”……

Recoleta: After all this time, I've finally found my ending.
虚构集：我终于找到了……我的结局……

She grasps the gleaming Die of Babylon.
她握住了那颗闪闪发亮的巴比伦之骰。

Recoleta: Just one more roll, and it will all be over.
虚构集：而现在，只需最后一下骰子的转动，一切都会结束……

Recoleta: My story, my town ... Everything will finally come to an end.
虚构集：我的故事，小镇中的一切，都会迎来真正的、我一直在追求的结尾……终于……

Recoleta: But the dream about the Panopticon ... It'll end as well, won't it?
虚构集：但那场环形监狱的梦境，也会同时结束，对吗……?

She stops.
她停下了动作。

The Bank Clerk: Oh, sweetheart, it's just a dream.
银行职员：亲爱的，那只是一场梦而已。

The Door-Side Beggar: Ha, don't tell me you're abandoning your lifelong pursuit for a measly dream!
门槛旁的乞丐：你要为了一场虚无的梦，抛弃你穷尽一生的追求吗?

The Murdered Donkey Driver: That dream is cruel. No one understands this great novel there or this amazing town.
赶驴人的幽灵：在那场残酷的梦中，没有人能够理解这部伟大的小说，理解发生在小镇中的一切。

The Blind Weaver: But here, you are a true writer. This is your home, Recoleta.
盲眼的织工：但在这里，你是一位真正的作家。这里才是你的故乡，虚构集。

Recoleta: But I already miss my friends in that dream. It exists, just like this place does.
虚构集：但我想念我的朋友们了……那场梦境同这里一样，也仍然没有结束。

The Dune Piscator: But we're your friends too, Recoleta!
沙漠捕鱼人：虚构集，我们也是你的朋友!

The Paracausality Researcher: You might disappear forever if you leave Amalfitano. Are you sure you want to leave?
能量扰动学家：……哪怕离开了阿马尔菲塔诺，你有可能永远地消散，你也要这么做吗?

The young writer puts down the die in her hand.
青年作家放下了手中的骰子。

The die that signifies the end of everything vanishes into the sandy wind.
那颗代表着一切终点的骰子，再次消失在了夹着沙的风中。

Recoleta: You know what I'm like, my dear friends. I've spent my life embarking on foolish, unrewarded adventures.
虚构集：朋友们，你们都知道的，我这一生，都在进行着一些愚蠢而不求回报的冒险……

Recoleta: That's just who I am, isn't it?
虚构集：毕竟这就是我，不是吗?

Recoleta: Amalfitano is indeed an ideal place—a place for wandering, for a short trip, and for losing oneself for a while.
虚构集：阿马尔菲塔诺确实是一个理想的地方。一个适合流浪，也适合短暂停留，更适合迷失的地方。

Recoleta: And it has you, my fictional friends, who I love so dearly.
虚构集：我亲爱的虚构朋友们，我永远喜爱你们……

Recoleta: But I must return to my dream and see my friends there. They're just as important to me.
虚构集：但我仍然需要回去我的梦境中看看，那些监狱中的朋友们，他们也同样重要……

As they hear her words, the ghosts of the town smile with relief.
闻言，小镇的幽灵们都露出了释怀的笑容。

The Paracausality Researcher: Yes, you're right, Recoleta.
能量扰动学家：是啊，你说得没错，虚构集……

The Paracausality Researcher: There's no denying that you're a noble and passionate soul. Every one of us knows it.
能量扰动学家：我们一直都知道的，你就是这样的人，这样高尚而充满热烈情感的人。

The Door-Side Beggar: Hmph, you're our dear friend, too. Why would we stop you from doing what you truly want?
门槛旁的乞丐：哼，我们是你最好的朋友，没有道理阻止你决定做的一切。

Everyone makes way for her as a path into a boundless void unfolds.
所有人都为女孩让出了道路。在她的面前，一条通往无边虚空的路出现了。

The Blind Weaver: We wish you the very best, Recoleta.
盲眼的织工：我们都祝福你，由衷地为你祈祷，虚构集。

The Blind Weaver: Goodnight, my dear. May your dream be a sweet one this time.
盲眼的织工：晚安，亲爱的——祝愿这一次，你能够获得一个美好的梦境。

Recoleta: Thank you all, my friends. I'll never forget you.
虚构集：谢谢你们，我的朋友们。我会永远想你们的。

The girl wipes the tears from her eyes and steps into the looming darkness.
女孩擦干眼角的泪痕，她义无反顾地迈入了黑暗之中。

All is silent as she enters the barren land. There is only the faint sound of footsteps echoing against a vast and empty darkness.
四周寂静得像荒芜之地的夜晚，只有轻盈的脚步声在这广袤又深邃的黑暗之中微弱回响。

Editor: I've read your work, Ms. Recoleta. To be frank, it lacks both depth and breadth.
编辑：虚构集小姐，我已拜读过你的作品了。坦白讲，它还没有达到足够的深度或广度。

Editor: This town of yours is still far from reflecting the complexity of society, and the narrative lacks a discerning perspective. It still needs some work if you want it to truly resonate with our audience.
编辑：它离现实社会的复杂性还有距离，应有的锐利视角也有所缺失。希望你继续打磨，寻找让它与现实产生更强共鸣的方法。

Editor: Just go for it, Miss. You're at a perfect age to explore, experience, and learn!
编辑：放开手做吧，年轻的作家。你正处在这样一个好年纪，一个对社会无知、好奇而四处闯荡的年纪！

Time wheels, and at last the girl feels her existence again within the void. She reclaims her voice.
女孩第一次从虚无中感受到了自己的存在，她重拾回自己的言语。

Recoleta: Wh-What's happening to me?
虚构集：我……发生了什么?!

A thousand, or perhaps countless, faces emerge before her again.
一千个，甚至无数张面孔的集合再一次浮现于眼前。

Recoleta: Ah, of course! The Rise and Fall of Sanity is my story.
虚构集：哈，原来如此！《理性家族的崛起与衰落》就是“我”的故事……

Recoleta: So, even though the novel's been destroyed, the story—and myself along with it—lives on in the minds of those who read it.
虚构集：也许正是那些看过这篇小说的人，使得这个故事延续，而我也因此存在……

Recoleta: Thank you for your feedback, editor! Even here in this great expanse of darkness, I can still hear your words!
虚构集：编辑先生，很感谢你的意见！即使在广袤又深邃的黑暗中，你也不忘传达你那热情的拒绝之辞！

Recoleta: You have my gratitude. Thank you for reading my novel, even if you didn't understand it and likely never will.
虚构集：哪怕你其实并没有理解我的小说，也永远不会看懂。但谢谢你成为了我的读者。

She navigates a labyrinth of words and an endless expanse of mirrored waters. The darkness surging toward her like a rush of waves on a dark night, making her presence feel heavier.
她在文字的迷宫与无限延展的水面中摸索着，黑暗如夜晚的海浪般向她涌来，使她的身影变得沉重。

Young Woman: Honestly, I find your story totally fascinating! But I'm still struggling to understand the connections between all these nameless characters. Couldn't you make it clearer, like a movie?
同行青年 I：说实话，我觉得听你讲故事很有意思！但我实在搞不懂这些没名字的角色之间的联系……它就不能像电影那样清晰明了吗?

Young Man: Hmph, typical—trust a writer to try to be all obscure and mysterious.
同行青年 II：哼，作家都是这副德性，喜欢卖弄技巧、故弄玄虚。

Recoleta: María, Pancho, you guys are the best traveling pals I've ever had!
虚构集：嘿，玛利亚，潘乔，你们是我遇到过最好的公路旅行同伴！

Recoleta: Our paths may diverge in the future, but the joyful memories of our journey across grasslands, snowfields, and deserts together will remain forever.
虚构集：即使未来的道路不同，但我们曾共同踏过草原、雪地与沙漠。我们留下了一条愉快的轨迹。

Young Woman: It's been great coming along with you. You're totally one of a kind. We'll be waiting for you at my aunt's vineyard. A little sun after a hard day's work will do you good.
同行青年 I：我们也很喜欢你！你是个很有趣的家伙。另外，辛勤劳动后的惬意阳光也是很棒的人生体验，我们在葡萄庄园等你过来！

The passionate companions wave to her, never looking back as they continue forward. The girl's steps are no longer weightless. With every step she takes, they feel heavier and more real.
热情的青年们朝她挥挥手，头也不回地向前走去。女孩的脚步不再虚无，每走一步，它们都变得更沉重和真实。

She lingers inside the infinite Mask in the Mirror, the boundless universe filling her with both confusion and illusion.
她在无限的镜子与面具中逡巡，无限的宇宙让她陷入迷茫与虚妄。

The Idealist: There is ambition in her writing. It's passionate and poetic, fractured and chaotic. But, when viewed as a whole, her work feels like little more than a superficial illusion. It lacks the depth to truly touch the soul.
理想家：我在她的文学中感受到了尝试的姿态——它热情又破碎，混乱又诗意。但归根结底，作品整体只是一类绚烂的幻影，徒有其表，缺少了穿透灵魂的精准性。

The Idealist: I will refrain from offering further comments until she stops romanticizing her childish adventures.
理想家：在她停止神话自己的青春之前，我是不会给出更多评价的。

The Physician: To put it bluntly, her phraseology feels overly deliberate to the point of distortion. Her verbiage is like a collection of vague sentiment bubbles.
狱医：坦白说，她的词句是刻意的、扭曲的。每一个词语都是一团含糊的感性泡沫。

Recoleta: I see, Aleph. Then this is how you really feel about my novel?
虚构集：原来如此……阿莱夫，这些都是你的真心话吗?

Aleph: A thousand readers will interpret a story a thousand different ways. Some believe the text itself is dead, and it is the reader who gives it life.
阿莱夫：在每一个读者的眼中，故事重生，人物变形，哈姆雷特不再是单一的存在，而是一千个、甚至无数张面孔的集合。

Aleph: The truth cannot be fully conveyed through words alone. That said, I think The Rise and Fall of Sanity is a good story.
阿莱夫：奥秘终归是不可被人的语言完全洞彻的。但我认为，《理性家族的崛起与衰落》是一个好故事。

Her heart skips a beat.
那颗属于作家的心脏，真切地跳动起来。

Within this "paradise" that harbors the boundless histories and mysteries of humanity, she finally finds the mirror that shows her reality as it truly is.
在藏有无尽人类历史与奥秘的“天堂”中，她终于找到了那一面映照出真实的镜子。

Recoleta: Oh, so the eternal paradise is a library of sorts, just like I always imagined! Or, is this just another reflection of my inner thoughts?
虚构集：噢，原来天堂还真长得跟图书馆差不多！还是说它只是我内心欲望的一种投影呢?

Recoleta: Hmm, I like it here. It's nice being surrounded by literature.
虚构集：我喜欢这里，喜欢那种被文字包围的感觉。

Recoleta: But it's time to go back. Back to reality.
虚构集：但……我该回去了，回到现实中去。

Recoleta: You're right about literature, Door-Side Beggar. It is a dangerous and futile calling, but I still believe in it.
虚构集：门槛旁的乞丐先生，你说得对，文学的确是无用的举动，但我相信它。

The investigators from the Foundation breathe a sigh of relief together.
来自基金会的女孩们松了口气。

Recoleta's reappearance is as sudden as her disappearance. Sonetto hasn't even had time to wipe the tears from the corners of her eyes.
女孩的出现就像她的消失一般过于突然，第一助手还没有时间擦干净眼角的泪珠。

Sonetto: Recoleta? You're back!
十四行诗：虚构集……？你回来了?!

Vertin: I'm so glad to see you're safe.
维尔汀：很高兴看到你平安无事。

Recoleta: And I'm so glad to see you two worried sick about me, tee-hee! Thanks, my best friends Sonetto and Vertin!
虚构集：嘿嘿！十四行诗，维尔汀！我很高兴，原来我们有这么熟!

Sonetto: ...
十四行诗：……

The reborn writer turns to the prisoner sitting dejected nearby.
焕发新生的青年作家，将目光落在陷入颓丧的囚徒身上。

Recoleta: See, Aleph? I still exist.
虚构集：看到了吗？事情并非如你所想的那样，阿莱夫。

Aleph: Amalfitano is gone. It's all over.
阿莱夫：阿马尔菲塔诺消失了，一切都结束了。

Aleph: You're simply a wandering ghost now, never to return home again.
阿莱夫：虚构集，你与那些无家可归的幽灵一样，再也无法回到故乡。

Aleph: You may still exist, but Amalfitano will never get its ending. You've nullified its existence, rendering all of this meaningless.
阿莱夫：即使你仍旧存在，你也再不能得到阿马尔菲塔诺的结局了……你否定了它，让这一切都失去了意义。

Aleph: I'm sorry I couldn't answer your question. I've failed once again.
阿莱夫：很抱歉，我没能解答你的问题。我又失败了……

His die falls to the ground. Once used to construct a beautiful dream, now whatever magic it held has dissipated.
属于魔法师的骰子跌落在地上。它曾用来搭建了一个美妙的幻梦，但如今它已经消散了。

Aleph: Amalfitano and the Panopticon were two parts of a whole.
阿莱夫：从阿马尔菲塔诺到科马拉，一切都是一个巨大的整体。

Aleph: With Amalfitano gone, Comala no longer has any reason to exist.
阿莱夫：当阿马尔菲塔诺消逝后，科马拉的一切也不需要存在……

Recoleta: I'm sorry, Aleph. You, who know all the mysteries of the world, who seek answers to every question,
虚构集：我很遗憾，阿莱夫先生。你知晓世间所有的奥秘，寻找一切问题的回答——

Recoleta: have lost yourself in the process.
虚构集：但在这过程中，你唯独遗忘了你自己。

Recoleta: You can answer everyone else's questions, but never your own.
虚构集：你能回答所有人的问题，但唯独回答不了自己的问题。

Recoleta: Who's the person behind that mask? Is he real? Does he still exist?
虚构集：那个面具下的人，究竟是谁？他还存在吗？

Aleph: Who am I?
阿莱夫：我……是谁？

The weighty ending to the story leaves the prisoner, still trapped in a blurred illusion, exhausted.
如此沉重的故事句号，让被困于模糊幻境的囚徒感到疲惫不堪。

Comala Prison groans, like an aging waterwheel struggling under its own weight, distorting, fading, and collapsing into the currents of his mind.
科马拉监狱发出沉重的声响，如同年迈的水车不堪重负，开始变形、消失、彻底地瓦解在精神的水流之中。

Vertin: Stay vigilant, everyone. This is just like when the Idealist and the Physician had their meltdown.
维尔汀：大家小心。这似乎是与狱医和理想家精神崩溃时一样的情况。

Vertin: Only this time, it seems even worse.
维尔汀：但这次的动静，比先前要大许多……

Recoleta: I think ... Aleph is trying to tear down the Panopticon.
虚构集：我想……是阿莱夫主动让科马拉监狱的一切瓦解了。

Beyond the crumbling walls, a shivering figure is faintly visible. He grips a gun tightly. The black barrel, shaking in his hands, is aimed at the people in the room.
倒塌的墙壁后，一个颤抖的人影隐约可见。他紧紧握着枪，漆黑的枪口随着双手晃动，朝向房间中的人群。

???: F-Freeze! Stay where you are, all of you!
???: ……等等，你们都不要动！就站在原地！

文学兵役
Armed with Literature 小径

Ahem ... Take a deep breath, soldier; the smoke's cleared now. This story—this "battle"—will soon come to an end.
???: 咳咳……喘口气，配给品的香烟已经抽完了，故事马上迎来结局，这场“战役”也要结束了。

A writer has departed from her domain, leaving her creations scattered behind her, like blood-soaked bandages and fragmented skulls in the trenches.
???: 一位作家终于离开了自己的疆域，只留下一地的创作物，就像那些战壕里留下的绷带和半颗脑袋。

What a garbled mess.
???: 读下来很够呛。

选项 / Choices

1. I don't understand it at all.
1. 我读不懂哪怕一点

2. I think I understand.
2. 我想我读懂了

分支 1 / Branch 1

Glad we're on the same page. Thank heavens my commander wasn't some kind of littérateur; else I'd have been blown to bits before I could decipher their poetic orders.
???: 我们达成了共识。我也庆幸自己的司令从来不是文学家，否则在我解读完一首诗的指令前，就要被炸得稀巴烂了。

分支 2 / Branch 2

whistle How wonderful for you. You know what? You should be the leader of the Literature Encryption Communication Team. Just arm yourself with a dictionary, and even enemies with .45 Maxim machine guns won't stand a chance against you.
???: 那太好了，建议你兼任“文学加密通话组”的组长，并为你配给一本字典，用以对抗 11.43 毫米马克沁机枪。

Because the poetry you recite will surely blow their minds before their bullets pierce yours.
???: 相信在子弹穿过你的眉心之前，你朗诵的诗歌就能让敌人脑袋开花。

选项 / Choices

1. You've developed a sense of humor.
1. 你似乎变幽默了

Well, it's all thanks to a certain writer, the embodiment of the wandering poet and traveler from Santiago to Buenos Aires. She impressed me with her precious experience as a cafe dishwasher and campground caretaker.
???: 多亏这位贯彻诗人式流浪生活的作家，从智利到布宜诺斯艾利斯，她用她宝贵的、罕有的，洗碗工与露营地保管员的兼职经验折服了我。

What really rekindled my sense of humor was her seriousness about her literary pursuits. You'd understand what I mean if you'd ever heard a cheesy joke at a comrade's graveside.
???: 她对文学的严肃性让我的幽默感死而复生。你如果在战友墓碑前听过冷笑话，或许就能明白我说的。

Drawing strength from her wanderings and rebellious exploits, she attempted to change society, wielding the sword of literature as a revolutionary intellectual and a leader of thought.
???: 总而言之，她从自己为数不多的流浪与革命经历中掏自肺腑，试图将“文学”作以社会变革的伟大手段，一位意见领袖，一位精英知识分子。

Some would hail her as a battle angel of Latin America, with words as piercing as bullets and poems as powerful as tactical bombers.
???: 有人会说，她是拉丁美洲的角斗士，而每个文字都是一颗子弹，一篇诗歌就是一架战术轰炸机。

选项 / Choices

1. I doubt literature has such a profound impact.
1. 我不相信那些关于文学的话

2. I believe in the power of literature.
2. 我相信那些话是事实

分支 2.1 / Branch 2.1

Many share your doubt, myself included.
???: 很多人与你想法一样，我也不例外。

分支 2.2 / Branch 2.2

You stand firm in your beliefs, huh? Well, maybe that's a good thing. A commander has to trust their soldiers, or they'll be forced to surrender before long.
???: 你从不将信将疑，还对一切充满信任。这也许是好事。将军总得相信自己的士兵，不然早该投降了。

Here, come closer. Let me tell you a secret ...
???: 来吧，还是让我跟你汇报个机密……

Many—if not all—people foolishly think it's the executioner who drops the guillotine blade, the powder that fires the bullet.
???: 很多人、不计其数的人，以为拉下闸刀的是刽子手，击发子弹的是火药。

While they're half right, they're substantially inaccurate. The craters on the battlefield aren't the result of bombs, but of clashing ideologies—a trigger pulled long before the powder ever ignited in the barrel.
???: 可他们只说对了一半。战壕上的坑洞，只是一场场思想与意识撞击后的残骸。早在火药燃烧之前，思想就钻进了枪膛。

As for literature ...
???: 而至于文学……

Well, it's probably best not to buy too much into the Latin American Boom. Forget about the status report from earlier.
???: 确实没必要相信那场始自于拉美的大爆炸，之前的报告你听过就算了。

That said, at least there's one thing that's certain:
???: 但至少……听我说，至少你可以笃信一点。

Books can bite back—and they'll leave scars.
???: 书翻太快也会割到手。

共同接续 / Shared continuation
Armed with Literature
文学兵役

愚人颂
In Praise of Folly 9TH-18

In Praise of Folly
愚人颂

A prisoner steps out from behind the wall, a weapon held in his shaking hand.
一名囚犯颤抖着从墙壁后走出，连带着手中的武器一起。

García: I was just setting up my exhibit when everything started shaking. Then I realized it wasn't just my imagination.
加西亚：我在展厅布展的时候，留意到监狱忽然震动了，然后我发现这并非我的幻觉。

García: So I followed the cracks in the wall and found my way here.
加西亚：我顺着墙壁的裂缝，找到了通往这里的路……

García: I didn't mean to eavesdrop, but something's happening to the Panopticon, isn't it?
加西亚：我并非有意偷听你们的对话，但……监狱正在发生着某种变化，对吗?!

His panicked hands shift the gun toward Aleph, who has collapsed on his side.
他神色仓惶地将枪口移向倒在一旁的阿莱夫。

García: Are you the Physician? Or is it Aleph?
加西亚：您就是狱医先生吗？……还是说，阿莱夫先生?

García: Whoever you are, please, please restore the Panopticon to the way it was! I'm begging you!
加西亚：不管是谁，拜托您了，拜托了……求您让监狱恢复原样吧……

García: You-You can do that, right?
加西亚：您一定……一定能做到的对吗!

Aleph: ...
阿莱夫：……

The mind that once created infinity now watches as it folds back into nothing before him.
曾经创造了无限的魔法师，如今只是沉默地注视着面前所发生的一切。

García: Why? Why aren't you doing anything? Damn it! Why is this happening?
加西亚：……该死，该死！怎么会这样!!

García: Oh, oh, the die! If you won't help me, then I'll do it myself!
加西亚：对了，那个骰子在哪儿?!既然如此，我只能……

The prisoner, in desperation, lunges forward.
处于绝境中的囚犯冲了上来。

Recoleta: Calm down, García!
虚构集：冷静点，加西亚!!

Sonetto: Timekeeper, he's ...
十四行诗：司辰，他……

García, weakened by his long confinement, is easily knocked to the ground, unable to withstand even the lightest touch of arcane skill.
久居监狱的囚犯被轻易地打倒在地，虚弱无力的他，甚至没能抵挡住神秘术的轻轻一击。

García: Why? Why is this happening to me?
加西亚：为什么，为什么会这样……

García: I was so close ... so close to completing the exhibition.
加西亚：我只是想完成我的展览。只差一点，另一个我只差一点的调整……

Recoleta: Can't you see, García? There is no one controlling this place now! You're free!
虚构集：加西亚，你还不明白吗？控制者的消失，代表着监狱中的一切都结束了……你自由了啊！

Recoleta: It isn't the die that's trapped you, nor is it the walls of this prison.
虚构集：一直以来，困住你的不是这个骰子，不是这座监狱，而是那些你没法看到的东西。

Recoleta: It's the rules and that overpowering gaze from the central tower, but now that's all gone.
虚构集：那些规训，那些权力的视线……它们都消失了。

Recoleta: You can go outside. You can set up your exhibit anywhere you want. No need to stay stuck in this—
虚构集：你可以去外边，去任何地方办你的展览，而不用一直被困在这个地方——

Looking back on all that he has lost, the artist cuts her off.
失去了一切的艺术家打断了对方的话。

García: No, Ms. Recoleta. You've seen the world out there. You know as well as I ...
加西亚：……你不懂，虚构集小姐。你从外面而来，你应该比我更清楚才对。

García: ... that there's nowhere else I can go but here.
加西亚：除了这里，我哪里都去不了。

García: This is the only place in the world where I can hold my exhibit.
加西亚：除了这里，我没有地方，可以办我的展览……

García: And you've ruined it. You've ruined everything.
加西亚：你把这一切都毁了。

Recoleta: ...
虚构集：……

Vertin: This room's about to collapse. We've got to leave.
维尔汀：这个瞭望塔中的房间马上要坍塌了，我们先离开吧。

Vertin: Mr. García, do you need a hand?
维尔汀：加西亚先生，您是否需要帮助?

García: I can take care of myself, thank you.
加西亚：……我可以自己走，谢谢你们。

García: I ... I'll go a different way. I have to go back and finish setting up my exhibit.
加西亚：我……我要回去完成我的展览，应该与你们不同路。

He drags himself forward with trudging steps, retracing his path to leave.
他挪动着沉重的脚步，顺着原路离开了这里。

Recoleta: Vertin, what about Aleph? We can't just leave him here.
虚构集：维尔汀，那阿莱夫呢？我们不能把他就这样丢在这儿……

Vertin: Of course not. We still have questions he needs to answer.
维尔汀：我们仍有一些疑问需要阿莱夫先生的解答。

Vertin: Sonetto, help me get him up. Let's get out of here.
维尔汀： 十四行诗，我们扶起阿莱夫先生，大家一起离开这里吧。

Sonetto: Yes, Timekeeper.
十四行诗： 好的，司辰。

The dejected prisoner looks at Sonetto with confusion.
颓然的囚徒略感疑惑地看向身边的第一助手。

Aleph: Your words are always at odds with your thoughts. You carry an ocean of questions, yet never reveal even a single drop of them.
阿莱夫： 你的言语总与所想分道扬镳。你的疑惑如此频繁，错综复杂，却也显得隐秘。

Aleph: Why have you never shared your doubts? Why do you stay silent in the face of everything and everyone around you?
阿莱夫： 为何你从来不发问？对周遭发生的一切，对身边的人与事物……

Sonetto: ...!
十四行诗： ……！

Sonetto: I ... I believe in my duty.
十四行诗： 我相信……我的使命……

The prisoner shifts his gaze to the other Foundation investigator.
囚徒的视线转向戴帽子的女孩。

Aleph: As for you, Paracausality Researcher. You're different from any other seeker of answers.
阿莱夫： 而能量扰动学家……我留意到，你和所有的求索者都不相同。

Aleph: Even on a desperate, near hopeless journey, your heart holds little doubt.
阿莱夫： 即使在这样一场孤注一掷的旅途中，你也很少产生疑惑。

Vertin: Perhaps not every question needs an answer, Mr. Aleph.
维尔汀： 阿莱夫先生，我想，不是每个问题都必须有答案。

Aleph: Is that so?
阿莱夫： ……是吗。

The prisoner, so used to answering others' questions, seems to have run into one of his own. But unfortunately, no one is here to answer it.
总是在解答他人问题的囚徒因此陷入了沉默之中。但遗憾的是，这次也没有人能解答他的迷思。

愚人船
Ship of Fools 小径

Look, it's sinking. Corpses float on the planks, and the fleeing prisoners are swimming toward the shore. Time to abandon ship.
???: 该撤退了，这艘船就要沉了。散落的破木板上挂着尸骸，逃亡的囚徒已经争相游向海岸。

选项 / Choices

1. What ship?
1. 什么船

One that was exiled to a desolate corner of the ocean by the resplendent civilized world.
???: 一艘被光辉靓丽的文明世界驱逐到无人之海的船。

It's both a prison and a sanitarium. Are any of your friends aboard? If so, you might find the following report a little offensive.
???: 既用作监狱，也用作病院，上面有你的熟人么？接下来的报告会很冒犯。

"Dregs of society" ... "Human scum" ... These are the terms used to describe its eccentric passengers.
???: 社会的毒瘤、渣滓……文明人有很多词形容船上的乘客。

To be fair, they do lack discipline and independence.
???: 这很中肯，他们确实缺乏纪律性和独立能力。

But that may well be a response to the heavy pain they've endured.
???: 可对于他们来说，或许只是涉入了过多痛苦导致的应激反应。

Some theorists suggest that they're innocent victims, trapped in the confines between rationality and irrationality, defined and redefined by historians as they please.
???: 理论学家也曾跳出来澄清，也有人说他们只是理性与非理性之间的囚徒，在历史中被不断重复定义的无辜者。

But let's ditch the theories and simplify things: the moment the shackle called "madness" was fastened around their necks—whether they were truly mentally ill or not—their lives were forever scarred.
???: 以上都是无意义的观念冲突，你可以只听我的总结——疯子，名为“疯癫”的枷锁已在他们的脖颈留下了一道道不褪的伤痕。

And now, the mad passengers are storming the shore.
???: 现在，疯子们正在抢滩登陆。

选项 / Choices

1. A favorable outcome.
1. 这是一件好事

2. They're spreading their disease.
2. 这是在散播疫病

分支 1 / Branch 1

I suppose it is. You can see the joy in their faces, even in the footprints they leave behind as they hop across the beach.
???: 那些游向彼岸的人欣喜若狂的表情清晰可见，还有他们在海滩上畅快奔跑留下的足印。

Yes, freedom is favorable, indeed. The freedom to squander our lives, to trample on the dignity of others, the freedom to embrace absurdity and meaninglessness.
???: 自由，是的，这是一件好事。我们自此拥有作践自己的生命，糟蹋他人的尊严，以及选择拥抱荒诞和无意义的自由。

分支 2 / Branch 2

But one can gain immunity through controlled infection—the disease can become its own vaccine.
???: 预先并可控地感染疾病也可以当作疫苗用。

Just beware of the ignorant commander who deifies a wandering lunatic in pursuit of a little knowledge.
???: 可要是有哪位无知的上将，为了新鲜的知识而将流浪的疯子捧为神，那就得戒备了。

Let's dig deeper—scavenge through the messy battlefield for dog tags—were these people born mad?
???: 再让我们深究一下——就像在战场的烂肉堆里捡狗牌一样。这些人生来就带疯病吗?

After watching the inhabitants of this earth tear each other apart in one war after another, I've concluded this: only knowledge drives people to madness; ignorance does not.
???: 在看过那么多彼此倾轧的战争后，我的个人理解是：只有知识会让人发疯，无知不会。

Madness is a side effect of the sedative that is "knowledge." As long as those on land continue to consume it, this ship will never be short on recruits.
???: 疯癫，只是“知识”这一镇定剂的副作用。只要陆地上的人还食用着知识，这艘船的兵源，就不会断。

This is a war between madness and civilization. Both sides have leveled accusations, spilled blood, and pummeled each other ...
???: 这就是战争，文明人和疯子之间的战争，互相把对方打为异类，然后互相沾上对方的血，互相倾轧……

... and soon, everyone will have leapt into the trenches and beaten and been beaten to a bloody pulp. Only a few can escape this fate.
???: 直到所有人都跳进战壕里，杀作一团分不清来源的肉球。仅少数人能回避这命运。

选项 / Choices

1. Like who?
1. 比如谁?

Check your six.
???: 你后面，六点钟方向。

The one leaning against the sunken ship, showing no signs of struggle or sorrow—García.
???: 那位倚靠在沉船上，既不挣扎，也不哀嚎的“加西亚”。

The seawater has flooded his windpipe and reddened his eyes, yet there he is, staring blankly at the shore ...
???: 海水已经侵入他的气管，呛得他眼珠红肿，而他望向陆地，就这么干巴巴地望着……

He's in his home base. He holds no hope for forgiveness from his enemies—not in the slightest. He's a one-man army, fighting only for himself. Alone.
???: 他已经身处自己的指挥部，毫不期盼敌人的原谅。他一人成军，为自己而战。

Now, do a 360 and look again—he's been utterly defeated.
???: 然后，请你再原地转体一周，一个回头的功夫，当你再看向他，他已经全军覆没了。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Ship of Fools
愚人船

科马拉诸相
Aspects of Madness 9TH-19

Aspects of Madness
科马拉诸相

Vertin: "Dear Urd,"
维尔汀: “敬爱的兀尔德女士：”

Vertin: "Why are you so interested in the Panopticon of Comala?"
维尔汀: “是什么让你对监狱中的一切起了兴趣?”

Vertin: "Dear Mr. Aleph,"
维尔汀: “敬爱的阿莱夫阁下：”

Dores: Whether as a doctor or a writer, I simply cannot turn a blind eye to the friction around me, especially the discord and injustice I've witnessed here in Comala.
德洛丝： 不论是作为医生还是作家，我恐怕都难以漠视身边的种种境况，尤其在科马拉这般充满冲突与不公的场所。

Dores: So, I would ask of you a question: Is there any way to resolve the endless conflicts in this place?
德洛丝： 若您能给予指点，我希望询问一个问题：有什么方法能够让这座监狱中那无休无止的纷争平息下来?

Aleph: To put an end to this, a true ending is required.
阿莱夫： 要终止这一切，必须获得一个真正的故事结局。

Aleph: Your arrival has made it possible for this simulation to have an ending—or rather, a victory.
阿莱夫： 您的到来，使得本轮的模拟可能迎来此等结局，亦可视为一种胜利。

Dores: What do you mean by "victory"? I'd appreciate it if you could clarify in simple terms. If this victory comes at the cost of any inmate's life, I'm afraid I cannot accept it.
德洛丝： 胜利是指什么呢？希望您给予更加直白的解答。如果这份胜利的代价将会侵害其他囚犯的生命，恐怕我并不能接受。

Dores: I also have another question for you: If I leave, will the stories and conflicts here come to an end?
德洛丝： 另外，请您回答我另一个问题：
若我离开，这里的故事与纷争会因此终止吗?

Aleph: Ms. Grace of Manus Vindictae will grant you passage. But in any case, the cycle of history will continue to repeat itself in this prison, and in the entire world.
阿莱夫： 重塑之手的淑女格蕾丝会为您放行。
但这不过是历史的闭环，周而复始的故事只会在这个监狱里一直上演。

Aleph: The sins of humankind will not cease until veins turn to wires, flesh and bone to geometric shapes, and the world around us twists in the colors of an oil painting.
阿莱夫： 就像我们曾经历过无数次时代的恶习那般，一切并不会停止，直至血管变成通讯电线，器官变成几何式零件，所有的一切都化作油彩。

Dores: I must say, your words have left me rather baffled. Fragments of the events you describe often appear in my dreams. Could it be that these things really happened?
德洛丝： 您的话让我感到茫然。您提到的那些事件曾出现在我的梦境中，像一段段破碎的幻想。难道它们都真实存在过吗?

Dores: If that's the case, why can't I recall the details? Why am I left with only disconnected pieces?
德洛丝： 但如果它们真实地存在，为何我记不清所有的细节，只有支离的片段……?

Dores: The madness in Comala, these bizarre dreams ... I must put an end to them.
德洛丝： 无论是科马拉监狱，亦或是这些怪异的梦境，我必须让这一切停止下来……

Dores: What have I forgotten? Has someone or something altered my memory? I can't shake the feeling that something crucial to me has been lost in the river of time. Some kind of duty, perhaps.
德洛丝： 我到底遗忘了什么？我的记忆被某种力量篡改了吗？我感到有某种重要的事物遗失在了时间的河流之中。也许是某个使命，也许是某种责任……

Dores: What should I do? How can I recapture what I've lost?
德洛丝： 如果要找回我所遗忘的一切，我应该怎么做?

Aleph: I won't answer a question that already has an answer, one given to you by the person who escorted you here and made you a promise.
阿莱夫：我不会回答一个已有答案的问题。
护送您前来的人一早就告诉了您答案，并许下了一个承诺。

Aleph: You're so close to the place where the truth lies. Think carefully. Why are you here?
阿莱夫：您已距离那个存放真相的地点十分接近。请好好回想一下，您为何会身处此地?

Vertin: These letters we found have answered a great deal, but there's still something that isn't clear.
维尔汀：这些我们在瞭望塔的等候室中找到的信件，说明了一切。

Vertin: Mr. Aleph, what exactly did the Manus promise Dr. Dores?
维尔汀：阿莱夫先生，请你告诉我们，重塑之手究竟和德洛丝女士许诺了什么?

Aleph: An era. A chance for her to remember her duty.
阿莱夫：一个时代。一个能让一无所知的她，记忆起自己使命的机会。

Vertin: An era?
维尔汀：一个时代……?

Vertin: You helped her leave the Panopticon in the end. Where did she go?
维尔汀：所以最后，德洛丝女士请求你将她送到哪里去了?

Momentarily roused from his dream, the prisoner looks blankly for a moment before his gaze drifts back toward the distant illusion.
从梦中短暂清醒过来的囚徒沉默了片刻，最后，他的视线看向了虚幻而不存在的远处。

Aleph: Southward.
阿莱夫：南方。

Aleph: There, on the no-man's continent, Manus Vindictae is preparing to recreate the parable of the past and future.
阿莱夫：在那片无人的大陆上，重塑之手准备实现那个关于过去与未来的寓言。

Aleph: A glorious past and a glimmering future belonging to arcanists.
阿莱夫：一个真正属于神秘学家的时代，一段辉煌的过去，也是所有人的未来。

Aleph: Dr. Dores is deeply connected to this particular parable.
阿莱夫：而德洛丝女士，与这个寓言有着最深层的联系。

Sonetto: Hmm. What exactly are the Manus planning to do in Antarctica?
十四行诗：重塑之手究竟在南极筹备着什么……?

Sonetto: And why would Dr. Dores go there voluntarily?
十四行诗：但德洛丝女士是主动前往南极，而并非受到了重塑之手的胁迫……

The information revealed stirs unease in the hearts of the investigators from the Foundation.
问话中得到的信息，让基金会的来客心中隐隐滋生不安。

Vertin: Mr. Aleph, when did Dr. Dores depart?
维尔汀：阿莱夫先生，请问她是什么时候启程的?

Aleph: It was a day when both the clouds and sun were visible.
阿莱夫：那是一个同时能看到阴云与太阳的日子。

Vertin: A day when both the clouds and sun were visible? Could you be more specific?
维尔汀：同时能看到阴云与太阳的日子……？所以，大概是多久之前?

Aleph: Specific? You mean the time of day?
阿莱夫：具体的……时间?

His mind long ago lost any sense of time, a necessary exchange to make room for an infinite cosmos of words.
对于能记忆世界上所有书本的每一行字的人而言，他早已丧失了对时间的感知，所能依靠的仅有文字的细节。

He once again finds himself without an answer.
无问不答的魔法师陷入了沉默。

Recoleta: When both clouds and the sun were visible? Hey, Vertin, I think I know!
虚构集：同时能看到阴云与太阳……？维尔汀，我知道了！

Recoleta: It was three days ago! Then, Dr. Dores wasn't going to Comala on the day I met her.
虚构集：是三天前！我在街上遇到德洛丝女士的那一天，她并不是在那时候进入监狱的。

Recoleta: She was leaving. She was headed to Antarctica!
虚构集：那是她离开科马拉监狱，前往南极的日子！

Recoleta: It was cloudy that afternoon, with a brief spell of sunshine, just like Aleph described.
虚构集：同阿莱夫所说的一样，那是一个被阴云遮蔽的下午，但短暂地出了一会儿太阳……

Vertin: Then it hasn't been long since she left. Excellent news.
维尔汀：德洛丝女士启程的时间离得并不远……这是一个好消息。

Sonetto: Three days. If we set off immediately, we might still catch up to her.
十四行诗：三天的时间……如果我们马上出发，应该仍有机会追上她。

Sonetto: But based on the intel we gathered in Ushuaia, Manus Vindictae bombed the entire port three days ago.
十四行诗：但根据我们在乌斯怀亚当地所收集的信息，重塑之手在三日前轰炸了港口的码头。

Sonetto: Clearly, they wanted to prevent any interference from the Foundation. It's unlikely we'll find any functioning ships there.
十四行诗：现在，没有任何一艘完整的船能够起航……也许这正是重塑之手的打算：他们想要阻止基金会的介入。

Sonetto: I'll report the situation to the Buenos Aires branch. Timekeeper, I'm afraid we'll have to find another way to get there.
十四行诗：我会将这里的信息回报给基金会布宜诺斯艾利斯分部。司辰，我们需要寻找别的前往方式。

Aleph: I have a boat.
阿莱夫：我有一艘船。

A small boat gifted by Manus Vindictae.
一艘由重塑所赠送的小船。

During the past several "Storms," he has taken this boat, traveling to Antarctica at Manus Vindictae's invitation to evade the reversion.
在往常的数次“暴雨”中，这位科马拉的囚徒正是搭乘它，多次应重塑的邀请前往南极大陆，以躲避回溯。

Vertin: Could you lend it to us? The situation's urgent, Mr. Aleph.
维尔汀：时间紧迫，阿莱夫先生，你愿意把这艘船借给我们吗?

Secret Dock, Ushuaia
乌斯怀亚·隐藏码头

Beneath a decrypted lighthouse, a battered little boat bobs in sync with the waves.
古老高耸的灯塔旁，一艘破旧不堪的小船正在海浪中摇晃。

It is small and fragile, not the kind that seems capable of braving an icy sea.
它看起来如此的渺小，如此的脆弱，仿佛下一个瞬间就会被无情的冰流吞没。

Aleph: This boat will automatically take you to McMurdo Port, the landing point Manus Vindictae established by the shores of the Ross Sea.
阿莱夫：这艘船会自动将你们送至麦克默多港口，重塑之手在南极罗斯海建立的登陆点。

Sonetto eyes the boat with skepticism, rightfully distrusting this "advisor" of Manus Vindictae.
第一助手将信将疑地打量着面前的小船。她对这位重塑之手的“顾问”并无太多的信任。

Sonetto: This looks like Manus technology. Its arcane energy source is highly unstable.
十四行诗：这艘小船，是重塑的工艺吗？它的神秘学能源十分不稳定……

Sonetto: Timekeeper, I suggest we wait for support in Ushuaia.
十四行诗：司辰，也许我们在乌斯怀亚等待基金会的救援会比较好。

Recoleta: I don't usually agree with Sonetto, but I have to admit, I don't have much confidence that a boat this small can actually make it to Antarctica.
虚构集：我很少有认同十四行诗的时候，但不得不说，对于这艘小船能否安全跨越南极周围的洋流，我也持怀疑态度。

Vertin: Mr. Aleph, do you know anything about Manus Vindictae's ritual? How far has it progressed?
维尔汀：阿莱夫先生，你知道重塑之手筹备的仪式，现在进行到何种地步了吗？

Aleph: The ritual could begin at any moment. I believe that's why they left Comala.
阿莱夫：仪式随时会开始——我想，这是重塑之手撤离科马拉监狱的理由。

Aleph: Upon departure, one of their members, a woman named Grace, told me they would seal off the sea.
阿莱夫：在重塑之手离去之时，名为淑女格蕾丝的信徒告诉我，他们会封锁这片海面。

Sonetto: Are we too late?
十四行诗：怎会如此，已经来不及了吗……

Aleph: If you wish to find Dores, you must follow the same path she took.
阿莱夫：如果你们想要找到德洛丝女士，你们就必须踏上这条相同的道路。

The distant drone of the raging waves fills their background like a repeating omen.
沉默的时刻，只有汹涌的海浪一如既往，如同某种循环往复的预示。

Vertin: I see. Mr. Aleph, members of the Foundation branch will arrive soon to evaluate your condition. I hope you'll answer their questions with the same patience you showed us. Thank you.
维尔汀：我明白了。阿莱夫先生，后续会有基金会分部的成员前来，对你的行为与病情进行评估，希望你也能耐心地回答他们的问题。

Vertin: Sonetto, let's go.
维尔汀：十四行诗，我们出发吧。

Sonetto: Yes, Timekeeper.
十四行诗：……好的，司辰。

As always, Sonetto keeps any mission-irrelevant queries to herself.
同往常一样，第一助手依旧没有提出自己的疑问。

The girls preparing to set sail turn to the young writer beside them.
准备启航的女孩们转向一旁的青年作家。

Vertin: Thank you for your assistance too, Recoleta. Perhaps you'll consider joining the—
维尔汀：也感谢你这段时间的协助，虚构集。也许你对加入基金会——

A thunderous crash echoes from behind them—the sound of a collapsing building.
就在此时，身后传来了建筑物轰然崩塌的巨大声响。

Recoleta: What was that? It came from the Panopticon!
虚构集：发生了什么?！这个方向是……科马拉监狱！

亦去亦返
A Journey to and Fro 小径

A Journey to and Fro
亦去亦返

I return once more to Comala Prison. To me, this massive cage is no longer an inescapable labyrinth. When I left, the lady from Manus Vindictae did not stop me, yet I could still feel her gaze—so sorrowful, so blurred, so cold—never once shifting away from me.

On the streets of Ushuaia, a young girl pointed me back toward the prison. That severed thread tugged at my heart, and I knew with certainty that my mission lay here. If I were placed before "fate," my life and death would seemingly follow a predetermined path to its destined end. And as I walk this path, I must carry not even a shred of hesitation.

It is time to speak with "Aleph," the one who answers all questions.
我还是回到了科马拉监狱。如今，于我而言，这座巨大的囚笼并非不可逃离的迷宫。在我离开科马拉监狱时，那位重塑之手的女士未曾阻拦我，但我仍然能感受到她的视线，如此悲伤、朦胧与寒冷，从未从我身上移开。
在乌斯怀亚的大街上，一位少女为我指明了返回监狱的道路。那截断线牵引着我的心神，我确信，我所追寻的使命就在此处。如果将我置于“命运”前，我的生死似乎也会以一个固定的路径走向它应有的终点。而我，在走上这条道路的同时，也不该带有任何的迟疑。
是时候与那位无问不答的“阿莱夫”先生谈话了。

灰烬安放地
In the Place of My Ashes 9TH-20

In the Place of My Ashes
灰烬安放地

Blazing flames reflect in their eyes, just like the name of this island might suggest.
熊熊烈火映照在每一个人的眼瞳里——就如同这座岛屿名字的由来一样。

A winter night stands sentinel over a great conflagration as every brick of Comala Prison crumbles and falls.
冬夜燃起的火光之中，科马拉监狱的每一块砖石都在脱落、崩塌，朝着无可挽回的方向溃败。

Recoleta: With Aleph's control gone, Comala is collapsing.
虚构集： 离开了阿莱夫的控制，科马拉监狱正在瓦解……

Recoleta: The inmates aren't even real criminals, are they? And they're still in there, with no clue that they're no longer being watched from the central tower!
虚构集： 那些囚犯，他们并不是真正的犯人对吗……他们还不知道发生了什么事情！他们不知道监视视线的消失，也不知道操纵者的离开。

Recoleta: We have to go tell them! We have to get them to safety!
虚构集： 需要有人告诉他们这个消息，得让他们到安全的地方去……

Vertin: Yes, we should help them get out, at least until support arrives.
维尔汀： 我们要设法保障监狱中人员的安全。至少，得等到官方救援人员的到来。

Vertin: But the Manus ritual ...
维尔汀： 但重塑之手的仪式……

The battered boat sways within their sight.
那艘破败的小船在众人的视线中摇晃着。

Recoleta: Don't worry. I'll go alone.
虚构集：我会回科马拉监狱去的。

Vertin: Huh?
维尔汀：嗯……？

Recoleta: You should hurry. When this is all over, I'll write to you, my dear friend!
虚构集：维尔汀，你们抓紧时间出发吧！当这儿的一切都结束之后，我会给你写信的，我亲爱的朋友！

Recoleta: During this journey together, our teamwork has been impeccable. So, you can trust me to do this.
虚构集：这一路上我们都配合得如此天衣无缝，你该把这个任务放心地交给我！

Recoleta: I'm not doing it just to help you or the organization you represent. I'm doing it because the inmates are my friends.
虚构集：这不仅仅是协助你们，也和你们背后所代表的组织无关。因为监狱中的囚犯们，也都是我的朋友……

Vertin: Okay. I trust you.
维尔汀：我相信你。

Vertin: Take care of yourself, Recoleta.
维尔汀：在救援中，请注意自己的安全，虚构集。

Sonetto: But if the "Storm" truly is imminent, as Dr. Merlin said, then, Ms. Recoleta, you'll ...
十四行诗：如果真如狱医所说，“暴雨”即将来临，虚构集小姐，你……

Sonetto, more familiar than anyone with the Foundation's exhaustive regulations, has no ready answer. She knows that, in this era, before those arcanists who remain ignorant of the truth, she must watch her words.
比谁都更清楚基金会那些繁复条例的第一助手陷入了沉默。她知晓，身处时代之中，面对那些对真相一无所知的神秘学家，她一个字都不能多说。

Recoleta: I don't quite understand what this "Storm" is all about, but don't worry. A brand-new adventure is the best thing that can happen to a writer.
虚构集：虽然我不知道你们提到的“暴雨”究竟是什么，但别担心！对一位作家来说，所有新奇的冒险都再好不过了！

Recoleta: And I doubt it'll surpass the epic adventures we've shared over the past couple of days. I'm going to write everything, including the two of you, into my new novel.
虚构集：嗯，我想，没有什么比这两天的经历更具有传奇色彩了，我要把这一切都写进我的新小说里，包括你们大家……

Vertin: Then I'd like to be the first to read this new novel, if that's alright?
维尔汀：你的新小说，我们是否能成为它的第一批读者？

Recoleta: Of course. Listen, I believe literature is like an endless, timeless river.
虚构集：当然！我相信文字是一条跨越时间与空间的河流。

Recoleta: So we'll meet again someday, somewhere, probably in someone else's story. Who knows?
虚构集：维尔汀，总有一天，我们会在别人的故事里再次相遇的。

She takes one last look at her new friends, feeling a longing as if they had known each other for decades.
她最后看了一眼这些可爱的新朋友们，就像她们已经认识了数十年一样。

Then, without a backward glance, the girl sprints back to the burning ruins of the prison.
女孩头也不回地跑向燃烧中的科马拉监狱。

Recoleta: Farewell, my cherished friends!
虚构集：再见了，我的朋友！

I hear a sound in the distance
远方的风中传来你的呼唤
Escucho algo en la distancia

Guiding me on to a land of existence
在黑暗中照亮我梦想的前路
que me indica el camino a la fantasia

So I journey on to a path that feels real
我将前往没有悲伤的旅途
y emprendo mi andar a una ruta real

There is a voice that's calling me
你的呼唤让我前行
hay una voz llamandome

To somewhere far—
归于永恒的国度
a otro lugar

Have mercy, please!
怜爱吧
ten piedad!

For happiness, I sing to you
我衷心赞颂 你的幸福
Por la felicidad yo te canto

And for freedom, I sing to you
我衷心赞颂 你的自由
y por la libertad yo te canto

Nothing can break me, nothing bring me down
无人能阻止我燃烧的心灵
nada podrá parar ni vencer mi ser

Like a child I leap around
如故事的回忆中 我轻盈地奔跑 跳跃着
como en la infancia voy saltando

For happiness, I sing to you ...
我衷心赞颂 你的幸福
Por la felicidad yo te canto……

All the visitors depart one after another.
所有的访客都相继离去了。

Amid the distant echo of singing, the "creator" of this prison stares into the fire as it burns.
在遥遥传来的歌声里，监狱的“造物主”静静地望着起火的建筑。

The moment holds for a time, until a breathless jaguar appears at the dock's edge, staring at the human before her with uncertainty.
直至气喘吁吁的美洲豹出现在码头的一侧。她惊疑不定地看着面前的人类。

Jailer: Dr. Merlin. You're Dr. Merlin, right? I finally found you.
狱卒：梅林先生……您是梅林先生对吗?！终于找到您了！

Jailer: What on earth happened in the central tower? Right after I left, the whole Panopticon started collapsing. The tower's in ruin.
狱卒：瞭望塔里究竟发生了什么事情……？在我离开房间不久后，监狱忽然就开始崩塌，瞭望塔也不复存在了……

Jailer: I've been looking for you everywhere. Please, sir, come with me. It isn't saf—
狱卒：我找了很久，终于在这里找到了您。请随我来，梅林先生，这里并不安全——

Aleph: That won't be necessary.
阿莱夫：没必要了。

Aleph: The snow is still falling, yet everything in the labyrinth has already gone up in flames.
阿莱夫：雪还没有停，迷宫的一切却早已付之一炬。

Aleph: Fortune, fate, karma—They're nothing but a ridiculous joke.
阿莱夫：所有吉凶祸福，命运的奥秘，都只是一场荒谬的玩笑。

Aleph: It's over, jaguar. You have lost your memories, your identity, your name, and now, your title. You are no longer a jailer trapped in the Panopticon.
阿莱夫：丢失了自己记忆、身份和名字的美洲豹，一切都结束了。你不再是被困在科马拉的狱卒。

Jailer: I don't get it, Dr. Merlin. What are you talking about?
狱卒：……梅林先生，我听不懂您在说什么。

The jailer takes a step back, her predator instincts sensing the danger in the words to come.
狱卒后退了一步。属于大型捕食者的直觉让她本能地抗拒接下来的话。

The damage may not be physical, but it threatens to shatter what little faith she has left to hold onto, and the life she has always known.
她有预感，那会击碎她一直以来的信仰，还有她习以为常的生活。

Jailer: I'm-I'm going back to Comala. Order must be maintained. The prisoners mustn't be allowed to escape.
狱卒：我、我要回去科马拉监狱了。我需要回去维持监狱的秩序，防止囚犯们趁乱逃跑……

Jailer: Please take care, Dr. Merlin.
狱卒：我先走了，梅林先生，您多保重……

Nerves torn between panic and hesitation, the jailer at last turns toward the searing flames.
仓惶犹疑的狱卒忍受着烈火的高温，往监狱的方向奔去。

Jailer: Hey, you! Don't run off like that. It's dangerous!
狱卒：嘿，你！不要乱跑，这很危险!!

No one heeds her cries.
无人顾忌她的呐喊。

One prisoner after another flees in terror, escaping the crumbling labyrinth.
一个又一个的囚犯夺路而逃，面色惊慌地逃离这座崩塌中的古老迷宫。

Inmate I: In deserts, in stars, in labyrinths!
囚犯 I：我们在荒漠，在恒星，在迷宫……!

Inmate II: We dream on death's straw pillow!
囚犯 II：我们在村庄，做梦，与死亡贴脸颊……!

The jailer drifts through the raging scene, unable to steer a sensible course. At last, she pins down a frail and powerless prisoner beneath her weight.
狱卒如同一条在海浪中彷徨的小舟，完全无法把握行进的方向。终于，一个瘦弱无力的囚犯被美洲豹扑倒在地。

Jailer: Stop!
狱卒：快停下！！

???: Get off me! Let me go!
???：放过我！我想要离开……

???: Are you blind? The Panopticon is falling apart!
???：你没看到吗，这里太危险了！监狱已经快崩塌了！！

Jailer: It's you, Roberta.
狱卒：……是你，罗贝托。

The jailer recognizes the prisoner under her grip.
狱卒认出了这名被制住的囚犯。

Roberta, a kind and quiet prisoner, always well-behaved, now panicked and desperate to escape.
罗贝托，美洲诗社的成员，一个在监狱中热心、善良、安分守己的囚犯。一个逃跑的囚犯。

Roberta: They're all mad! I knew it. They've been insane from the start!
罗贝托：他们……他们都疯了！我早就知道，他们本来就是疯子……！

Roberta: The whole place is burning to the ground, and they still won't leave! They're still talking and talking about things that no one cares about.
罗贝托：这里已经着火了，他们还不愿意离开，还念叨着那些无人在意的东西……

Roberta: Ah! I can't help them. I've never understood what they were talking about—the rhythms, the factions, the ideologies ...
罗贝托：我……我帮不了他们，我也没法帮他们，我从来都不理解那些他们提到的玩意儿，什么韵律、派系、主义……

Roberta: Yes, the people were nice, the Idealist, too, but I've had enough of this prison. I've had enough of the Panopticon.
罗贝托：是的，诗社的一切都很好，理想家先生人也很好，但我受够监狱了，我受够科马拉的一切了……

She collapses onto the ground, sobbing.
她趴在地上痛哭着。

Roberta: I never should've joined these movements. It was all meaningless from the beginning.
罗贝托：我后悔了，从一开始，我就不该参加那些运动的，那些反抗根本毫无意义！！

Roberta: I wanna leave this place—go to Spain or France, anywhere but here. I want to go back to Magdalena.
罗贝托：我想去欧洲，去西班牙或者法国，我不要待在这儿了……我想回到玛格达莱娜身边。

Jailer: Huh ...
狱卒：啊……

The jaguar releases her grip. Without a backward glance, Roberta leaves.
美洲豹移开了制住囚犯的爪子。对方头也不回地离开了这里。

The jailer steps back into the circular structure she knows as her only home.
狱卒走进了这栋她最熟悉的环形建筑。

For happiness, I sing to you
我衷心赞颂 你的幸福

And for freedom, I sing to you
我衷心赞颂 你的自由

Nothing can break me, nothing bring me down
无人能阻止我燃烧的心灵

Under the night sky, she sees Comala Prison glowing like a brilliant bonfire.
夜幕下，她看到科马拉监狱如同一堆明亮的篝火，闪烁着前所未有的、撼动人心的亮光。

Jailer: ♫...
狱卒: ♫……

Three days ago
三天前

Street, Ushuaia
乌斯怀亚·街道

Dores: But how does literature make you feel?
德洛丝: 那么，它给你带来了一种怎样的感受呢?

Recoleta: As though I'm a kid looking through a kaleidoscope for the first time.
虚构集: ……感受吗？有时我觉得自己像个学习口语的孩子，正努力地念出书本第一页的第一个词汇。

Recoleta: Well, maybe that's not the best way to put it. Perhaps something a little more subtle.
虚构集: 等等，这个比喻也许并不恰当，需要更为精妙、更为直观的……

The young writer drowns in the vortex of words as the blind woman walks away.
在青年作家陷入文字的漩涡之时，盲眼的女士已经独自走远了。

She walks silently toward Comala Prison, arriving at the dock hidden between cliffs and reefs.
她静静地朝着科马拉监狱的方向走去，来到了藏匿在悬崖与礁石后的码头。

There, the prisoner who answers all questions awaits her arrival.
在那儿，解答疑惑的囚徒正等待着她的到来。

Dores: A ship sailing to an unfamiliar land.
德洛丝: 一艘船。去往一片陌生的土地。

Dores: A parable of the past and future. An era that once existed and is yet to come.
德洛丝: ……一个代表过去与未来的寓言，一个曾经存在、即将到来的时代。

Dores: Is this the answer you've provided, Mr. Aleph?
德洛丝: 这就是您所提供的回答吗，阿莱夫先生?

Aleph: No, Urd. You will have to find this answer yourself.
阿莱夫: 不，兀尔德女士，这是一个需要您自己去寻找的回答。

Aleph: No one can help you with this—no one.
阿莱夫: 没有人能帮助您。没有人。

Dores: I see. Thank you, Mr. Aleph. I will remember what you've told me.
德洛丝: 我明白了。谢谢您，阿莱夫先生，我会记住您所对我说的话。

So the platonic year
因此柏拉图年
<So the platonic year>

Whirls out new right and wrong,
席卷出新的是非观
<Whirls out new right and wrong,>

Whirls in the old instead;
而卷入旧的观念
<Whirls in the old instead;>

All men are dancers and their tread
所有人都是舞者，他们的舞步
<All men are dancers and their tread>

Goes to the barbarous clangour of a gong.
迈入了野蛮铿锵的锣鼓声
<Goes to the barbarous clangour of a gong.>

W.B. Yeats—Nineteen Hundred and Nineteen
威廉·巴特勒·叶芝：《一九一九年》

密谈
A Secret Meeting 小径

The moment armies start to march, the world stands still.
???: 一场战争开启之时，世界便开始了原地踏步。

You fight or fall back, charge forward, or run. Those are the only rules on the battlefield.
???: 前进，撤退，冲锋，溃败，活在战场上不需要理解其他规则。

I don't see a start time on this report, nor does it state the reason for or the demands of this war.
???: 这份报告上甚至没有写它是何时开始的，也没有陈述战争的诉求。

选项 / Choices

1. That's because the war hasn't started yet.
1. 战争还未开始

2. Because this is a war waged with paper and pens.
2. 词句是文学的战场

分支 1 / Branch 1

That's what you think. The scars left on the land may be the most obvious form of destruction, but the true devastation of war is one that develops gradually in the souls of people.
???: 当然，你可以这样说。土地的疮痍总是触目惊心，灵魂的徘徊只能让人后知后觉。

分支 2 / Branch 2

Ah, a literary war. Indeed, the violence enacted upon words is often just as devastating as an order on a battlefield.
???: 作家施加在音节与词语上的暴力，不亚于一道非人性的军令。

Words must fulfill their duties to their creators, just as soldiers must answer to their commanders.
???: 士兵必须按照军令行事，文字也得跟随作家的意愿排列。

选项 / Choices

1. I still don't see how this relates to what's happening now.
1. 这与现在发生的又有什么关系

You don't? Hmm. The young writers have been exiled—sent down a path with no signs to follow and no destination.
???: 这是一场看不到结局的流浪，年轻的作家可用的道标并不多。

In dark days of bloody conflict, soldiers often find comfort in scriptures and verses—or in letters from their loved ones.
???: 正如在厮杀的间隙，一些战士会捧出宗教的箴言，另一些则会流连来自亲友的书信。

They hold those words close—a fragile piece of home—a brief solace from the roaring of the battlefield.
???: 他们通常将这称为归宿，靠它盖过炮弹的轰鸣声，来提醒自己保持人性。

But, as they fall one by one, they learn the bitter truth. No destiny awaits them but death, that bitter homesickness still weighing heavy in their hearts.
???: 但他们总会意识到自己很可能回不了家，迟早带着思乡病死在战场上。

选项 / Choices

1. I hope they can at least find some peace in their dreams.
1. 一场梦会是最好的良药

In dreams? Maybe. Walking the streets of your hometown, spending a lazy afternoon at the writing desk—dreams can take you anywhere.
???: 当然，梦会带你去往任何地方，不管是老家的街景，还是趴在桌上写书的下午。

But live there too long, and the lines between fiction and reality will blur, and soon you'll never wake up again.
???: 直到你分不清梦和现实，最后忘了如何醒来。

Soldiers crawl through trenches, roll in the mud, and charge to their deaths again and again ...
???: 士兵将在烂泥巴战壕里徘徊一生，士官长将一遍遍地发出送死的军令。

... while words are forever trapped within the confines of poetry, made to live, die, and live again under the golden prophecy ...
???: 而词句将永远逡巡于诗篇的结构里，诗篇永恒复苏在预言的律令下……

Ugh. I can't stand the way poets talk.
???: 诗人说话真是拗口。

共同接续 / Shared continuation

Excerpt from the New York Times
《纽约新闻报》节选

英文 / ENGLISH

Around midnight two days ago, a large fire broke out in the oak forest on the western outskirts. The delay of the warning and the complex terrains full of inflammables in the forest resulted in a fire that lasted a whole night till dawn and 13 deaths.
The victims entered the forest at dusk. Identities of 6 of them have been confirmed: the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers Tomson Joyce, Shelley Gerald, Kelly Keith, and the project manager Russell James. The others' are still being verified.

The Weyerhaeuser used to be a leader in the wood industry, yet it went bankrupt not long ago due to the wood supply crisis these years. After donating the formula of the Resurrection Potion (basic version) to the Maria Sanatorium in New York, the Sacred Heart Sanatorium in Ohio, and the Presbyterian Church Health Center on certain conditions, the Weyerhaeusers sold all of their forestry lands.
On the night of the fire, the Weyerhaeusers, their buyers, and the workers went into the forest to start the disafforestation project before they died. The police has found traces of arcanist's activities and a small amount of gasoline at the scene, which shows the case is an arson attack. More investigations are needed to identify the suspect.

Reporter: James Welles/Dorey Johnson

中文 / CHINESE

前日深夜，位于市郊西侧的橡木树林发生大范围火灾，由于预警不及，林中地形复杂且可燃物繁多，抢险困难，火势持续直至清晨时分才得以扑灭。

于当日黄昏时分进入森林的十三名人员全部遇难。死亡人员中已确认身份的六人，包括韦耶豪瑟夫妇，与其交易者汤姆森·乔伊斯、雪莱·杰拉德、凯利·基思，施工负责人罗素·詹姆斯。其余人员身份均在进一步核实中。

因近年来的木材供应风波，原本根基深重的韦耶豪瑟在前些日子宣告破产。韦耶豪瑟夫妇将基础版起死回生剂的配方，有偿捐赠与纽约玛利亚疗养院、俄亥俄州圣心疗养所与长老会医疗中心三方后，又将名下的所有林业用地对外抛售。

火情发生当晚，韦耶豪瑟夫妇与购买者三人带领工作小组进入森林，预备开始铲除作业，随后遇难。经市警署排查与分析，火情现场的残留有神秘学家活动与少量汽油的痕迹，已可确定为人为纵火案件。更多关于犯罪嫌疑人的信息仍在进一步调查当中。

报道记者：詹姆斯·威尔斯/多丽·约翰逊